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Rift shows limits of tough trade strategy

U.S.-Canada breakdown spotlights tensions, as other nations look on

BY DAVID J. LYNCH

The shocking collapse of U.S.-Canada trade talks is the latest sign that President Donald Trump's bulldozer approach to remaking the nation's trade relationships may be reaching its limits.

The president tried in recent days to use an untested legal power to force Canada to swallow trade concessions. Instead, Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney quit the negotiations rather than accept a lengthening list of U.S. demands.

As a result, 50 percent U.S. tariffs took effect early Saturday on an array of Canadian products, including hockey sticks and Crown Royal whiskey.

As Carney prepared to walk away — a rare example of a foreign leader telling the president “enough” — Trump was retreating on another trade front. On Friday, after insisting for more than a year that tariffs do not affect consumer prices, he lifted tariffs on beef imports, saying the move would lead to lower grocery prices.

The two developments, coupled with legal challenges to Trump's tariffs, leave the president's signature economic policy in a state of flux.

“It's a big setback for Trump's trade policy. We're at a juncture where other countries may be very closely watching how this plays out as they also are becoming increasingly frustrated with the demands the U.S. is placing on them in these largely one-sided

SEE TRADE ON A13

From a D.C. reporter to an investigator for Trump

How John Solomon became a sleuth for the administration

BY SCOTT NOVER

John Solomon, a longtime investigative reporter, says he's not a conspiracy theorist. He says he's not a conservative. He says he's not carrying water for President Donald Trump — for whom he now works.

Solomon has joined the White House as chairman of the newly formed and vaguely defined Government Transparency Task Force, where he is working to unearth and publicize government records at the heart of Trump's political persona — including allegations of election interference and political abuses by federal law enforcement.

The role, which is temporary and unpaid, is the culmination of an unusual journey for Solomon from an investigative reporter for the Associated Press and The Washington Post who dug into politicians of both parties into an increasingly prominent voice in conservative media echoing some of Trump's boldest claims.

He now is a kind of inside-the-SEE SOLOMON ON A6

Rubber meets road in D.C.



CHRIS GRAYTHEN/GETTY IMAGES

Kyle Kirkwood, a 27-year-old Floridian, won the Freedom 250 Grand Prix on Sunday. The event was the first IndyCar street race ever in the nation's capital, with a downtown track spanning 1.66 miles. **Story, C7**

Republicans pivot on data centers, flip to negative

BY JEREMY B. MERRILL

Sen. Jon Husted once promoted data centers as all upside for his state of Ohio. “Data centers are essential to our digital lives,” the Republican said in 2024, praising a planned Google project that he claimed would establish “central Ohio as an important tech hub in America.”

This spring, as he drew nearer to what is expected to be a

Tone shift follows similar one made by Democrats, Post analysis finds

tight November reelection race, Husted's view of data centers appeared to change. He introduced a Senate bill that his website promises will “protect Ameri-

cans from footing the bill for new data centers.”

Husted is far from the only Republican to shift from all-out data center booster to publicly speaking critically about the facilities in recent months, following growing signs that many voters are unhappy about the rapid spread of the computer-stuffed and power-guzzling facilities.

In the past six months, Republicans' public statements

about data centers have turned sharply negative, according to a Washington Post analysis of thousands of social media posts and newsletters from hundreds of politicians from both major parties since April 2024.

That shift follows a similar one made by Democrats, who have mostly focused on the negative effects of data centers since early last year, the Post analysis

SEE DATA CENTERS ON A2

Doctors say president's weight poses a significant health risk

BY DAN DIAMOND

President Donald Trump has faced scrutiny for bruising on his hands, swelling in his ankles and apparent drowsiness, among other questions about his health. Some doctors say they're worried about another risk: the

23 pounds that Trump may have gained since his last campaign for president.

In August 2023, when he was charged in Georgia in an election interference case, Trump's booking record listed his weight as 215 pounds. He weighed 238 pounds in May of this year, ac-

cording to a medical report released by the White House that month. That would make him about 1.6 pounds shy of being classified as “obese,” as he was in 2019 and 2020, given his height of 6-foot-3.

Trump's medical measurements have been long dissected,

and it's unclear where the 2023 weight figure originated. But the president has appeared heavier in photos than he did during his campaign, and the administration said he gained 14 pounds between his most recent annual medical checkups.

White House physicians have

said they've advised Trump — who has made little secret of his love for fast food and his distaste for intense exercise — to focus on weight loss, improving his diet and sustained physical activity. Outside doctors put it more directly: The 80-year-old president

SEE TRUMP ON A5



MARIO TAMA/GETTY IMAGES

Palisades Village, an outdoor shopping center in the Pacific Palisades neighborhood of Los Angeles, sits next to lots where some homes are being rebuilt following a devastating wildfire last year.

Nineteen months after fire, community works to rebuild

Signs of progress in Pacific Palisades as shopping mall reopens

BY N. KIRKPATRICK

LOS ANGELES — Fresh flowers at the farmers market. Ice cream dripping down the side of a cone. The hum of traffic on Sunset.

Nineteen months after the Palisades Fire leveled much of the seaside community, scars of the fire are increasingly overshadowed by signs of progress.

A luxury shopping mall recently reopened in Pacific Palisades, surrounded by a sea of plywood homes and the melody of saws and jackhammers. Many residents are rebuilding, but most have not been able to move back yet.

Still, many in the Palisades say that lately there is new momentum toward recovery. With the reopening of Palisades Village and the return of the farmers

market, the fabric of community, they say, is slowly being rewoven.

“The village has always played an important role in tying the community together,” said Kim Kedesian, the owner of K Bakery. Kedesian is one of the few people both living and working in the Palisades.

Palisadians and attendees from nearby packed North Swarthmore Avenue last Saturday, as billionaire developer Rick Caruso cut the ribbon to officially reopen Palisades Village.

Old friends greeted each other with hugs, and the many dogs in attendance gave each other friendly sniffs. The lines for coffee were long. “It's like Disneyland,” said one person waiting in line for ice cream.

The Sotherland family sat in front of the coffee shop Alfred. They didn't lose their home in the fire, but it burned their doormat and smoke coated the inside of their house with heavy metals.

“Hi, Zaro. Is your mom here?” Amanda Sotherland said to a young girl passing by. “Tell her

SEE PALISADES ON A16

IN THE NEWS

A deluge of attacks Abdul El-Sayed's victory in the Democratic Senate primary in Michigan triggered a wave of anti-Muslim rhetoric online, a Post analysis finds. **A3**

Mixed emotions When older siblings head off to college, what happens to the younger ones left in a half-empty nest? **B1**

THE NATION **A wildfire** caused by humans in the Reno, Nevada, area led authorities to urge 90,000 people to evacuate. **A7** **The Pentagon** fired the publisher and editor of the military newspaper Stars and Stripes. **A8**

THE WORLD **Prince Harry** and Meghan's decision to trade what appeared to be an idyllic life in sunny coastal California for the gloomy, gray skies of Britain represents an unexpected reversal. **A10**

THE ECONOMY **Back-to-school** supplies are more expensive, a report finds, with many teachers asking parents to spend nearly \$100. **A12** **Buc-ee's** has set off a backlash in Ohio by suing a small convenience store for trademark infringement. **A12**

STYLE **A report** found shrinking LGBTQ representation in movies, but 2026 feels encouraging, Shane O'Neill writes. **B1**

SPORTS **The Nationals** hit rock bottom with a sweep at the hands of the Marlins to cap a 1-8 road trip. **C1**

THE REGION **Some brides** are ditching modern uniformity in favor of vintage gowns with unique design elements. **C7**

HEALTH & SCIENCE **Books are good** for your brain, and reading fiction might help you strengthen some important social skills. **D1**

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Charolette Baierl and Sally Simpson protest a planned data center in Cheswick, Pennsylvania. Gov. Josh Shapiro and his GOP opponent, Stacy Garrity, have sparred over data center support.

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CORRECTION

• In some Aug. 23 editions, a sports photo caption misstated the team that Hull beat in its return to the English Premier League. Hull beat Manchester United, not Manchester City.

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DATA CENTERS FROM AI

found. Some Republican candidates are now trying to take the issue for themselves ahead of the midterm elections by attacking Democratic opponents with accusations they are too soft on data centers.

Last week, Rep. Tom Tiffany (R-Wisconsin), the GOP candidate for Wisconsin governor, made more than a dozen online posts that claimed his opponent, Democrat David Crowley, was too soft on data centers. Tiffany has promised to end tax breaks for the facilities; Crowley wants more regulation and for communities to get to choose whether to accept new data centers.

Stacy Garrity, the Republican nominee for Pennsylvania governor, has called Gov. Josh Shapiro, who is seeking reelection, “the biggest data center cheerleader in the nation.” On Tuesday, Shapiro announced new data center restrictions. Shapiro’s spokesperson said Garrity had a “long record of supporting completely unregulated data center development.” A spokesperson for Garrity said she had believed Shapiro’s prior statements on data centers but later discovered he hid their impact on local communities.

A spokesperson for Husted said in a statement that the senator’s position had not changed. “He has always believed that it should be up to the local communities whether or not they want new data centers,” the statement said.

The National Republican Senatorial Committee warned Tuesday in a memo obtained by The Post that “Data centers are the anchor hanging around Husted’s neck,” and could cause him to lose.

A poll conducted in June and July by the Annenberg Public Policy Center found that nearly half of Americans strongly opposed any construction of them in their area.

Honeymoon period

Two years ago, when only a third of Americans had used an AI chatbot, lawmakers rarely mentioned data centers online. When they did, it was generally to celebrate the arrival of one of the facilities in their district, talking of jobs, investment and the future.

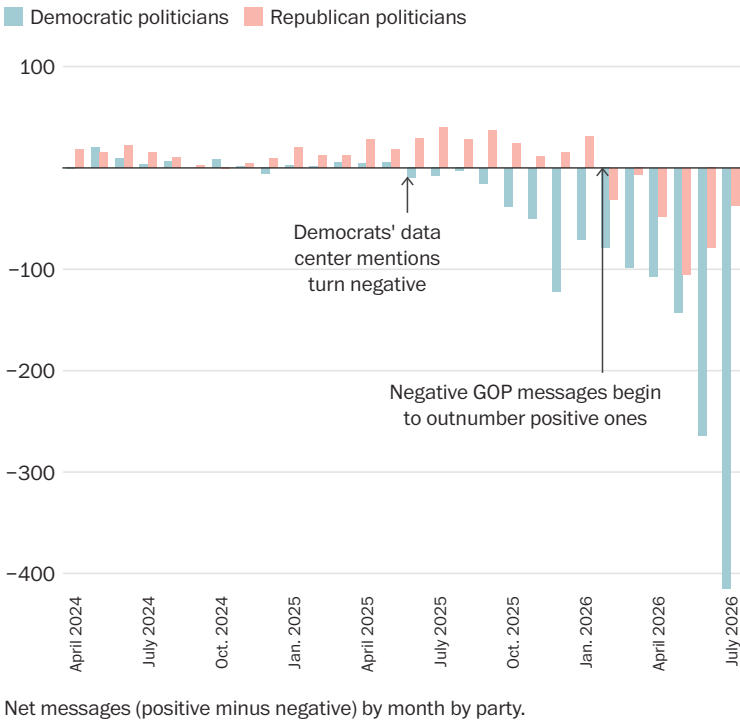
“I was excited to celebrate the opening of the Meta Data Center in Cheyenne that will help Wyoming be on the ground floor of cutting-edge technology and boost our economy,” Sen Cynthia Lummis posted in July 2024.

Illinois is fast retaking its place as the home of high-tech, high-growth industries of the future,” Gov. JB Pritzker (D) wrote of the groundbreaking of a new data center in October that year. “That means good-paying jobs and economic opportunity.”

After President Donald Trump returned to office with support from major AI investors last year and declared that he had “inaugurated a golden age for American manufacturing and technological dominance,” the number of Republican politicians posting about data centers more than doubled in the first half of the year. In that pe-

Both parties now mostly focus on data centers' downsides

Most Republicans previously celebrated data centers, for creating jobs or signalling investment.



Net messages (positive minus negative) by month by party.
Source: Post analysis of politicians' social media posts provided by the National Conference on Citizenship and email newsletters collected by the Post.

riod, more than 90 percent of their posts and newsletter mentions were positive.

“It is a relatively new issue for most politicians,” said David Karol, a political scientist at the University of Maryland, who wrote a book about how parties shift their positions. “So the politicians are figuring it out, along with everyone else.”

At the same time Republicans were embracing data centers, protest movements were already underway across the country as residents objected to their environmental impact and power usage and Trump embraced them as symbols of a resurgent United States.

Democratic politicians flipped to being mostly negative about the facilities in June 2025. Five days after Trump’s executive order, Sen. Ed Markey (D-Massachusetts.) wrote “Data centers are eating up our electricity—and unless we do something about it, we’re going to keep paying the bill for their meal.”

By January of 2026, more than eighty Democratic politicians had already spoken up online about data centers and the vast majority of their 400 posts were negative. The most common criticism was their alleged role in hiking electric rates.

As pushback against data centers grew louder, they became a bogeyman for Republicans too. In February this year, twice as many comments were about data center’s costs than their benefits. More than half of Republican’s posts that month cited rising power bills. Others focused on subsidies and tax breaks for data centers or painting them as a threat to agriculture and the rural way of life.

Tiffany did both in March, writing “NO subsidizing data centers on Wisconsin farmland” in a post that listed them as threats alongside green energy and Communist China.

Many Republicans have also cited cases where data centers — or electrical infrastructure meant to serve them — led to

people having homes or farmland taken via eminent domain.

“Eminent domain is government theft. I am NOT letting Big Tech steal our homes for their ugly data centers,” wrote Rep. Nancy Mace in June.

“I warned about these costs long before the media turned this into a national conversation,” she said in a statement to The Post.

Longtime supporters of data centers in both major parties are still updating their stances.

Texas governor Greg Abbott recently began calling for restrictions on data centers — after years of promoting them.

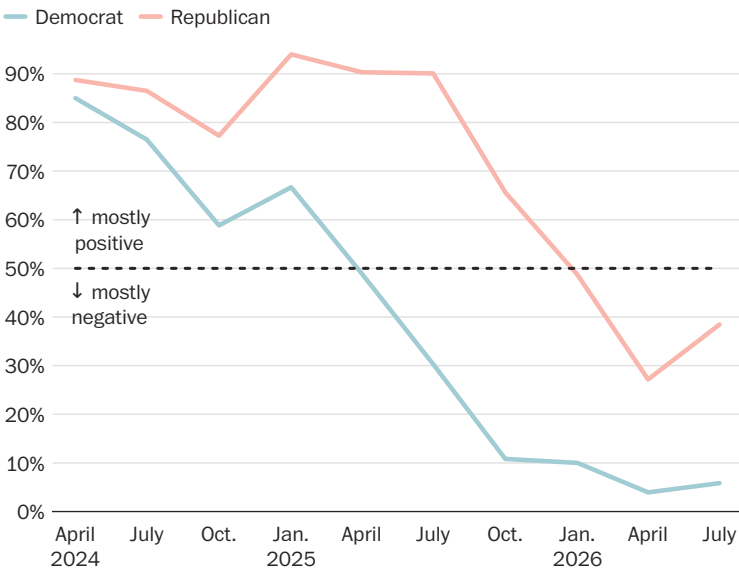
Illinois’ Democratic governor Pritzker did too. A spokesperson for Pritzker, said in a statement that “Responsible governance means reassessing incentives when circumstances change.”

Data centers still have some friends

Sen. Bill Cassidy (R-Louisiana) is still praising Meta’s data center in Richland Parish in northeast Louisiana: “Econ-

Politicians used to talk positively about data centers. Not anymore.

Online posts about the facilities from politicians in both parties have become more critical.



Source: Washington Post analysis of social posts provided by National Conference on Citizenship and email newsletters.

ic growth increases the tax base and sales tax revenue” and saying “Teacher bonuses there are up to \$50,000 this year.”

Others focus on the need to compete with China. “Ask yourself who benefits when Americans turn against data centers. China does,” wrote Rep. Eric Burlison (R-Missouri) in June.

Several politicians tipped as likely to run for president in 2028, have mostly stayed silent on social media about data centers.

Sen. Jon Ossoff (D-Georgia) doesn’t appear to have posted about them, although he did write a letter to federal regulators about Georgians’ rising power bills. Neither has Secretary of State Marco Rubio. JD Vance’s only post on X about data centers is from 2021.

California Gov. Gavin Newsom has taken more of a middle road. He has mocked Trump’s stance on data centers, tweeting “Trump is burning more coal to run data centers. Welcome to the Golden Age!” But in a June episode of his podcast Newsom praised construction jobs building data centers as “legit.” He also noted concerns about their impact on power bills but added

that rates they had already been growing.

Rep. Ro Khanna (D-California), whose district spans Silicon Valley and has said he is considering a 2028 run, in 2025 spoke in favor of building more American data centers. He criticized a Trump administration AI deal with the United Arab Emirates by asking: “Why are we putting data centers and research hubs in Dubai? We should have those high-paying new technology jobs in the United States.”

By June this year, Khanna had adopted a more critical and populist view, calling for “An end to data center extraction taking a community’s water and jacking up their bills, sucking all the money in the hands of a few tech billionaires.”

Khanna did not respond to a request for comment.

Karol, the political science professor, said this kind of shift is more common in politics than is commonly understood. “Politicians generally think it is in their interest to take the currently popular position. They react and they do update.”

Evan Halper and Scott Clement contributed reporting.

About this story

The Post analyzed 4,300 social media posts and newsletters matching the phrase “data center” from politicians from July 2024 through mid-August 2026. The posts, collected across a variety of social platforms, were provided by the National Conference on Citizenship; the newsletters were collected directly by The Post.

Posts and newsletters were classified as positive, negative, or neutral using an AI model (GPT 5.6 Luna). The AI model classified posts as negative if it focused on data centers’ downsides and positive if it focused on their benefits. The model got an accuracy rate of 90 percent on a hand-labeled set of 200 posts. Errors mostly occurred on posts that contained arguments both for and against data centers or that implicitly criticized other politicians’ stances on data centers. Posts classified as “neutral” were excluded from the visualizations.

THE NATION

El-Sayed’s win triggered wave of anti-Muslim rhetoric

Post analysis found shift in online commentary, a focus on his identity

BY PRAVEENA SOMASUNDARAM AND LUKE CONNORS

Hours after Abdul El-Sayed won the Democratic Senate nomination in Michigan this month, Sen. Tommy Tuberville (R-Alabama) called the man who could be the first Muslim senator a “TERRORIST” and “RADICAL ISLAMIST” on social media.

Tuberville’s post previewed a deluge of attacks on El-Sayed’s Muslim identity from influential and high-profile conservatives.

By mid-August, 15 days after the primary, religion had become the dominant topic of conservative conversation online about El-Sayed — overtaking mentions of socialism and communism that once dogged the progressive candidate, according to a Washington Post analysis of thousands of right- and left-wing posts and public statements.

Nearly 1 in 3 posts about El-Sayed from right-wing figures mentioned Islam, Muslims or sharia by Aug. 18, according to The Post’s analysis of conservative commentary across social media, newsletters and podcasts.

The fixation on El-Sayed’s faith is part of a growing embrace of open Islamophobia by some Republicans this year, coinciding with a war on Iran and increased hostilities in the Middle East. Politically, those barbs have triggered few penalties within the party. Some Republican lawmakers like Tuberville, whose office declined to comment for this article, have used anti-Muslim messages to mobilize their most ardent supporters.

Islamophobic comments have also been flung at other Muslim Democrats, including New York Mayor Zohran Mamdani and Reps. Rashida Tlaib (Michigan) and Ilhan Omar (Minnesota).

The attacks can cut especially deep in Michigan, which is home to around 240,000 Muslims, one of the largest populations in the country.

Mike Rogers, the Republican Michigan Senate candidate, has focused on casting El-Sayed as an extreme candidate in the hopes of courting independent voters and moderate Democrats. He usually does not highlight El-Sayed’s religion, but his Republican and conservative allies often do.

The Republicans’ Senate campaign arm called El-Sayed “the most radical Senate candidate in America” and referred to him by his full name, Abdulrahman Mohamed El-Sayed, in its debut general election ad against him on Aug. 5, the day after the primary.

When the GOP Senate group later described El-Sayed on X as a “radical socialist,” MAGA and anti-Muslim activist Laura Loomer responded that the post hadn’t gone far enough.

“Please call him a jihadist,” she wrote. “The word socialist has no meaning.”

Loomer told The Post that she felt Republicans needed to be more critical of El-Sayed’s faith, citing his views on Israel’s War on Gaza, which he has described as a genocide.

“These people are being cowards because they are afraid of being called Islamophobic,” she said in an interview.

Loomer, whose polemic posts against El-Sayed appeared frequently in the analysis, said she called President Donald Trump in early August to urge him to call Islamic candidates “jihadists.” Trump did so shortly after in the Oval Office, claiming “jihadists” were being elected when asked about Republican messaging for the midterms.

Before the Democratic primary, right-wing posts about El-Sayed were focused on his political ideology. The contest between El-Sayed, who was endorsed by high-profile progressives including Sen. Bernie Sanders (I-Vermont), and Rep. Haley Stevens, a moderate, was defined by stark differences over issues including Israel, health care and money in politics.

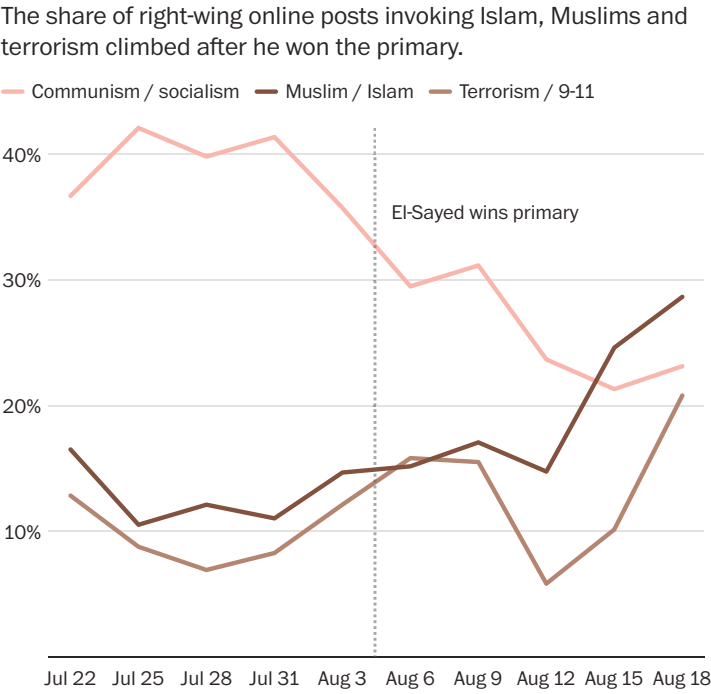
But right-wing posts about El-Sayed surged after the primary election and started to sound different, The Post’s analysis found.



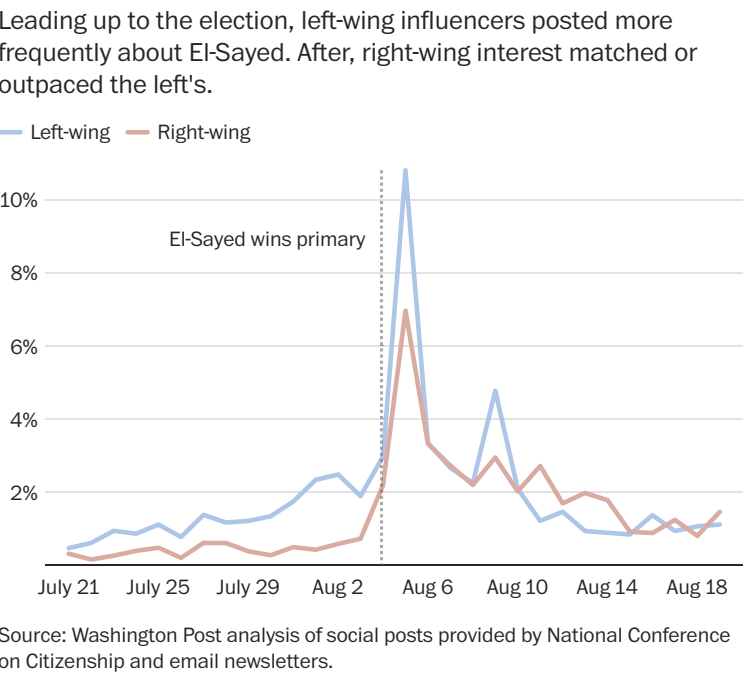
JEFF KOWALSKY/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Abdul El-Sayed, who won the Democratic Senate nomination in Michigan, at his Aug. 4 election night event in Detroit.

Right-wing focus on El-Sayed has shifted away from liberal ideology



Right-wing attention in El-Sayed grew after he won the primary



“It’s telling that after Abdul won, MAGA’s response was to attack his faith rather than defend Mike Rogers’ record.”

Roxie Richner, a spokesperson for El-Sayed, in a statement

hundreds.

“It’s telling that after Abdul won, MAGA’s response was to attack his faith rather than defend Mike Rogers’ record,” Roxie Richner, a spokesperson for El-Sayed, said in a statement.

Rogers’s campaign did not return a request for comment.

Rogers, a former congressman who narrowly lost a Senate race in 2024, has blasted El-Sayed for campaigning with controversial leftist streamer Hasan Piker, who has been criticized across the political spectrum for his comments in 2019 saying “America deserved 9/11” in the context of U.S. foreign policy before the terrorist attacks. Piker has apologized for the comments, and El-Sayed has called them dumb.

“I spent years hunting terrorists and bringing Osama bin Laden to justice,” Rogers said in a statement the week El-Sayed won the Democratic nomination. “Never in a million years did I think that I would be running against someone who believes America deserved 9/11.”

After the primary, Trump, who campaigned in 2016 on banning Muslim immigrants, called El-

Sayed a “communist loser” and “radical left socialist.”

On Aug. 8, Trump posted on his Truth Social platform a photo of himself and first lady Melania Trump from the 2025 inauguration ball beside a photo of El-Sayed with his wife, who wears a hijab.

“Two VERY DIFFERENT America’s,” the graphic read.

In a CNN interview, El-Sayed responded that Trump was right: “One in which your overlords are two people who don’t like each other but joint in the interest of making billions of dollars off of you, or two people who genuinely love each other, enjoyed some pancakes together, want to come together to build the kind of America where they can raise a family, and know that that family is going to have the good things.”

Anti-Muslim rhetoric frames Muslim candidates as “interloper[s] who [have] come in to take something away from them,” said Amy V. Doukoure, lead staff attorney for the Michigan chapter of the Council on American-Islamic Relations, a Muslim American civil rights and advocacy group.

“That kind of divisory politics, it wins, unfortunately,” Doukoure said.

CAIR’s Michigan office has seen a rise in anti-Muslim rhetoric since El-Sayed won his party’s nomination, Doukoure said.

When she spoke to The Post on Thursday, it was the third day in a row that police officers had visited her workplace to investigate death threats the group had received, she said.

El-Sayed has dismissed the fixation on his Muslim identity as an ineffectual attack.

During an appearance on NBC News’s “Meet the Press,” he said the emphasis on his full name echoed how Republicans tried to belittle former president Barack Obama by emphasizing his middle name, Hussein.

In a rally after his primary victory, El-Sayed said he knew the GOP was trying to use his name against him.

“Mike, listen man, if you can’t say the name, it’s Abdulrahman, keep the name out your d---mouth,” El-Sayed said. “I’ll be happy to give you lessons.”

A look inside a trial that could revolutionize cancer care

Scientists say the study of an experimental treatment for melanoma built using messenger RNA might mark the beginning of a transformation

BY DANIEL WU

After Mark Orwig had a melanoma tumor removed from his cheek in 2023, he began to worry about the future. The smallest remnants of the deadly skin cancer can linger in the body after a successful surgery, eventually causing the disease to recur.

Orwig, like most melanoma patients, must watch for the cancer for the rest of his life. He worried about affording scans and treatments that could help keep it at bay. He thought about his odds. Then a doctor told him about a clinical trial being run nearby at the University of California at San Francisco.

“He says, ‘It’s groundbreaking,’” Orwig recalled. “It’s a groundbreaking process that I think is going to revolutionize cancer and many other treatments.”

“I said, ‘If that’s the one, let’s go.’”

That was how Orwig, a 73-year-old tennis coach from Moraga, California, joined 1,136 other skin cancer patients around the globe in testing intismeran autogene, an experimental treatment that drugmakers Moderna and Merck say is the most promising example of an emerging field of cancer vaccines built using messenger RNA, the technology behind the coronavirus vaccines.

The Phase 3 trial, which tested intismeran’s ability to prevent melanoma from recurring when combined with a separate proven immunotherapy, was successful, drugmakers announced Wednesday. The news sent stock prices for both companies soaring and opens the door for the Food and Drug Administration to potentially approve the first mRNA-based cancer treatment.

The data that would inform that decision came from patients like Orwig, who, like all the trial participants, does not know whether he received injections of intismeran or a placebo during his year-long regimen.

Orwig’s melanoma has not recurred. He experienced side effects from his injections but is healthy and continues to coach tennis everyday. And he said he felt a sense of purpose in joining a long history of cancer research as it reaches a potential milestone.

“Somebody did it for me,” Orwig said. “I’ve got to do it for the next people who have melanoma.”

How the process worked

Orwig said he believes his work and an outdoorsy lifestyle in the San Francisco Bay Area may have contributed to his skin cancer. Besides his hours on the tennis court, he is also an avid runner and surfer. His mother also had skin cancer. Orwig was treated several times for basal cell carcinoma, a different form of skin cancer, in his middle age.

In September 2023, during a checkup, doctors flagged a small, clear bump on Orwig’s cheek. It was diagnosed as a Stage 3 melanoma, and Orwig quickly underwent surgery to remove it. The cancer, which had spread under Orwig’s skin, ultimately required doctors to remove a large section of his cheek.

That can be just the beginning of a patient’s experience with the cancer, said Ryan Sullivan, direc-



PAUL KURODA/ FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Mark Orwig, a 73-year-old tennis coach, joined skin cancer patients around the globe in testing a cancer vaccine built using mRNA.

tor of the cutaneous medical oncology program at Mass General Brigham Cancer Institute. Depending on the kind and severity of melanoma, the risk of the cancer returning can be as high as 80 percent for some patients. Melanoma can be fast-growing and elusive, and a few cancer cells left after a surgery can stealthily spread to other parts of the body.

“Anything you can do to improve cure rates is great,” Sullivan said.

Orwig’s diagnosis and treatment made him eligible for the trial of intismeran, which boosts immunotherapy usually delivered after a melanoma removal by helping the body target cancer cells. He entered the trial in December that year.

Six patients at UCSF participated in the clinical trial, according to Adil Daud, a professor of medicine at UCSF who oversaw them. Patients across 25 countries and around 30 sites in the United States took part in the trial, according to Moderna.

To begin, doctors submitted a rice-grain-size sample of Orwig’s tumor to a lab for analysis. Intismeran is unique among cancer treatments as a personalized



COURTESY OF MARK ORWIG

Doctors removed a large section of Orwig’s cheek in 2023 after he was diagnosed with Stage 3 melanoma.

drug — researchers sequence a patient’s tumor to find mutations unique to their cancer, then encode instructions into a custom-made mRNA vaccine to target that cancer’s specific mutations.

That may not always be possible, Daud said. The process of analyzing a cancer tumor after surgery, which involves staining it with dyes, can use up the tis-

sue needed for a DNA analysis, which could limit some patients’ access to the treatment if it becomes more widely available.

“Genome sequencing is getting better and better,” Daud added. “Right now you need a fair amount of tumor, but as time goes by, I don’t know if that’s persistently going to be a problem.”

While he waited for labs to

follow up, Orwig began infusions of Keytruda, an approved immunotherapy drug that helps the body’s immune system fight cancer. After six weeks, he started on injections of either the vaccine or a placebo.

For a year, Orwig received infusions of Keytruda every six weeks and injections in the arm every three weeks.

Two-thirds of the participants in the trial received intismeran, and the rest received a placebo; Orwig is not allowed to know which. But he and Daud said he experienced side effects after his injections that appeared similar to those from other mRNA vaccines, like the Moderna coronavirus vaccine. After his first injection, Orwig said he felt fatigue, nausea, headaches and soreness, which he said were much more severe than from a coronavirus shot. It took around a week to recover, though he learned to cope better on subsequent injections.

“It was pretty tough,” Orwig said. “... As it went on, it got a little bit better, and I developed routines on how I would first start [recovering].”

Side effects?

One of Orwig’s peers in the tri-

al at UCSF stopped receiving Keytruda and injections after experiencing more severe side effects. Richard Dehmel, 80, developed colitis, inflammation of the large intestine, in November 2024, several months after beginning his regimen, he said. Dehmel was hospitalized for dehydration due to diarrhea caused by the condition.

Daud, the UCSF doctor, cautioned against drawing conclusions from Orwig or Dehmel’s individual experiences. He added that it could be hard to distinguish between conditions caused by Keytruda, which can cause side effects including colitis, and intismeran.

“Even though the vaccine is personalized [to target cancer] ... there’s a lot we don’t understand about the immune system,” he said.

Moderna and Merck have said in previous clinical trials that the most commonly reported side effects related to intismeran were fatigue, pain at the site of injection and chills, and that the number of serious reactions was comparable to patients who received only Keytruda.

When it comes to assessing a cancer vaccine, no news is good news, Daud said. Orwig completed his regimen and continues to receive checkups as part of the trial. His cancer has not recurred.

Dehmel developed complications from his colitis which took around a year to recover from, he said. His melanoma recurred, and he had a second operation in January to remove a new tumor.

Both participants celebrated the news this week that the clinical trial was successful, they said.

“I’m utterly delighted,” Dehmel said of the trial’s success. He added that he was disappointed by how the treatment ended for him but knew it was a possibility going in.

“One always hopes that a trial vaccine will be personally useful,” he said. “But ... I’m an engineer, and in science you need data, and so I was happy to sign up for this so that we could get more data.”

Experts said the full picture on intismeran is still incomplete. Moderna and Merck have not yet released the data from the latest clinical trial, and participants like Orwig and Dehmel will still need to be monitored to assess the treatment’s long-term effectiveness. But the success of the trial is still a significant milestone and could spur the development of other cancer vaccines.

“There’s a bladder cancer trial and a lung cancer trial looking to do very much the same thing that this trial did,” Sullivan said. “Just the concept [that] cancer vaccination can lead to a positive Phase 3 trial, I think, will make people very interested in investing in this.”

Orwig completed his latest skin checkup Thursday, where doctors found no abnormalities. He went straight to the tennis courts from the hospital for his afternoon lessons.

“I’m thankful and I’m glad I did what I did,” he said. “A lot of trials don’t go anywhere. This trial is definitely going to go somewhere ... and anybody that gets into the same situation I got into in the future is going to really benefit from it.”

A woman was lost and confused in 100-degree heat. This teen came to help.

BY SYDNEY PAGE

Royal Cothrun was riding his bike near his home in Gilbert, Arizona, when he noticed a woman struggling to walk. It was over 100 degrees outside, and her face was bright red.

Royal, 14, pulled over.

“I knew it was a serious situation,” he said.

He asked the woman — who was carrying a large shopping bag — where she was headed. She said she was trying to get home to her apartment but wasn’t sure where it was. Royal checked his phone, and the closest apartment was about three miles away.

He walked with her into the shade. As they talked, her words became harder to follow.

“The more I started talking to her, the more jumbled her words got,” he said. “She kept saying ‘It’s hot’ and ‘Help me.’ She kept mumbling and falling over.”

The woman seemed afraid, Royal said. Her phone was stuck in her purse, as the zipper was jammed.

“I used all my strength to try to open it, and I couldn’t,” Royal said. “I could tell she was panicking a bit.”

It was also clear she was overheating.

“I didn’t know if she was going to pass out or what was going to happen,” Royal said.

Then the woman said she remembered her son’s phone number, and Royal called him. Jeff Morgan answered and right away rushed over to the scene that day, June 7. While they waited for him to arrive, the woman fell and scraped her arm. Royal tried to help her up, he said, but she refused.

“She wouldn’t get up, she just said the rocks were cold and she didn’t feel dizzy when she was laying down,” Royal said.

Morgan arrived and called paramedics, who showed up shortly thereafter. Royal said he waited until the woman left in her son’s car — about an hour and a half after he first stopped to help.

Morgan said he was stunned by the teen’s actions and grate-

ful that he didn’t keep riding his bike when he saw someone in need.

“It’s just a miracle that she encountered somebody so selfless and caring,” he said. “It was just really remarkable to me that he stayed with her like she was his family member.”

Morgan’s mother, Theresa, turned 76 in July and was diagnosed with dementia last year, he said. She had gone to a nearby grocery store that day and became lost on the way home.

“She had not done anything like that in the past ever,” he said, noting that his mother no longer goes out on her own and now lives with her youngest son. “We love her dearly, and we are making sure that this type of thing doesn’t happen again.”

Gilbert Fire Chief Rob Duggan said the day could easily have ended differently.

“She had already been out for a decent amount of time, and it wouldn’t have taken much longer for her to lose her ability to walk,” he said. “Confusion worsens in the heat.”

What struck him, he said, was how quickly Royal understood the danger she was in.

“He was acutely aware that she was in trouble,” he said. “His level of discernment to recognize that is pretty impressive given his age.”

At a Gilbert City Council meeting on Aug. 11, Duggan and Vice Mayor Chuck Bongiovanni presented Royal with a key to the city, a lifesaving award and a rescue department hat. The award was first reported by Gilbert Sun News.

“He’s a great kid,” Bongiovanni said. “We were proud to do that.”

Both officials said the story sends a broader message.

“Gilbert is like many other communities, where a lot of times our teenagers get some bad press for their actions,” Duggan said. “This is a great example of what I think of the majority of our teenagers. ... There are a bunch of great teenagers out there doing really kind things, and we need to celebrate that.”

Morgan agreed.

“Royal is an example for us



KAMI COTHRUN

Royal Cothrun, 14, was honored Aug. 11 by the city of Gilbert, Arizona, for helping a woman with dementia.

all,” he said. “He’s our hero.”

Royal said he didn’t expect any recognition.

“I honestly just thought she was in need, so I helped her,” he said.

Doctors: Trump’s post-campaign weight gain is worrying

TRUMP FROM A1

would be safer if he reduced his waistline.

“We know that obesity is a strong risk factor for numerous health issues — as well as premature disability and death,” said Scott Kahan, the director for the National Center for Weight and Wellness, and a George Washington University physician. “Addressing obesity to protect the president’s health should be a priority similar to ensuring Secret Service protections for his life.”

The White House did not directly respond to questions about Trump’s weight, pointing instead to his energy and stamina.

Trump has demonstrated signs of healthy aging. His weekly White House schedule frequently includes intense periods of meetings, press events and public remarks; he spends many weekends playing golf. His physicians have repeatedly said that they’ve been impressed by his energy, cognitive fitness and other positive markers.

“I told him he could do a better job with his diet, and he would be a little healthier if he exercised and lost some weight, but other than that, he was in outstanding shape for his age,” Ronny Jackson, who served as Trump’s physician in his first term, wrote in a 2022 memoir.

But Trump’s weight is a risk factor, medical experts have said, acknowledging that many Americans struggle with similar challenges.

More than 40 percent of adult Americans are obese, and an additional 30 percent-plus are overweight, according to federal data.

Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. and other senior officials have said that helping reduce Americans’ weight should be a priority as part of their campaign to “Make America Healthy Again” and help people live longer lives.

The president has also repeatedly invoked weight — his own and others’ — in public remarks. It is a favorite taunt he uses against opponents such as Illinois Gov. JB Pritzker (D) and his former adviser Chris Christie.

“I would never call anybody fat,” Trump said in a speech at last month’s White House correspondents’ dinner, where he mocked the idea of Christie and Rep. Jerry Nadler (D-New York) fighting over a cheesecake. “I have my own problems, you know?”

Trump has sometimes quipped about his own appearance, saying he hasn’t wanted to wear bulletproof vests because they could make him look fat. He has also jokingly defended his diet.

“Maybe junk food is good and the other food is no good,” Trump said in the Oval Office in May. “I know many, many people that all they do is watch their weight, their this, their that, and they kicked the bucket, and here we are. I feel great.”

In a statement, the White House praised Trump’s fitness and contrasted him with predecessor Joe Biden.

“President Trump’s sharpness, unmatched energy, relentless work ethic and historic accessibility stand in stark contrast to what we saw during the last administration when Democrats and the legacy media intentionally covered up Joe Biden’s serious mental and physical decline from the American people,” spokesman Davis Ingles said in a statement. “President Trump is the sharpest and most accessible President in

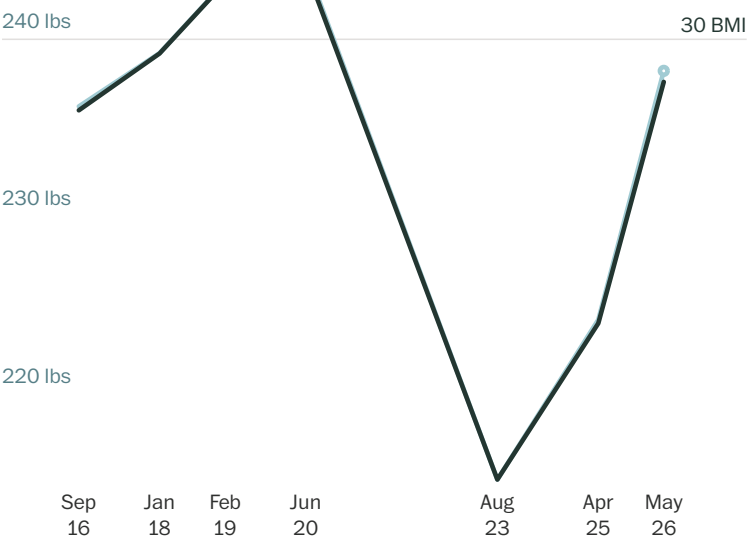


MARK SCHIEFELBEIN/AP

Trump’s diet and weight have been scrutinized over the course of his political career, with his love for McDonald’s a staple.

Trump’s reported weight has fluctuated over time

Doctors have encouraged the president to lose weight. A body-mass index of 30 is considered “obese.”



Source: Medical reports released by the White House and Trump’s 2016 presidential campaign; Trump’s booking record from Fulton County (Ga.) jail

American history who is working nonstop to solve problems and deliver on his promises.”

The White House did not respond to other questions about the president’s health, including physicians’ recommendation this year that Trump address his weight and whether he has ever taken a GLP-1 anti-obesity drug.

Trump has said he has never taken a GLP-1 drug.

Trump’s diet and weight have been scrutinized across his political career, with his love for McDonald’s a staple.

Pressed by interviewer Barbara Walters in 2015 on whether there was anything they would change about their father, Trump’s children eventually conceded that they didn’t like his diet.

“I want him to eat healthier,” Ivanka Trump told Walters.

Trump also discussed his weight in a September 2016 appearance on “The Dr. Oz Show.” A letter released by Trump’s personal physician that month said he weighed 236 pounds.

reporters that month. “We talked about diet and exercise a lot. He’s more enthusiastic about the diet part than the exercise part, but we’re going to do both.”

It is unclear whether Trump adopted any changes to his diet or began more exercise during his first term, and spokespeople for the White House and Jackson did not respond to questions about it.

Sean Conley, Jackson’s successor, said in February 2019 that Trump weighed 243 pounds, making him technically obese. Conley in June 2020 said Trump weighed 244 pounds.

Four months later, Trump

contracted a serious case of covid-19, the impact of which is linked with obesity, physicians have found.

The president received a then-experimental antibody cocktail, produced by Regeneron, that he credited with helping save his life. He left office in January 2021.

Trump was noticeably thinner as he announced another campaign for president in 2023. A doctor’s note released by the campaign in November said that he had “reduced his weight through an improved diet and continued daily physical activity.”

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MANUEL BALCE CENETA/AP

Trump had an appointment at Walter Reed National Military Medical Center in Bethesda in May.

The journalist Trump trusts to go looking for secrets

SOLOMON FROM A1

White House investigative reporter — albeit without a security clearance — with direct access to the intelligence officials who can declassify the documents he is seeking out.

The secrets he's looking for, he said in an interview, fall into four categories: foreign policy failures, election security, ethics breaches and the “weaponization” of government.

“It's really the same,” Solomon, 59, said of the work. “I use the same journalistic instincts I would have if I were a journalist.”

Operating largely behind the scenes, Solomon said he was involved in preparing a speech Trump gave in July, during which the president hailed the task force and cited newly declassified documents and warned of “shocking vulnerabilities” in the U.S. election system. Trump claimed the “deep state,” including members of the U.S. intelligence community, tried to suppress evidence of China's attempted meddling in the 2020 election, but the documents largely described intelligence assessments of China that already were public.

Outside the White House following the speech, Solomon acknowledged to reporters that the U.S. intelligence community had so far found “zero evidence that a foreign power flipped a vote in 2020, '22 or '24.”

Asked whether the 2020 presidential election — which Trump has claimed was rigged against him — was legitimate, Solomon said, “I'm still researching.”

“But there's no intelligence—?” MS NOW's Vaughn Hillyard queried.

“Not yet!” Solomon said back. “Not that we've found.”

Solomon's work on the task force has largely found an audience through his own website, Just the News, where he still publishes, and elsewhere in right-wing media.

Earlier this month, he wrote an article for the White House website based on “[i]nternal FBI memos newly declassified” surfacing allegations about actions by the FBI and its former director, James B. Comey, one of Trump's nemeses, from early in his first term. The article ends with a disclosure that Solomon “wrote this story for the White House Website, which is allowing any media to publish it.”

Some of his work has broken through more broadly. Articles in The Post and elsewhere cited the task's force work after the FBI seized electronic devices belonging to former congressman Eric Swalwell (D-California) as part of an investigation of sexual assault allegations against him. (Swalwell has not been charged with a crime and hasn't commented.)

Solomon's presence at the White House follows a surprising transformation.

Throughout the 1990s and 2000s with the AP, and then briefly with The Post, Solomon regularly broke news on high-profile stories about national politics and federal law enforcement. But in recent years, starting with a tumultuous stint at the Hill that was discussed and scrutinized during proceedings for Trump's first impeachment, he has fixated on elections — a favorite topic of the president's.

More than two dozen people who worked with Solomon said in interviews that they do not recognize the hard-charging reporter they once knew in the man now working for the president. Several said they felt disappointed in Solomon, who they said has promoted conspiracy theories about Russia, Ukraine, the Biden family and the vulnerability of American elections. While a number of former colleagues spoke on the record, others declined because they were either not authorized to speak by their employers or they feared potential government retribution.

Some of them said they see a direct line from the John Solomon of decades past — who regaled editors with scoops, chest-thumped around newsrooms and ingratiated himself with influential sources — and the one who has decamped to the Trump White House to search for a smoking gun on election interference.

“He followed his sources into this world of conspiracy theories and nihilism,” one former colleague said. “Part of our political class and part of our country has detached from facts and truth and reality. That includes a number of journalists — and that's a tragedy.”

Solomon declined to comment on the claims of former colleagues who spoke on the condition of anonymity.



GERALD MARTINEAU/THE WASHINGTON POST

John Solomon, once a reporter for the Associated Press and The Washington Post, has joined the White House as chairman of the Government Transparency Task Force.

‘A big talker’

Solomon's father was a Connecticut police chief who earned acclaim for catching killers. The New York Times wrote in 1995 that the elder Solomon's “skill in snaring murderers has earned him the moniker Super Sleuth among law-enforcement officials.” Solomon's brother charted a similar course. A former police detective in Greenwich, Connecticut, he now runs a non-profit for financial crimes investigators.

“I grew up in a house full of cops, I learned to love to dig, probe and investigate,” Solomon told the Connecticut Post in 2008. “Journalism offered a very fulfilling way to do that.”

He studied journalism at Marquette University in Milwaukee and worked as a sports reporter for United Press International before being hired at age 20 by the AP's Milwaukee bureau, where he edited coverage about serial killer Jeffrey Dahmer. Soon after, he won a spot in the AP's Washington bureau and moved his young family to Northern Virginia.

Solomon rose in the bureau's investigative ranks and broke stories about the Oklahoma City bombing, President Bill Clinton's impeachment and the advance warning about Hurricane Katrina that President George W. Bush had received.

While at the AP, Solomon cited unnamed law-enforcement officials when reporting that the FBI overheard Sen. Robert Torricelli (D-New Jersey) on a wiretapped phone call discussing fundraising with an organized-crime figure. Robert S. Mueller III, who was an assistant attorney general at the Justice Department at the time, approved a subpoena of Solomon's phone records after the story was published. The case led to an outcry from First Amendment advocates and vaulted Solomon into the national discourse.

At both the AP and The Post, Solomon was known for his larger-than-life demeanor — “a big talker,” in the words of one Post colleague.

“I distinctly remember that he told a bunch of us that he tried to make 20 calls on his commute into work every morning,” said former Post reporter Derek Willis, now a lecturer at University of Maryland's journalism school.

At first, Willis said, he thought that was a ridiculous claim, but upon reflection, he figured that if anyone could do it, it was Solomon (who confirmed his voluminous commute calling).

Kathleen Carroll, former AP executive editor and senior vice president for news from 2002 to 2016, said Solomon's work required close supervision by his editors.

“John benefited from and needed to have a strong editor,” said Carroll, who did not supervise him directly. “He had a tendency to get out over his skis a little bit, and he needed a very prosecutorial editor: How do you know that? Who told you that? Where did that come from?”

Solomon said Carroll was not in a position to know about his

sourcing.

Few people at either outlet said they perceived a political bent in his reporting. Jeff Leen, a former investigative editor at The Post, said Solomon was a “very aggressive reporter with investigative instincts who got a lot of scoops” and led a high-profile collaboration with “60 Minutes” on the FBI's controversial use of bullet lead analysis. “I know he got more conservative after he left The Post, but while he was with me he was straight and just-the-facts,” Leen said.

Carroll said she thinks Solomon changed after he left the AP. “It's not unusual among investigative reporters for there to be a whiff of conspiracy in things. They spend a lot of time looking at society's underbelly and finding it wanting,” she said. “I don't know what festered there that led him to the path that he's now on. ... I don't know what happened, and it makes me sad.”

‘The worst hire I ever made’

When Solomon entered conservative journalism in January 2008, it was as an outsider. He left The Post after a year to edit the Washington Times, a conservative paper owned by an offshoot of the Unification Church of the messianic leader Sun Myung Moon, arguing his goal was to try to ensure fact-based reporting.

“If I made one fundamental change,” he said about the Times in June 2008, “it's to make sure opinion and commentary didn't bleed onto the news pages.” He wrote a memo to staff banning “archaic” terms such as “homosexual” and “illegal aliens” and reflected that a headline about Hillary Clinton published on his watch was too “sexist” and “tart.”

Solomon resigned from the Washington Times in November 2009 amid a Moon family feud.

He then developed various business plans: to buy the Washington Times (which was unsuccessful), to rename it the Washington Guardian (which did not happen) and to build his own news site called the Washington Guardian, which he did and later sold to the Washington Times.

In 2010, he took a job at the nonprofit Center for Public Integrity, known for long-term investigative reporting, first as a temporary journalist-in-residence. But he quickly became the chief digital officer and then the executive editor.

Gordon Witkin, then the center's managing editor, had remembered Solomon's impressive scoops on the Oklahoma City bombing and wanted someone well-sourced to beef up his team's national security and law-enforcement coverage. “What I came to observe was that John was well-sourced but he was also a Machiavellian snake,” he said in an interview. He said Solomon ingratiated himself with the center's top leaders and board and sought control of the organization — an episode documented by Columbia Journalism Review in 2012.

Witkin called his decision to bring in Solomon “the biggest mistake of my professional life.”

Solomon wanted to turn the slow-moving nonprofit into a daily news powerhouse with an \$80,000 TV studio. But his plan called for an advertising and subscription service that would have paid commissions to an outside company he controlled, CJR reported.

When his business plan was not approved, he responded by targeting an editor who opposed it, according to the CJR article and Bill Buzenberg, the center's executive director at the time. Solomon began an ethics investigation of a journalism project overseen by the editor, though a board member and lawyers found no breach of ethics or the law.

Buzenberg said in an interview that he was initially charmed by Solomon. He said that Solomon was energetic and well-sourced, but that he soon “learned not to trust him at all.”

“He just made stuff up. Numbers were never firm,” Buzenberg, who had previously served as NPR's vice president of news, said, calling Solomon “the worst hire I ever made.”

Solomon said he enjoyed a fine relationship with Buzenberg and Witkin until he raised questions about the series. “Perhaps they still have hard feelings,” he said.

Solomon resigned and took a job with the combined Newsweek and Daily Beast newsrooms under longtime magazine editor Tina Brown. He lasted one year there before selling his website, the Washington Guardian, to the Washington Times and returning to the paper in 2013 to oversee news, opinion and business strategy. In 2015, he joined the conservative local news giant Sinclair as the chief operating officer of a new digital news site Circa.

But it was Solomon's last job for a major news company — at the Hill — that became a national story.

Hired by Trump acquaintance and then-owner Jimmy Finkelstein in 2017 to run the Hill's video business, Solomon began publishing his own stories and promoted them in regular appearances on the Fox News opinion show “Hannity.” Finkelstein sold the paper to Nexstar in 2021.

In some stories he quoted controversial Ukrainian prosecutor Yuri Lutsenko, who told Solomon that U.S. Ambassador to Ukraine Marie Yovanovitch gave him a “do not prosecute” list. Lutsenko later changed his story and told the New York Times there was a mistranslation during his interview with Solomon.

Solomon's stories advanced claims that Ukraine tried to meddle in the 2016 presidential election to bolster Hillary Clinton. He said he stands by these stories.

Trump raised some of these allegations on a 2019 call with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, appearing to threaten to withhold military funding from Ukraine unless Zelensky investigated Joe Biden and his son Hunter Biden. The House of Representatives impeached Trump in connection with the incident in 2019, though the Senate ac-

quitted him.

Solomon's coverage led to an uproar among the Hill's reporting staff. After staffers complained to management, editor in chief Bob Cusack recategorized Solomon's work in 2018 as opinion. Solomon said he asked Cusack to label his work as opinion.

Yovanovitch, who had been ousted as U.S. ambassador to Ukraine, told House impeachment investigators in November 2019 that she was the target of a “smear campaign” by Trump and his personal lawyer, Rudy Giuliani, and a House committee found that Solomon was key to advancing that campaign.

That same month, Rep. Jackie Speier (D-California) refused to speak to a reporter with the Hill, citing Solomon's columns and saying it was “reprehensible” that the paper would publish “that kind of crap” that “has no veracity whatsoever.”

Days later, the Hill initiated a review, led by Cusack. It added extensive editor's notes identifying shortcomings in Solomon's reporting. The review found that Solomon “failed to identify important details about key Ukrainian sources, including the fact that they had been indicted or were under investigation. In other cases, the sources were his own attorneys.”

Solomon criticized this assessment, saying that the outlet never interviewed him and that he had not yet retained the lawyers he quoted when the stories first published.

Cusack declined to comment.

Giuliani, then Trump's lawyer, identified himself as a key source to Solomon about the Bidens, Ukraine and Mueller's investigation of Russia's 2016 election interference: “I really turned my stuff over to John Solomon,” he told the New York Times in 2019.

Solomon denied this, saying it would have been inappropriate because he was negotiating a podcast deal with Giuliani at the time.

By September 2019, Solomon had resigned from the Hill to start his own media company, Just the News. He was also named a Fox News contributor, but that relationship lasted only a year.

A scarlet letter

Solomon describes his current job as a kind of state-sponsored Freedom of Information Act request. The White House first mentioned the task force earlier this summer, but it's unclear who else is involved beyond Solomon and a group of intelligence officers. Solomon said he works with officers assigned to the President's Intelligence Advisory Board who review and determine whether to declassify the documents he requests. Solomon says he has no access to what his team finds until the White House decides to release it.

He said that he gets the documents at the same time as the public — they're posted to the White House website — and that he devotes his time to providing background briefings for White

SEE SOLOMON ON A7

More than two dozen people who worked with Solomon said in interviews that they do not recognize the hard-charging reporter they once knew in the man now working for the president.

SOLOMON FROM A6

House reporters.

“If there’s something that involves the president’s declassification, it’s his decision whether to declassify,” he said. “I abide by that,” adding the president and White House officials have been very “cordial” and “hands off” with regard to his work.

Solomon said he is on leave as Just the News editor in chief and doesn’t earn a government salary. Still, he continues to publish articles with his byline and co-hosts a daily show “Just the News, No Noise” on the right-wing streaming platform Real America’s Voice, in which he sometimes covers his team’s findings.

He said he asked the White House counsel for approval. “The guidance I got was pretty simple, which is if you do anything that gives you an advantage in the job for your site — [you’re] done,” he said. “If you publish a story like everybody else at the same time, because you made it available to everybody, you’re not in any way leveraging the advantage of your government job. They told me that would be fine, and I’ve abided by that.” The White House said that Solomon is in line with ethical guidelines for special government employees, engaged with White House



SAUL LOEB/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Solomon said he was involved in preparing Trump’s July speech, during which the president warned of “shocking vulnerabilities” in the U.S. election system.

ethics officials and was advised on managing potential conflicts. Just the News, which Solomon owns through a company called Bentley Media Group, makes money from advertising and donations. It has a “strategic partnership” with Real America’s Voice, which also hosts a video version of the Stephen K. Bannon podcast “War Room” as well as “The Charlie Kirk Show.”

The day after Trump’s July speech, Solomon went on his show and talked about his search.

“Yes, I was kind of involved in that speech last night and the final preparations before the president let the American people know that for the last six years we’ve had a glass chin when it comes to election security,” he said. “It doesn’t mean that we’ve caught widespread cheating yet. But it is absolutely certain now that the American public was in an election system that had significant vulnerabilities.”

The good news, he said, is that “today the process of fixing those vulnerabilities begins.”

On Aug. 12, Solomon published a story on Just the News based on documents he found. One declassified spreadsheet appears to show that the FBI listed Solomon as a “conduit” for Russian disinformation for his role in the 2019 impeachment proceedings. Solomon said this label was applied out of fear that he might participate in a documentary.

Still, Solomon had become subject, source and scribe.

Glenn Kessler, who ran the Fact Checker column at The Post for years, said Solomon was “no slouch” at investigative reporting. “It’s just that he’s turned those talents on behalf of an

ideological agenda, which is generally what you are not supposed to do as a reporter,” he said.

Kessler said that Solomon’s current role represents a fantasy for any journalist. “In some ways it’s the dream job for an investigative reporter,” Kessler said, but that he argues Solomon has crossed a line. “There doesn’t seem to be the motivation to seek the truth. It’s a motivation to advance one side, one person’s narrative.”

Solomon said Kessler’s assessment deserves “four Pinocchio’s,” referring to the Fact Checker’s rating for falsehoods while at The Post.

Even from his new perch, Solomon remains attached to his long-held identity as a journalist.

Joining the ranks of the federal government feels “very odd” to him, he said, likening his government badge to the scarlet letter worn by Hester Prynne.

His White House colleagues even bought him a T-shirt that says, “Well, now I’m the deep state.”

But he said he’s doing important work. “We’re not outing sources,” he said. “We’re not damaging national security. We’re telling stories that were long secret that the public could have benefited from — and I’m grateful.”

Human-caused Nev. wildfire forces mass evacuations

Authorities urge 90,000 in Reno area to flee; at least six people are injured

BY JOHN RABY,
JACK BROOK
AND JOHN SEEWER
Associated Press

A fast-growing wildfire destroying homes in northwest Reno, Nevada, on Sunday was human-caused and uncontained, authorities said, as they encouraged some 90,000 people to evacuate. At least six people were injured.

The Hawk Fire began Saturday and quickly grew to 20 square miles as it spread across the Peavine Peak area of the Humboldt-Toiyabe National Forest, where rugged foothills are ringed by homes and businesses near the California state line.

The fire moved rapidly Saturday night, jumping over fire trucks and making it difficult for responders to get to hotspots while residents were trying to get out, Washoe County Sheriff Darin Balaam said.

“It was extremely confusing,” the sheriff said, describing how changing winds sent the flames in different directions.

Several structures were destroyed and the injured included three civilians and three first responders, officials said. They did not provide additional details on how the fire was started, saying it was under investigation.

Some 42,000 residents have been ordered evacuated as the “GO NOW” zone expanded, approaching the University of Nevada at Reno campus. An additional 45,000 people were in the adjacent evacuation warning zone. Authorities implored all of them to leave and be prepared to stay away for several days, because shifting and strengthening winds were expected to make the fire even more unpredictable.

“Please get out if you can right now,” the sheriff said.

Nevada Gov. Joe Lombardo (R) declared a state of emergency in Washoe County and mobilized the Nevada National Guard to support aerial firefighting with two helicopter crews as well as 60 troops to help police safeguard evacuated neighborhoods. Also responding were 800 fire personnel.

Nearly 10,000 customers were without power in Washoe County on Sunday, down from 60,000 on Saturday. Portions of U.S. Route 395, a major north-south highway, were closed because of the fire. Reno, with more than 280,000 residents, is the largest city in Nevada outside of metro Las Vegas.

Washoe County emergency officials opened the Reno-Sparks Convention Center to evacuees but said they could not bring their pets — small animals and large animals were to be left at two other locations. Casinos in Reno offered discounted hotel rooms to evacuees.

Cari Kieffer said a video posted on social media showed her house destroyed by fire, with only a scorched basketball hoop still standing.

“I woke up this morning and just started crying — all my kids, they lost everything,” Kieffer said Sunday. “We lost all our stuff. Everything we own is gone.”



@SQUINTDEV/REUTERS

A social media video shows smoke and flames from the Hawk Fire near Reno, Nevada, on Saturday. The blaze began Saturday and spread rapidly Saturday night.

Kieffer had been watching her son’s football game Saturday when she learned that their home on the outskirts of Reno was in the evacuation zone. An application the family used to track the fire’s progress had been lagging significantly behind its actual location, she said, so they thought firefighters had kept the blaze from their neighborhood.

Instead, Kieffer, her husband and their four children ages 3 to 16 raced to save their dogs and

whatever possessions they could retrieve. Ash rained down, and the wind blew like an oven blast from a wall of flames advancing down the hillside toward their neighborhood, she said.

“I kept looking outside and the flames just kept getting closer and closer every time I looked,” Kieffer said. “I was like, we got to go like now.”

Eyes watering and throat burning, Kieffer grabbed a handful of clothes, a Bible, her wed-

ding photos and her mother’s ashes. In the frenzy, as firefighters yelled at her family to leave immediately, she said, she forgot her family’s birth certificates and was unable to salvage her childhood photos.

The family drove to a friend’s home but had to evacuate again. They learned later Saturday evening that their own home was gone.

Jaida Hargrove’s grandfather, Rick Arrate, lived alone on

Peavine Mountain, which overlooks Reno and Sparks. Firefighters used a bulldozer, cut down trees and applied fire retardant in their attempt to contain the flames, Hargrove said.

“They all thought it would be okay,” she said. “And then, in about 30 minutes, the winds just changed and it came way too fast.”

Arrate and the firefighters were quickly forced off the mountain. “All he was able to take with him was his two golden retrievers,” Hargrove said.

Arrate spent Saturday night with Hargrove’s parents, his next steps unknown.

The fire was so small Saturday morning that it wasn’t even a concern, said Tyler Duvall, who went camping over the weekend. By the next day, his house was in the evacuation zone.

“The wind really blew it up,” Duvall said.

On Saturday alone, 15 new fires popped up across Nevada. Months of dry weather and a record lack of snow this past winter across the West have created prime fire conditions. Earlier this month, wildfires in eastern Washington state forced the evacuation of 60,000 people in the Spokane area, while three wildfires north of Reno forced more than 13,000 residents from their homes.

Retired police officer and firefighter Ted Melden has seen his share of Mother Nature’s fury since moving to Reno with his wife this month from Chapin,

South Carolina. So far, he has experienced a hailstorm with flash flooding, two different power outages and, now, the second wildfire incident in the region in two weeks.

“Just another natural disaster,” Melden said.

In the two years he lived in South Carolina, Melden said, Hurricane Helene knocked over trees in his yard, while a tornado did some damage in his neighborhood.

For now, Melden has not been ordered to leave his home, but he has his bags packed.

“You just have to roll with the flow and be ready,” he said.

David Barb returned from a weekend hunting trip to find that the fire had leveled his taxidermy shop, but his house nearby appeared to have been spared thanks to workers with a landscaping company who cut a fire break, he said. His wife was home when the fire started on the other side of the mountain and later evacuated to a friend’s house.

“I’m kind of devastated, but thank God everyone’s safe,” he said Sunday.

The University of Nevada, where many of the 20,000 undergraduates moved into their housing this weekend, was just outside the evacuation zone Sunday.

Two hospitals evacuated patients and the sheriff said his office was keeping a close watch on whether to evacuate the county jail.



SIMON JOWITT/REUTERS

Video posted on social media shows smoke in Reno. Nevada Gov. Joe Lombardo (R) declared a state of emergency in Washoe County and mobilized the Nevada National Guard to support aerial firefighting.

Pentagon fires editor, departing publisher of Stars and Stripes

The two had been critical of interference from the Defense Department

BY SCOTT NOVER AND LIAM SCOTT

The Pentagon on Friday fired the publisher and the editor in chief of Stars and Stripes, the military newspaper funded by the Department of Defense that has long enjoyed editorial independence from the government, according to the publication's outgoing editor in chief.

The Defense Department sent a separation notice to publisher Max Lederer, who announced his retirement this past week, telling staff in a parting note he had disagreed with decisions from Pentagon top brass. During the second Trump administration, under Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, the publication's independence has come under threat as top Pentagon leaders have derided the newspaper as “woke.”

Erik Slavin, the editor in chief, said he and reporter Lara Korte also received separation notices Friday.

Slavin said he and Korte were fired for participating in a CBS News interview, during which he said any hypothetical censorship of the military newspaper would cross a red line.

Before Lederer was fired a Defense Department official, Andrew Brey, emailed the publisher asking that he fire Slavin and Korte for participating in the CBS interview, according to two people familiar with the situation, who spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of retribution. The Pentagon said that Lederer was fired for cause due to insubordination but did not comment beyond that.

In the interview with CBS's “Sunday Morning,” Korte discussed the increasingly tense relationship between the publi-



The Defense Department sent separation notices to the publisher and editor in chief of Stars and Stripes, as well as a reporter.

cation and the DOD. “I am working for Stars and Stripes. Not for the Pentagon,” she said. “Not for any administration. Not for any policymaker. I am here to cover the military community.”

“I stand by the principle that Stars and Stripes should remain independent for service members,” Slavin said in a Friday interview with The Washington Post.

“I consider it a great privilege to live alongside members of the military and share their stories,” Korte wrote in a Friday statement. “These firings are a shame

for the institution and service members, who swore to defend the Constitution and deserve the right to a free and independent press.”

Lederer did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

The Pentagon confirmed the firings and said the three employees have five days to appeal. They declined to offer further comment.

Stars and Stripes was first published during the Civil War and has continuously reported on and for the U.S. military com-

munity since World War II. But it has come under strain since the Pentagon outlined a sweeping “modernization” effort in a March memo, barring it from using wire services like the Associated Press and mandating that all content be consistent with “good order and discipline,” a phrase used in military justice. Two advisory board members sued the government over the memo in June calling it an act of “illegal censorship.”

In April, the Pentagon fired the Stars and Stripes ombudsman, a role charged by Congress

with safeguarding the paper's editorial independence. She sued the government on First Amendment grounds in June.

This month, the Pentagon installed an active-duty Navy captain, William Urban, as deputy publisher without consulting Lederer. A group of Senate Democrats on Thursday sent a letter to Hegseth outlining their concerns that the move could indicate further erosion of the paper's independence.

Rufus Friday, chair of the Stars and Stripes publishers' advisory board, said the board

“is deeply concerned that these actions further threaten to interrupt the editorial independence that is essential to Stars and Stripes' credibility and its ability to serve the military community with trusted, independent journalism.”

William Gallo, the publication's bureau chief for Europe and the Middle East, told staff in an email obtained by The Washington Post that despite the terminations, the mission of Stars and Stripes continues.

“I am still here, and you are still here. And we will continue to do independent journalism, in accordance with our legal mandate,” he wrote. “I know more clearly than ever that we all chose to work at Stars and Stripes because we believed in its mission. That mission still exists.”

One Stars and Stripes staffer, who spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of professional retaliation, said they were concerned about the newspaper's continued ability to independently cover the military.

“I have to assume that anything is fair game at this point,” they said.

In an open letter published Friday, Urban did not address the trio of firings but said he feels confident that the Pentagon will respect the paper's editorial independence. “During my interviews with the Office of the Secretary of War (OSW) to be the Military Deputy to the Publisher, I received multiple assurances that OSW was committed to the editorial independence of Stripes,” he wrote.

Urban mentioned the newspaper's reporting on the poor conditions aboard the USS Abraham Lincoln. “There was plenty of time between the initial report and the subsequent reporting for OSW to shut us down on the subject if they were not committed to our editorial independence,” he said. “It is time to take them at their word and get on with the business of reporting.”

Trump's visa ban on 75 countries is struck down by a federal judge

BY TEO ARMUS

The Trump administration must resume processing visas for people from 75 countries that the government deemed likely to become a “public charge,” a federal judge in New York ruled Friday, curbing one of the latest efforts to restrict legal immigration pathways to the United States.

The halt to visa processing began in January, affecting dozens of countries in every corner of the globe. It was meant to limit visas for people the government said would probably rely on public benefits for their basic needs, long a complaint from President Donald Trump.

But U.S. District Judge Jeanette Vargas, an appointee of President Joe Biden, ruled that

the policy “represents a direct abrogation” of consular officers' exclusive, congressionally granted authority to determine if someone is eligible for a visa.

Vargas also said the nationality-based visa ban, which applied to all nationals of the 75 countries no matter their income or economic status, ignores anti-discrimination protections in federal immigration law.

Vargas's order came in response to a lawsuit from two nonprofit groups and 11 individuals: six people whose family members' visa applications had been rejected under the freeze, and another five who had filed work-related petitions to come to the United States.

Amaha Kassa, executive director of African Communities Together, one of the groups

that sued, welcomed the ruling against a policy that he said lacked solid evidence or rationale.

“The decision on whether [someone should] receive a visa should be an individual decision,” he said. “It shouldn't be based on profiling on stereotypes of certain countries.”

A State Department spokesperson declined to comment on ongoing litigation but said in a statement that the Trump administration is “protecting the American people by upholding the highest standards of screening and vetting of visa applicants.”

The January policy did not affect visas that had already been issued. Nor did it apply to non-immigrant visas, such as those granted to students and tourists,



President Donald Trump and Secretary of State Marco Rubio, pictured earlier this month.

but otherwise prevented consular officers from issuing visas on work or family grounds.

Experts said that the indefinite pause would turn away nearly half of all legal immigrants over a one-year period. People from the countries affected, many of them in Africa, the Middle East and the Caribbean, account for 40 to 45 percent of

all immigrant visas.

The visa freeze followed a broader State Department directive in November that tightened rules around potential immigrants who might become “public charges.”

According to the Associated Press, State Department officials cited data from the Council of Economic Advisers noting that

more than 30 percent of households with immigrants from the targeted countries received some form of public assistance.

But Kassa, of African Communities Together, said such an approach painted all people from the targeted countries with an overly broad brush. The purpose of these visas, he noted, is often to reunite families.

The visa freeze had been one of many ways in which State Department has sought to restrict migration to the U.S. in recent months.

Also last year, the Trump administration expanded a travel ban on entry to the United States to the citizens of 39 countries after an Afghan immigrant was charged in the shooting of two National Guard troops. Of those countries, 24 were included in the suspension of visa processing.

A federal judge in June ordered the federal government to resume processing citizenship, green-card and work permit applications for people affected by the ban.

DIGEST

ECONOMY

Trump says he has deal on beef prices

President Donald Trump said Friday that he's making a deal to bring down ground beef prices, without providing many details.

In a post on his Truth Social website, he said he would remove tariffs on up to 300,000 metric tons of ground beef imports. “We have a commitment that this beef will be sold at 25 percent below current market prices,” Trump wrote.

The White House did not respond to questions about how this deal would work: Who will sell this cheaper beef, and why? Several supermarket brands and grocery trade groups did not respond to questions from The Washington Post or said they did not know anything about the deal.

Lifting tariffs won't necessarily do much to reduce beef prices, since more than 80 percent of the beef Americans eat is raised domestically.

Trump is focused on ground beef because the price has soared, while other groceries that spiked in price during the high inflation of 2022 have leveled off. The average cost of a pound of ground beef in 75 U.S. cities was \$6.89 last month, nearly double what it was in 2016. Ground beef now costs more per pound than bacon for the first time.

The rising cost of energy resulting from the war in Iran has contributed to climbing prices for several grocery items, including beef.

Demand for beef has been rising; red meat is currently in vogue. At the same time, the U.S. cattle herd has shrunk, contributing to higher prices.

Monday's planned reopening of the feeder cattle trade with Mexico, closed for more than a year over concern about screw-worm parasites, may eventually help support U.S. beef production. But agricultural economists say that won't change the fundamental factors — reduced herd size and domestic production — driving the elevated prices.

— Julie Z. Weil, Cat Zakrzewski and Rachel Lerman

CAMPAIGNS

RNC leads DNC in cash, filings show

With the midterms less than a dozen weeks away, the Republican National Committee continues to boast a massive cash advantage over its Democratic counterpart, according to Federal Election Commission disclosures made by both committees last week.

The filings, which cover the month of July, show that the Democratic National Committee had about \$16 million of cash on hand at the end of the month

compared with the Republican National Committee's \$130 million in cash.

The DNC also has \$17.9 million in debts, though the committee has reduced its debts by roughly 3 percent from the \$18.5 million in debts and obligations owed at the end of June.

The Democrats' fundraising arm has been mired in money issues for months: The Washington Post reported in July that though DNC Chair Ken Martin and allies expected Democratic victories and the approaching midterms to bring major donors back, that hasn't materialized.

The RNC raised \$19 million in July while the DNC raised \$9 million.

Regarding the DNC's spending strategy, a DNC official pointed The Post to a Wednesday Substack post from Martin, where he argued that across the country, “Democrats are showing up.”

“This DNC has raised a record amount from both major donors and grassroots supporters when compared to the last midterm cycle in Trump's term,” he wrote.

— Violet Jira

TEXAS

Abbott wants inquiry into washing stations

Texas Gov. Greg Abbott (R) on Friday escalated his campaign to get rid of washing stations for Muslims at Texas's two largest

airports, asking the Justice Department to investigate the facilities as discriminatory.

“They are not interfaith chapels open to all,” Abbott said in a statement. “They exist to benefit the Muslim population alone.”

The stations have been at the Dallas-Fort Worth International Airport and Houston's George Bush Intercontinental Airport for years, providing Muslims with a place to wash their hands, feet and faces before prayers, which they perform five times a day.

Recently, Abbott, who is seeking reelection for a fourth term, asked the Department of Transportation to withhold grant money from the airports until they closed the facilities.

Shortly after, officials at Dallas-Fort Worth airport decided not to proceed with additional washing stations they had planned.

Muslim leaders and experts in religious liberties rejected Abbott's claim that the facilities discriminate against non-Muslims. Several said opposition to the washing stations is the latest example of GOP leaders, perhaps most visibly in Texas, railing against Islam.

“Although Gov. Abbott's letter characterized what the airports were providing as discriminating in favor of Muslims,” wrote Steven T. Collis, a University of Texas at Austin law professor, in an email to The Post, “this

newest saga is actually part of a much broader pattern of state officials targeting Muslims and trying to make Texas an inhospitable place for them.”

— Molly Hennessy-Fiske

FOOD SAFETY

CDC issues alert on alfalfa sprouts

The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention issued a food safety alert Friday warning people not to eat potentially contaminated alfalfa sprouts.

The public health agency said 55 people across 15 states — the majority in Minnesota and Wisconsin — have gotten sick with salmonella or E. coli and that the illnesses were linked to alfalfa sprouts. Four people were hospitalized.

Affected products included alfalfa sprouts grown by Minnesota-based Everything Sprouts and sold under the Calco and Everything Sprouts brands, the CDC said. Consumers are advised to throw away or return any potentially affected alfalfa sprouts and sanitize surfaces that may have touched the product.

The CDC typically issues food safety alerts when a recall cannot be recommended, such as before a specific source has been identified. A recall can sometimes follow.

Symptoms of E. coli infection include stomach cramps, diarrhea and vomiting usually three

or four days after consumption. Symptoms of salmonella infection include diarrhea, fever and stomach cramps anywhere from six hours to six days after consumption.

— Amy B Wang

DEFENSE DEPARTMENT

U.S. casualties jump to 774 in Iran war

The number of U.S. service members reported wounded or killed in the Iran war has jumped to 774, after the Pentagon added scores of new troops to the wounded list in the past week.

To date, 18 of those troops were killed in the conflict and 756 were wounded, according to the Pentagon's casualty reporting system. The numbers rose even as the United States has largely been in a ceasefire with Iran in recent weeks. Some of the added troop numbers may reflect lag time between an injury being documented in the military's medical system and it showing up in the casualty database.

President Donald Trump did not extend the ceasefire with Iran, which expired last Monday. Since then, there has not been a large-scale resumption of combat operations by either side. The conflict, which Trump said would be done in weeks, has stretched into its sixth month.

— Tara Copp



CHIP SOMODEVILLA/GETTY IMAGES

Construction continues on the ballroom in May. The president has said the ballroom is necessary because it would provide a secure, hardened facility. But former officials argue the White House already has one.

Secret bunker complicates Trump’s case for a ballroom

WHITE HOUSE FROM A1

emerging legal argument in the ongoing lawsuit over the \$600 million ballroom complex's construction: that the facility must be completed due to its significance for U.S. national security.

The people spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss elements of the secretive facility, some of which have not been previously reported.

The Washington Post is withholding some details of the bunker and its construction in order to not compromise sensitive White House security protocols.

Asked about Trump's assertions about the need for a new military complex, the White House defended the project and criticized past officials for discussing existing security structures.

"The East Wing Modernization Project is inextricably tied to the security of the President, the White House grounds and the certain security infrastructure assets," said White House spokesman Davis Ingle in a statement.

"Recent events such as the foiled attack on the historic UFC Freedom 250 event at the White House proves exactly why the East Wing Modernization Project is severely needed for large scale events, which include drone proof structures and drone ports among other critical security enhancements," Ingle added.

Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. issued an order Friday allowing the Trump administration to continue ballroom work in the short term as the Supreme Court weighs an emergency appeal in a lawsuit challenging whether the construction requires the approval of Congress.

A U.S. district judge and a federal appeals panel have both ordered the administration to stop building the ballroom until lawmakers authorize the project. But the judges carved out an exception: construction on national security needs, such as a planned military complex underneath the ballroom, can continue.

In August court filings supporting the White House's case, Trump's top national security team urged the Supreme Court to allow the project to proceed. The construction, they said, comes as

the president faces rising threats from foreign adversaries and terrorists, alongside advances in commercial drone technology that could more effectively target White House grounds.

Trump officials argued the ballroom complex would provide essential security upgrades to the president's residence and help guarantee the U.S. government could continue functioning during a crisis.

White House Deputy Chief of Staff Stephen Miller wrote in his filing that the facility "serves continuity-of-government interests by ensuring that the President and senior national security staff are able to operate from a protected facility during any attack on the nation's capital."

Army Secretary Dan Driscoll has repeatedly asserted the ballroom's construction would help resolve an "emergency" in the White House's "defensive posture" posed by the spread of military-grade drones.

Driscoll told the Supreme Court in an Aug. 13 filing that completing the ballroom complex was necessary so Trump could run the country in a crisis.

"Securing this reinforced subterranean node guarantees uninterrupted command and control in place," Driscoll wrote, calling the project "a nondiscretionary prerequisite to ensure the President can maintain continuity of government, uninterrupted operations, and effectively exercise National Command Authority during an attack or global crisis."

The arguments echoed the Trump administration's increasing effort to rely on national security as a way to justify the ballroom's completion.

Trump has taken to calling the project a "military complex" in his public comments and social media posts, and has repeatedly posted AI renderings of drones, troops and even fuel tanker trucks stationed on the future East Wing roof to press his case.

"The ballroom is so much a military component with the drones and the bomb shelters," Trump told reporters on the South Lawn on Wednesday.

The White House has been racing to complete the project before any court-ordered halt takes effect. Officials told the Supreme Court earlier this month that construction was about

“The East Wing Modernization Project is inextricably tied to the security of the President, the White House grounds and the certain security infrastructure assets.”

White House spokesman Davis Ingle, in a statement

"65% complete" and that about 250 workers are working 20 hours per day, seven days a week to quickly finish it.

The structure goes five stories deep into the ground, and much of the underground work has been completed, the administration said. The project is already 70 feet above ground in some places, officials told the Supreme Court.

After asserting in court last year that the secure portion of the project could be carried out independently of the ballroom, the administration has reversed its argument.

Maj. Gen. Garrett R. Hoffman, director of the White House Military Office, told the Supreme Court that the aboveground ballroom and belowground military facility are "inextricably intertwined elements" and that the new construction "provides extraordinary protection to these spaces that has not been available in the past."

Officials have also stressed that the concrete, steel and other materials used for both parts of the project are being chosen for national security reasons. In court filings, they detailed how the ballroom's construction materials are intended to stop bombs, rockets, missiles and even nuclear blasts.

"It is, in a very large way, a 'safe room' for the Presidency and the continuity of government," wrote Joshua Fisher, a senior White House official who is managing the project, in his Supreme Court filing.

The two former officials noted this same argument had been invoked two decades ago to construct the White House's existing subterranean bunker that is hardened against nuclear blasts and other threats. They questioned why the administration

has suggested that the White House lacks such a secure location, including one that could help ensure a functioning government in national security crises.

They also contrasted secretive efforts to build the existing bunker to the current project. Details about the secure White House facility are among the most closely guarded secrets in the U.S. government, the former officials said, and its construction was concealed from many lawmakers, administration officials and the public.

During the new ballroom's construction, Trump has repeatedly revealed private aspects of the planned East Wing military complex, such as its medical capabilities and "drone port." And the renovation has occurred in public view, potentially allowing foreign adversaries to spy once-hidden elements of the White House complex — a threat Trump officials invoked in their court filings to urge that construction continue.

Trump has separately accused the National Trust for Historic Preservation, the organization that sued to halt the ballroom's construction, of being "treasonists." He has claimed that the nonprofit group, which Congress charged with helping preserve historic buildings, was asked not to file a lawsuit for national security reasons.

"I said the problem with the suit — I told them this — is that we have many military things in this ballroom, and ideally, they shouldn't be revealed," Trump said in the Oval Office on Aug. 17. "But now they are revealed, so the world knows about it."

The National Trust's filings have not revealed any new information about the ballroom project that Trump or the ad-

ministration did not previously disclose.

National Trust officials also told The Post that they were never briefed on the bunker, that they were not asked by Trump or the White House to not file a lawsuit, and that they sued to halt the ballroom because they believe the president does not have the authority to unilaterally make wholesale changes to the historic White House grounds.

Trump officials did share classified information directly with U.S. District Judge Richard J. Leon as he weighed the National Trust's arguments, beginning last year. Leon ultimately ordered a halt to ballroom construction but said the administration could keep working on the underground military complex.

The White House's protections for presidents have evolved as threats have increased.

For decades, the White House bunker was limited to a small facility located in the basement of the East Wing, built during World War II to help protect President Franklin D. Roosevelt in case of an emergency. That site — known as the Presidential Emergency Operations Center, or PEOC — is where the Secret Service hurried Vice President Dick Cheney and first lady Laura Bush during the 9/11 terrorist attacks.

The attacks of Sept. 11 prompted the White House to begin work on a much more secure facility, said journalist Ronald Kessler, who referenced construction of the bunker in his 2018 book, "The Trump White House: Changing the Rules of the Game." The upgraded facility, he wrote, was completed during the Obama administration, had a months-long food supply and was equipped with its own self-contained airflow system.

"It's a serious issue. What could be more important than maintaining continuity of government?" said Kessler, who supports the Trump administration's efforts to expand the White House's secure facilities through the ballroom project.

Kessler and the former officials who spoke with The Post acknowledged the necessity of providing the president with a secure facility amid ongoing serious threats. Trump has faced multiple assassination attempts,

the latest of which — from Iran earlier in the summer — prompted the Secret Service to stage an elaborate ruse that ended with the president flying back from the NATO summit in Ankara on a separate aircraft, apart from Air Force One.

Still, the two former officials questioned the White House's public case that the existing architecture is insufficiently hardened. The existing site, the two people said, is buried deep into the Washington bedrock, accessible by a private elevator and built specifically to protect the president from a vast array of threats, including an attack from a weapon of mass destruction.

Its specifications, the former officials said, include many of the safety protocols the White House is describing in an attempt to justify the new ballroom complex.

The former officials also warned that the administration's abrupt decision to demolish the East Wing, and expose what sat underneath it, could have itself created national security risks. The PEOC, two former officials said, sat only about 20 feet under the East Wing and may have been destroyed or damaged in the construction process.

Fisher, the White House official managing the project, said that he was worried that halting construction now could unwind nearly a year of work.

"Pausing work now, as the district court has ordered, will jeopardize everything we have done so far," Fisher told the Supreme Court. "Depending on how long that freeze persists, it might force us to tear down everything we have done as a degraded mass, to allow for whatever comes next — something that would be disruptive and extremely dangerous."

Similar arguments have not swayed lower-court judges.

Leon, the district judge who first ordered the administration in March to halt its ballroom construction, chastised Trump officials for arguing that they needed to complete the project for safety and security reasons.

"Here is the bottom line," Leon wrote in a follow-up ruling in April. "Defendants themselves forged ahead and created this 'coordinated and managed safety hazard' on White House grounds."

THE WORLD



Britain's Prince Harry and Meghan, Duchess of Sussex, ride in a carriage after their wedding ceremony near London in 2018. The two will be private citizens when they and their children are back in Britain.

Five reasons no one saw Prince Harry’s return coming

California seemed less like exile and more like a fairy-tale ending for a prince who’d found his L.A. princess. Here’s why their move back to the U.K. is such a surprise.

BY KARLA ADAM

Prince Harry is coming home. Mind the gap whiplash.

Prince Harry and Meghan, the Duke and Duchess of Sussex, are moving back to Britain within days and enrolling their children, Prince Archie, 7, and Princess Lilibet, 5, in British schools — an extraordinary plot twist suggesting that England will not be just a base for the Sussexes, but their main home.

Trading what appeared to be an idyllic life on the sunny California coast for the Tupperware-gray skies of Britain came as a startling reversal.

“Not since Bobby Ewing stepped out of the shower in Dallas have we been forced to perform such a double take,” wrote Camilla Tominey in the Daily Telegraph, reaching back four decades for one of TV’s most famous plot twists.

A spokesperson for Harry and Meghan declined to comment when asked why the couple were returning.

Speculation over possible explanations have swirled — from the health of King Charles III to homesickness to the returning couple’s finances.

Two people familiar with the situation, speaking on the condition of anonymity to discuss private royal affairs, confirmed that the Sussexes would return to the United Kingdom later this month, living outside of London.

Perhaps the only predictable thing about Harry and Meghan, his Los Angeles-born wife, is their capacity to surprise. Six years ago they dramatically exited the U.K. after stepping back as working royals.

California didn’t look like exile but rather a fairy-tale ending: beaches, rescue chickens clucking in the backyard and Oprah Winfrey as a neighbor. What more could a prince who’d already found his princess want?

There were plenty of reasons to stay away from the London fog. Here are five that explain why royal-watchers and all of us were caught by surprise.

1. Harry said security concerns meant he couldn’t bring his family back

Harry could not have been clearer. Last year, he told the BBC: “I can’t see a world in which I’d bring my wife and children back to the U.K. at this point.”

In hindsight, “at this point” is doing a lot of work in that sentence. Harry was speaking to the public broadcaster after losing a legal appeal over his security arrangements while in Britain. He even took the government to court — and ultimately lost — over the decision to strip him of automatic, taxpayer-financed police protection after he stepped down as a working royal. That decision has not been reversed.

However, the BBC reported Thursday that the family’s level of publicly funded security will be reassessed, as the existing arrangement was based on them visiting Britain, not living there.

There were other hints in Harry’s May 2025 interview with the BBC that the U.K. still had pulling power. “I love my country. I always have done, despite what some people in that country have done,” he said. “I miss parts of the U.K., of course I do, and I think that it’s really quite sad that I won’t be able to show, you know, my children my homeland.”

And yet, last month, Harry did exactly that. Meghan and the kids joined Harry on a trip to the U.K. including a visit with King Charles.

2. No palace, no royal job

If Harry and Meghan were coming back to work for a slimmed-down monarchy, that would be one thing. But they are not returning as working royals. There is no desk waiting for Harry at Buckingham Palace.

They will be private citizens. Queen Elizabeth II rejected a “half in, half out” option, and there’s no evidence of a change of heart by Charles. Harry and Meghan gave up Frogmore Cottage, their five-bedroom residence in Windsor, after being asked to relinquish the property in 2023.

Harry is expected to be closely involved with the Invictus Games, a sporting competition for wounded veterans, and he retains strong ties with other U.K. charities. Meghan is expected to continue with her lifestyle business, As Ever.

But there has been no royal summons. No recall. Indeed, the king only heard of the plans over the weekend. Apparently, this was not his idea.

3. Harry’s war with the tabloids

Harry’s loathing of the British



A newsstand in Britain after the publication in 2023 of Harry’s memoir, “Spare.”

tabloids is no secret. His public war with them was at odds with the royal family mantra: “Never complain, never explain.” His anger goes back to the death of his mother, Princess Diana, who was hounded by the press, and was further fueled by fear that Meghan could also fall prey.

In June 2023, in his lawsuit against the publisher of the Daily Mirror, Harry became the first senior royal in more than a century to testify in court. He stated that he and his wife moved to California “due to the constant intrusion, inciting of hatred and harassment by the tabloid press

into every aspect of our private lives, which had a devastating impact on our mental health and well-being.”

He took his fight to other newspapers as well. In 2025, he settled with Rupert Murdoch’s media group for more than 10 million pounds (about \$13 mil-



Harry in 2016 at the Invictus Games, an international sporting event for wounded, injured and sick service members. Harry is a patron of the Invictus Games Foundation.

lion). Last month, however, he lost a case against the publisher of the Daily Mail, which Harry called a “complete and obvious whitewash, but sadly not altogether unexpected.”

Now, he is returning his family to a country whose tabloid culture he said once drove them away.

4. The royal rift

Harry’s relationship with his father, Charles, has improved since the spring of 2025, when Harry disclosed that the two weren’t speaking. They had tea that September, and Harry’s family met Charles and Queen Camilla last month at Highgrove, the monarch’s personal home in Gloucestershire.

It appeared to go well, and Harry was reportedly “buoyed” and “energized” by the meeting.

But while Harry’s relationship with Charles has thawed, his relationship with his brother Prince William, the likely next king, remains in a deep freeze. The two do not talk. The BBC said William and Catherine were made aware of the Sussexes’ return, but Kensington Palace has not released a statement.

5. California looked like home

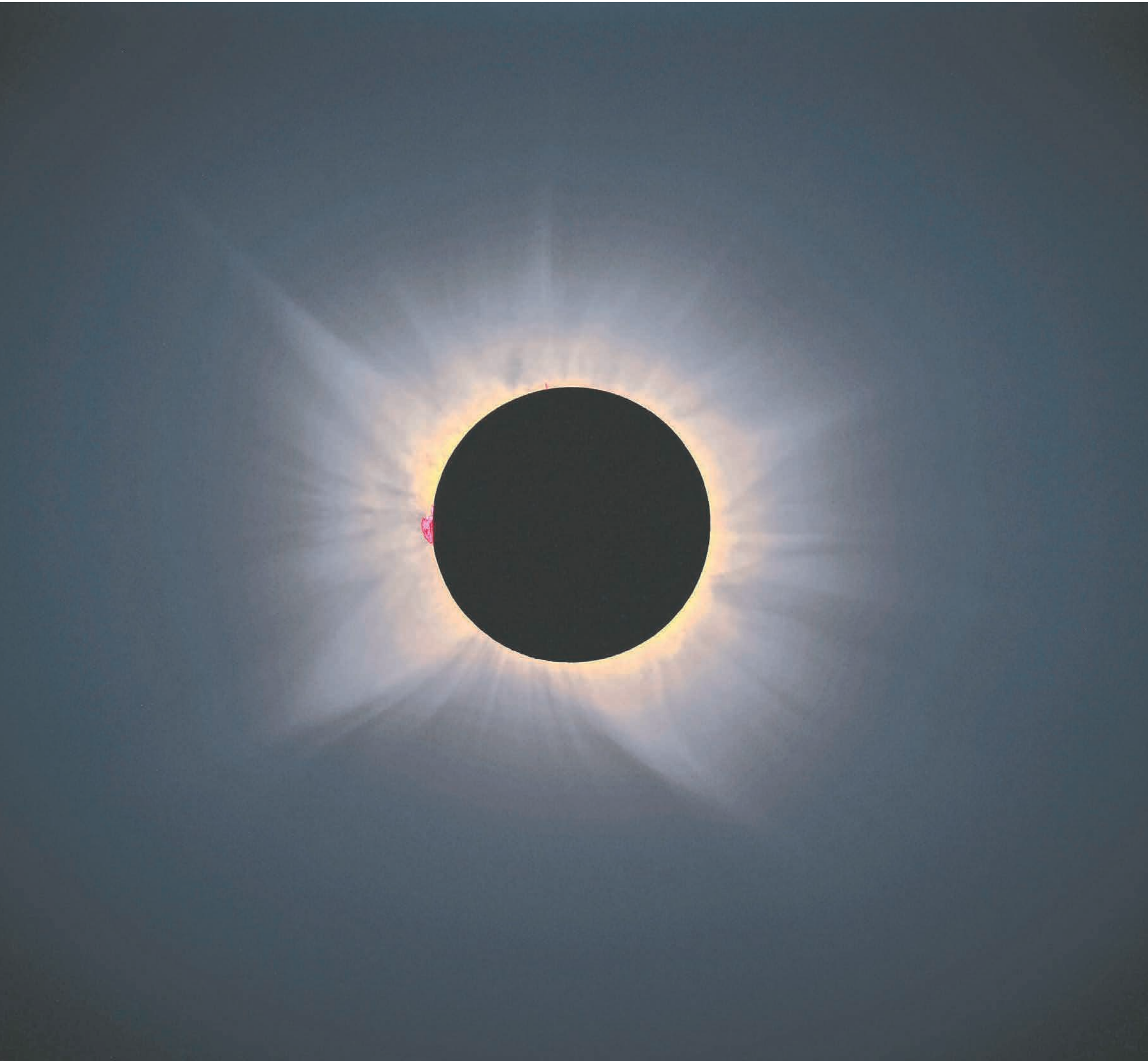
There were chickens in the backyard, children playing in the garden, bicycle rides with Archie, and intertwined palm trees that Harry thought represented himself and Meghan. If this was exile, banishment had a lot going for it.

At least in the images they projected, the Sussexes seemed settled.

In May 2021, Harry told the podcast “Armchair Expert” that in their Santa Barbara community, Montecito, he walked around “feeling a little bit more free” and could take “Archie on the back of my bicycle.”

The U.K., on the other hand, was a place Harry visited — and sometimes only fleetingly. When Charles was diagnosed with cancer in February 2024, Harry jumped on a plane but reportedly spent only 45 minutes with his father at Clarence House, and he was back at Heathrow the following day. In the 2021 docuseries “The Me You Can’t See,” Harry said that when he flew to Britain, he felt “worried, concerned, a little bit tense and uptight,” adding that “London is a trigger because of what happened to my mum.”

Now, and again, it’s home.



A photo composite of the moment of totality during the Aug. 12 solar eclipse. The corona, the sun’s atmosphere, has a high dynamic range, or range in brightness, making it tricky to capture in an image.

Capturing the majesty of the sun’s atmosphere

Only visible during a total solar eclipse, there are few things more difficult to photograph

BY MATTHEW CAPPUCCI

There are few things more beautiful than the corona, the sun’s atmosphere, visible only during total solar eclipses like the one that occurred earlier this month over a narrow swath of eastern Greenland, western Iceland and Spain.

There are also few things more difficult to photograph.

Total solar eclipses happen somewhere on Earth once every 18 months, give or take. They often track over desolate or remote areas. They last seconds on the minute. And to capture one, there’s no way to practice until totality arrives.

I’m by no means a photographer, but I’ve learned a thing or two over the years. While shooting tornadoes, meteors and lightning strikes has become routine, I have found there is no way to accurately capture a total solar eclipse, or the corona, in a single photograph.

That’s because the corona has a high dynamic range, or range in brightness. The lower corona, closest to the sun’s surface, is bright. The outer corona, millions of miles away, is faint and diaphanous.

During totality, the moon fully blocks the sun’s direct light, and the corona becomes visible. The human eye can see all parts of the corona at once. The camera, however, can’t. Capturing the outer corona requires a longer exposure to absorb more light and detail. That overexposes the inner corona.

That means a composite, or a stitched-together blend of several photographs, is the only way to accurately represent the corona. (When I write “accurately,” I mean it in the sense of depicting what a scene looks like in real life. I want to document and visually immortalize the magic of nature.)

I didn’t know all of that in 2017, when I witnessed my first total solar eclipse near Alliance, Nebraska. I was a bit more prepared when I flew to Chile for the July 2, 2019, eclipse, and I learned a little more in 2024. This time, I was really ready. I brought a 600 millimeter telephoto lens (i.e. a big, long one that’s super zoomy), researched the settings I needed and learned to use Photoshop.

Months in advance, I scouted locations across northern Spain in the path of totality. I settled on a remote hillside in Tórtoles de Esgueva. I didn’t want any human-built structures — just a distant lake flanked by hills on either side. A winding dirt road in the middle of the shot anchored the scenic vista’s symmetry. My friend Austin then used an app to check the position of the sun against the topography to make sure it would be above the horizon at eclipse time.

When totality came, I had 1 minute 43 seconds to snap a range of exposures. To capture “Bailey’s Beads,” or the last pinpricks of sunlight shining through the valleys of the moon, I elected for just a thousandth of a second. The brighter, lower corona was 1/250th of a second. Then I scrubbed through slightly longer exposures to resolve the dim outer corona. The longest was a half a second. (In

retrospect, I probably should have gone even longer.)

In the final 15 seconds of the eclipse, I used two other cameras to snap wide-angle panoramic shots. I wanted a couple of souvenir images with the landscape included, too. Then it was time to get to work.

A corona composite

I chose five single-image frames and manually aligned them. That meant making sure the overlapping images were properly lined up. Computers can do this automatically, but I wanted to do it by hand. That’s because the computer aligns based on objects. In this case, the object it would see was the moon. But the moon was very, very gradually moving in front of the sun. That meant the moon’s position was a pixel or two different between each exposure. That’s why I pre-

ferred to align based on the corona.

Once I did that, I tweaked the transparency of each image. The topmost layer was the inner corona, and the bottom layer was the outer. Together, they all stack into a combined image. (It’s like looking through a series of windows, one in front of another. If you painted a single letter on each window and then stared lengthwise through all of them, you’d see a full word. Same thing here.)

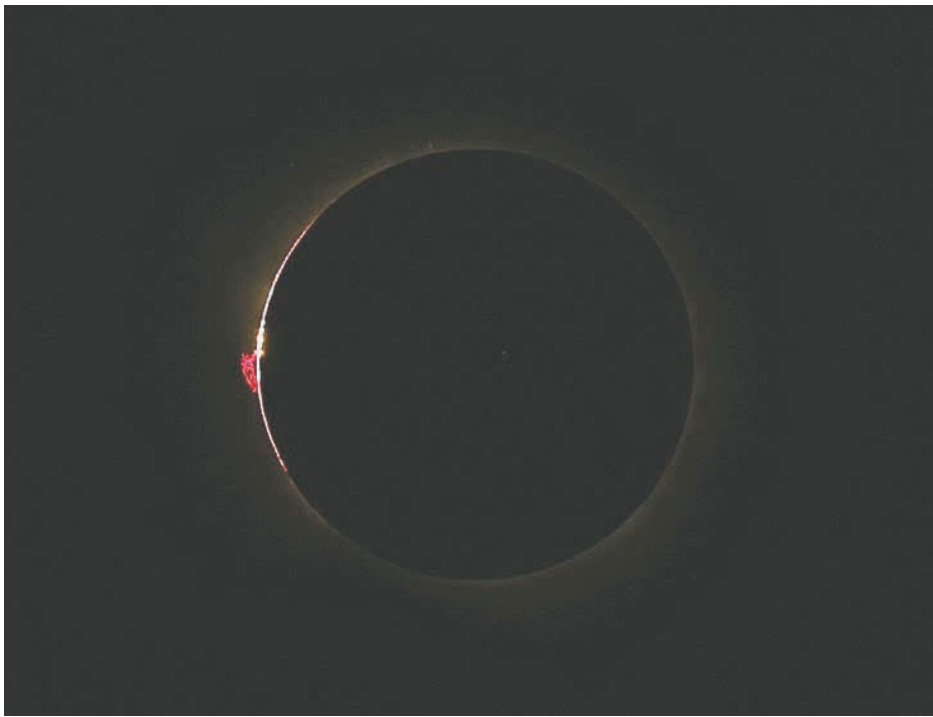
I tweaked each until I was happy with the combined image — one that shows the roiling inner corona *and* the correctly resolved streamers of the outer corona. If you look closely, you can even see a few coronal loops close to the sun’s surface. That’s where magnetic flux pours into space and then reconnects elsewhere on the solar disk, tracing a loop.

You’ll also notice a big, red flame-looking thing on the left. That’s a “prominence,” or a plume of rising plasma in the photosphere and chromosphere (the first and second layers of the sun’s atmosphere, respectively). It’s *huge* — several Earths could fit inside. The glow comes from charged, superheated hydrogen (though there’s some helium in there, too). With lots of overlapping images, the red was washed out, so I re-added the prominence once the rest of the stack was done.

The final obstacle was the moon. Remember how the moon was moving a bit? Overlapping five slightly misaligned moons made an annoying blurred circle. I simply extracted the moon in isolation from one of the images and added it as a top layer to preserve its crisp edges. For Free Papers Check soft. ac The pitch-black darkness was how it looked in real life.

I’m a stickler when it comes to representing scenes according to their real-life appearance. To get the color of the corona correct, I matched it to a separate photo (one of the panoramic shots). Ordinarily the corona looks white, but this was a sunset eclipse. That made it visually appear peachy, like any sunset would.

The end result is something I’m proud of. It’s not a crazy-enhanced or digitally altered masterpiece. It’s simply a representation of the majesty I witnessed, and experienced, perched atop a desolate Spanish hillside.



A brilliant red offshoot erupts off the left side of the sun as darkness falls during the total solar eclipse on Aug. 12, as seen from Tórtoles de Esgueva, Spain.

ECONOMY & BUSINESS

Cost of back-to-school supplies is rising, report finds

Many teachers ask parents to buy items that total nearly \$100

BY JULIE Z. WEIL

It's back-to-school shopping season, which means parents are spending money on new crayons and notebooks. Parents are calculating just how much they can afford to spend on school supplies, what children can reuse from the year before and what on teachers' lists will have to be abandoned.

The cost of school supplies has risen nearly 8 percent since last year, according to a report from the left-leaning groups the Century Foundation and Groundwork Collaborative, which pointed out that the makers of such school staples as Elmer's glue, Mead and Five Star notebooks, and Logitech headphones have all spoken publicly about raising their prices because of the Trump administration's tariffs on imported goods.

The days of students making an annual trip to the office supply store with their back-to-school shopping lists in hand have gotten an internet-age makeover. Today, more than a million classroom teachers have posted the items they want their students to buy to the website TeacherLists.com. The average total spending to buy the whole list? \$91.55, for an average of 15 items, for those who shop at Target and Walmart, the website's vice president, Elizabeth Lampert, said. With one click, parents can add all the items on the list to their online shopping carts at a store like Amazon, Staples or Office Depot, and buy the whole kit with another click.

Princess Heard, a single mom of two in Roswell, Georgia, starts putting away money for fall back-to-school supplies as soon as her kids come home from their last day of school each spring. Heard, who works for a health insurance company, budgeted that she would need \$200 this year to outfit her kids with new backpacks and the items from their teachers' lists. She took online surveys for cash to make the money.

When she took her kids to Target the day before school started, she kept a calculator



MICHAEL M. SANTIAGO/GETTY IMAGES

Back-to-school shopping at a Target in Brooklyn this month. A recent Good Morning America-Ipsos poll found that most parents say such trips are more expensive this year.

open on her phone, tallying as they put what they needed into the cart. She hit her \$200 maximum before they finished their lists. "The deals weren't as good as they normally were, in previous years," she said. "We didn't get as many supplies as I normally do. ... Usually I'm able to get everything."

Heard ended up deciding not to buy any of the classroom supplies the teachers requested, like wipes and tissues. She'll bring some in later in the school year, she said.

In a Good Morning America-Ipsos poll conducted late July, two-thirds of parents said back-to-school shopping is more expensive this year, and nearly nobody said it's cheaper. They said they'd spend an average of

\$118 per child on school supplies, and a total of more than \$800 on sports gear, clothes, books, technology and other back-to-school shopping.

Some of the items most commonly on teachers' lists are relatively cheap. Target, which said in a news release that 95 percent of its school supplies are at or below last year's retail prices, is selling 24-packs of Crayola crayons, double packs of Elmer's glue, two big pink erasers, or pocket folders with prongs for 50 cents each right now.

Annie Redlin, a nurse in Rochester, Minnesota, who shares parenting ideas on her website, asked her three sons to gather up all their leftover supplies and dump them out on the floor ahead of their first day

of school next week. She called out each item on their teachers' shopping lists, asking if they already had it in the pile.

"We do not need all new markers. ... Some of those notebooks have two pages used; we rip out the pages," Redlin said. "Seventy-five percent of the things I'm sending back to school this year are reused, which is really helpful for the budget. ... They've never once said, 'Mom, I don't have new crayons like my friends.'"

Her husband, a physical education teacher at the boys' school, took them shopping for what was left on their list: crayons for the first-grader, new binders and folders, a pencil holder for the sixth-grader. He walked out having spent about

\$35 for the three kids.

"Truthfully, I feel a little bit of a sense of relief," Redlin said. "Life feels really expensive right now, with groceries and clothes for three growing kids. It was really nice to not feel stressed about how much money I spent on school supplies."

In Alexandria, Virginia, 14 public elementary schools have posted their supply lists on TeacherLists.com. The average second-grader is asked to bring 13 items at an average cost of \$61.87 at Target.

But many families end up spending more. Several of the Alexandria schools' lists, for example, include the same clear plastic pencil case, selling for \$4. If your kid wants the one with a Minion or Pokémon or

a Star Wars figure on it, it's \$7. Upgrade from clear to pink or blue, and it's \$10. Add a wavy fidget design, it's \$14.

Zoie Hoffman, a math tutor in Las Vegas, had to buy school supplies for her first-grade twins for the first time this year. It cost about \$200 to buy everything on the school list: scissors, crayons, markers, colored paper, cardstock, paper towels, baby wipes.

She tries to save money, including by looking for high-quality backpacks and water bottles that she won't need to replace for years. But she also bears in mind that most of her children's education is free.

"My mindset is, we're going to public school, and you know, this is just part of it."

Buc-ee's faces backlash after suing over an Ohio mini mart's beaver logo

BY JULIE CARR SMYTH
Associated Press

BEAVERCREEK, OHIO — A lip-licking alligator, a smiling moose and a hat-wearing bear are among the many cartoon animals to have found themselves in the crosshairs of Buc-ee's, the Texas-based convenience store chain that has a penchant for protecting its bucktoothed beaver mascot.

But now Buc-ee's has set off a Buckeye backlash across Ohio and beyond after taking on a beaver in the city of Beavercreek with a trademark infringement lawsuit.

Supporters of Beaver's Mini Mart have attacked Buc-ee's online and boycotted the chain, and the mini mart's home city passed a resolution making the beaver an official part of its history. Comedian John Oliver has even weighed in on the kerfuffle.

On an episode of "Last Week Tonight With John Oliver," he detailed Buc-ee's aggressive history of trademark lawsuits targeting various woodland creatures and launched a website hawking merchandise bearing a knock-off "Buc-off" logo and a squirrel mascot named Mr. Nutterbutter. On X, #boycottbucees trended.

Buc-ee's sued Beaver's Mini Mart in late July, four months after the chain known for its extensive food offerings and massive restrooms opened its first Ohio store less than a half-hour's drive away.

Buc-ee's argues that the shop's beaver logo too closely resembles the convenience store giant's branded Buc-ee ("Bucky") beaver. The company asked for a jury trial in federal court in Ohio.

Beaver's Mini Mart occupies a long, low building with a shingle roof at a suburban intersection. In contrast, the new 74,000-square-foot Buc-ee's off Interstate 70 near Dayton has more than 100 gas pumps, 24 electric vehicle chargers and 700 parking spaces. A second Ohio store has been approved to open



PHOTOS BY JULIE CARR SMYTH/AP

A customer walks into Beaver's Mini Mart in Beavercreek, Ohio, this month. Buc-ee's argues that the shop's beaver logo too closely resembles the convenience store giant's branded beaver mascot.

in 2028.

While preparing to enter the state in February, Buc-ee's sued the northern Ohio holding company for Mickey Mart gas stations, arguing that its Mickey the Moose logo could be confused with Buc-ee. (The company's response: "A moose is not a beaver.")

The Buc-ee's beaver logo features the face of a beaver with prominent buck teeth wearing a red ball cap against a yellow backdrop. The Beaver's Mini Mart mascot is a full beaver, unclothed, waving and smiling against a white background.

Customers have been critical of Buc-ee's decision to target the much smaller store.

"I love Buc-ee's, but I don't plan on going back until they start making better business decisions," Austin Collins, 32, a project manager from Fairborn, said outside Beaver's, where he was making his first visit to protest the lawsuit.

He called targeting a beaver-named business in Beavercreek "a little spiteful." License plates from three states were visible in the parking lot.

Buc-ee's has defended the lawsuit as protective of its valuable trademark. In a statement on its website, the company said it first learned of Beaver's Mini Mart when its owner, Vic Boparai, filed a trade name registration Oct. 23.

The small business, incorporated in 2017, changed its name from Hanes Road Carryout to Beaver's Mini Mart in January 2025, according to the paperwork. That was about four months after Buc-ee's broke ground near Dayton. Recognizing a conflict, the company said it repeatedly attempted to reach Boparai without success, so it was forced to sue.

Boparai has since issued a statement of his own, though without addressing the company's concerns nor the merits of the lawsuit.

"We want to say thank you to the community and the entire country for supporting us and our business," he said. "We are



Buc-ee's decision to target Beaver's Mini Mart has been the subject of a segment on HBO's "Last Week Tonight With John Oliver."

overwhelmed by your support for our business and other small businesses everywhere."

The Associated Press has been unable to reach Boparai at Beaver's Mini Mart or by calling the store.

Beavercreek City Council responded to the dustup by passing a resolution Aug. 10 making the beaver a permanent and official part of its 200-plus-year history. Bucky the Beaver, mascot of the Beavercreek Local Schools, visited the meeting ahead of the unanimous vote.

On social media, images lampooning the fight are rampant. One showed the Ohio State University football mascot, Brutus Buckeye, tackling Buc-ee the beaver.

Support has taken other forms, too. One was a GoFundMe campaign aimed at assuring that costs associated with the lawsuit don't put Beaver's Mini Mart out of business, as has happened to other establishments Buc-ee's sued. It had raised at

least \$69,000.

The mini mart gave permission to the Original Goodie Shop bakery in Upper Arlington to use its logo on a signature cookie, with \$1 from each one sold going to support Beaver's legal fees. Cake, Hope & Love, a Beavercreek bakery, also is offering cookies adorned with bucktoothed beavers that urge shopping local.

Other Dayton-area businesses — including a Lego store and a root beer shop — temporarily altered their logos to include beavers in a show of solidarity. Dozens of businesses in Beavercreek already incorporate the city name or word beaver in their names.

Republican Ohio Gov. Mike DeWine, who attended and praised the grand opening of the Dayton-area Buc-ee's store in April, described the lawsuit as "absurd."

"It is Beavercreek, for heaven's sake," the governor told reporters.

Pence says U.S.-Canada trade fight poses new risks

BY SAMMY WESTFALL

Former vice president Mike Pence said Sunday that the U.S.-Canada trade fight that erupted this weekend poses new risks for the economy, with American consumers already struggling with high costs.

“We hear about the issue of affordability right now,” Pence told CNN’s “State of the Union.” “I think the last thing we need right now, as our economy is getting back on its feet, is a trade

war with Canada.”

U.S. tariffs of 50 percent took effect Saturday on an array of Canadian products, including whisky and hockey gear, after the collapse of trade talks.

Pence, speaking via video from Kyiv, where he was traveling to mark the 35th anniversary of Ukraine’s independence, noted “hot rhetoric” from both President Donald Trump and Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney.

In a move analysts say shows the limits of Trump’s aggressive

trade strategy, Carney vowed to match the U.S. tariffs “dollar for dollar” as he walked away from the talks.

Pence said he hoped, for “the sake of American families,” that “what we’re looking at here is negotiation and not confrontation in a trade war.”

“That’s how I would advise the president: Drive a hard bargain. But let’s pursue free trade with free nations, most especially our trading partners to the north,” he said.



On CNN’s “State of the Union,” former vice president Mike Pence said he hopes for negotiation.

Carney walkout lands another blow to Trump’s signature economic policy

TRADE FROM A1

ed trade agreements,” said Wendy Cutler, a former U.S. trade negotiator who is now senior vice president at the Asia Society Policy Institute.

Indeed, the United States has negotiated 10 “reciprocal trade agreements” over the past year with nations such as Malaysia, Cambodia and Argentina, along with other trade frameworks with the European Union, the United Kingdom and Japan.

Hearing of the concessions that the U.S. offered Canada, including reductions in tariffs on industrial metals, some trading partners may demand revisions to their deals, Cutler said.

Administration officials have approached each bargaining round convinced of two things: Decades of U.S. trade policy hollowed out the nation’s manufacturing communities. And a muscular new approach, leveraging the appeal of the \$32 trillion U.S. economy, can force other nations to give way and encourage the reindustrialization of the U.S.

For the administration, trade negotiations are not a contest of equals. The talks start from the premise that U.S. negotiating partners must make concessions, opening their markets and in some cases promising to invest in the United States, simply to win a reprieve from unilateral U.S. trade barriers.

Both Jamieson Greer, the president’s chief trade negotiator, and Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent have publicly complained that Canada and China are the only nations that retaliated for the tariffs that Trump imposed last year.

The administration sees its actions as restoring fairness to an imbalanced global trade system, making such retaliation unjustified. But China’s tough stance last year, which included a temporary interruption of essential rare earth minerals, paid off. The president lowered his triple-digit tax on imports from China and reached a trade truce in an October meeting with Chinese leader Xi Jinping, who is due in Washington on Sept. 24 for more talks.

The Canada negotiations were aimed at averting the new 50 percent tariffs, which Trump had threatened in July unless Carney dropped retaliatory measures imposed in response to earlier U.S. tariffs.

On Tuesday, Trump delayed his initial deadline, posting on Truth Social that the two sides had reached “a DEAL” and needed three days to finalize the documents.

The subsequent breakdown



Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney speaks to the news media after trade negotiations with the United States were suspended.

spotlighted tensions in the president’s strategy, including questions over the durability of any deal reached with the U.S. administration.

After all, the U.S. and Canada, along with Mexico, already have a trade deal: the United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement (USMCA) of 2020, which Trump hailed at the time as “the largest, fairest, most balanced, and modern trade agreement ever achieved.”

But this year, the president threatened to quit the deal and demanded sweeping changes to it, aimed at promoting more U.S. manufacturing. He also imposed tariffs on Canadian goods starting last year, a breach of the accord.

On Saturday, speaking in Ottawa, Carney alluded to the difficulty of negotiating with a mercurial president.

“We’ve recognized from the start that America has changed,” Carney said. “We recognize that sometimes, its signature is written in pencil.”

Negotiating with the U.S. is also complicated by divisions within the administration. All top officials share Trump’s goal of spurring domestic manufacturing. But as Greer haggled with the Canadians this past week, a split emerged over the U.S. trade representative’s willingness to reduce an existing 50 percent tariff on aluminum derivatives to 25 percent in return for Canadian concessions.

At a White House meeting, White House trade adviser Peter Navarro and Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick, whose department administers the national security tariffs, clashed with Greer, representing industry views that the higher aluminum tariffs were needed to encourage domestic manufacturing.

“Navarro and Lutnick were both yelling at Greer saying: ‘What are you doing? This is stupid. You know, we’re not giving these things away,’” said one industry representative, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to

describe the confidential talks.

Late in the talks, the U.S. sought to exclude from tariff reductions heavy trucks produced in Ontario, such as the Ford F-350 and F-450, and the GM Silverado. Over time, that would have made it “more uneconomic” for the automakers to keep making the vehicles in Canada, Carney said. The administration also sought to restrict Canada’s right to sign trade deals with other countries, a key part of Carney’s strategy to reduce dependence on its increasingly unreliable southern neighbor.

Trump’s undiplomatic style — including saying that Canada should surrender its sovereignty to become the 51st U.S. state — made it harder politically for the Canadian leader to accept a deal. Public opinion in Canada has turned fiercely anti-American.

“A 160-year trading relationship has found its red line,” said Flavio Volpe, president of the Automotive Parts Manufacturers’ Association in Toronto. “Demanding that your closest trad-

ing partner mirror your trade policy with third countries is akin to asking them to surrender agency over foreign policy. This episode shows that doesn’t work, no matter the disproportionate market leverage of the USA.”

Trump also has a general disregard for the \$3.4 trillion worth of merchandise that the U.S. imports annually. Speaking in June about his North American neighbors, the president told reporters in the Oval Office: “We don’t need anything that Canada has, we don’t need anything that Mexico has, but they need everything that we have. ... We don’t need their cars, we don’t need their lumber, we don’t need their energy, we don’t need anything that they have.”

In fact, U.S. farmers rely on Canadian sources for nearly 80 percent of the potash fertilizer they use each year, according to the U.S. Geological Survey. Northern border states, including New York, Michigan, Vermont, Minnesota and Maine, run on electricity produced by

Canadian hydropower. And Midwestern refineries are optimized to process heavy sour crude oil from Canada, helping keep gas prices lower than they otherwise would be, according to the Federal Reserve Bank of Kansas City.

Total U.S.-Canada trade each year exceeds \$700 billion.

The talks’ failure leaves businesses on both sides of the border burdened by a sudden jump in costs. Small businesses in the U.S. will face an especially sharp cash crunch, as they must pay tariffs before their customers pay them 30 or 60 days later, said Jason Miller, a professor of supply chain management at Michigan State University.

“I expect a significant drop in a lot of these different import categories because importers simply can’t afford to bring them in. That may mean certain products not on the store shelves,” said Miller.

In other cases, companies will struggle to find a domestic alternative to Canadian goods, especially for intermediate products such as packaging materials. So they will continue importing and pass along some of the 50 percent cost shock to their customers.

On Saturday, Carney said Canada will retaliate on Sept. 8 for the new tariffs with its own trade measures. By delaying his response, he is leaving time for cooler heads to prevail, analysts said.

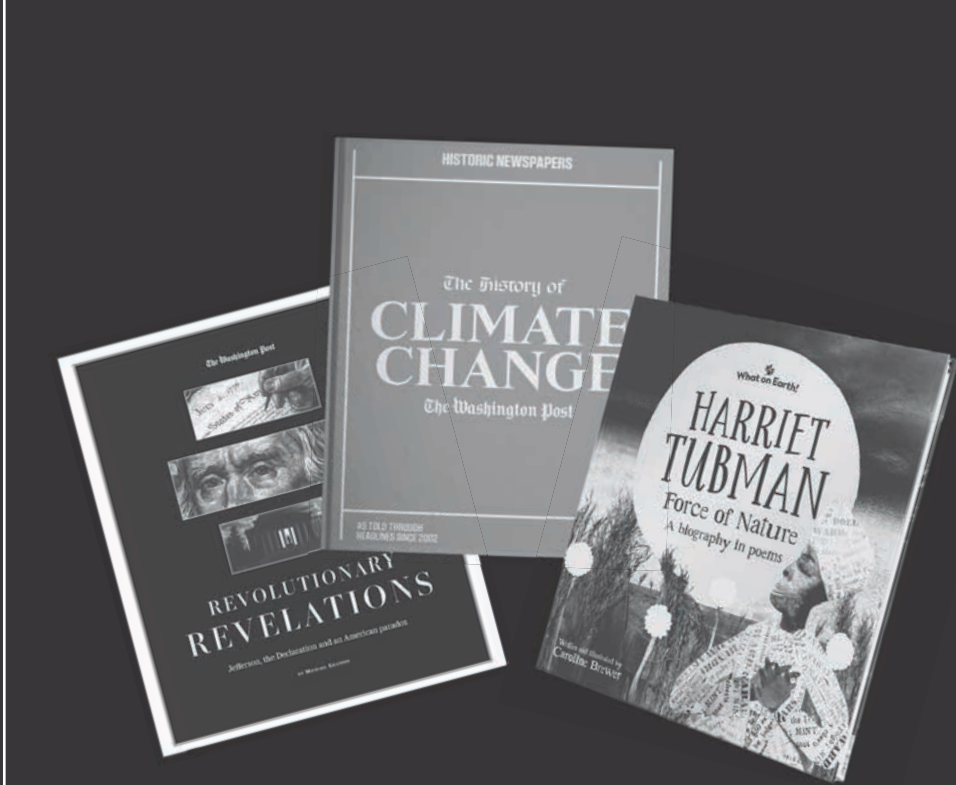
“Then the parties come back to the table. North America is too integrated for it to unravel on the basis of a deal that was put together over 14 days,” said Dan Ujcz, a trade lawyer in Columbus, Ohio.

If a deal had been reached this weekend, it would have paved the way for the official start of negotiations between the two nations over the proposed USMCA changes.

Instead, the administration now must manage a cycle of retaliation and counterretaliation while perhaps facing a new courtroom fight over the legality of Trump’s 50 percent tariffs, which were imposed under a never-before-used 1930 trade law.

Meanwhile, Trump’s 50 percent tariffs on goods ranging from hockey sticks to alcohol are expected to raise prices for American consumers less than three months before the Nov. 3 midterm elections, which have the potential to give Democrats control of Congress.

Those elections, polls show, are expected to turn on voters’ frustration with the rising cost of living.



The Washington Post

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OPINION

The Washington Post

AN INDEPENDENT NEWSPAPER

EDITORIALS

The sad decline of the great American town hall

THE AUGUST RECESS used to be prime time for the congressional town hall. Scores of lawmakers, freed from their duties in D.C., would tour their districts and engage directly with constituents. While not always cordial, such interactions have been a hallmark of American representative democracy since the colonial period.

Unfortunately, they're on their way to becoming a relic. During this year's recess, only 42 members of Congress — 35 Democrats and seven Republicans — scheduled at least one in-person town hall, according to LegiStorm's tracker. A decade ago, in August 2016, more than 170 appeared for such events.

The coronavirus pandemic accelerated the downward trend. There were 2,309 in-person town halls in 2019. That number never recovered from its collapse during the shutdowns. In 2025, there were 1,095.

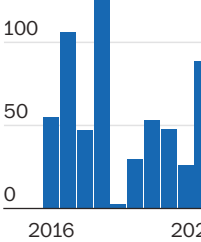
The decline of political civility in the 2020s is one likely cause. Elected officials may be leery of uncontrolled settings where they might be pressed on difficult issues in ways that can turn ugly. Activists sometimes try to hijack town halls.

Members of the majority party tend to be more reluctant to hold town halls than members of the minority party. Several town halls for Republican members descended into chaos last year, with booing or chanting attendees drowning out the lawmaker. That prompted Rep. Richard Hudson (North Carolina), chair of the National Republican Congressional Committee, to advise against in-person events.

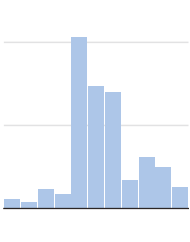
Democrats faced so much anger at town halls over the Affordable Care Act during the Obama administration that they, too, avoided them. There might be a vicious cycle where politicians retreat from town halls as political tensions increase, and the remaining town halls

Fewer lawmakers are participating in August recess town halls

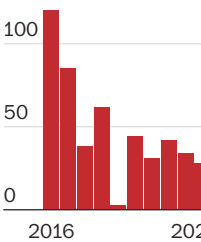
Democrats who appear for in-person events



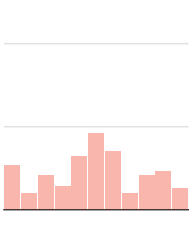
Democrats who appear for virtual events



Republicans who appear for in-person events



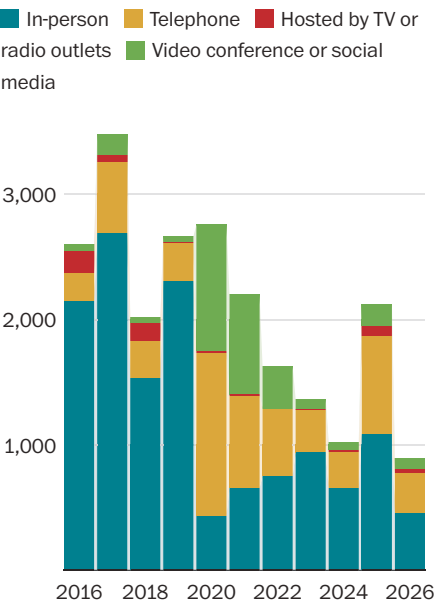
Republicans who appear for virtual events



The charts show the number of members of Congress from both chambers who have appeared for at least one town hall during each year's summer recess. That includes all scheduled this year as of Aug. 21.

Source: LegiStorm

The number of town halls has fallen sharply over the past decade



2026 data as of Aug. 21.

Source: LegiStorm

have encouraged other members to hold such events. The good news is that Congress last year dramatically increased funding available for lawmakers' security.

The decline of a centuries-old tradition is a warning sign about the vigor of representative government. Social media regularly serves voters short video clips of politicians — often out of context — but that's no substitute for direct conversation.

Restoring the town hall would require braver politicians and less antagonistic constituencies. Until that comes to pass, it seems likely that Americans' ability to interact with those who govern them will continue to wane.

EDITH PRITCHETT

NEW ITEMS COMING TO MEGHAN MARKLE'S 'AS EVER' ONLINE SHOP



LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Communities deserve the facts on data centers

Regarding the Aug. 12 news article “The data center backlash is building, just in time for the midterm elections”:

The communities opposing the construction of new data centers are not wrong to ask hard questions. However, it's unfortunate that many of the facts are being distorted. Some of the reason for this is rooted in a foreign influence campaign designed to denigrate America's artificial intelligence dominance so that China, in particular, can dominate the technology and jobs of the future.

For example, S&P Global found no clear correlation between data center expansion and electricity rate hikes. Meanwhile, Maine, which has very few data centers, saw the nation's biggest electricity rate spike between May 2024 and May 2025. Virginia, which has more data centers than anywhere on earth, saw one of the nation's smallest increases in utility costs during that same time period, and it was roughly in line with inflation.

The article claimed that diesel-powered sites are spewing air pollution throughout Virginia. However, these backup diesel-powered generators are limited by state law to emergency use and testing only.

Communities deserve the facts. At a moment in time when politicians are all too eager to oppose data centers for political points, the benefits communities are seeing from AI infrastructure can be amazing. Look at Loudoun County: Data centers sit on about 3 percent of the land but generate 45 percent of the county's tax revenue.

Moratoriums or data center bans won't cause AI to disappear or your electricity bills to go down. But they will help hand China the future America should be building.

Kyrsten Sinema, Phoenix
The writer, an independent, represented Arizona in the Senate from 2019 to 2025, and is a co-chair of the AI Infrastructure Coalition.

Chief Justice Charles Evans Hughes further explained in opposing Roosevelt in 1937 that increasing the number of justices would confound or arrest rather than facilitate the court's deliberative processes.

The editorial errantly gave the Republicans a pass in manipulating Supreme Court appointments for partisan purposes. Remember the procedural blockade that Sen. Mitch McConnell (R-Kentucky) put up in 2016 against entertaining President Barack Obama's nomination of Merrick Garland to fill the vacancy created by Justice Antonin Scalia's passing because it was during an election year?

Bruce Fein, Washington
The writer served as associate deputy attorney general under President Ronald Reagan.

“The Supreme Court of the United States shall be composed of nine Justices, consisting of one chief justice and eight associate justices.” That is the language of the proposed Keep Nine Amendment to the U.S. Constitution. It would permanently preserve the independence of the Supreme Court. Members of Congress, state and federal officials, and candidates in all parties should endorse it.

The Constitution is silent on the size of the Supreme Court. Without an amendment defining the number of justices, a Congress and president could change that number for political advantage. This strategy is known as court-packing.

Support for the amendment extends across party lines. Court-packing would be a constitutional disaster for the nation and any party that embraced it. An independent Supreme Court is vital for the future of democracy. If one party packed the Supreme Court, another party with a new majority would retaliate by packing the court again. The result would undermine both the independence of the court and the rule of law.

Nine Supreme Court justices have worked well since 1869. We do not need or want 31 Supreme Court justices.

Paul Summers, Nashville
Stephen Rosenthal, Richmond
Roman Buhler, Elma, New York
Paul Summers and Stephen Rosenthal, former attorneys general of Tennessee and Virginia, respectively, are co-chairs of the Coalition to Preserve the Independence of the United States Supreme Court. Roman Buhler is the coalition's executive director.

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World hunger decline is the fruit of growth

HERE'S A BIT of news worth celebrating: Despite multiple violent conflicts around the globe, and stubborn inflation, 2025 was the third year in a row in which global hunger fell.

That's according to a July report from the United Nations' Food and Agriculture Organization, which found that the number of undernourished people in the world dropped by a remarkable 14 million since 2024. There are still far too many in need of food — 645 million people, or just under 8 percent of the world population — but the trend line is encouraging.

There are nuances. The numbers remain well above pre-pandemic levels, and they mask some regional disparities. Asia and Latin America recorded the largest declines in food insecurity, but in Africa, the number of people who struggle to meet their dietary needs has remained stagnant.

And while the report predicts the decline will continue through the end of the decade, it warns that several factors could blunt those gains. One is this year's war in the Middle East, which has disrupted global energy markets as well as the supply of fertilizers.

Still, the report captures a heartening trend: Even though the cost of a healthy diet has steadily increased just about everywhere in the past decade, the proportion of people who cannot afford it has persistently declined.

That is the fruit of economic growth across much of the world, which has spurred incomes to rise faster than food prices. It's also a result of technological advances in agriculture. Innovative farming techniques continue to defy warnings that climate change and population growth would ravage agricultural systems.

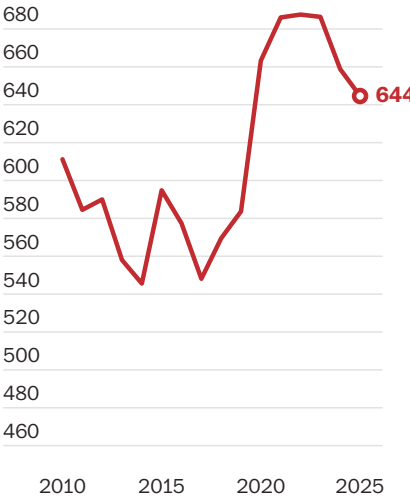
Those advances are also good for the climate. The volume of carbon emissions per unit of food produced is declining, as Cornell University researchers illustrated in a study published in January.

Despite the significant inroads against world hunger, it remains too commonplace. The best way to meet that need in the long run is to create conditions for economic freedom and the growth it brings.



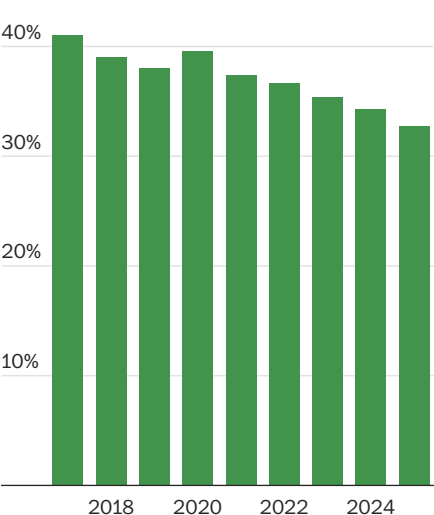
Soybeans are harvested at a farm in Warren, Indiana, on Sept. 17, 2025.

The number of undernourished people globally, in millions



Source: Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

Percentage of global population unable to afford a healthy diet



Source: Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

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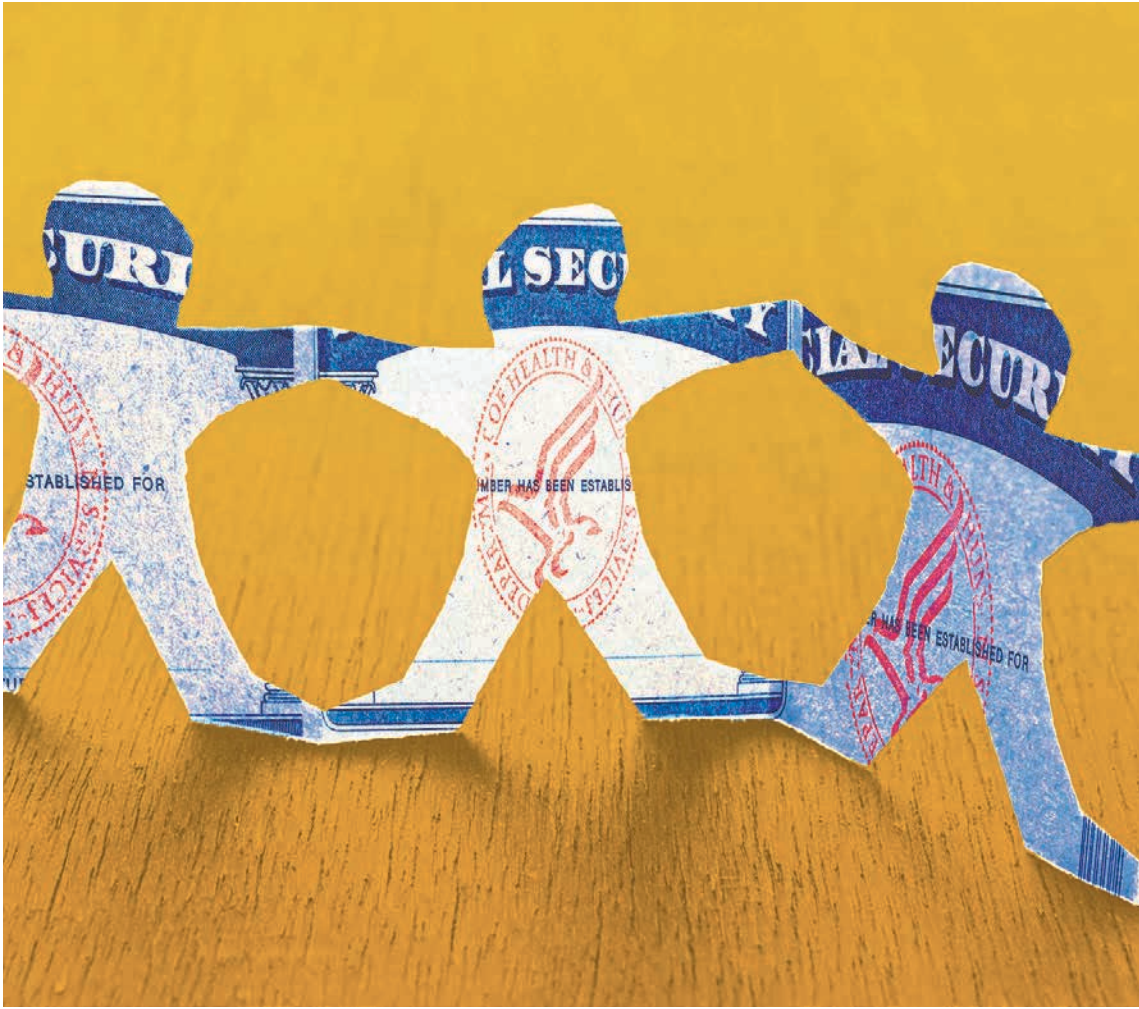
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OPINION

The best way toward a Social Security fix? This one is tried and true.



BY MARC GOLDWEIN

The Senate Finance Committee recently convened lawmakers to begin figuring out ways to shore up Social Security’s finances. It’s about time: The program’s retirement trust fund is just six years from insolvency, at which point the law requires an abrupt 22 percent benefit cut.

The hearing, at which I testified, focused not on what policies to enact to save Social Security, but on how to agree upon those policies. Recently, responsible lawmakers in both chambers have called for a special process to secure solvency. This is an important step in itself — because both sides are going to need to work together to preserve the program for future generations.

One proposal, the Promise Act, spearheaded by Sens. Dick Durbin (D-Illinois) and Bill Cassidy (R-Louisiana), would direct the bipartisan Social Security Advisory Board to develop an initial solvency plan for Congress to consider, amend and debate, and hopefully enact. Another — Reps. Tom Cole’s (R-Oklahoma) and Tom Suozzi’s (D-New York) Bipartisan Social Security Commission Act — would create a new bipartisan board to recommend solvency legislation.

These types of special processes are exactly what it will take to get the ball rolling on urgently need-

ed reforms. They will create an opportunity for Democrats and Republicans to come together on a plan to save Social Security before it is too late.

Special interests on the left and right, unfortunately, have attacked these kinds of solutions for fear they will upset the status quo. Groups such as Americans for Tax Reform (ATR) and AARP agree on very little, except for their unwillingness to accept a realistic compromise that could actually save Social Security. AARP opposes any changes to slow the growth in benefits, even for the richest seniors, while ATR is against any increase in taxes, even to permanently restore Social Security stability.

Their arguments, however, don’t hold water. These critics claim that the commission-driven approach violates the normal legislative process. On the contrary, when it comes to Social Security, outside commissions, committees and advisory councils *are* the regular process.

All the most significant Social Security laws throughout the program’s 91-year history were developed with the help of outside entities. The original Social Security Act establishing the program came out of then-Labor Secretary Frances Perkins’ Committee on Economic Security. Major legislation in 1939, 1950, 1956, 1972 and 1977 came from Social Security Advisory Councils — the predecessors to today’s Social Security Advisory Board. And the landmark 1983 reforms that bought us 50 years of

solvency were negotiated in part through the bipartisan National Commission on Social Security Reform, known as the Greenspan Commission after its chairman, economist Alan Greenspan.

The critics argue that Social Security is best addressed through “regular order” in the Finance and Ways and Means committees. But those committees have had 40 years to try to save the program, to no avail. Before this month, the Finance Committee hadn’t even held a full-committee *hearing* on solvency in 15 years.

There’s also the claim that commissions are just a way to force through either massive benefit cuts or tax increases. But these bodies don’t force anything. They offer a process for developing a plan — based on public input — for Congress to consider, amend, and approve or reject.

Those concerned about benefit cuts should worry less about a commission and more about the looming 22 percent cut; if it went into effect today, it would amount to an average of roughly \$500 less in benefits per retiree per month, more than what most retired households spend on groceries. And those concerned about tax increases should be concerned about waiting until the last minute, when the fastest way to save Social Security will involve either a massive and immediate tax hike or unprecedented levels of borrowing that will guarantee even larger taxes on future generations.

Perhaps the most laughable critique is that a commission won’t work. At last week’s hearing, the AARP witness declared that “the history of special commissions is littered with very good intentions and failed results.”

This is nonsense. Over the years, Congress has established literally hundreds of commissions, advisory councils and other groups focused on everything from consumer product safety to civilian space programs. Many fail — just as many legislative efforts fail. But from the Greenspan Commission to the 9/11 Commission to the Base Realignment and Closure (BRAC) commission, many succeed.

And those that work best do so by establishing a clear mission, bringing in expertise and creating a safe space for bipartisan negotiation and cooperation.

AARP, ATR and other special interests don’t oppose a commission because they’re worried it will fail; they oppose it because they’re worried it will succeed. And that means accepting compromise.

Resistance to compromise was the reason AARP opposed the 1983 efforts, a balanced mix of benefit and revenue changes that secured Social Security for half a century. As the lead Democratic negotiator, Robert M. Ball, wrote, “AARP opposed just about every constructive proposal that emerged from the entire negotiating process.” The ATR, similarly, would rather let the country barrel toward a fiscal crisis than move an inch on taxes.

If Congress waits for special interests to approve its Social Security plan, our choices will be either automatic 22 percent cuts or \$190 trillion in added debt.

It’s time to step up and agree on a commission as the best process for saving Social Security.

Marc Goldwein is senior vice president and senior policy director for the nonpartisan Committee for a Responsible Federal Budget.

MEGAN MCARDLE

The internet always routes around the censors

The first time I was the internet’s “main character” was way back in 2003. I deserved it, as much as anyone can. Still seething from 9/11, I’d blogged something very stupid and wrong about violent anti-war protests.

The internet was a much less crowded place, but it’s hard to describe how awful that experience was. Nothing in the analog world prepares you to be hated by so many people so volubly and viciously. Today’s social media scale makes it much worse, and I have sympathy for anyone who goes through it.

I can only imagine how devastating it must have been for Jason Arday, who came under scrutiny after Nathan Cofnas, a postdoctoral researcher at the University of Ghent, published a newsletter article in July alleging that Arday, the youngest Black professor ever appointed at the University of Cambridge, had committed extensive plagiarism in his scholarly work. Cofnas also raised questions about Arday’s professed life history: autistic, nonverbal until 11 and illiterate until 18. Arday claimed he was a survivor not just of a brain tumor and testicular cancer, but also of a knife-wielding maniac. He said a pig’s head was sent to his family, and he boasted incredible feats of ultramarathoning.

Cofnas is a controversial figure who has advocated for “race realism,” the idea that racial groups have genetic differences that can affect traits such as intelligence. Cambridge initially described the accusations as a “vile smear campaign.” On social media, however, Arday became the personification of everything that was wrong about academic diversity, equity and inclusion. Then the press dug in and substantiated many of the accusations, including the fact that Cambridge had been informed of problems with Arday’s work in 2023 and apparently decided to look the other way. Many claims that Arday made about his life were found to be unproven or exaggerated.

On Aug. 5, Cambridge finally announced an investigation, and Arday resigned later that night. Nine days later, British authorities announced that Arday, 41, had been found dead in his London home. Police have not cited a cause of death, but do not believe it to be suspicious.

Everyone is looking to place blame for Arday’s death. Many blame not just Arday for his fabrications but Cambridge for overlooking obvious problems and elevating him to a position in which questions would eventually become unavoidable.

Others fault the press for paying so much attention to this story, and some of them are calling for official or quasi-official restraint. Those people are right to mourn Arday’s death as tragic on every level, for all the reasons Michelle Goldberg laid out in her excellent New York Times column.

It is never correct to chastise the media for printing things that are true and important. Arday’s academic misconduct is well-documented at



University of Cambridge professor Jason Arday died at age 41 on Aug. 14.

this point. To say that they are unimportant is to say that it doesn’t matter whether one of the finest universities in the world can distinguish truth from fiction, or scholarship from a cut-and-paste job. If that’s what Arday’s academic defenders believe, then we should be paying more attention to what’s going on at Cambridge, not less.

But they’re mistaken even if you think that a free press doesn’t mean the freedom to pile on. In this year of our Lord 2026, the kind of censorship they want is not just a terrible idea. It is an impossible dream.

Note that Arday did succeed in suppressing the story — for a time. The New York Times reported earlier this month that Times Higher Education, a British magazine, assembled a lengthy dossier on Arday, but that “a prominent British defamation law firm helped kill the article.” That merely ensured that the story came out in the worst possible way, first on Substack and then social media, a cascade that amplified the negative attention.

I am tempted to say that those calling for press restraint are mentally stuck in 2020. But really, they are acting as if we still live in the pre-internet era.

It was difficult even 30 years ago to make a story go away. But it was possible. Feminist advocates helped persuade American newspapers to stop publishing the names of rape victims, and Britain’s Contempt of Court Act of 1981 has long restricted publication of reporting that could unfairly influ-

ence a criminal case until the trial is over. Before the internet, if the media didn’t publish, there was almost no way for the public to find out.

The social justice activists who pressured media outlets and social media companies in the 2010s to put a broader range of topics off-limits were acting as if the press still had that kind of power. But as entrepreneur John Gilmore once observed, the internet treats censorship as damage and routes around it. No reputable news organization published the name of “Jackie,” the accuser in the 2014 University of Virginia rape hoax, but you can find it if you’re willing to look. It takes Chinese-style repression, not scolding, to suppress a story in the internet age. Anything less merely increases the demand — and thus the reward — for saying the forbidden thing.

The internet eventually filled that demand with podcasts, newsletters, media start-ups and alternative social media platforms that thrived by defying the emerging orthodoxy and chronicling its excesses. “Woke 1” ended not in a new social justice dispensation but in heightened mistrust and diminished influence for the institutions that embraced it.

That’s a lesson that Cambridge should have heeded, as should those now agitating for press restraints. In the internet era, the truth will always win out. The public will not be satisfied with anything less.

Better for the world than for America



Philippine Foreign Secretary Theresa Lazaro and Japanese Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi talk in Manila on July 23.

BY ZACHARY KARABELL

It has not been a banner summer for the United States. The country is mired in a war with Iran with no graceful exit opportunities; a new round of tariffs threatens to further disrupt fragile global trade relations; and the domestic economy faces inflation combined with paltry growth. President Donald Trump has not been a positive force for the U.S. this year, and many of his administration’s policies don’t bode well for the future. But by weakening America, Trump may strengthen the rest of the world.

Take military alliances — Trump is forcing U.S. allies to become more self-reliant. The war in Iran was supposed to cement U.S. leadership in the Persian Gulf and hasten the expansion of the Abraham Accords between Israel and its Arab neighbors. Instead, the conflict has put distance between America and its regional partners, especially Saudi Arabia. In late July, the Trump administration signed a deal with the kingdom for civilian development of nuclear energy. Then, a day later, the administration said that the deal was actually contingent on Saudi Arabia joining the Abraham Accords, which it had no immediate intention of doing. Within weeks of the agreement falling apart, Saudi Arabia signed a NATO-like defense pact with Turkey and Pakistan that bypasses the U.S. and makes any agreement with Israel unlikely. Trump’s threat on Monday to bomb Oman if it interferes with negotiations with Iran is even more likely to hurt U.S. standing in the region.

Other countries are also pivoting away from the U.S. as it becomes a more inconsistent ally. Trump’s on-again, off-again threats to annex Greenland have led European nations to rely increasingly on their own defense capabilities and non-U.S. alliances. Although Europe still needs some U.S. support, popular opinion has flipped from seeing the U.S. as a valuable partner to viewing Europe as independent and responsible for its own defense.

Similar trends are evident among Asian nations hoping to counter China’s power. Instead of leaning on American defense, countries such as Japan and the Philippines are looking more to each other and enhancing their military capabilities. While this is not yet sufficient to replace reliance on the U.S., these countries are leagues ahead of where they were even a decade ago. Trump’s decision to reduce U.S. military cooperation with South Korea, citing his “very good” relationship with North Korean dic-

The ‘Trump effect’ has accelerated the move away from Washington and Wall Street and toward a more decentralized, diversified set of alliances and agreements around the world.

tator Kim Jong Un, could also accelerate this move away from the U.S.

And, of course, allies are becoming more independent from the U.S. economy. Countries around the world are finding new trading partners and trying to limit their dependence on the dollar as the sole vehicle of international commerce. The Trump administration’s willingness to use the dollar as a tool for political coercion has pushed European countries to look for new options. The dollar remains the most important currency for global transactions, and it doesn’t have one clear competitor. However, that could change. The share of foreign buyers of U.S. government debt has decreased over the past decade, and multiple alternatives to the dollar-denominated global payments system have launched.

It is too soon to write an obituary of U.S. military or economic leadership. But the “Trump effect” has accelerated the move away from Washington and Wall Street and toward a more decentralized, diversified set of alliances and agreements around the world.

That will reduce relative American power and influence in ways that could soon weigh on the U.S. domestically. A world that is less interested in buying American government debt could raise the cost of servicing the trillions of dollars the U.S. government already owes. A world less dependent on the U.S. militarily may become less interested in the U.S. economically, closing off opportunities for American businesses and investors. It also leaves America more vulnerable to China’s growing market presence.

But, while that will undoubtedly hurt the U.S., it could help other countries. More resilience, less dependence and new avenues for global cooperation will strengthen any country that adapts, whether it is Saudi Arabia, South Korea, Brazil or the Philippines.

This emerging system is, in some respects, what the post-1945 system of alliances was trying to create: sovereign, stable countries self-sufficient enough to meet their citizens’ needs and interconnected enough to prevent the worst conflicts from occurring. In its rush to cement the U.S. as the dominant global power, the Trump administration is instead creating a world order where America is less important.

Zachary Karabell, an author and investor, writes “The Edgy Optimist” on Substack.

Mall opens in Pacific Palisades as community rebuilds

PALISADES FROM A1

we said hi.”

The Sotherlands, who bought a home in the nearby Brentwood neighborhood while they fight their insurance company, frequented the village before the fire and are happy to see it return. Walking around, they ran into friends, most of whom are still living somewhere else.

“A lot of us still can’t live here,” Amanda said, “so this is as close as we can get.”

Many see the village as a third space, away from home and work, where people can gather.

“I hope it’s actually their living room. I don’t know if that’s a third space, a second place, space or a first space. But as long as they feel at home here, then we’re doing our job,” Caruso said.

Caruso’s family lost three homes in the fire. The shopping mall, which was protected by a private firefighting force, sustained damage and Caruso invested \$100 million toward remediation.

He sees reopening the village as a responsibility to the community, one he hopes will inspire other businesses to open back up: “I think that when you’re in a community, you have the means, you have ability to take the lead and be a catalyst.”

While there was nearly unanimous enthusiasm for the what the return could bring to the community, not everyone sees themselves shopping at its luxury stores. Some of the village’s stores are local businesses.

Kedeshian, the owner of K Bakery, lost her home and the fire damaged her Palisades location, forcing it to close. She now lives in a condo and reopened her bakery in the village last Saturday.

“The pioneers,” she said, referring to those who move back without retail or a community, “have to accept the fact that there’s nowhere to shop. Now that this is here, it will stir more people.”

After the Palisades Fire killed 12 people and wiped out 6,845 structures, forcing people to move away, many were hungry for community connection. Some found solace through meetups in Santa Monica. Others at Pilates classes or the few restaurants that opened.

“Did you burn or are you standing?” became a new greeting among those from the Palisades, said Haldis Toppel. “It is the kindness, it is the familiarity that we have with one another.”

Toppel, 83, lost her home of 52 years. Her lot overlooks the Queen’s Necklace, a portion of the coast that curves from Santa Monica up through Malibu. At night, city lights look like a string of pearls.

She sees the empty lots in her neighborhood as a foundation, a perspective she says was shaped growing up in postwar Munich. “Little by little, the blocks were cleared,” she said. “Little by little, they were rebuilt.”

But more than rebuilding homes and businesses, it is the social infrastructure that needs to be rebuilt: chance meetings at the gas station or grocery store, youth soccer games, churches and schools.

“The Palisades is made up of its people,” Toppel said.

“Five bam,” Peng Port said as she placed a tile on the table during a mahjong game at Palisades Village on Monday. The clacking of tiles was drowned out by the sounds of construction at a nearby Nancy Silverton restaurant.

“Mahj!” said her friend Marc Port as he turned his tiles over to win the game. The table collectively moaned, “Oh no.”

The two met while playing pickleball, but when Marc was injured, he learned mahjong. He returned home in December and is happy to see the community returning: “Each house is like a flower coming up in spring.”

At another table, Eva Doviack and Darian Jennings discovered that Darian’s in-laws live next door to Jennings.

During the fire, Jennings’s husband and son filled buckets of water from their pool and used a garden hose to fend off the flames. “It was the craziest thing, and we had never met and we just randomly sat next to each other,” Doviack said.



Workers are seen on a home under construction. The reopening of Palisades Village coincided with the 1,000th home to begin reconstruction. So far, 37 have been completed.



Visitors at the newly reopened Palisades Village earlier this month.



With the reopening of the village and the return of the farmers market, the fabric of community, some say, is being rewoven.



Darian Jennings, left, and Eva Doviack embrace at the village. Doviack’s in-laws live next door to Jennings.

“The village has always played an important role in tying the community together.”

Kim Kedeshian, owner of K Bakery in the village

The reopening of the village coincided with the 1,000th home to begin reconstruction, according to a tracker by the Palisadian-Post. So far, only 37 have been completed.

“If you build it, people will come,” said Michelle Murphy, who lost her home in the fire. She is the owner of Pali Trading Post, which opened on July 1 across the street from the village.

Murphy has never operated a store before, but she thought the community needed one. Caruso’s promise to bring the village back was enough assurance that she could open.

Before the village opened, there were a handful of restaurants, including Palisades Garden Cafe, a local hangout for Pali High students. The library opened with limited hours. A park will soon be under construction. What Palisadians say they need most is another grocery store.

On Wednesday, the farmers market returned to the Palisades for the first time since the fire. Stands selling produce, flowers, Kombucha and jewelry filled North Swarthmore Avenue.

Kristine Granz popped over before picking up her two daughters at Palisades Charter High School.

Without a grocery store other than Vons, which she said lacks great produce, she has to be smart about stops at the store. The farmers market, she said, really helps.

“It’s a feast for the eyes. I’m trying to figure out what I’m going to buy first,” she said.

Granz was particularly excited to see her hummus guy, but also so many familiar faces.

“Who haven’t I seen?” she said. “It really is Mayberry.”

Brianna Sacks contributed to this report.



RYAN PLUMMER/MUBI/AP

“Teenage Sex and Death at Camp Miasma” is about a young, queer director (Hannah Einbinder, left) meeting a reclusive former scream queen (Gillian Anderson).

Historically, back-to-school is when I realized that I missed every summer movie I had planned to see. Not this summer! I made a conscious effort to drag myself to the movie theater. I gave it “the ol’ college try.” More like “the ol’ small liberal arts college that was once all-female but now welcomes all genders try.” By which I mean I saw a lot of LGBTQ movies.

As I sampled the season’s sapphic summer cinema and devoured dude-on-dude dramas during the dog days, I found myself feeling ... shockingly hopeful! Were summer movies always this good? Were they always this gay?

By the numbers, they may actually be getting less gay. According to GLAAD’s “Where We Are in Film” report published in July, the number of LGBTQ characters in movies last year dropped to 20.4 percent from 23.6 percent in 2024. (If you’re curious about their methodology, a recent episode of the “What Went Wrong” podcast gets granular about it.)

Quantitatively, we’ll have to wait until next year to see how movies fared in 2026. But qualitatively? I’ve been encouraged by what I saw this summer! Filmmakers with rich, unique, fully realized visions made movies for audiences that were sophisticated, wry and open to nuance (the

Having a gay old time at the movies

A report shows a drop in LGBTQ characters last year. A summer trip to the cinema tells another tale.

BY SHANE O’NEILL

slapstick of “Stop! That! Train” notwithstanding).

It’s strange to feel bullish in a bear market. Everyone I know who works in the film industry is freaking out right now about disappearing work, the threat of AI, the potential Paramount Skydance/Warner Bros. Discovery merger (and David Ellison’s “trust me, I’m not political!” New York Times op-ed), and a general climate of uncertainty and trans scapegoating.

Nevertheless, lavender cinema persisted!

Here’s a roundup of all the films I saw this summer made by LGBTQ people featuring prominent queer themes. (Queer. Not gay. It matters.)

‘Stop! That! Train!’

Can you extend a movie parody challenge from “RuPaul’s Drag Race” into a 90-minute movie? Apparently, yes. But *should* you? Oh, why not!

“Stop! That! Train!” is a broad comedy about hostesses on a luxury train headed for a deadly storm. It’s a pastiche of showbiz tropes, celebrity cameos, “Airplane”-style one-liners, “Drag Race” cast members and “Drag Race” catchphrases. In other words, it has everything RuPaul likes besides fracking.

RuPaul started her career as an outsider giving
SEE LGBTQ FILM ON B2

Mixed emotions when a sibling leaves for college

BY TAYLOR SWINTON

At around 10 a.m., Christopher Burke, sporting a “Temple Dad” cap, walks into his house with breakfast sandwiches for his kids, Skyler, 18, and Mason, 15. The two grab their breakfast as a white Nissan SUV sits in front of the garage, ready to be loaded.

The family, including mom Tygerian Talbott, puts on their tennis shoes and gets to work. They pack pink bags, suitcases, packing tubs and groceries into the back of the truck like a game of “Tetris.” Skyler and all her be-

longings will soon be on their way to her new home: Temple University.

Skyler and Mason are busy students. Throughout her senior year, Skyler was involved in cheer, student government and the National Honor Society. Mason, a rising high school sophomore, is a travel baseball player and takes the game very seriously. Still, even with their packed schedules, the siblings always found time to pop into each other’s rooms and talk about their days, or some other non-

SEE SIBLINGS ON B3



NICHOLAS J.R. WHITE

Cal Flynn went to Africa, Antarctica and the Amazon in researching her book “The Savage Landscape: How We Met the Wilderness.”

BOOK REVIEW

Exploring Earth’s wild places to write this book

BY ERIK PEDERSEN
Orange County Register

Cal Flynn traveled tens of thousands of miles around the world to research her book, “The Savage Landscape: How We Made the Wilderness,” journeying to remote areas in Africa, Antarctica and the Amazon and encountering AK-47-toting men, isolated Indigenous communities, big game hunters, turbulent seas, wild animals and an erupting volcano along the way.

Oh, and that time the ground gave way beneath her, and she fell into an ice cavern.

“Some of the situations I got myself into were inherently risky,” says Flynn via Zoom from her home in Scotland. “That’s part of what a wilderness is; it’s something that we perceive to be wild, that we perceive to be threatening.”

“The Savage Landscape,” however, isn’t the diary of an adrenaline junky; it’s a work of intrepid nonfiction research and report-

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A rainbow of LGBTQ offerings for the summer film season

LGBTQ FILM FROM B1

a camp imitation of an insider. When she released her hit single “Supermodel” in 1992, part of its appeal was the unlikelihood of a drag queen actually finding worldwide fame and success.

She’s still pulling that thread in “Stop! That! Train!,” playing the U.S. president navigating a potential disaster. Her timing and delivery are impeccable, even if the joke is far less absurd in the era of a reality-TV president.

RuPaul is no longer on the outside looking in, but her performance retains the attention to detail of an obsessive fan. It’s a testament to her charisma (and uniqueness, nerve and talent) that her shtick is still winsome after more than 30 years.

Available to rent on streaming services.

‘Teenage Sex and Death at Camp Miasma’

Onto another movie made by a pop culture obsessive!

“Teenage Sex and Death at Camp Miasma” is about a young, queer director (Hannah Einbinder) meeting a reclusive former scream queen (Gillian Anderson). It’s the third movie from Jane Schoenbrun, whom I profiled as part of our 2025 Post Next list. Schoenbrun has been a darling of indie film since their first film came out in 2021. Their cult has grown more fervent with each movie.

Here’s what I’ve learned about Schoenbrun as a filmmaker:

They like long titles: “We’re All Going to the World’s Fair,” “I Saw the TV Glow,” “Teenage Sex and Death at Camp Miasma.”

They love media. Not just TV shows and movies and internet ephemera but the actual physical media that conveys them: VHS tape, film, flat-screen TVs, glitching monitors. Sometimes it feels fun and fetishistic; sometimes it feels like nostalgia for the sake of nostalgia.

Their movies keep getting better. I was not a fan of “World’s Fair.” I mostly enjoyed “TV Glow.” I liked “Camp Miasma.” Each had moments that took my breath away. Each ran a little long. Each was a little emotionally shallow. Each stuck with me.

Schoenbrun’s dark, painterly vision is best enjoyed in a movie with laughs such as “Camp Miasma.”

All in all, I recommend this movie on the strength of its two leads. Especially Anderson, who seems to be doing an impression of Dolly Parton on benzos. Bonus points for a movie that actually depicted all five letters of LGBTQ (plus “I” for “intersex” to boot!).

In theaters.

‘Blue Film’

A beautiful, challenging, icky,



“Stop! That! Train!” is a comedy about hostesses on a luxury train headed for a storm, starring Ginger Minj, RuPaul and Jujubee.



“Blue Film,” a movie about sex work, pederasty and how the past becomes the present, features Kieron Moore and Reed Birney.

heartbreaking two-hander about sex work, pederasty and how the past becomes the present. It’s a hard watch, and I’m stoked that we’re living in a moment when filmmakers can make uncomfortable and complex films like this.

Available to rent on streaming services.

‘Drunken Noodles’

I’m also glad that we live in a moment when a whimsical, low-budget summer daydream such as “Drunken Noodles” can get

made! It wasn’t the greatest thing I’ve ever seen, but it had the best sex scenes of the summer and prominently featured Sal Salandra’s porny, lovely thread paintings, of which I was already a fan. If you’re curious about Salandra’s fusion of erotica and embroidery, you’ll have to Google it yourself. I ain’t linking out to that SMUT!

Available to rent on streaming services.

‘Girls Like Girls’

In 2015, Hayley Kiyoko re-



Myra Molloy and Maya Da Costa in “Girls Like Girls,” inspired by director Hayley Kiyoko’s 2015 single of the same name.

leased the single “Girls Like Girls.” This year, she released her feature directorial debut, also titled “Girls Like Girls.” It’s basically a feature-length version of the “Girls Like Girls” music video, right down to the protagonist’s banana seat bicycle and plastic “tattoo” choker.

Personally, I didn’t need the “Girls Like Girls” video to be any longer than its original five minutes, but it was nice to see some tender father-daughter moments between Zach Braff and Maya da Costa.

Available to rent on streaming services.

‘She’s the He’

First-time filmmaker Siobhan McCarthy wrote, directed and edited a present-day queer take on teen sex comedies like “American Pie” and teen gender-swap farces such as “One of the Guys.”

Like “Bottoms” before it, the problem in “She’s the He” isn’t so much that the protagonists are trans or gay, but that they’re selfish and shortsighted. Y’know, just

My cousin was convicted of sexual abuse. My family is supporting him.



Carolyn Hax

Adapted from an online discussion.

Dear Carolyn: My cousin, 17 years older than I, has been convicted of sexual abuse to his young teen daughter. My immediate family are deeply, completely certain he’s been wronged and it’s a vendetta by his ex.

This man chased me as a small child for hugs and kisses — even when I was screaming in terror. I reminded my family of this. They told me it was harmless and to stop being dramatic.

We live in a different country but have long calls each week. My gut tells me I need to pull away with my kids, as this attitude is so wrong to me. Whoever is right, a child is clearly hurt here.

But I’m hesitant in case I’m overreacting. I could do with some perspective, please. Protecting my kids is key, right?

— *Anonymous*

Anonymous: You lived it, and your screams say you knew something was wrong. So yes. Trust your experience.

I am happy to offer outside perspective, but here’s something that’s available to you without anyone else’s lens. When you spoke up about your experience recently, your family could have said this: “That must be an awful memory for you. We don’t believe the incidents are related, but if you need to sit this one out, we will understand.” Instead, they told you to *stop being dramatic*. In other words, they chose the path of totally invalidating your pain and your



ILLUSTRATION BY NICK GALIFIANAKIS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

memory when they didn’t have to, in order to prioritize a cousin who was *convicted* of child sexual abuse. Not opinion — fact.

So, yes. Protect your kids, and yourself, too — from your cousin, from ignorance, from the pain of being told you don’t matter. Because your family just told you they won’t.

To Anonymous: You are definitely not overreacting. Your family is underreacting, or more accurately, terribly and neglectfully reacting.

Think about this: Not only was the man convicted of a sex crime — against his own daughter — his daughter is also part of the whole family. So they are calling their own family

member a liar!

Your own experience speaks to the veracity of the heinous offense. You owe your children what you sadly did not receive: protection from this criminal.

— *Also Anonymous*

Also Anonymous: Their “young teen” relative, which makes the dismissive certainty of their loyalties even more appalling. Thank you for flagging that.

Write to Carolyn Hax at tellme@washpost.com. Get her newsletter delivered to your inbox each morning at wapo.st/gethax.

Join the discussion live at noon Fridays at washingtonpost.com/live-chats.

Table etiquette, not forks, is what matters in your lunch with the boss

Miss Manners

JUDITH MARTIN, JACOBINA MARTIN AND NICHOLAS IVOR MARTIN

out to lunch at her exclusive club. I had to buy a tie, which is fine, but I just know I’ll use the wrong fork.

Help!

Only if you promise never again to use that meaningless cliché about the “wrong fork.”

The age of specialized eating implements was over more than 100 years before you were born. Even in its prime, it affected only a small class, as aristocrats scorned it and the working class ignored it.

If there are even two forks at your place setting, it would be surprising. A club, like a restaurant, does not know what you plan to order, so the staff cannot set the table for specific foods. If they could — and had, for example, a salad fork and a meat fork — all you would need to know is to pick them up from the outside in.

But heaven forbid that Miss Manners should imply that table manners do not count. If you

hunch over your plate, chew with your mouth open or otherwise disgust your boss, she could very well hold it against you, even if unintentionally.

While it is doubtful that your first job will require you to entertain clients at expense account meals, your boss’s reaction to sloppy eating will be visceral.

Table manners are not that hard, and you could learn them in a few minutes. But it would be a good idea not to order any unfamiliar dishes.

Dear Miss Manners: I understand that black dresses are traditionally not supposed to be worn at a wedding. But what if there are female groomspeople at a black-tie affair?

I’m planning to have my daughter and my three sisters stand with me at my wedding next year, and since I’m going to be in a tuxedo, I thought they might all wear black, as well.

Congratulations on realizing that your wedding party should consist of those closest to you, regardless of gender.

Most people still approach this by casting gender-specific roles. This comes of not understanding that the tradition dated from a time when brides and bridegrooms were not

like real teenagers! I’ll take that as progress!

Available to rent on streaming services.

‘Leviticus’

The big indie success story of the summer was “Obsession,” which was made for \$750,000, grossed more than \$400 million, and stoked Hollywood interest in high-concept, low-budget horror.

“Leviticus,” a horror film about gay “conversion therapy” gone wrong, was more expensive (\$3.5 million) and less profitable (about \$8.6 million gross) than “Obsession,” but is still a lesson in how atmosphere and emotional entanglement can hold interest as much as special effects and celebrity actors.

I appreciated its message about how isolation is weaponized against queer youth, and how the only way to fight back is through community and connection.

But I *really* loved the sweeping, wide shots of rural industrial Australia, and seeing Mia Wasikowska in a series of drab, modest and somehow impossibly chic costumes.

Available to rent on streaming services.

‘Maddie’s Secret’

I’m happy to say that in aggregate, this summer’s lower-budget movies seemed to be drifting away from mumblecore realism, and toward heightened and stylized filmmaking. No one did that better than John Early, whose directorial debut captured the absurdity, camp and tenderness that made us obsessed with TV movies in the first place.

“Maddie’s Secret,” inspired by made-for-TV eating-disorder melodramas and “Showgirls,” was by far my favorite movie of the summer. Deeply observed! Perfectly choreographed! Unafraid to walk the razor’s edge between parody and sincerity! You’ll laugh, you’ll cry, you’ll be blown away by the precision of Kate Berlant’s physicality.

For more than a decade, Early has been among the funniest people walking the earth. He was finally given the resources to fully realize his vision. Or, as he said in multiple interviews during his press tour, he was given just enough money to direct and star in a movie that pushed him to the brink of complete physical and emotional exhaustion.

I’m choosing to take “Maddie’s Secret” as a sign of hope for LGBTQ filmmaking. But we won’t know for sure until we see how many more films Early gets to make, how much support he gets to make them, and how many more filmmakers like him are given the chance to prove themselves next year.

Available to rent on streaming services.

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The Washington Post

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MAXINE WALLACE/THE WASHINGTON POST

From left, Mason Burke, Tygerian Talbott, Skylar Burke and Christopher Burke pack Skylar's belongings on Aug. 17 in Bowie, Maryland, as she prepares for her freshman year at Temple University.

When the older sibling goes to college, the nest isn’t empty

SIBLINGS FROM B1

sense.

“I would like to say that I won’t miss it, but I’m probably going to because I’ve lived with her for like the past almost 16 years now,” Mason said.

We often think of and sympathize with parents who have no children in the house and have successfully sent their adult kids into the world. But what happens when an older sibling leaves the family home and younger siblings are still there with their parents? What happens in a “half-empty nest”?

To Mason, it’s going to be “a big adjustment.” Sure, he and his older sister always picked fights with each other, but they’ve also grown closer as they got older. “I like my little brother now,” Skylar said. Talbott, their mother, said they’ve become each other’s confidants.

While Skylar is away at school, Talbott hopes to understand Mason more. As a quiet kid, Mason relies on Skylar for the simplest things. Often, when she asks Mason a question, he responds

with, “let me ask Sky.”

“He’ll have to understand that his voice is his power, and it’s going to be nice. Even though it’s sad that she’s leaving, it’s going to leave him in a space where he has to be more vocal, where he has to be assertive,” Talbott said.

Older siblings are often seen as natural-born leaders. Dan Erickson, a clinical assistant professor in the School of Counseling at Arizona State University, explains that older siblings are constantly relied on for support and to help with younger siblings, especially as they get older.

The way these older-younger dynamics play out between siblings is dependent on the age gap, the number of siblings, personality traits within the family and how much parents are involved in emotionally raising their children. That makes each case of launched older siblings leaving younger siblings behind totally different.

J’laBrion Gauthreaux, a freshman at the University of Memphis, has four younger siblings. J’laBrion, 18, was a large help around her family home, step-

ping up when her mother might be at work or her stepfather wasn’t home. Getting all four of her younger siblings ready for bed and school the next morning was sometimes part of her routine.

J’laBrion said it helped her build a bond with her siblings. “I help my mom out because I know it’s hard trying to raise five kids, sending one off to college, and we have a dog. I want my siblings to be prepared. I don’t mind. I actually enjoy it,” she said.

J’laBrion’s sister, Jzanyse, 11, describes her older sister going to college as heartbreaking. She is excited for her sister, but it will be hard not to have her in the house, especially on the first day of school and other major events that her sister is normally there for. “I’m used to having her around, always waking me up in the morning and helping me plan out cute outfits for school. Now she’s going to be in college. It’s also hard because this is the person I’ve been with my whole life,” Jzanyse said.

The second oldest, D’Shawn Foster, 12, said this is the time for

him and Jzanyse to be more responsible as they look after their other siblings and help their parents, just like J’laBrion did.

D’Shawn said that although he’ll miss her, he knows his sister is off to do amazing things.

“I’m very inspired by my sister, for the big things she does. I am very proud of her. I feel like I may want to go to college,” D’Shawn said.

For the Winns, siblings Carlisle and Meade have also gotten closer over the last few years. “He’s like one of my best friends,” Carlisle, 16, said.

She said their relationship strengthened by bonding over how annoying their parents are. Over the years, their bond has grown so much that it doesn’t need a collective annoyance at their parents to thrive; Meade, 18, has even befriended some of Carlisle’s friends.

“It feels slightly rare, though, because a lot of my friends have a sibling leaving this year, and they’re friendly, but not super good friends,” Carlisle said.

Now that Carlisle is entering her junior year of high school and

Meade is a freshman at Clemson University, Carlisle’s biggest concern is having all of her parents’ attention.

“Especially with it being junior year, they’re going to be so on me about my grades and everything, but it’ll be fine,” Carlisle said.

Her mother, Logan Winn, has heard these grievances and understands that being an 11th-grader comes with a want for privacy.

“I have to put faith in her that we’ve done everything we can do and he’ll make good decisions, and she doesn’t want me in her business,” Logan said.

Sofia Jalil, 18, a freshman at Michigan State University, and her sibling, Isa Jalil, 13, aren’t close enough to befriend each other’s friends just yet. Isa and Sofia have a four-year age gap, and while Isa sees her as a cool older sister, they wouldn’t say they’re besties.

“Maybe this is good timing for you guys,” their mother, Alema Siddiki, said to Isa.

This can be a benefit of being separated from your sibling, according to Erickson. Sharing a

childhood with someone is an involuntary situation where you have to be around each other often. Adulthood allows siblings to transition their relationship into something that feels more like a choice.

“This is the opportunity to engage in a way that feels good and authentic to you and to them as well,” Erickson said. He said that sibling separation is not all “doom and gloom.” Rather, it’s a time for siblings to have the willingness to engage in a friendship within their dynamic.

As Mason sat on the couch with his headphones on, scrolling through TikTok, Skylar pointed out that he hasn’t said he would miss her to her face. He disagreed but said that life shouldn’t be much different while she’s away.

Later, after lowering the door of the packed trunk of the car, Christopher Burke joked, “It’s going to hit one day. You’re going to find yourself sitting in her room and call[ing] her saying, ‘Look where I’m at!’”

Mason shakes his head. Only time will tell.

In ‘The Savage Landscape,’ Flynn makes her way into the corners of the world

BOOK REVIEW FROM B1

ing, even if sometimes your palms may start sweating as Flynn describes the situation.

A writer and journalist with the calm, thoughtful demeanor of an academic, Flynn is also the author of the 2021 book, “Islands of Abandonment: Nature Rebounding in the Post-Human Landscape,” a vivid look at places damaged by war, climate change, industry and people, from the radioactive land around Chernobyl and the “biological desert” of a World War I battlefield to a remote Scottish island overrun with feral cattle, the descendants of creatures left behind when the last human inhabitants abandoned the place in the 1970s.

“To be alone in that way is very unusual and very unsettling,” she says of her time on the isle of Swona, a haunted, haunting place. “I was having sort of waking nightmares, imagining threats where there were none. That is actually kind of a natural reaction to a strange situation.”

“I think maybe that’s what I’ve always had in my mind,” she says, “writing about these places that make us fearful.”

Into the wild

While the previous book explored landscapes after catastrophe, “The Savage Landscape”

finds her heading downriver into Brazil’s Yanomami Indigenous Territory, trekking under guard into the Congo Basin and sneaking past barriers to approach a volcano spewing bathtub-sized globs of lava in Iceland. She investigates preservation efforts, the treatment of Indigenous communities and the most effective ways to achieve stated environmental goals.

Describing the book as a history of wilderness told through 10 journeys, Flynn combines reporting with her own reflections. She takes a hard look at the choices humans are making about maintaining a livable earth, which, for her, means moving beyond fixating on pristine or untouched landscapes.

“Finding places that were wholly unimpacted by humans was almost impossible,” says Flynn. “It’s like the idea of ‘perfect nature’ doesn’t really exist.”

While questioning current policies and strategies for preservation, it’s clear she’s not suggesting that we do less to safeguard the environment.

“We do need protections. We do need limitations on how we use and exploit the natural world,” she says. “I think that’s pretty inarguable.”

As well, the research for her previous book opened her eyes to the possibility that land once con-

sidered ruined or irredeemable might have as-yet unknown potential.

“I’d written quite a lot, as you know, on ‘posthuman landscapes,’ as I describe them,” she says. “I saw there that many of those landscapes could, in fact, be extremely valuable.”

That value may come from studying how ecosystems can respond and possibly rebound from human-generated stressors. Flynn also pushes back against the idea of declaring some places beyond hope.

“This idea of the pristine environment is something that is increasingly being picked apart, that maybe nothing really is pristine,” she says. “That’s a big conversation we’ve been having around climate change.”

“You can reason yourself into thinking that, Oh, there’s no point in saving this, because it’s already damaged,” she says. “If that’s the majority of the world, which it almost certainly is, where does that leave you?”

Sacred spaces

In the book, Flynn writes about sacred natural sites, locations that have been cared for and protected by Indigenous cultures. Often, this stewardship has a spiritual or religious element.

“When we look at landscapes populated by Indigenous groups,

by that I mean people who have remained in place for long periods of time, the culture of the people who live there is intertwined very deeply with the landscape itself,” she says.

While not established expressly as conservation sites, these sites, also known as sacred groves, often end up serving that function.

“India, for example, is absolutely packed with sacred groves,” she says. “There are hundreds of thousands of them, and what you tend to find is that these will be the last remaining old-growth forests, or they’ll be the last undisturbed versions of a riverine ecosystem, or they will be full of species that no longer exist in other parts of the nearby landscape.”

“It’s because they’ve been held under protection of some kind for a really, really, really long time, and the result is that religion serves to create a nature sanctuary,” she says. “Here, it’s a kind of fear or reverence for a landscape that saves it. Fear of a wrathful god can be more powerful than simply building a fence.”

Flynn says she thinks a similar reverence for landscape exists even in more secular cultures.

“The way that people talk about hiking, for example, often does echo the language of the sacred. Or people talk about epiphanies or transcendence in nature,” she

says. “You see this all the time on Instagram. This is the way that people do relate to the landscape around them, even if it’s not necessarily within some kind of larger religious system.”

“I think it might be baked into the way that we think about nature and ... of being part of something greater than ourselves,” she says.

World outside your door

Flynn says she wrestled with the need to travel so much, but ultimately felt that writing about a global issue, along with the specific cultural circumstances of a particular area, meant traveling to these locales to do her own reporting and research.

“I felt that I needed to go and see things playing out,” she says. “I do have a background as a news reporter, and my news editor was always sort of kicking into me the need to go and see things and meet people.

Over the course of the book, she gets into some challenging situations, which raises the question of whether it was prudent to be traveling alone, as she often was.

“It would primarily be myself, and then in some places, for example, like a fixer or a guide,” she says, citing the efforts of her guide in the Amazon as essential. “Without him, it would have been hopeless.”

But she also explored the possibilities that come from embracing the strangeness of a place on her own, such as her attempts to get up close to that erupting volcano.

“In Iceland, when I was primarily traveling alone and hiking alone into the exclusion zone, that was part of the experience I really wanted to lean into because I think when a lot of people think about wilderness, they think about that solitary aspect and this idea of feeling lost and alone,” she says. “And so I was trying to work with the logistical questions ... and keep some of that element of the aloneness alive.”

But all of this travel shifted something within her, too.

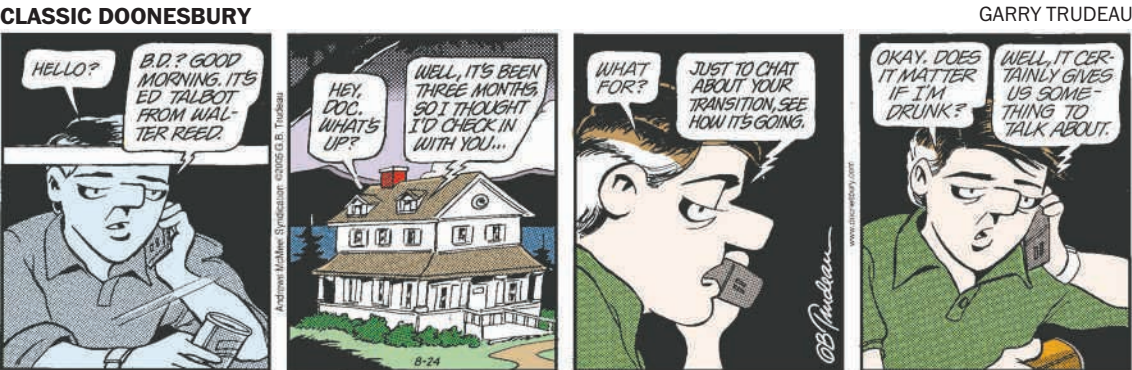
“It seems maybe perverse that I needed to travel the world to come to the conclusion that maybe traveling is not the solution,” she says. “I think I needed to do it to research and to learn about wilderness preservation. But do I need to travel to get the feeling that I’m looking for? No.”

These days, she says she’s been seeking out interactions with nature closer to home.

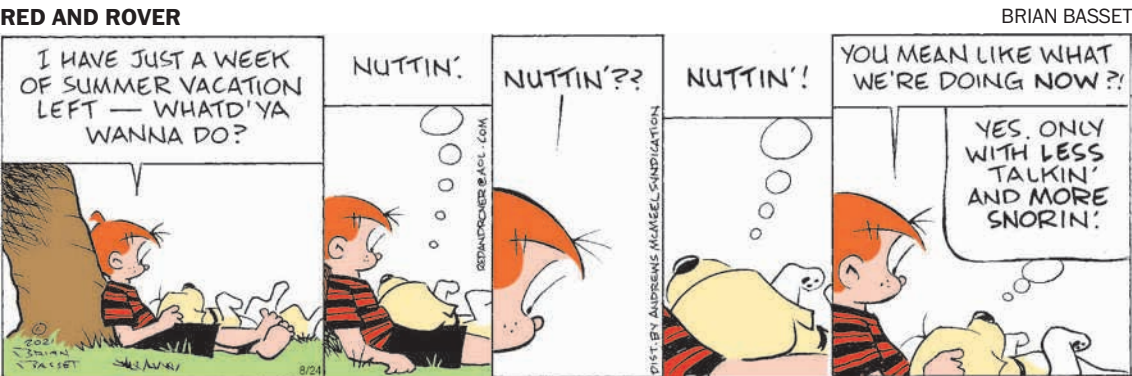
“I can sit very still, and a bird will come and hop over my feet,” she says. “That’s a kind of wilderness interaction, but it’s also a very feasible, reachable, accessible interaction with nature that blows my mind.”

“And that’s on my doorstep.”

CLASSIC DOONESBURY



RED AND ROVER



FRANK AND ERNEST



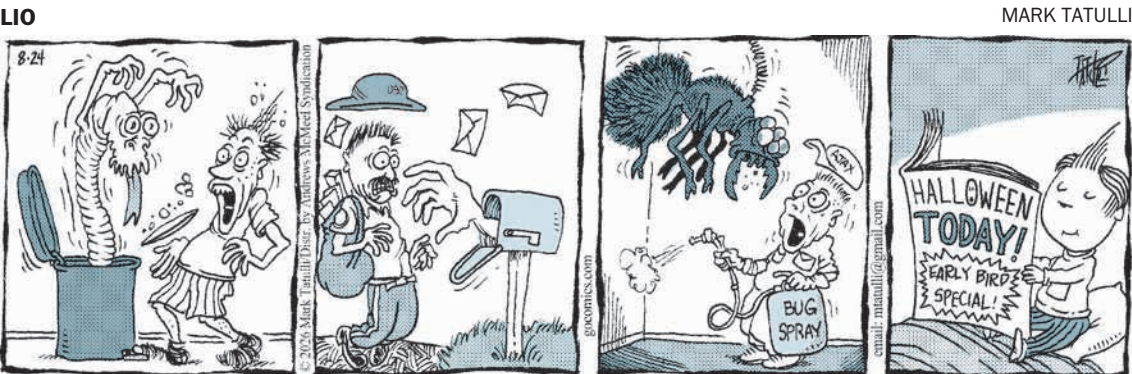
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RHYMES WITH ORANGE



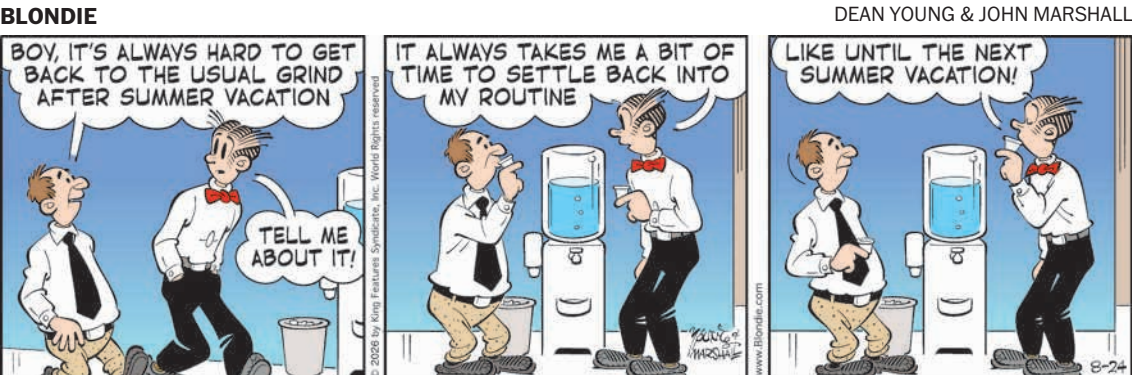
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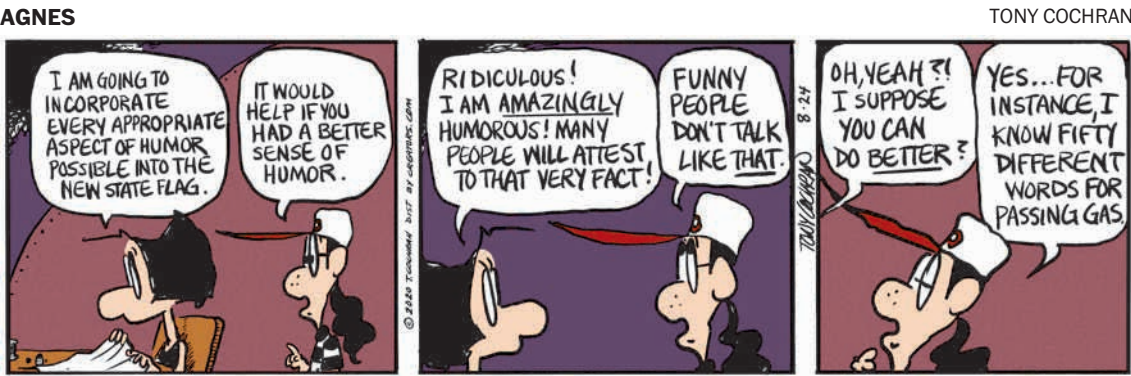
PEARLS BEFORE SWINE



PICKLES



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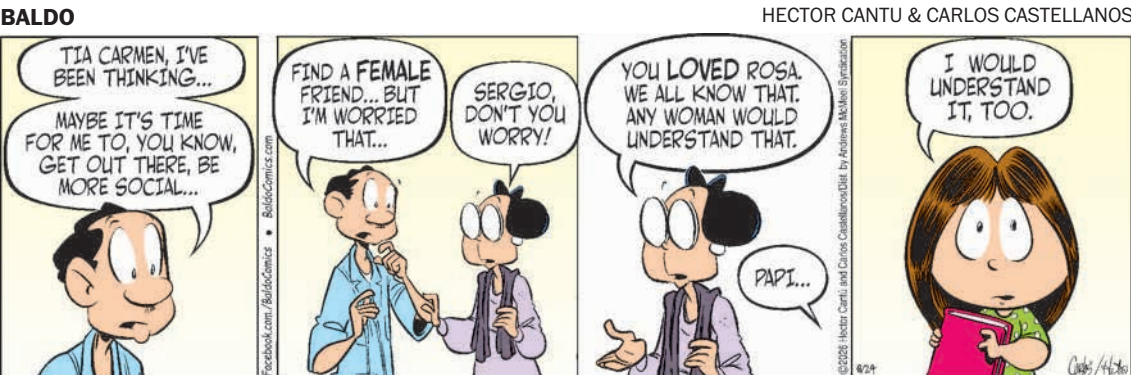
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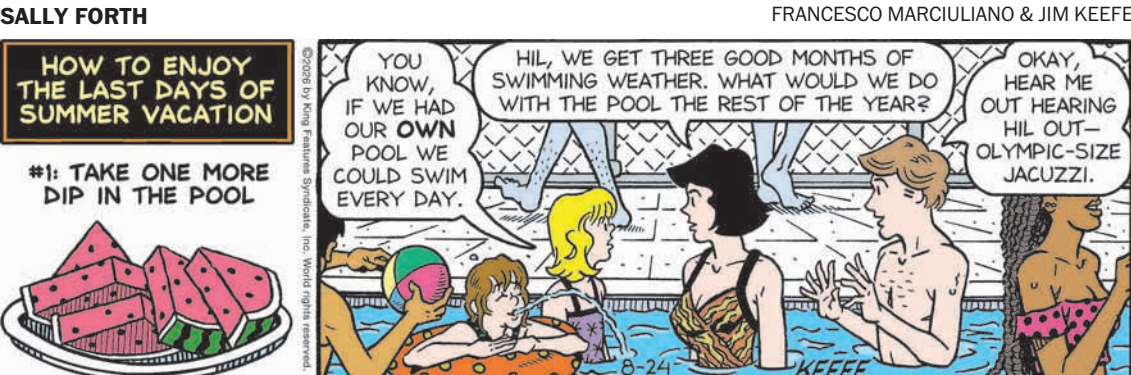
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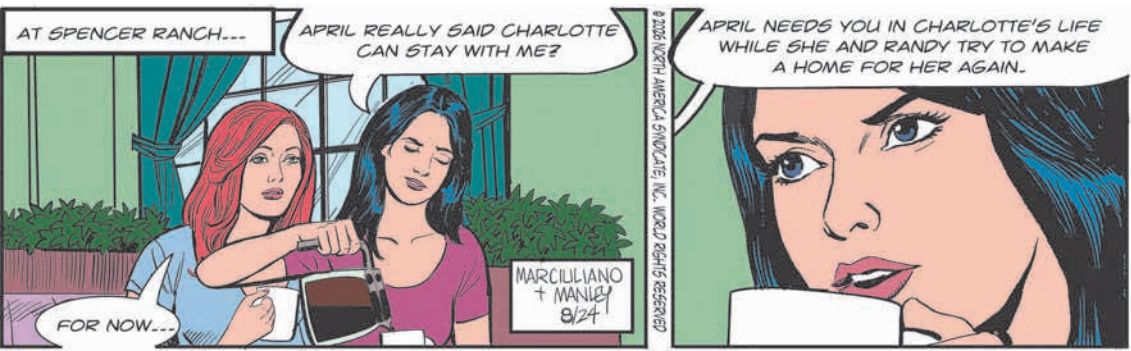
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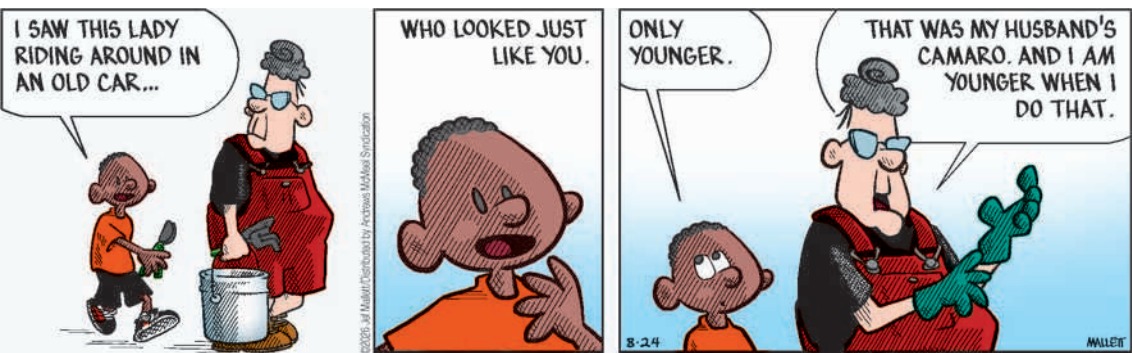
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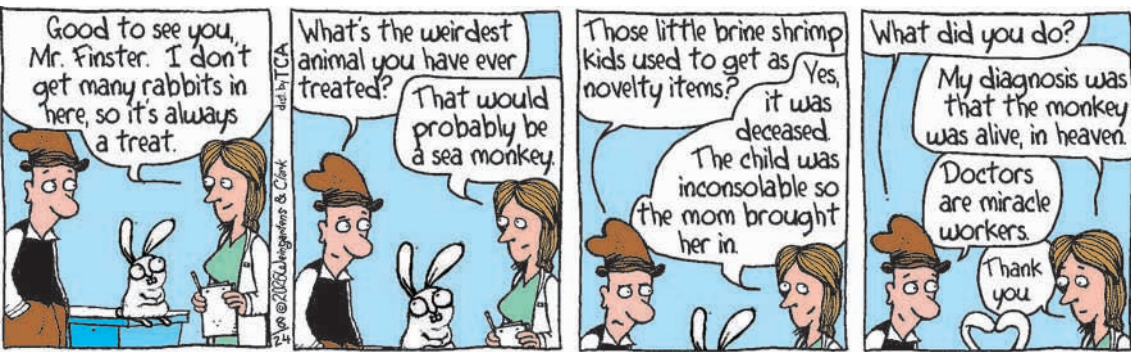
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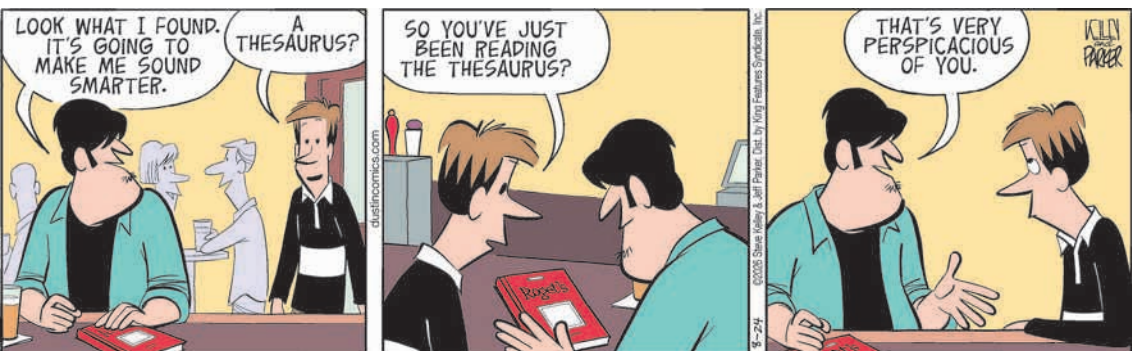
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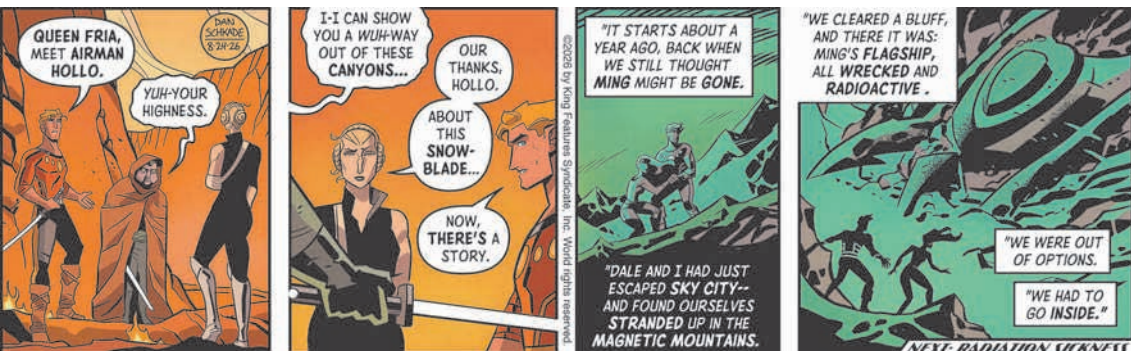
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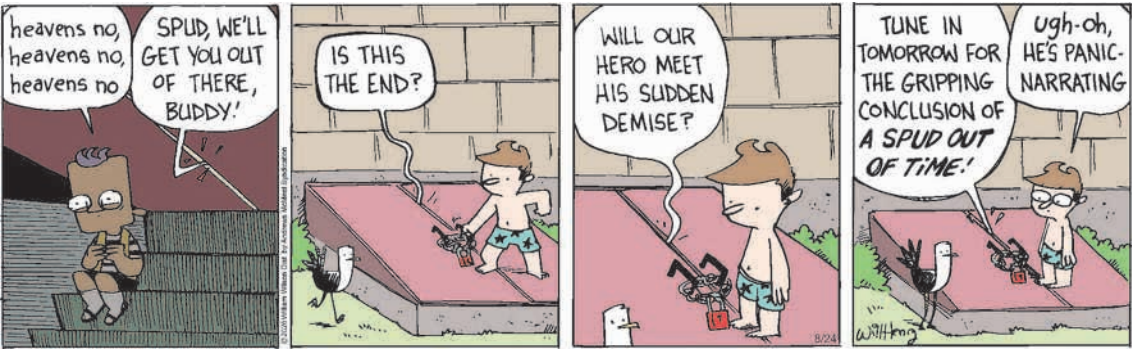
WILEY

BABY BLUES



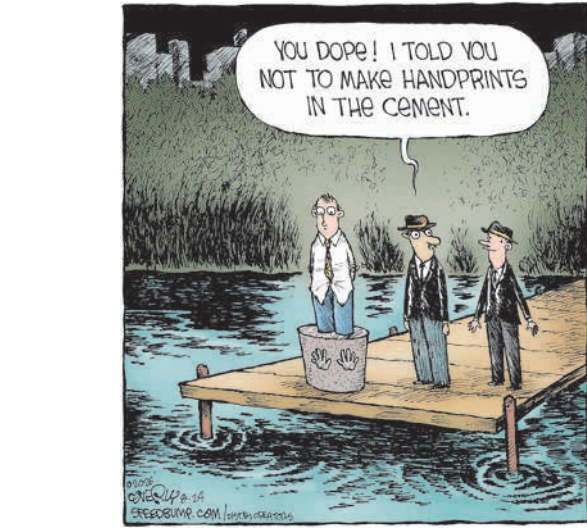
RICK KIRKMAN & JERRY SCOTT

WALLACE THE BRAVE



WILL HENRY

SPEED BUMP



DAVE COVERLY

DENNIS THE MENACE



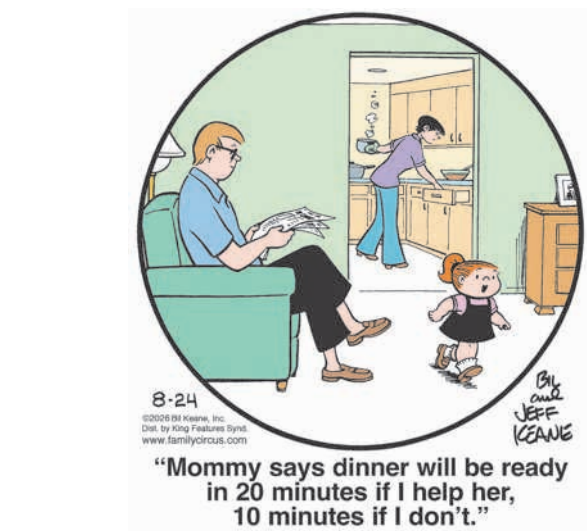
H. KETCHAM

ON THE FASTTRACK



BILL HOLBROOK

FAMILY CIRCUS



BIL KEANE

REPLY ALL LITE



DONNA A. LEWIS

BEETLE BAILEY



GREG, BRIAN & NEAL WALKER

The bidding:			
SOUTH	WEST	NORTH	EAST
1 ♥	Pass	2 ♠	Pass
3 ♥	Pass	6 ♥	All Pass
Opening lead — ♥ 2			

The Washington Post

SPORTS

MONDAY, AUGUST 24, 2026

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LYNNE SLADKY/AP

Jackson Kent, left, had issues with his command and was pulled after 4½ innings. “I thought it was better,” Manager Blake Butera said of Kent’s third MLB start.

The Nats’ nadir

BY DANIELLE ALLENTUCK

For much of this season, the Washington Nationals looked better than they had in years. They fought back late in games, had a winning record and were on the outer edges of the playoff hunt.

Then August hit. Three key pieces departed at the trade deadline, two veteran rotation placeholders were designated for assignment and two all-stars suffered injuries. As the Nationals concluded their three-city road trip Sunday with a 6-2 loss at the Miami Marlins, it’s apparent how much they are missing those pieces.

The Nationals went 1-8 on this trip and are 6-15 in August, tied for the second-

MARLINS 6, NATIONALS 2

Another sweep caps 1-8 trip as playoffs fade from sight

worst record in the majors. They were swept by the National League East rival New York Mets and Marlins, with their one win coming against the Texas Rangers. Any hope of making the playoffs this season has all but disappeared as Washington fell to 61-71.

“Not what we want,” Jacob Young told

reporters. “We’ve been a great road team a lot of the year, we didn’t get the hits when we needed them. ... We expect to go back home and play some better baseball and start winning some games.”

CJ Abrams, who rolled his ankle Aug. 19, was sidelined for the fourth game in a row. James Wood, who suffered an oblique strain Aug. 3, is taking longer than expected to return. Their absences have come after the trades of Foster Griffin, Luis García Jr. and Curtis Mead.

The Nationals looked to rookie Jackson

SEE NATIONALS ON C5

Rockies at Nationals

6:45 p.m., Nationals.TV

Weeks after trade, García still follows old club

BY DANIELLE ALLENTUCK

BALTIMORE — A few hours before he took the field with the New York Yankees on Wednesday, Luis García Jr. sat with his feet propped up, tapping away on his phone in the visitors’ clubhouse at Camden Yards.

Almost two months ago, he stood proudly at the same locker after hitting two home runs in the Washington Nationals’ 6-4 win over the Baltimore Orioles. The team was 43-42. García, then the longest-tenured member of the Nationals, remarked that day that the future was bright. And getting to be a part of the



JAMIE SABAU/IMAGN IMAGES

“I watch the highlights, always,” Luis García Jr. said of the Nationals, who traded him to the Yankees at the deadline.

turnaround after five miserable seasons meant the world to him.

“I’ve been here in this organization for a long time,” he said June 28. “Just being here, present, being here for my teammates, that’s really important. This year, yes, it’s a young team, but everyone is really excited.”

Just a month after that win, the Nationals traded García to the Yankees, Curtis Mead to the Boston Red Sox and Foster Griffin to the Cleveland Guardians. Add on James Wood’s prolonged oblique injury, and the once-promising season has been stalled in its tracks.

SEE GARCÍA JR. ON C5

Mystics win in Portland, will head to playoffs

MYSTICS 105, FIRE 100

Career-high 31 points by Austin extend season

ASSOCIATED PRESS

PORTLAND, ORE. — Shakira Austin had a career-high 31 points and 10 rebounds, and Georgia Amooore hit two free throws with 4.2 seconds left to help the Washington Mystics rally from a 14-point deficit and beat the Fire, 105-100, on Sunday night.

The victory clinched the Mystics’ first playoff berth since 2023.

“We’re definitely excited that we clinched a playoff spot, but we know there’s so much more work that we have to do. We want to win out before the [FIBA] break,” second-year Mystics forward Kiki Iriafen said in a postgame news conference.

Iriafen shot 7 for 11 from the field and finished with 18 points and 10 rebounds for the Mystics (22-15) for her 17th double-double. Sonia Citron added 14 points, and Cotie McMahon and Amooore scored 13 apiece.

Amooore’s foul on a three-point shot was upgraded to a flagrant. Carla Leite made all three free throws and then added a layup that cut the Fire’s deficit to 92-90 with 3:09 to play. Amooore responded with a basket inside, and Portland got no closer.

Leite had 27 points and 11 assists, and Emily Engstler hit five three-pointers and finished with 23 points, both career highs, for the Fire (15-22). Megan DiLeo had 21 points on 7-for-8 shooting, and Bridget Carleton added 18 points, five assists and five steals.

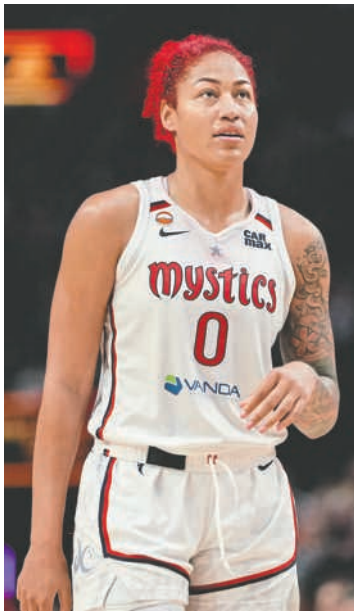
Leite hit two threes and DiLeo scored four points in the final minute before Amooore’s free throws sealed it.

Portland used a 14-2 run to take a 34-22 lead about two minutes into the second quarter, but the Mystics scored 18 of the next 22 points, taking a one-point lead when Citron converted a three-point play.

The Mystics continue their road trip against the Phoenix Mercury with games Tuesday and Thursday.

Mystics at Mercury

Tuesday, 10 p.m., Monumental



SOOBUM IM/IMAGN IMAGES

Shakira Austin finished with a career-high 31 points to help the Mystics clinch their first playoff berth in three seasons.



AARON DOSTER/IMAGN IMAGES

Frances Tiafoe, right, fell to Arthur Fils in three sets, 6-3, 1-6, 6-0, in the Cincinnati Open, earning Fils his first Masters 1000 title.

Tiafoe drops Cincinnati Open final to Fils in three sets

BY JEFF WALLNER
Associated Press

MASON, OHIO — Arthur Fils of France defeated American Frances Tiafoe, 6-3, 1-6, 6-0, in the men’s Cincinnati Open final for his first Masters 1000 title, and Coco Gauff defeated fellow American Jessica Pegula, 6-2, 6-4, to capture her second women’s Cincinnati title on Sunday.

The Fils-Tiafoe match was the first time two Black players met in an ATP Masters 1000 final.

Fils is the third Black man to win a Masters 1000 title, joining Ben Shelton, who won twice in Canada, and Jo-Wilfried Tsonga, who won in Paris in 2008 and Canada in 2014.

At 22 years old, Fils is the youngest French champion in Masters 1000 history. He became the second French player to win a Cincinnati final, joining Guy Forget in 1991.

“Very happy with that,” Fils said. “It’s been a tough last year. I didn’t play the French Open

[because of a hip injury]. I lost early in Washington. People think that I’m done. But here we are. I got the title.”

It was the second time Tiafoe appeared in the Cincinnati Open final, losing to Jannik Sinner in 2024. The Hyattsville native was looking to become the first American male to win in Cincinnati since Andy Roddick in 2006.

“I’m going to have two Cincinnati finals trophies at the crib,” Tiafoe said. “I wish they were both champion ones. Losing on

Sunday sucks. I’ve had a tough summer. I was able to play five great matches and beat quality players.”

Fils overpowered Tiafoe early in the first set on Sunday, winning 12 of 13 points to take a 3-0 lead. Tiafoe was dominant in the second, rolling to a 3-0 lead.

Tiafoe used the time break before the third set to stretch and receive massage treatment on his upper left leg and lower back.

“My hip bothered me a little

SEE CINCINNATI ON C3

THE DAY IN SPORTS

SOCCER Spirit can't break funk, falling at home to Pride

The Washington Spirit conceded in the third minute and fell, 1-0, to the Orlando Pride at Audi Field on Sunday, extending its winless run to four games.

On a breakaway down the right side, **Barbra Banda** crossed to **Haley McCutcheon**, who fired just inside the left side of the net past the reach of a diving **Sandy MacIver**.

The Spirit (11-6-4) controlled the game, finishing with 73 percent of possession and a 23-10 advantage in shots, but couldn't find the equalizer against the Pride (8-11-2), which snapped a three-game skid.

Washington, which last won July 29, remains at 37 points, tied for second in the NWSL with the Portland Thorns. First-place Gotham FC had a chance to add to its 43 points with a win over Angel City FC on Sunday night. ...

Manchester City marked **Enzo Maresca**'s first English Premier League game in charge with a stirring late rally, scoring twice in the final 10 minutes to grab a 2-1 home win over Bournemouth.

Josko Gvardiol placed a finish into the bottom corner in the first minute of stoppage time for the winner, which was initially given offside before being awarded following a video review, after **Marc Guehi** had equalized with a 84th-minute header from a corner.

Elsewhere, **Dominik Szoboszlai** converted a penalty in the ninth minute of stoppage time to salvage a 2-2 draw for Liverpool at Newcastle in a match overseen by two new managers. ...

Raphinha and **Fernán López** scored two goals each as Barcelona cruised to a 5-0 victory at Elche, beginning its defense of the Spanish league title in style.

Julián Álvarez heard boos from the Atletico Madrid crowd in his return to action in a 2-2 draw against Villarreal after asking to leave the club. ...

AC Milan opened its Italian league campaign with a 2-1 win at Torino, with goals three minutes apart by **Alphadjo Cisse** and **Adrien Rabiot** in the second half. ...

Ferran Torres scored twice in his Paris Saint-Germain debut to help the French defending champion draw, 2-2, at Rennes in its Ligue 1 opener. ...

UEFA President **Aleksander Ceferin** said he won't run against FIFA President **Gianni Infantino** but warned the beleaguered head of world soccer that he must either quit or face a leadership challenge in March.

Six Nordic national soccer associations also added pressure on Infantino, saying they had "lost confidence" in his leadership. ...

Bayern Munich's **Harry Kane** and **Giulia Gwinn** won Germany's player of the year awards for 2026.

Bayern's **Vincent Kompany** also won the coach's accolade, Kicker magazine said, according to the results of its yearly polls of members of the Association of German Sports Journalists. ...

Highly rated teenage midfielder **Ayyoub Bouaddi** was left out of Lille's squad for its opening game of the Ligue 1 season amid reports of an imminent big-money move to Manchester City.

GOLF Third title could make Clark player of the year

Wyndham Clark has been through this before — losing a big lead in the final round, playing alongside a gallery favorite. But he finished strong at the BMW Championship, just as he did at the U.S. Open, and closed with an even-par 70 for a three-shot victory at Bellevere in St. Louis.

Clark won for the third time this year, putting him squarely in the conversation for PGA Tour player of the year considering one was a major and the other was a FedEx Cup playoff event.

Patrick Cantlay, who came in at No. 43 in the FedEx Cup, showed plenty of moxie. Four times, he bounced back from a bogey with a birdie, closing with three birdies in a row for a 68 to finish runner-up and be among the top 30 in the FedEx Cup who advance to the Tour Championship.

Also moving into the top 30 was **Gary Woodland**, who pulled within one shot of the lead until topping his tee shot into a creek on the ninth hole on his way to a double bogey.

Robert MacIntyre closed with a 65 and tied for seventh, enough to move him into the top 30. Those falling out of the top 30 were **Rickie Fowler**, **Bud Cauley** and **Kurt Kitayama**. British Open



MAJA HITIJ/GETTY IMAGES

No blues

American sprinting star Melissa Jefferson-Wooden gets a lift from the official mascot of the Kamila Skolimowska Memorial track and field meet following her victory in the women's 100-meter final at Slaski Stadium in Chorzow, Poland, on Sunday.

SPOTLIGHT: TENNIS

S. Williams, Alcaraz will face qualifying team

BY BRIAN MAHONEY

NEW YORK — Serena Williams and Carlos Alcaraz will have to wait a little longer to learn their first opponent in the U.S. Open mixed doubles championship.

Williams and Alcaraz were drawn Sunday to face one of the teams that advances from the eight-team qualifying tournament that will be played Monday.

Williams will be returning to the U.S. Open for the first time since 2022. The six-time singles champion and Alcaraz, who has won the men's title twice, were awarded a wild card into the 16-team tournament Saturday.

The first round and quarterfinals of the mixed doubles are Tuesday, with the semifinals and final Wednesday. The winning team shares \$1 million.

Facing one of the qualifiers will be a tough assignment, because most of the players in the qualifying tournament are

Final two doubles spots in U.S. Open tournament will be determined Monday

doubles specialists. The qualifying tournament was added this year to give those types of players a chance to compete after they were almost entirely shut out last year when the U.S. Tennis Association, seeking more star power, revamped the mixed doubles and based direct entry on the players' rankings in singles.

Two-time defending women's champion Aryna Sabalenka and 23-time Grand Slam singles champion Novak Djokovic earned the No. 1 seed after having the lowest combined singles ranking among the teams. Their first opponents are Leylah Fernandez and Frances Tiafoe.

Americans Jessica Pegula and Taylor Fritz are seeded No. 2 and will open against Diana Shnaider and Casper Ruud. Ruud was scheduled to team up with Iga Swiatek again after they reached the final in 2025. But Swiatek withdrew, and Schnaider needed a partner after Daniil Medvedev pulled out.

The other first-round matches: Elina Svitolina and Gael Monfils, who are married, vs. Alex Eala and Felix Auger-Aliassime; Belinda Bencic and Flavio Cobolli vs. Taylor Townsend and Alexander Zverev; Karolina Muchova and Jakub Mensik vs. the other team from the qualifying tournament; Emma Navarro and Tommy Paul vs. Amanda Anisimova and Learner Tien; Mirra Andreeva and Andrey Rublev vs. two-time defending champions Sara Errani and Andrea Vavassori; and Shnaider and Ruud vs. Pegula and Fritz.

— Associated Press

TELEVISION AND RADIO

MLB	
6:30 p.m.	Tampa Bay at Detroit » Fox Sports 1
6:45 p.m.	Colorado at Washington » Nationals.TV, WJFK (106.7 FM)
9:45 p.m.	Cincinnati at San Francisco » Fox Sports 1
WNBA	
8 p.m.	Golden State at Minnesota » USA Network
10 p.m.	Atlanta at Los Angeles » Peacock
SOCCER	
12:30 p.m.	Italian Serie A: Lazio at Bologna » CBS Sports Network
2 p.m.	Saudi Arabian Pro League: Al Hazem at Al Ittihad » Fox Sports 2
3 p.m.	English Premier League: Chelsea at Fulham » USA Network

TENNIS	
11 a.m.	U.S. Open, qualifying » ESPN2
1 p.m.	U.S. Open, qualifying: ATP: Winston-Salem Open, early rounds; WTA: Monterrey Open, early rounds » Tennis Channel

WOMEN'S COLLEGE VOLLEYBALL	
6 p.m.	Pittsburgh vs. Xavier » Fox Sports 2
8 p.m.	Texas at Marquette » Fox Sports 2

LITTLE LEAGUE BASEBALL WORLD SERIES	
1 p.m.	Panama vs. Canada » ESPN
3 p.m.	Ohio vs. Texas » ESPN
5 p.m.	Japan vs. Czech Republic » ESPN
7 p.m.	Alabama vs. Pennsylvania » ESPN

Lateef served as the primary backup last season to **Dylan Raiola**, who transferred to Oregon.

Colandrea arrived at UNLV following two seasons at Virginia, where he threw for 4,083 yards and 26 touchdowns. ...

Running back **Ahmad Hardy**, a preseason all-American, will miss Missouri's season opener against Arkansas-Pine Bluff on Sept. 3 as he recovers from being shot in the leg three months ago.

Coach **Eli Drinkwitz** said in July that it could take Hardy five to eight weeks to be cleared to play. ...

Clemson suspended defensive tackle **Vic Burley** indefinitely following an arrest early Saturday morning, Coach **Dabo Swinney** said in a statement.

Swinney said Burley was charged with disorderly conduct after being arrested by the Clemson University Police Department. ...

Forward **Mark Mitchell**, who started 133 games at Missouri and Duke over the past four years, is transferring to Kentucky for a disputed fifth season of men's college basketball.

After scoring 18.3 points for the Tigers last season as a two-time all-SEC player, Mitchell signed a contract with the Denver Nuggets that was not guaranteed.

Mitchell, along with scores of college athletes who graduated from high school in 2022, appear to be on a path to play a fifth season in five years.

AUTO RACING

After losing a lug nut, Blaney prevails in N.H.

Ryan Blaney overcame a major fumble by his pit crew and charged from 17th to first for his second consecutive NASCAR Cup Series win at New Hampshire Motor Speedway.

The Team Penske driver led a race-high 115 of 301 laps in Loudon and fended off **Bubba Wallace** by 0.586 seconds.

Josh Berry, who is trying to find a ride for the 2027 season, finished a season-best third, the fourth consecutive top 10 for the Wood Brothers Racing driver.

The top five was rounded out by **Christopher Bell** and **Kyle Larson**. **Ryan Preece** was ninth and kept his Chase hopes alive by gaining 19 points on **Shane van Gisbergen**, who finished 20th and remains in the 16th and final spot for the 10-race title run.

It's the 20th career victory and third this season for Blaney, who had cruised to a big lead when a lug nut fell off the left-front tire of his No. 12 Ford during a pit stop under caution with 111 laps remaining.

The 2023 Cup Series champion picked his way through traffic and was back up to seventh when the yellow flag flew on the 226th lap for a three-car crash. Crew chief **Jonathan Hassler** made an aggressive strategy call for two right-side tires, and Blaney gained six spots in the pits to retake first place. ...

McLaren's **Lando Norris** passed **Kimi Antonelli** and **Lewis Hamilton** in the space of a single lap before holding on to take the Dutch Grand Prix for back-to-back Formula One victories.

Norris started on the pole but was overtaken by Antonelli's Mercedes at a restart after the race was stopped for a heavy crash by home hero **Max Verstappen**, who was unhurt, shortly after the start.

Antonelli was second after his Mercedes teammate **George Russell** was ordered to move out of his way, following a failed gamble on a tire change by Antonelli. Russell clung on to finish third ahead of Hamilton.

Mercedes boss **Toto Wolff** defended the use of team orders, saying they're "always harsh from one driver's perspective."

CYCLING

Brennan surges to take second stage of Vuelta

Young British rider **Matthew Brennan** finished strong to win the second and longest stage of the Spanish Vuelta ahead of race leader **Tadej Pogacar**.

The 21-year-old Brennan capitalized on good work from Visma-Lease a Bike teammate **Wout van Aert** in an uphill sprint and got ahead of second-place **Pau Miquel** and third-place Pogacar to complete the 214.3-kilometer (133.1 mile) hilly trek through Provence in southern France in 4 hours 47 minutes 47 seconds.

Pogacar, who edged **Ethan Hayter** by 0.09 seconds in the opening time trial Saturday, kept the race leader's red jersey by finishing with the same time as the stage winner.

— From news services



Tyler Biadasz, cut by the Commanders in March, signed with the Chargers but won't play a regular season snap for them this year.

NFL NOTES

Chargers put C Biadasz (ACL) on season-ending IR

ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Los Angeles Chargers placed center Tyler Biadasz on season-ending injured reserve after he injured his left knee in a joint practice with the San Francisco 49ers.

The Chargers signed wide receiver Gary Jennings on Sunday to fill the roster spot.

Biadasz went down after 49ers defensive tackle Sebastian Valdez fell into his leg during an 11-on-11 drill and was carted off the field. ESPN reported Biadasz suffered damage to his ACL and other injuries.

The 28-year-old Biadasz signed with the Chargers in March shortly after the Washington Commanders released him.

He has started 84 regular season games and seven playoff games over his career with the Commanders and Dallas Cowboys, who drafted the former Wisconsin standout in the fourth round of the 2020 draft.

•**RAIDERS:** Running back Ashton Jeanty had to be helped off the field after apparently being injured late in practice and was unable to put pressure on his right leg.

Las Vegas did not provide a statement on Jeanty's status, and there was no indication of when an update would come. Coach Klint Kubiak is not scheduled to speak with reporters until Tuesday.

Jeanty went down after trying to catch a pass, and his teammates at the club's indoor practice facility quickly went quiet. The entire team then knelt and prayed.

•**BROWNS:** Todd Monken will take at least one more day before deciding whether Shedeur Sanders or Deshaun Watson will be Cleveland's starting quarterback for its opener.

The first-year head coach said he anticipates announcing the starter Monday. Monken also said Watson's comments after the

Browns' 31-7 loss to the Buffalo Bills on Saturday are not expected to play a deciding factor in his final decision....

The Browns placed defensive end Alex Wright on injured reserve because of a season-ending Achilles tendon injury he suffered during a joint practice against the Buffalo Bills on Thursday.

The Browns signed Derek Barnett to fill Wright's spot. The nine-year veteran had five sacks last season for the Houston Texans.

•**49ERS:** San Francisco took star tight end George Kittle off the physically unable to perform list, providing hope he might be able to return from a ruptured right Achilles tendon before the season opener.

The 49ers got good news on the injury front 10 days before they were set to depart for Australia for a Week 1 game against the Los Angeles Rams on Sept. 11, with both Kittle and running back Christian McCaffrey back at practice.

San Francisco is scheduled to leave Sept. 2, and Kittle said last week that he needed to get practice time in pads before then to determine whether he would make the trip and try to play Week 1.

McCaffrey had missed the past two weeks of practice with what the team had described as "tightness."

•**EAGLES:** Running back Ja'Quinden Jackson was released from a hospital and traveled home with Philadelphia after he was injured against the New England Patriots on Saturday night.

Jackson tackled Lan Larison on the opening kickoff and lay motionless right after making the hit. After he was injured, medical personnel from both teams attended to him and quickly called for a backboard and ambulance.

The Eagles said Saturday night that Jackson had strength and movement in all extremities and had been taken to a hospital for further evaluation.

ANALYSIS

In Ravens' victory, Green stands out on defense while center remains a concern

BY MIKE PRESTON

Baltimore Ravens second-year outside linebacker Mike Green had two strong plays in the first quarter of Saturday's 13-3 preseason win at the Minnesota Vikings. One resulted in a sack, and another created pressure on quarterback J.J. McCarthy, but there needs to be more.

Both came against Vikings tackle Henry Byrd, a converted guard who played at Princeton. We're not talking about Alabama, LSU, or even Indiana, but Princeton, an Ivy League school. Byrd looked lost on both plays, but maybe it's a sign that Green got the message after a disappointing preseason opener against the Philadelphia Eagles.

Regardless, the Ravens have a strong group of backups on the defensive line, including tackles C.J. Okoye, Broderick Washington and Aeneas Peebles. They dominated Minnesota's offensive line, as the Vikings rushed for only 65 yards. The Ravens also collected five sacks.

Center concerns

The biggest difference between centers Danny Pinter and Ethan Pocic was easily on display. Pinter, out for the season with a torn patellar tendon he suffered earlier this week, has quicker feet and is able to get to his blocks within a step or two.

Pocic, a 10-year veteran, is a much better pass blocker and gives little ground in the middle of the offensive line. Regardless, the Ravens will struggle to recover from losing Tyler Linderbaum in free agency, but the pass protection should be better this year.

No QB controversy

After Joe Fagnano had another solid performance Saturday, some want him to replace Tyler Huntley as the backup to starter Lamar Jackson, but we saw this last year and ended up with Cooper Rush. Fagnano completed 15 of 20 passes for 123 yards and a touchdown against Minnesota while Huntley



Ravens linebacker Mike Green sacked Vikings quarterback J.J. McCarthy during the first half of Saturday's 13-3 victory in Minneapolis.

went 5 for 8 for 63 yards.

The big difference is that Huntley is almost as elusive as Jackson, and the Ravens won't have to change their offense at all if Huntley plays.

Plus, Huntley is a big-game performer and always steps up when Jackson goes down.

Actually, this is a no-brainer. Again.

Look away

Could someone please tell WBAL to stop showing so many isolated shots of defensive coordinator Anthony Weaver on the sideline?

I am a big fan of Weaver, but he doesn't even call the plays on defense. That assignment goes to Coach Jesse Minter.

Punter progress

Rookie punter Ryan Eckley has been inconsistent in training camp, but maybe he turned the corner against Minnesota. The sixth-round pick out of Michigan State averaged 55.3 yards on six punts with two landing inside the Vikings' 20-yard line. He did this in training camp, but maybe he's overcome some early-season jitters.

Maybe.

Coaching questions

The more I watch first-year offensive coordinator Declan Doyle operate, the more I believe the Ravens might become the best screen team in the NFL since the days when Mike McCarthy was the Green Bay Packers' coach from 2008 to 2018.

The Ravens run regular screens, but also have "jailbreak screens" to the slot or outside receiver. It's a great weapon when the team has a slot receiver such as Zay Flowers.

But I do want to know why Doyle didn't have more misdirection plays or why Minter didn't

use a timeout when the Vikings took possession inside their own 10 with less than two minutes to play in the second quarter. At that point, the Ravens had all three.

Players to watch

I already mentioned them once, but two young players to watch are first-year defensive tackle David Olajiga and outside linebacker Ethan Burke, the rookie from Texas. Olajiga had a sack Saturday, and Burke had three tackles, including a forced fumble, which the Ravens turned into the game's only touchdown.

Olajiga plays with force, and

Burke has a strong nose for the ball. Plus, Burke is 6-foot-6 and 267 pounds. That's a big man, even in his home state of Texas.

Tight end report

While on the subject of rookies and young players, how about rookie tight end Josh Cuevas, the fifth-round pick from Alabama?

Cuevas had three catches for 36 yards and was a factor when the Ravens worked the misdirection plays in the flats. Maybe, just maybe, Doyle is holding onto something until the regular season begins. How about some more waggles and bootlegs?

Easy choice

It's easy to see why veteran Kyler Murray beat out McCarthy for the starting quarterback job. McCarthy couldn't hit the ground if he dropped the ball.

The third-year quarterback from Michigan consistently overthrew receivers in the first quarter, then overthrew Myles Price in the end zone on a short pass attempt. Murray has his own problems standing at only 5-10, but at least he is more accurate. Yao Ming, the former 7-6 center for the Houston Rockets, couldn't have caught the pass intended for Price.

Preparation mode

I liked it when Carson Wentz was the Vikings' starting quarterback, even if only for a short while.

Wentz has a strong arm and can get the ball out quickly. He completed 9 of 11 passes for 92 yards, and that's what the Ravens will face in the Cincinnati Bengals' Joe Burrow and, to a lesser degree, the Pittsburgh Steelers' Aaron Rodgers.

Hold up

Message to Ravens backup right offensive tackle Gerard Lichtenhan: Stop the holding. Three holding penalties in one game is quite a lot. Also, that's left guard John Simpson's job as the most penalized offensive lineman in the league last year.

— Baltimore Sun

Fils beats Tiafoe and Gauff bests Pegula for Cincinnati Open titles

CINCINNATI FROM C1

bit, but that's neither here nor there," Tiafoe said. "It's not about how I feel. I'll be all right in a week [for the U.S. Open]."

Tiafoe saved three championship points in the final game before Fils closed out the victory.

The Frenchman had 11 aces and won 71 percent of his points on first serve. He improved to 10-0 in deciding sets this year and 8-0 against American opponents.

Fils also won his only previous meeting with Tiafoe in Miami last year, also in three sets.

"It feels very good to have a trophy next to me, especially Masters 1000," Fils said. "Never won one before. You just have to stay positive and find a way to make it work. Being positive is going to help me in the next weeks in the U.S. Open."

In Saturday's semifinals, Pegula beat defending champion Iga Swiatek and Gauff defeated Sara Bejlek to set up the first all-American women's final at the Cincinnati Open in 56 years.

The last time two American women played in the Cincinnati final was in 1970, when Rosie Casals beat Nancy Richey.

Pegula's best finish in Cincinnati came in 2024, when



Arthur Fils defeated Frances Tiafoe in the first ATP Masters 1000 final featuring two Black players.

she lost to Aryna Sabalenka in the final.

Gauff, who won the 2023 title beating Karolina Muchova, stormed out to a 5-0 lead in the first set Sunday before winning, 6-2. Pegula battled back to within 5-4 in the second before Gauff closed out the win. Gauff won five of six break points.

"I think it was a long journey, but I'm happy," Gauff said. "I think it's night and day, the player I was last year to now. I don't think that this is an indicator that I'm going to do well in New York. Just knowing the quality ones that I had this week, hopefully I can use that experience."

Gauff had five wins in straight sets in Cincinnati.

"I thought she just played at a really high level and didn't really have many dips," Pegula said. "I didn't really think I played bad. The more you construct the point [against her], the worse it is because she almost likes to run. It was tough today. A dangerous, confident Coco is going to New York."

The head-to-head series between Gauff and Pegula is now tied at five apiece. Sunday was their second meeting in a final, with Gauff winning at Wuhan last year.

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BASEBALL

National League

EAST	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR	CENTRAL	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR
Atlanta	76	55	.580	—	3-7 W-1	Milwaukee	81	50	.618	—	7-3 L-1
Philadelphia	73	58	.557	3	9-1 W-9	Chicago	75	56	.573	7	4-6 W-1
Miami	67	64	.511	9	5-5 W-3	St. Louis	66	66	.500	16½	5-5 L-3
Washington	61	71	.462	15½	2-8 L-4	Pittsburgh	63	69	.477	19½	5-5 L-3
New York	59	72	.450	17	6-4 L-1	Cincinnati	62	69	.473	20	3-7 L-1

Marlins 6, Nationals 2

NATIONALS	AB	R	H	BB	SO	AVG
Lile If.....	4	1	1	0	2	.242
Ortiz dh.....	4	0	0	0	0	1.210
Crews rf.....	4	0	2	1	0	.214
K Ruiz c.....	3	1	1	0	1	.280
Tena 2b.....	4	0	0	0	0	.234
Vivas 3b.....	4	0	1	1	0	.231
Chaparro 1b.....	2	0	0	0	1	.240
Núñez ss.....	4	0	0	0	0	.224
Young cf.....	3	0	0	0	0	1.224
TOTALS	33	2	5	2	3	—

MARLINS	AB	R	H	BB	SO	AVG
Lopez ss.....	2	1	0	1	2	.306
Ramirez dh.....	3	2	1	0	1	.240
Adell rf.....	3	0	1	1	1	.228
Edwards 2b.....	4	0	1	2	0	.285
E. Ruiz cf-rr.....	4	0	0	0	0	.244
Sanoja 3b.....	4	0	1	0	0	.279
De Los Santos 1b.....	2	0	1	0	0	.333
Marsee ph-cf.....	1	2	1	0	0	.211
Conine rf-1b.....	3	1	1	0	1	.264
Navareto c.....	2	0	0	0	0	.129
Mac ph-c.....	2	0	1	2	0	.235
TOTALS	30	6	8	6	6	—

WASHINGTON 000 101 000 — 2 5 0
MIAMI.....100 022 01X — 6 8 1

E: Fairbanks (1), LOB: Washington 9, Miami 7. 2B: Lile (24), Crews (13), Vivas (9), Hernández (14), Sanoja (27), Mack (8). RBI: Crews (29), Vivas (22), Hernández (53), Edwards (24), Mack (38), Lopez (58), SF: Lopez.

NATIONALS IP H R ER BB SO IPERA
Kent.....4½ 4 3 3 3 5 908.03
Williams.....2½ 2 2 2 3 3 472.65
Kranick.....2 1 1 0 0 156.59

MARLINS IP H R ER BB SO IPERA
Junk.....4½ 2 1 0 2 694.25
Petersen.....½ 0 0 0 1 123.52
Faucer.....1 1 1 1 1 184.07
Ralston.....2 2 0 0 2 310.00
Fairbanks.....1 0 0 1 1 205.80

WP: Petersen (3-3); LP: Kent (0-2). Inherited runners-scored: Williams 2-2, Petersen 2-0. HBP: Junk 2 (Chaparro Young). ABS Challenge: Junk (Ball-Overtaken to Strike) T: 2:45, A: 17,826 (37,446).

HOW THEY SCORED

MARLINS FIRST
Otto Lopez grounds out. Agustín Ramírez walks. **Heriberto Hernández double**, Agustín Ramírez scores. Xavier Edwards grounds out. Heriberto Hernández to third. Estuary Ruiz called out on strikes.

Marlins 1, Nationals 0
NATIONALS FOURTH
Daylen Lile doubles. Abimelec Ortiz lines out. **Dylan Crews doubles**, **Daylen Lile scores**. Keibert Ruiz grounds out, Lyle Crews to third. Jose Tena lines out.

National 1, Marlins 1
NATIONALS FIFTH
Griffin Conine strikes out swinging. Brian Navareto strikes out swinging. Otto Lopez walks. Agustín Ramírez singles, Otto Lopez to second. Heriberto Hernández walks, Agustín Ramírez to second. Otto Lopez to third. **Xavier Edwards singles**, **Heriberto Hernández to second**, **Agustín Ramírez scores**, **Otto Lopez scores**. Estuary Ruiz strikes out swinging.

Marlins 3, Nationals 1
NATIONALS SIXTH
Dylan Crews grounds out. Keibert Ruiz walks. Jose Tena strikes out swinging. **Jorbit Vivas doubles**, **Keibert Ruiz scores**. Andres Chaparro files out.
Marlins 3, Nationals 2
MARLINS SIXTH
Javier Sanoja files out. Jakob Marsee pinch-hitting for Devonson De Los Santos. Jakob Marsee walks. Griffin Conine walks. Jakob Marsee to second. Joe Mack pinch-hitting for Brian Navareto. **Joe Mack doubles**, **Griffin Conine to third**, **Jacob Marsee scores**, **Otto Lopez out on a sacrifice fly**, **Griffin Conine scores**. Agustín Ramírez grounds out.
Marlins 5, Nationals 2
MARLINS EIGHTH
Javier Sanoja files out. Jakob Marsee singles. Griffin Conine singles. Jakob Marsee to third. **Joe Mack hits into a fielder's choice**, **Griffin Conine out to second**, **Jacob Marsee scores**. Otto Lopez files out.
Marlins 6, Nationals 2

NATIONALS' LEADERS

Entering Monday's game.
BATTERS AVG OBA H HRR BB SO
Wiener.....286 398 20 3 12 12 19
García.....283 313 101 23 76 16 61
Trout.....280 319 77 8 43 15 33
Abrams.....279 354 131 29 91 46 124
Wood.....265 391 116 30 73 90 153
Mead.....254 352 72 17 48 39 62

PITCHERS ERA IP H ER BB SO
Dion.....0.00 12 2 0 4 13
Geeze, Tol.....0.00 1 1 0 0 1
Yean.....1.80 10 5 2 2 6
Fernández.....2.25 4 3 1 2 3
Williams.....2.65 17 15 6 6 22
Poulin.....2.70 36.2 27 11 21 25

NL WILD-CARD STANDINGS	Team	W	L	Pct	WCGB
	Chicago Cubs	75	56	.573	+4
	Philadelphia	73	58	.557	+2
	San Diego	71	60	.542	—
	Arizona	69	62	.527	-2
	Cleveland	65	66	.496	-4
	Texas	64	68	.485	-½
	Baltimore	63	68	.481	-2
	Minnesota	63	68	.481	-2
	Seattle	62	69	.473	-3
	Detroit	61	69	.469	-3½

AL WILD-CARD STANDINGS	Team	W	L	Pct	WCGB
	N.Y. Yankees	74	56	.569	+9½
	Boston	71	59	.546	+6½
	Cleveland	65	66	.496	-4
	Texas	64	68	.485	-½
	Toronto	64	68	.485	-½
	Baltimore	63	68	.481	-2
	Minnesota	63	68	.481	-2
	Seattle	62	69	.473	-3
	Detroit	61	69	.469	-3½

NL leaders

Entering Monday's games.

BATTING	Arraez, Phi.....	322
	Gonzales, Pit.....	307
	Morero, Ari.....	306
	Lopez, Mia.....	306
HOME RUNS	Schwarber, Phi.....	39
	Olson, Atl.....	36
	Gomodo, Col.....	34
ERA	Misiorowski, Mil.....	1.68
	Sale, Atl.....	1.20
	Sánchez, Phi.....	1.94
	Skenes, Pit.....	1.71

Entering Monday's games.

BATTING	Alvarez, Hou.....	320
	Simmons, TB.....	310
	Diaz, TB.....	306
HOME RUNS	Alvarez, Hou.....	36
	Camrino, TB.....	35
	Rico, NY.....	34
	Alonso, Bal.....	30
ERA	Schlittler, NY.....	2.17
	Gease, Tor.....	2.37
	Messick, Cle.....	2.14
STRIKEOUTS	Williams, Cle.....	209
	Schlittler, NY.....	193
	Detmers, LA.....	172

Athletics 7, Astros 6

Max Muncy hit a go-ahead solo homer in the seventh inning, and the Athletics rallied from a six-run deficit to beat Houston.

ATHLETICS	AB	R	H	BB	SO	AVG
Bolte cf.....	5	1	3	0	0	.2270
Cortez lf.....	5	0	1	0	0	.261
Gelof 3b.....	4	1	0	0	0	.258
Butler rf.....	4	1	1	1	0	.262
White 1b.....	5	1	1	0	0	.260
Muncy dh.....	3	1	1	0	1	.215
Walton 2b.....	3	1	1	0	0	.284
Hernaz ss.....	2	1	0	0	2	.233
Serven c.....	4	2	3	0	0	.233
TOTALS	36	7	10	7	316	—

ASTROS	AB	R	H	BB	SO	AVG
Peña ss.....	5	2	2	0	0	.284
Alvarez dh.....	2	1	1	0	0	.320
Paredes 3b.....	3	1	1	0	0	.260
Altuve 2b.....	4	1	1	1	2	.245
Vasro cf.....	5	0	1	0	0	.1231
Walker 1b.....	5	0	1	0	0	.1233
Wade lf.....	4	0	0	0	0	.1213
Smith rf.....	3	1	0	0	1	.121
Trammell ph-rr.....	1	0	0	0	0	.214
Vázquez c.....	3	0	0	0	0	.1217
Diaz ph-c.....	1	0	0	0	0	.1253
TOTALS	35	6	6	6	10	—

ATHLETICS.....000 060 100 — 7 10 1
HOUSTON.....310 200 000 — 6 8 0

E: Fairbanks (5), LOB: Athletics 7, Houston 9. 2B: Butler (14), Bolte (11), Peña (15). HR: Serven (4), off Javier Muncy (7), off Okerk; Altuve (14), off Basso; Paredes (17), off Perkins.

ATHLETICS IP H R ER BB SO IPERA
Basso.....1 4 3 3 0 0 4.88
Perkins.....5 3 1 1 5 6.68
Blewett.....1 0 0 0 0 0 0.45
Medina.....1 1 0 0 1 2.370
Harris.....1 0 0 0 0 0 2.65

ASTROS IP H R ER BB SO IPERA
Javier.....4 4 3 3 2 8.647
De Los Santos.....½ 3 3 3 0 14.50
Teng.....1½ 1 0 0 4 12.44
Okerk.....1 1 1 1 0 12.09
Blubaugh.....1 1 0 0 1 0.325
Hader.....1 1 0 0 0 0 2.084

WP: Perkins (3-9); LP: Okerk (6-2); St. Harris (13). Inherited runners-scored: Teng 1-0. IBB: off Perkins (Alvarez), off Perkins (Alvarez), off Medina (Alvarez).

HBP: De Los Santos (Gelo), Teng (Walton). WP: Perkins, Teng. ABS Challenge: Perkins (Ball-Overtaken to Strike) Pitch timer violations: Perkins (pitcher) T: 3:15, A: 30,708 (41,000).

Phillies 6, Cardinals 4

Kyle Schwarber's 39th homer of the season was a two-run shot with two out in the bottom of the ninth inning as Philadelphia rallied from a four-run deficit and beat St. Louis.

The win was the Phillies' ninth straight and gave Philadelphia its third consecutive series sweep.

CARDINALS	AB	R	H	BB	SO	AVG
Wetherholt ss.....	5	1	2	1	0	.244
Herrera dh.....	3	0	1	0	1	.1242
Walker lf.....	4	1	0	1	0	.1289
Ramirez 1b.....	4	0	2	0	0	.1291
Báez lf.....	4	0	1	0	0	.1239
Church cf.....	0	0	0	0	0	.239
Jordan 2b.....	4	0	1	0	0	.243
Fernin cf-rr.....	4	1	1	0	0	.1247
Urrías 3b.....	4	0	1	0	0	.164
Pagés c.....	4	0	1	0	0	.1214
TOTALS	36	4	10	4	19	—

PHILLIES	AB	R	H	BB	SO	AVG
Schwarber 1b.....	5	0	0	0	0	.1245
Trisham cf.....	0	0	0	0	0	.245
Harper dh.....	3	1	2	0	1	.1260
Stott 2b.....	3	0	0	0	0	.259
Arraez 2b.....	1	0	0	0	0	.322
Marsh lf.....	0	1	1	0	0	.277
Realuto c.....	4	1	1	0	0	.224
Crawford cf.....	3	1	0	1	0	.269
Sosa 3b.....	4	1	2	3	0	.1261
De La Cruz rf.....	2	1	0	0	0	.259
TOTALS	34	6	6	3	5	—

ST. LOUIS.....000 110 100 — 4 10 0
PHILA.....000 006 006 — 6 9 0

Two outs when winning run scored.
LOB: St. Louis 6, Philadelphia 5. 2B: De La Cruz (2), Harper (25), Sosa (5). HR: Fernin (6), off Sánchez; Schwarber (39), off O'Brien.

CARDINALS IP H R ER BB SO IPERA
Leahy.....4 2 0 0 2 4.313
Gastelum.....1 1 0 0 0 15.40
Bruihl.....1 1 0 0 0 0.334
Staneck.....1 0 0 0 0 0.459
Soriano.....0 0 0 0 0 0.255
O'Brien.....½ 6 6 1 0 3.93

PHILLIES IP H R ER BB SO IPERA
Sánchez.....6½ 9 4 4 0 7.62
Mayza.....1½ 1 0 0 1 13.39
McFarlane.....1 0 0 0 0 0 1.142

WP: McFarlane (3-1); LP: O'Brien (3-5). Inherited runners-scored: Mayza 2-0. ABS Challenge: Schwarber (Strike) T: 2:41, A: 42,610 (42,901).

Guardians 7, Rockies 2

Chase DeLauter had two triples and drove in two runs, Jo Adell had two RBI, and Cleveland rolled past Colorado to finish a sweep.

The win was the fourth in a row and sixth in the past eight games for the Guardians.

GUARDIANS	AB	R	H	BB	SO	AVG
Kwan cf-rr.....	5	2	2	0	0	.1264
DeLauter dh.....	4	3	2	1	0	.288
Adell rf.....	5	2	2	0	0	.124
Halpin cf.....	0	0	0	0	0	.212
Lowe 1b.....	5	1	1	0	0	.265
Genao 3b.....	5	0	0	0	0	.288
Urrías 2b.....	4	0	0	0	0	.240
Martínez lf-rr.....	3	1	2	1	0	.1245
Hedges c.....	4	0	2	0	0	.271
Rocchio ss.....	3	1	0	1	0	.249
TOTALS	37	12	7	3	5	—

ROCKIES	AB	R	H	BB	SO	AVG
McCarthy lf.....	3	0	1	0	0	.294
Carriag cf.....	4	0	0	0	0	.1273
Castro 3b.....	4	1	0	0	0	.1264
Moniak dh.....	4	0	0	0	0	.260
Norby 1b-2b.....	3	1	1	0	0	.1216
Beck rf.....	2	1	1	0	0	.1195
Johnson ph-rr.....	2	1	0	0	0	.1284
Sullivan c.....	4	0	1	0	0	.233
Ritter 2b.....	2	0	0	1	0	.111
Rumfield ph-1b.....	2	0	0	0	0	.1287
Tovar ss.....	3	0	1	0	1	.205
TOTALS	33	2	7	2	9	—

CLEVELAND.....320 100 00 — 7 12 0
COLORADO.....020 000 00 — 2 7 0
LOB: Cleveland 7, Colorado 7. 2B: Adell (21), Sullivan (12), Castro (19), Johnson (27). 3B: DeLauter 2 (3).

GUARDIANS IP H R ER BB SO IPERA
Griffin.....5 2 2 3 4.319
Yoho.....1½ 2 0 0 0 14.45
Herrin.....1 0 0 0 0 0 1.288
Allen.....1 0 0 0 0 0 0.1289

ROCKIES IP H R ER BB SO IPERA
Sugano.....3 9 5 5 1 24.96
Manfredi.....1 2 1 1 0 23.00
Hergert.....2

BASEBALL



Shane Baz pitched well against the Rays, but Baltimore's offense couldn't score until the ninth inning.

O's offense fails Baz again in loss

RAYS 3, ORIOLES 1

BY JAKE KAUDERER

BALTIMORE — As soon as Shane Baz wasn't dominant, everything unraveled for the Orioles on Sunday.

The right-handed starter cruised through five scoreless innings, but he received zero run support, continuing a season-long trend. The Tampa Bay Rays eventually capitalized. They scored three runs in the sixth inning, which proved to be the difference in Baltimore's 3-1 loss to Tampa Bay.

It marked the second time in a week that the Orioles (63-68) dropped the series finale against the American League-best Rays with a chance to sweep them. The defeat moved Baltimore to 1½ games out of the final AL wild-card spot. It also gave Baz his MLB-high 14th loss this season after he went 5½ innings with three strikeouts.

"He's been great all year. That's

something that doesn't reflect how good he's been," center fielder Colton Cowser said. "We just need to put up more runs whenever he's pitching. He's always keeping us in it."

Baz looked primed to notch his 12th quality start this season after retiring the first two hitters in the sixth inning. But he surrendered consecutive singles, and a wild pitch allowed Rays first baseman Jonathan Aranda to score. All-star Junior Caminero then drilled a single off Baz, and catcher Liam Hicks drew a walk.

Southpaw Grant Wolfram relieved Baz after 96 pitches. He allowed an RBI single by Chandler Simpson, creating what felt like an insurmountable deficit for a lifeless Baltimore offense.

The Orioles eventually broke through in the ninth against closer Bryan Baker, when Cowser led off the frame with his 12th home run this season. Leody Taveras reached on an error by Caminero to put the tying run on base, but the top of Baltimore's order didn't make any further noise, and Baker, a former Oriole, secured his MLB-high 37th save.

"It was a good series here. Tough one today," Manager Craig Albarnaz said. "Took a series against a really good team."

The Orioles mustered a season-low two hits, continuing their struggles throughout August. Baltimore entered Sunday posting just 3.75 runs in 20 games this month. The club hadn't averaged below 4.40 runs per game in any month this season aside from March, in which the team played only five games.

There has been one constant with the offense: It struggles when Baz is on the mound.

He entered Sunday receiving just 3.12 runs of support per game, the third-lowest mark in MLB. Kyle Bradish is the Orioles' starter with the next-lowest run support, but he gets a more respectable 4.53 runs per game. Baz has been given one or zero runs of support in five of his last six games.

— Baltimore Sun

Nationals hit rock bottom, getting swept by the Marlins to cap a 1-8 road swing

NATIONALS FROM C1

Kent to be their stopper Sunday. For the third time in his three major league starts, Kent struggled with command, and the Marlins extended at-bats to quickly get the left-hander's pitch count up.

Kent needed 27 pitches to make it through the first inning. He walked Agustín Ramírez on 11 pitches, and Heriberto Hernández lined an 0-2 double to give the Marlins a 1-0 lead.

Kent kept the Marlins off the board over the next three innings, thanks in part to a spectacular play by Young. With one out in the third, the center fielder scaled the outfield wall to rob Hernández of another extra-base hit, then fired it to José Tena, who relayed to Andrés Chaparro to double up Otto Lopez.

"Everything's happening so fast out there, it's mostly just instinctual," Young told reporters. "What you practice your whole life kind of takes over and you go try to catch everything."

In the fourth inning, Daylen Lile got the first hit of the day for the Nationals, hitting a line drive that bounced through the chain-link fence in right field. It was deemed a ground-rule double, and Dylan Crews followed two batters later with a double of his own to tie the game.

Washington had a chance in the fifth to take control, loading the bases with two outs after Chaparro and Young were hit by pitches and Lile walked. But Abimelec Ortiz went fishing on a Michael Petersen slider to end the threat.

Kent entered the fifth at 73 pitches. He struck out Griffin Conine and Brian Navarreto, but a Lopez walk and a Ramírez single ended his day after 4½ innings, the longest outing of the 23-year-old's young career.

"I thought it was better," Manager Blake Butera told reporters of Kent's start. "Wanted to get him through the fifth there, he had two outs to start the inning, those next two guys got on him."

Trevor Williams took over and immediately walked Hernández



Trevor Williams entered in relief with two outs in the fifth inning and gave up a two-run single, putting the Marlins ahead to stay.

to load the bases. He then fell behind Xavier Edwards 3-1 and hung a four-seamer, which Edwards lined to left field, scoring Lopez and Ramírez as Lile's throw skidded in too late.

The Nationals got one back in the sixth on an RBI double from Jorbit Vivas. The Marlins, though, took control right back. They scored two more runs in the bottom of the inning off a double from Joe Mack and a sacrifice fly from Lopez, and one more in the eighth inning as the Nationals' infield failed to turn a double play.

Washington had one last chance in the ninth inning after Chaparro and Nuñez reached base to begin the inning. But Young, Lile and Ortiz went down in quick succession, and the Nationals ended the game 1 for 11 with runners in scoring position.

"I don't want to say it was a lack of effort or anything like that. We just couldn't get the big hit," Butera told reporters.

NATIONALS ON DECK		
vs. Colorado Rockies		
Monday	6:45	Nationals.TV
Tuesday	6:45	Nationals.TV
Wednesday	6:45	Nationals.TV
Thursday	1:05	Nationals.TV
vs. Miami Marlins		
Friday	6:45	WTTG (Ch. 5), Nationals.TV
Saturday	4:05	Nationals.TV
Sunday	12:15	NBCSN/Peacock
Aug. 31	6:45	Fox Sports 1, Nationals.TV
vs. Atlanta Braves		
Sept. 1	6:45	Nationals.TV
Sept. 2	1:05	Nationals.TV
Radio: WJFK (106.7 FM), WDCN (87.7 FM)		



Daylen Lile got the Nationals on the board in the fourth inning after reaching on a ground-rule double.

He's in NYC, but D.C. has big place in García's heart

GARCÍA JR. FROM C1

Ahead of Monday night's game against the Colorado Rockies, the Nationals had gone 6-13 since the trade deadline and fallen to 10 games under .500.

The trades brought much-needed pitching depth to help the team in the future. But they also put a dent in a promising season and separated a closely bonded clubhouse.

On Aug. 2, Washington was wrapping up a four-game series at Truist Park against the Atlanta Braves. García was held out of the lineup as the Nationals neared a deal with the Yankees. He waited all game for the news, but the trade wasn't finalized until an hour afterward, when he and the team were already on their way to Philadelphia.

On the plane, García and his teammates were emotional as they enjoyed one last journey together. When the plane landed, the players formed a hug line and one-by-one made their way to García to say goodbye.

"Seeing everybody sad, some

people cried — it was uncomfortable for me," García said Wednesday.

The Nationals were the only organization he ever knew. He signed as an international free agent in 2016, debuted for the team in 2020 and, after a career-best first half this year, became one of the clubhouse leaders.

He grew up with the Nationals. The first few days with the Yankees, he said, were hard. He was sad to move on without his friends. But the trade, he reminded himself, was also an opportunity. Not only will he probably go to the playoffs for the first time in his career — the Yankees hold the top American League wild card spot — he also gets to play in front of his family.

García was born in the Bronx and still has relatives, including his mother and father, who reside there. He estimates he has close to 25 family members in the area, and they come watch him play almost every night.

"It's really good," García said. "When I have a day off, I can go be with my family, so it's really



"They try to make me feel good, feel at home," Luis García Jr. said of his new Yankees teammates.

different."

And while he misses his old teammates, his new ones have been welcoming.

"Everybody here has been very good to me," García said. "They try to make me feel good, feel at home. It's going well so far."

He was hitting .242 with six extra-base hits, including three home runs, and a .740 OPS for the Yankees after Sunday's win over the Toronto Blue Jays. It's not quite up to the level he was hitting in the first half of the season, when he had a .873 OPS, but he understands there's an adjustment period to being on a new team.

While García's still getting acquainted with the Yankees, he's keeping an eye on the Nationals. He still talks on the phone to his old teammates — Nasim Nuñez calls him every day, he said — and keeps up with their games and news. He thinks CJ Abrams moving to second will be a good move for him, he said.

"I watch the highlights, always," García said.

Although he's not a part of the team anymore, he still thinks, just like he said after that game at the end of June, that the Nationals are on track to achieve something special soon — even if he will have to watch it happen from the outside.

SCOREBOARD

PRO FOOTBALL

NFL preseason

THURSDAY, AUG. 6
HALL OF FAME GAME — IN CANTON, OHIO
 Carolina 33, Arizona 30

WEEK 1

THURSDAY, AUG. 13

at Cincinnati 16, Detroit 14
 at Pittsburgh 28, Green Bay 9
 Indianapolis 13, at New England 13
 L.A. Chargers 27, at Houston 7
 Arizona 27, at Las Vegas 14
 Tennessee 19, at San Francisco 13

FRIDAY, AUG. 14

at Washington 20, Miami 7
 Tampa Bay 24, at N.Y. Jets 16
 Denver 27, at Atlanta 7

SATURDAY, AUG. 15

at Baltimore 24, Philadelphia 7
 Minnesota 13, at N.Y. Giants 10
 at Buffalo 29, Carolina 14
 at Chicago 34, Cleveland 10
 Jacksonville 24, at New Orleans 20
 L.A. Rams 20, at Kansas City 12
 Dallas 17, at Seattle 7

WEEK 2

THURSDAY'S RESULTS

Las Vegas 22, at Houston 20

San Francisco 41, at L.A. Chargers 17

FRIDAY'S RESULTS

N.Y. Jets 17, at Pittsburgh 0

Carolina 34, at Jacksonville 17

SATURDAY'S RESULTS

at Detroit 17, Washington 13

Baltimore 13, at Minnesota 3

Buffalo 31, at Cleveland 7

Atlanta 34, at Indianapolis 6

N.Y. Giants 26, at Miami 3

at L.A. Rams 34, New Orleans 0

at Cincinnati 27, Chicago 9

at New England 24, Philadelphia 21

at Tampa Bay 16, Kansas City 15

Dallas 34, at Arizona 13

SUNDAY'S RESULT

Seattle at Tennessee, late

WEEK 3

THURSDAY'S GAMES

Pittsburgh at Buffalo, 7
 New England at Cleveland, 8
 San Francisco at Las Vegas, 8
 L.A. Rams at L.A. Chargers, 10

FRIDAY'S GAMES

Washington at Baltimore, 6
 Atlanta at Miami, 7
 Houston at Carolina, 7
 N.Y. Giants at N.Y. Jets, 7:30

Tampa Bay at Jacksonville, 7:30

Cincinnati at Philadelphia, 8

Seattle at Kansas City, 8

New Orleans at Dallas, 8

Arizona at Green Bay, 8

Minnesota at Denver, 8

SATURDAY'S GAMES

Detroit at Indianapolis, 6
 Chicago at Tennessee, 6

Buccaneers 16, Chiefs 15

Late Saturday

KANSAS CITY.....0 9 6 0 -15
 TAMPA BAY.....0 0 7 9 -16

SECOND QUARTER

Kansas City: FG Butker 45, 10:18.
 Kansas City: FG Butker 58, 1:41.
 Kansas City: FG Butker 69, :00.

THIRD QUARTER

Tampa Bay: Kieft 2 pass from Daniels (Potter kick), 6:50.
 Kansas City: Johnson 1 run (kick failed), 2:26.

FOURTH QUARTER

Tampa Bay: FG Butker 66, 14:05.
 Tampa Bay: Tucker 1 run (pass failed), 10:05.
 Attendance: 61,480.

PASSING

First Downs.....KC TB
 Total Net Yards.....234 242
 Rushes-Yards.....22-104 25-99
 Passing.....130 143
 Turnovers.....3-10 2-24
 Kickoff Returns.....3-72 3-67
 Comp.-Att.-Int.....23-35-1 19-29-0
 Sacked-Yards Lost.....2-23 3-22
 Punts.....4-46-0 5-47-0
 Fumbles-Lost.....2-0 2-0
 Penalties-Yards.....6-57 7-79
 Time Of Possession.....:31:51 28:09

MISSED FIELD GOALS

Kansas City: Nussmeier 9-17-7-4, Fields 9-12-0-64, Oladokun 5-6-1-15.
 Tampa Bay: Browning 8-11-0-84, Daniels 9-14-0-71, Mayfield 2-4-0-10.

RUSHING

Kansas City: B. Smith 6-37, Johnson 7-25, Demercado 5-18, Fields 1-15, Oladokun 1-5, Walker 2-4.
 Tampa Bay: Tucker 2-23, Daniels 7-19, Browning 2-14, Irving 3-14, Kpeneu 4-13, J. Williams 2-9, Rivers 1-7, Gainwell 1-7.

RECEIVING

Kansas City: Royals 6-51, Brinningsot 3-28, Allen 3-7, Wiley 2-15, Brawley 2-9, B. Smith 2-2, Armstrong 1-14, Johnson 1-10, Demercado 1-6, Thornton 1-5, De Jesus 1-4.
 Tampa Bay: Patterson 6-56, K. Johnson 4-56, J. Williams 2-24, Sharp 2-13, Kieft 2-4, Greene 1-8, Rivers 1-5, Silis 1-minus 1-1.

MISSED FIELD GOALS

Kansas City: Butker 43.

Cowboys 34, Cardinals 13

Late Saturday

DALLAS.....14 10 3 7 -34
 ARIZONA.....0 6 3 0 -13

FIRST QUARTER

Dallas: Davis 8 pass from Milton (Aubrey kick), 6:33.
 Dallas: Mingo 93 pass from Milton (Aubrey kick), 3:43.

SECOND QUARTER

Arizona: FG Ryland 38, 13:11.
 Dallas: Milton 1 run (Aubrey kick), 11:14.
 Dallas: FG Ryland 31, 3:37.
 Dallas: FG Aubrey 50, :36.

THIRD QUARTER

Arizona: Kiner 1 run (Ryland kick), 8:47.
 Dallas: FG Aubrey 29, 1:55.

FOURTH QUARTER

Dallas: Mahaf 15 run (Aubrey kick), 2:05.
 Attendance: 62,674.

PASSING

First Downs.....DAL ARI
 Total Net Yards.....413 325
 Rushes-Yards.....34-175 26-135
 Passing.....248 190
 Turnovers.....0-0 0-0
 Kickoff Returns.....4-97 6-160
 Intceptions Ret.....1-22 1-22
 Comp.-Att.-Int.....16-23-1 21-30-1
 Sacked-Yards Lost.....1-6 2-17
 Punts.....0-0 2-41.5
 Fumbles-Lost.....1-0 0-0
 Penalties-Yards.....4-20 8-63
 Time Of Possession.....29:17 30:43

RECEIVING

Dallas: Milton 9-13-0-179, Howell 7-10-1-65.
 Arizona: Minshew 19-23-1-177, Slovis 2-7-0-30.

RUSHING

Dallas: Blue 15-75, Abanikanda 8-39, Davis 5-29, Mahaf 1-15, A. Smith 1-8, Howell 1-7, Milton 3-2.
 Arizona: Hull 11-51, Stewart 2-40, Kiner 10-29, Slovis 1-11, Minshew 2-4.

RECEIVING

Dallas: Kuntz 3-36, Brown 2-77, Mingo 2-62, A. Smith 2-18, J. Kuntz 2-3, Schoonmaker 1-19, Valdes-Scantling 1-14, Davis 1-8, Hudson 1-8, Mims 1-minus 1-1.
 Arizona: Fairweather 5-39, Smith-Marsette 3-16, Fe-bolo 2-42, Virgil 2-26, Bowman 2-23, Brooks 2-14, Hull 2-14, Green 1-18, Quitoriano 1-9, Kiner 1-6.

MISSED FIELD GOALS

Arizona: Ryland 62.

TRANSACTIONS

NFL

Cleveland Browns: Signed DE Derek Barnett to a one-year contract. Placed DE Alex Wright on injured reserve.

Los Angeles Chargers: Placed C Tyrion Bledsoe on injured reserve.

San Francisco 49ers: Signed WR Mario Williams with an injury settlement.

San Francisco 49ers: Re-signed TE Khalil Dinkins to a one-year contract. Reinstated TE George Kittle from the active/physically unable to perform list.

Houston Texans: Signed WRs Jay Johnson and Sterling Shepard. Placed LB K.C. Osaal on injured reserve.

Vegas Raiders: Placed CB Chigizhe Anusiem on injured reserve.

Seattle Seahawks: Placed WR Jake Bobo on injured reserve. Signed WR Julian Hicks.

MLS

LA Galaxy: Signed M Brett Phan and D Mason Vanney to short-term agreements.

PRO BASKETBALL

WNBA

EAST	W	L	Pct	GB
y-Minnesota.....	24	13	.649	—
y-Indiana.....	25	14	.641	—
y-New York.....	23	15	.605	1½
y-Washington.....	22	15	.595	2
Chicago.....	15	23	.395	9½
Toronto.....	11	26	.297	13
Connecticut.....	9	27	.250	14½

WEST	W	L	Pct	GB
y-Minnesota.....	31	7	.816	—
y-Minnesota.....	25	11	.694	5
y-Las Vegas.....	26	13	.667	5½
Dallas.....	22	16	.579	9
Portland.....	15	22	.405	15½
Los Angeles.....	13	24	.351	17½
Phoenix.....	13	24	.351	17½
Seattle.....	7	31	.184	24

y-Clinched playoff spot

FRIDAY'S RESULTS

Minnesota 94, at Washington 84
 at Chicago 73, Portland 70
 Toronto 82, Golden State 79 in Vancouver, British Columbia

SATURDAY'S RESULTS

at New York 109, Indiana 102
 at Los Angeles 77, Connecticut 68
 Atlanta 99, at Phoenix 89

SUNDAY'S RESULTS

Washington 105, at Portland 100
 at Dallas 92, Seattle 70
 Indiana 113, at Chicago 90
 Las Vegas 88, Toronto 78 in Vancouver, British Columbia

MONDAY'S GAMES

Golden State at Minnesota, 8
 Atlanta at Los Angeles, 10
 at Detroit 17, Washington 13
 at Cincinnati 27, Chicago 9
 at New England 24, Philadelphia 21
 at Tampa Bay 16, Kansas City 15
 Dallas 34, at Arizona 13

TUESDAY'S GAMES

Washington at Phoenix, 10
 at Chicago Connecticut, 7
 Portland at Dallas, 8

WEDNESDAY'S GAMES

Golden State at Connecticut, 7
 Toronto at Seattle, 10

THURSDAY'S GAMES

Washington at Phoenix, 10
 Golden State at New York, 8

FRIDAY'S GAMES

Washington at Los Angeles, 10
 Portland at Atlanta, 7:30
 Connecticut at Indiana, 7:30
 Toronto at Las Vegas, 10

SATURDAY'S GAMES

Chicago at New York, 1
 Toronto at Phoenix, 10
 Arizona at Green Bay, 8
 Minnesota at Denver, 8

SUNDAY'S GAMES

Minnesota at Atlanta, 3
 Los Angeles at Seattle, 5
 Golden State at Portland, 7
 Connecticut at Dallas, 8

MYSTICS' NEXT THREE

at Phoenix Mercury

Tuesday 10 Monumental

at Phoenix Mercury

Thursday 10 Prime Video

at Los Angeles Sparks

Friday 10 Ion

Radio: WTEM (980 AM)

Mystics 105, Fire 100

Washington	MIN	FG	FT	O-T	A	P	PTS
Portland	28	19	28	21	30	—	105
MIN	23	26	21	30	—	—	100

WASHINGTON	MIN	FG	FT	O-T	A	P	PTS
Irafiere	30:06	7-11	4-7	5-10	2	4	18
Onyenwere	23:44	2-6	2-2	0-1	3	0	8
Austin	32:46	11-18	9-13	3-10	0	1	31
Amoree	23:43	4-6	2-2	1-3	2	13	13
Citron	32:36	4-5	6-8	0-3	6	2	14
McMahon	17:56	2-4	5-7	0-2	4	1	13
Betts	16:57	2-4	0-8	2	1	13	2
Laney-Hamilton	14:37	0-4	3-4	0-1	4	1	3
Florez	7:24	0-1	0-0	0-0	0	1	0
Dugalic	0:07	0-1	0-4	0-0	4	2	0
Prosper	0:04	0-0	0-0	0-0	0	0	0

TOTALS	200	36-61	34-42	9-38	22	13	105
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Percentages: FG .541, FT .727, 3-Point Goals 7-14, 50% (Amoree 5-4, McMahon 2-4, Onyenwere 2-4, Dugalic 0-1, Laney-Hamilton 0-1, Team Rebounds: 10, Team Turnovers: 4, Blocked Shots: 6 (Betts 3, Austin 2, Florez), Turnovers: 13 (Austin 3, Irafiere 3, Amoree 2, Citron 2, Laney-Hamilton 2, Onyenwere), Steals: 6 (Laney-Hamilton 2, Austin, Betts, Citron, Irafiere), Technical Fouls: None.

PORTLAND	MIN	FG	FT	O-T	A	P	PTS
Engstler	29:29	9-13	0-0	0-6	2	5	23
Puoch	17:36	0-1	0-0	1-3	0	5	0
Dileo	27:07	2-7	0-0	0-0	4	2	4
Carleton	36:07	8-14	0-0	1-4	5	18	18
Leite	29:54	8-20	9-9	1-11	2	27	27
Samuelson	14:20	0-4	0-0	0-1	0	1	0
Dolson	12:53	1-4	0-0	2-3	1	3	2
Winterburn	11:57	1-3	0-0	0-2	0	1	2
Buhner	10:31	1-4	0-0	0-0	0	1	3
Harrison	10:06	1-3	2-2	1-2	1	2	4

TOTALS	200	36-74	15-15	7-25	21	38	100
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Percentages: FG .486, FT 1.000, 3-Point Goals 13-28, .464 (Engstler 5-7, Dileo 3-4, Leite 2-5, Carleton 2-7, Buhner 1-2, Samuelson 0-2), Team Rebounds: 5, Team Turnovers: 1, Blocked Shots: 0 (Dileo, Engstler), Turnovers: 12 (Engstler 4, Harrison 2, Puoch 2, Buhner, Carleton, Leite, Williams), Steals: 9 (Carleton 5, Leite 2, Engstler, Harrison), Technical Fouls: None.

At 14,860 (19,393).

Wings 92, Storm 70

SEATTLE	17	18	22	12	—	70
DALLAS	34	22	17	19	—	92

SEATTLE: Fam 0-50-0, Malonga 4-10-4-12, Magbego 0-4-2-2, Johnson 9-19-0-23, Melbourne 3-7-0-6, Holmes 0-1-0-0, Horston 2-3-0-4, Thierry 0-1-0-0, Dolson 0-1-0-0, Cooke 1-4-2-5, Mair 2-6-0-6, Samuelson 1-6-0-3, Totals 25-74-8-9-70.

DALLAS: Kuler 3-2-2-9, Shepard 5-11-1-11, Smith 3-3-3-9, Buckers 12-16-2-32, Ogunbunale 2-7-1-2, Clark 0-2-0-0, Siegrist 4-8-1-19, Yueru 1-3-3-6, Sims 0-2-0-0, Sutton 3-6-2-2-9, Totals 33-66-15-17-92.

Three-Point Goals: Seattle 12-39 (Johnson 6-15, Melbourne 3-7, Mair 2-4, Cooke 1-2, Samuelson 1-4, Dolson 0-1, Holmes 0-1, Horston 0-1, Magbego 1-1, Thierry 0-1, Fam 0-3, Malonga 0-3, Dallas 11-23 (Buckers 6-6, Ogunbunale 2-5, Sutton 1-2, Yueru 1-2, Kuler 1-4, Clark 0-1, Sims 0-1, Siegrist 0-2), Fouled Out: None, Rebounds: Seattle 24 (Fam, Johnson 6), Dallas 40 (Shepard 11), Assists: Seattle 12 (Cooke, Magbego 3), Dallas 23 (Ogunbunale 6), Total Fouls: Seattle 17, Dallas 11, At 6,251 (7,800).

Aces 88, Tempo 78

A: 14,860 (19,393).

LAS VEGAS: Tablot 4-5-0-9, Wilson 10-15-6-22, Smith 4-4-0-2-8, Gray 4-9-1-19, Young 9-18-2-21, Bell 0-0-0-0, Parker 1-5-0-6, Coulibaly 5-5-2-12, Shelton 3-5-0-6, Latson 3-1-1-2, Loyd 0-3-2-2, Yamamoto 3-7-1-19, Totals 34-65-15-20-88.

TORONTO: Fagbenle 5-8-2-2-13, Juskaite 4-7-1-11, Harrison 4-11-4-5-12, Allemard 1-3-0-3, Rice 4-14-0-14, Rankie 2-4-0-4, Key 1-6-0-2, Nurse 1-3-3-19, Totals 29-66-10-12-78.

Three-Point Goals: Las Vegas 5-20 (Yamamoto 2-5, Tablot 1-1, Wilson 1-2, Young 1-7, Gray 0-1, Loyd 0-2, Pissott 0-1), Toronto 1-2-2-2, (Nurse 4-10, Juskaite 2-4, Rice 2-5, Fagbenle 1-2, Allemard 1-3, Key 0-1, Harrison 0-2), Fouled Out: None, Rebounds: Las Vegas 29 (Smith 8), Toronto 28 (Harrison 7), Assists: Las Vegas 22 (Gray, Wilson 7), Toronto 22 (Rice 5), Total Fouls: Las Vegas 14, Toronto 22, At 15,877 (18,890).

Three-Point Goals: Indiana 18-33 (Clark 8-12, Mitchell 6-9, Hall 2-3, Hall 1-1

IndyCars roar through Washington's streets for Freedom 250 Grand Prix

BY LES CARPENTER,
LIAM BOWMAN,
CLEVE R. WOOTSON JR.
AND BEN CONARCK

With D.C. streets in front of the U.S. Capitol transformed into a racetrack, drivers on Sunday bolted past the National Gallery of Art, the National Archives and other landmarks in the Freedom 250 Grand Prix, the first IndyCar street race ever in the nation's capital.

President Donald Trump waved the green flag to start the competition at around 1 p.m.

Then the rubber met the road. For nearly three hours, cars swarmed by in a brightly colored blur that shook the pavement and filled the air with exhaust fumes.

The downtown racetrack spanned 1.66 miles and had seven turns, including two particularly challenging ones. Drivers took the straightaways along Pennsylvania and Independence avenues at speeds of around 160 mph. They circled the National Mall 147 times covering roughly 250 miles.

Around 4 p.m., Kyle Kirk-

KYLE KIRKWOOD WINS EVENT

Trump takes late-night lap in presidential limousine

wood, a 27-year-old Floridian, emerged as the winner. He told reporters that he had woken up the morning of the event with his heart racing because he was so excited for it.

"Outside of the Indy 500, there's not another race that you want to win [as much]," he said.

The street race, which drew upward of 150,000 spectators,

was the culmination of events this summer launched by Trump to mark America's 250th birthday.

Earlier festivities included an Ultimate Fighting Championship event on the White House South Lawn in June and a Fourth of July pyrotechnic show, which made history with more than 840,000 fireworks

but was delayed when a lightning storm forced the crowd to disperse.

The weather for the Freedom 250 Grand Prix was far more favorable, with sunny skies and temperatures in the 80s.

Still, predictions of a perilous course proved prophetic. Thirty-seven laps into the event, American racer David Malukas crashed into a wall coming out of a turn and fellow American Sting Ray Robb ran into Malukas's disabled car. Safety workers quickly arrived on the scene, and neither driver appeared to

be injured.

Fans line up to buy jerseys, an IndyCar model and crab cakes

Thousands of spectators crowded into the National Mall, temporarily rebranded the Air National Guard Fan Zone.

Some sported IndyCar jerseys of their favorite teams. Others wore patriotic or America 250-themed attire. Long lines formed at concession tents with names like "Freedom Grill" and "Checked Faves," selling

SEE GRAND PRIX ON C9

Why D.C.'s brides are ditching uniformity



The look, the history, the sustainability factor — vintage gowns have a lot going for them, and more women are taking note

CAROLINE GUTMAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Catarina Martinez, left, talks to Erica Hewins, owner of With Loves Studios in Alexandria, while trying on a vintage dress during a recent bridal appointment.

BY KENDALL STATON

It can be easy to experience déjà vu browsing through the racks of a modern bridal store. The dresses — mostly made from white polyester fabric and cut into synonymous shapes — all start to look the same.

So, when it's time to find *the* dress, some brides are ditching modern uniformity in favor of vintage bridal gowns with lace, rosettes and other unique design elements that add depth and texture.

"With overcommercialization, everything

is the same and bleak, and there's not a lot of character — there's not a lot of flair to it," said 24-year-old bride-to-be Helena Chaves. "I love a good plain, simple, satin dress, but a lot of weddings look the same. When you get the vintage aspect, everything is very unique and characterful."

Chaves is one of a growing number of brides looking to old fashions for their wedding gowns. Pinterest's 2026 Wedding Trends Report shows searches of vintage motifs are spiking. Last year, there was a 1,090 percent increase in people looking at 1980 wedding

dresses compared with the year before.

People also looked for specific styles from previous eras, such as drop-waist wedding gowns, a style first popularized in the 1920s, which had a 1,405 percent increase in searches.

Flipping through a rack of curated dresses at a pop-up in downtown D.C., Chaves, who has lived in the District for seven years and is getting married next fall, said Big Business has made weddings sterile, but vintage gowns are evidence that "throughout the years, love

SEE GRAND PRIX ON C10

'Yea or Nay' game tests knowledge of congressional votes

BY KENDALL STATON

Policy consultant Pavan Venkatakrishnan has a new morning routine. Wake up. Check his phone. Test his knowledge on old congressional votes. Brush his teeth. Go to work on the Hill.

He's among the users of a new online game that's drawing in political junkies who can't seem — or don't want — to escape the throes of Congress, even in their personal time.

"Yea or Nay," which launched Aug. 10, offers players the daily chance to recall how five senators voted on three actions, such as landmark bills or presidential appointments.

How did New York Democrat Daniel Patrick Moynihan vote on a 1996 welfare reform bill? Nay. How did Arizona Republican John McCain vote on the confirmation of John Ashcroft, George

W. Bush's pick for attorney general? Yea.

Users earn up to 15 points and, depending on their scores, are grouped into factions such as "committee chair" or "master of the Senate."

"It's like catnip for the type of person who takes pride in remembering Byron Dorgan's vote record from 2008," Venkatakrishnan said, referencing the former lawmaker from North Dakota.

He said he has yet to score less than 13 out of 15.

Alex Goddard, the game's developer, said that, unsurprisingly, the program has found a large share of its players in the nation's capital. Goddard grew up surrounded by politics. His dad, Taegan Goddard, founded Political Wire, a prominent policy blog, in 1999.

The younger Goddard had made a handful of other games

before, but he said this one found its own form of virality on X in recent days as journalists and policy workers posted their scores. Players can't find "Yea or Nay" on an app store, just on the internet. Goddard said he has about 100 daily "Yea or Nay" puzzles prewritten.

"Republicans and Democrats didn't only use to vote together."

Alex Goddard, game's developer

Beyond being a fun way to test your wits, the game is also a reflection of today's political polarization and how bipartisan ship has slowly gone by the

wayside, Goddard said. On social media, some users shared their surprise at certain votes highlighted in the game, such as Rhode Island Republican Lincoln Chafee being the only GOP senator to cast a "nay" vote on the Iraq War in 2001.

"You can learn in some ways how much politics have changed," Goddard said. "Republicans and Democrats didn't only use to vote together. People voted across the aisle."

Venkatakrishnan, 20, said he found the game from an X post shared by Political Wire and almost immediately became hooked, calling the format "very Gen Z."

"This game was almost designed in a lab for me specifically, because I spend as much time as I do thinking about Congress as I do working with it," he said.

Benjamin Burroughs, an asso-

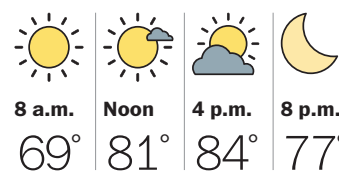
ciate professor of emerging media at the University of Nevada at Las Vegas, said "Yea or Nay" had a "Wordle"-esque "magic bullet" of going viral, connecting with a strong fan base and keeping players coming back daily with new puzzles.

Peter Sterne, a magazine editor in New York, praised the game for its level of detail in descriptions of the bills and each senator's bio. He called himself a political junkie but admitted with a laugh that he made a faux pas on one puzzle when he guessed that Joe Manchin III voted nay on a bill that bears his name. (He of course voted yea.)

Still, Sterne powered through his momentary lapse and has continued to play and learn from the game he can't put down.

"It's 'Wordle' for people who are fans of 'The West Wing,'" he said.

TODAY'S WEATHER



High today at approx. 4 p.m.: 84°

Precip: 5% Wind: W 6-12 mph

For weather news, go to C16

MARYLAND

Tens of thousands of Baltimore students are back in school Monday. **cs**

VIRGINIA

How a Richmond woman got the water utility to correct a \$10,000 bill. **cs**

OBITUARIES

Nancy Kassebaum Baker came from power but eschewed it herself. **c11**

MARYLAND

At National Book Festival, Artemis II astronaut reflects on historic voyage

BY JAKE KAUDERER
Baltimore Sun

Reid Wiseman had always wanted to venture as far away from Earth as possible. Not because he doesn't love the planet, but because all he's ever wanted to do is fly. It's safe to say he succeeded in that endeavor. In April, Wiseman was part of a four-person crew that led Artemis II, a 10-day mission around the moon. The Cockeysville native's team traveled farther into space than any humans in history. Wiseman reflected on the voyage while speaking at a panel at the National Book Festival in D.C. on Saturday. He described his expedition as one "with the three greatest human beings on this planet."

"The moon, it's not the destination. It's just the next step in exploring the solar system."

Reid Wiseman, commander of the Artemis II mission

"From the time we launched until the time we landed, we had tremendous grace, and we had limitless trust in each other," Wiseman said. "It was an honor." The Artemis II was NASA's first crewed lunar mission in more than half a century. The firsthand observations gathered of the lunar dark side will help the agency in its quest to establish a long-term presence on the moon, which could eventually lead to Mars. "The end goal of Artemis is a sustained lunar presence. The moon, it's not the destination. It's just the next step in exploring the solar system," he said. It wasn't always easy for Wise-



NASA/GETTY IMAGES

Reid Wiseman says he formed a unique bond with his crewmates, one of whom suggested naming a lunar crater after Wiseman's wife, Carol, who died of cancer in 2020.

man and his crew. At one point during training, political unrest arose. Issues with the spacecraft, which Wiseman said took two years to assemble after being designed over 10 years, also popped up. The problems created doubts about the mission — even from Wiseman, the crew's commander.

"At one point, I said, 'Let's just push this thing off a cliff,'" said the former Navy fighter pilot. But the team persevered. Wiseman didn't hesitate to credit his crewmates, calling them smarter and more experienced than him, and adding that "the world needs them." The group forged a unique

bond. One of Wiseman's crewmates even suggested honoring his wife, Carroll, who died of cancer in 2020, by naming a crater after her. "What an honor for my crew to have that much love for me and my family, that they would want to do this," Wiseman said. Wiseman said he constantly thought about his family while in

space. On the descent back to Earth, all he thought about was seeing his two daughters again. Wiseman said he wished he could've spent an hour talking about the 13-minute descent. At one point, the crew's spacecraft was going 39 times the speed of light, he said. Wiseman admitted he was scared. But that fear eventu-

ally turned to elation as he realized he would make it home. Being so far from Earth helped Wiseman recognize how beautiful it truly is. "Anybody on Earth lives in a really special place on this beautiful crown jewel of our solar system — possibly the entire universe," he said.

MARYLAND

Baltimore City Public Schools open Monday. Here's what to know.

BY RACQUEL BAZOS
Baltimore Sun

Baltimore City Public Schools open Monday, welcoming back tens of thousands of students under the leadership of new CEO Jermaine Dawson. Dawson took the reins from Sonja Brookins Santelises, who ran the district for a decade. Although Santelises presided over years of test score improvement, Baltimore continued to trail state test score averages and to struggle with chronic absenteeism. Starting July 1, Dawson began a district-wide listening tour that will run through October. So far, he has visited about 40 schools. By next June, he hopes to have been to every public school in Baltimore, he said Tuesday at the Board of School

Commissioners meeting. At the end of the first week of school, Dawson is scheduled to update the public on what he has learned, according to the district's website. "I do not take this job lightly. This is not a job for me; this is a calling to make sure that we impact the lives of young people," he said Tuesday. "I vow to work tirelessly to ensure that our students are truly career-ready, future-ready and world-ready." Heading into the new academic year, here are three things to know about City Schools.

Standardized tests The district's opening Monday comes as Maryland Comprehensive Assessment Program results show Baltimore continuing to lag behind most of the state. An English-language arts pro-

ficiency rate of 32.9 percent is the highest score City Schools have had since 2017, according to Theresa Jones, the district's chief achievement and accountability officer. In math, 13.3 percent of Baltimore students were proficient. Meanwhile, more than half of students statewide were proficient in English this year, with 27.1 percent meeting that standard across all math tests. That accountability measure is changing, however, as school systems across the state will take the first Maryland System of Testing Academic Readiness standardized tests in third through eighth grades this year. The Maryland State Department of Education says the new tests will be shorter, allow faster reporting of results and provide more accurate scores. Dawson said the district needs

to "be honest" about not closing the gap with the state and focus on proficiency, not growth. "Our new North Star in Baltimore City [Schools] is to meet and to exceed the state's target," Dawson said. "Basically what I'm saying ... is we need to get better, and we need to get better faster."

Teacher vacancies Emily Nielson, City Schools' chief of human capital, presented tentative data to the school commissioners Tuesday, showing about 100 vacancies anticipated for the first day. "We're still seeing a pretty significant fluctuation in vacancies," Nielson said. "We are working hard to fill those. Principals are still doing interviews. ... We're processing folks. So I anticipate that number will go down."

Final numbers on first-day staffing will be published next year, she said. Over the summer, the district hired 423 teachers — fewer than in previous years, Nielson said. That decrease is, in part, a "testament to our year-over-year improvements in teacher retention over the last several years," she said. Fewer new school-based positions in the budget meant fewer teachers moving into those other positions, leaving classes unaccounted for too, she said.

Dawson's goals Dawson set three focus areas for his inaugural year: reducing chronic absenteeism, making sure ninth-graders advance to 10th grade on time, and boosting the district's four-year graduation rate.

Dawson's vision for students is to move them toward what he calls the "four E's": enrollment in higher education or trade school, enlistment in the armed services, employment, or entrepreneurship. He said the district needs to set its sights beyond simply graduating students. Dawson said he asks himself what students will be doing three months after they turn their tassels. "If we can't effectively answer that question, then we have not done enough to make sure that we set our children up for success, because graduation is not the end. It's actually the beginning," he said. Dawson plans to visit 10 schools on Monday and might bring his sixth-grader along to his first stop at the City Schools bus depot, he said.

VIRGINIA

Richmond mom fights months-long battle over erroneous \$10K water bill

BY SAMUEL B. PARKER
Richmond Times-Dispatch

Virginia Rose is "pretty sure" she didn't use \$10,000 worth of water. "We're not running a crypto mining operation or data center here," Rose said of the Richmond home where she lives with her husband, son and soon-to-arrive twins, who are due any day now. The problem, Rose said, began this past winter, when the Roses' city utility bill started climbing. Since the family moved into their current home in 2024, Rose said the typical monthly bill has been in the ballpark of \$200. But in February, the family received a \$450 bill. The bill for the following month was \$550. Confused and concerned, Rose called the city's Department of Public Utilities to get an explanation. What followed was a months-long ordeal that Rose said was only resolved after the Richmond Times-Dispatch contacted City Hall to ask about the situation. A DPU representative told Rose that the issue had arisen because DPU had been estimat-

ing the family's water use rather than checking the meter to determine their actual consumption. Under city code, the department can rely on estimates rather than meter reads for up to three consecutive billing periods. "They said they would have somebody come out and actually look at our meter," Rose said, noting that the DPU representative urged her to "just pay the \$550" — or to just guess what she probably owed and pay that amount — and expect to receive an account credit if it was later determined that she'd overpaid. "You know, it's a lot of money," Rose said. "But we did end up paying, assuming that they would come out and fix it." Rose didn't hear back. When she received the family's April bill, she expected it to be for the typical \$200 monthly amount, and maybe even to reflect a credit on the account. Instead, the bill indicated that the Roses owed more than \$10,000. "I was like, 'Oh, my God! Well, they did do something,'" Rose said. So she called DPU again and

was told that department staffers had, in fact, visited her home and "fixed" her meter. But the representative struggled to explain the \$10,000 charge, acknowledging that it probably was not accurate and assuring her that the department would open a ticket and get back to her. And then, nothing.

"We're not running a crypto mining operation or data center here."
Virginia Rose, recipient of the inflated water bill

Rose kept calling but couldn't get answers over the phone. Eventually, she was told she'd be contacted by a supervisor within three days. But that never happened. All the while, the bill kept going up because of interest and penalties, until it reached nearly \$11,500. Rose said she was afraid DPU would shut off her water. "And at that point, I reached

out to you," Rose told the Times-Dispatch. On July 27, roughly five months after Rose received the first inflated bill, the Times-Dispatch contacted city officials to ask about the Roses' account. On Aug. 10 — eleven days after the Times-Dispatch's deadline — city spokeswoman Rhonda Johnson replied that DPU "does not discuss specific customer account information." "In instances where there may be a bill discrepancy, customers are encouraged to pay what their normal utility bill amount is as they follow the dispute/escalation process," Johnson said. Although Johnson would not answer questions about what had caused the \$10,000 utility bill, officials had started taking action behind the scenes. Rose said that within three days of the Times-Dispatch's inquiry, DPU staffers showed up at her home, cut up the bushes outside her house to dig up and access her underground water meter, and left blue spray paint everywhere. It was the first time the yard had been disturbed, she said, leaving her skeptical about

whether anyone from DPU had actually checked on her water meter the first time around, as officials claimed. "They had to make a mess to do this," she said. And then, at last, the verdict: A senior member of DPU's customer service department called Rose to inform her that she was off the hook for \$11,358.78 in charges, fees and interest. In fact, the staffer said, DPU owed the Roses \$430 for overcharges. Rose said she "didn't really get much clarity" on what had happened, beyond "something was wrong with your meter." So she asked: "What will my regular bill be? What should I expect to pay on a regular basis?" "We'll have to just see what the average is for the next couple of months," a DPU representative told her. Johnson told the Times-Dispatch that "DPU has made progress in resolving outstanding issues by adding additional staff resources, and [we] hope to continue to see improvement as new billing system issues are resolved." Both efforts — the staff-

ing and systems upgrades — are part of Mayor Danny Avula's plan to offer "best-in-class services" to Richmond residents. But the DPU billing issues are hardly new. Earlier this year, a glitch in the department's new billing system resulted in at least 15,000 DPU customer payments not being applied to accounts, causing those accounts to appear delinquent and raising questions as to where the dollars had gone. And last year, the Times-Dispatch reported that DPU had cut off another customer's water after instructing her not to pay her errant \$7,000 bill for months. Asked whether she feels she's a recipient of "best-in-class services," Rose unequivocally said no. "This didn't meet my bar. None of it met my bar for customer service," she said, expressing frustration that she'd had to resort to contacting the local newspaper to get a \$12,000 mistake corrected. "I hope that the situation can be remediated so that it doesn't have to be a reporter reaching out for the average citizen to fix a very clear problem," she said.



The Guide to Offers
The Washington Post

Enter for the chance to win a pair of tickets to Quicksand & Bane - August 31

It's impossible to overstate Quicksand's influence on hardcore. Formed in New York City in 1990 by veterans of Gorilla Biscuits, Youth of Today, Burn and Bold, the band pushed hardcore's raw aggression into heavier, groove-driven territory, helping define the sound that would become known as post-hardcore. Joining them are Soul Blind, whose thick, pedal-drenched sound channels the weight of their hardcore roots through the hooks, haze and massive guitars of modern rock. Don't miss this one of a kind performance.

See details at [washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388](https://www.washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388)



Drivers zoom along Pennsylvania and Independence avenues at 160 mph

GRAND PRIX FROM C7

chicken tenders, \$25 crab cake sandwiches and other festival fare.

Trailers lined along the Mall hawked official race merchandise, including T-shirts, caps and beer cozies. A red “Make Racing Great Again” cap was selling for \$60.

A commemorative coin went for the same price. A model IndyCar, meanwhile, could be had for \$99. As the hours ticked down before the race, spectators lounged in the grass, played cornhole and other lawn games set out, or sought shade beneath scattered picnic table umbrellas.

Besides a few complaints about the long lines and lack of grandstand seating, the crowd appeared in good spirits.

Dave Hausfeld, who drove up from Raleigh, North Carolina, to be at the race, said his only critiques were “not enough grandstand seating, and not enough TV monitors around for us to see what the hell is going on.”

“Other than that, I think they’ve exceeded expectations,” he said, calling the event a “once-in-a-lifetime opportunity.”

Trump takes a lap in ‘The Beast’

Before the sun came up Sunday, the reinforced presidential limousine known as “The Beast” could be seen navigating the track as early as 3 a.m. in preparation for Sunday’s ceremonial lap, according to a person with knowledge of the trial run who was not authorized to speak to the media.

“I’m going to make a little circle in a nice, secure car,” Trump said in a broadcast interview with Fox before the race. “Slightly slower than the ones we’re going to witness, but we’ll have a good time.”

“Outside of the Indy 500, there’s not another race that you want to win [as much].”

Kyle Kirkwood, winner of the Freedom 250 Grand Prix

Trump, who personally greeted the drivers and took a photo with them alongside first lady Melania Trump, said officials had to close bridges leading into the city “because so many people wanted to come.”

During the race, Marcus Armstrong triggered two cautions, the second one after he aggressively took a corner and clipped Christian Rasmussen, who then took Rinus VeeKay out of the race.

Earlier, Alex Palou, the heavy favorite, was assessed a penalty for hitting the equipment of another team’s car when exiting the pit area. He was forced to drive at pit stop speeds through the pit area while the rest of the field kept racing.

The penalty dropped him from sixth at the time to 21st, effectively erasing his chances.

Instead, Kirkwood prevailed. Denmark’s Christian Lundgaard finished second and Australian Will Power finished third.

‘Like no other race, ever’

In the lead-up to the event, Trump said it would be “like no other race, ever” — a sentiment echoed by IndyCar President Doug Boles, who called it “iconic” in an interview with “Fox & Friends Weekend.” Boles described seven months of planning that went into building the track, installing concrete barriers and welding down more than 200 manhole covers.

Before the race, Mayor Muriel E. Bowser (D) served as the grand marshal, ushering drivers to their cars. Interior Secretary Doug Burgum delivered the famous line “Gentlemen, start your engines.”

Josh and Vanessa Sigler drove 11 hours from their home in Terre Haute, Indiana, just to see the race.

“It’s awesome. I hope they do it again,” Josh Sigler said of the experience.

Hadley Kader, 28, made the trek with her family for the race from Virginia Beach for what she described as history being made in real time.

The whizzing cars and soaring planes, Kader said, represented what America is all about.

“Freedom, yeah,” Kader said. “That’s one word that can describe it.”

Some spectators said they



MICHAEL NOBLE JR./FOR THE WASHINGTON POST



ERIC LEE/GETTY IMAGES



JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON/AP



JACQUELYN MARTIN/AP



ERIC LEE/GETTY IMAGES

were drawn to the event by a love of auto racing, not enthusiasm for Trump.

“I don’t like the guy, but you can’t say no to an event like this,” said Pablo Jara, 35, of Falls Church, Virginia. “Especially as somebody that grew up watching racecars, this is a once in a lifetime opportunity. Don’t care who put it together.”

Showcase for motorsports

Trump had been personally involved in the Freedom 250 planning from the start. In January, he signed an executive order launching the first IndyCar street race in the nation’s capital as part of the year-long celebration of America’s 250th birthday. The order directed the Interior and Transportation departments to help map a course around the National Mall and expedite the permits and approvals.

The president has promoted the race as a showcase for American motorsports and Washington’s monuments. In July, he hosted IndyCar stars Palou, Malukas and Felix Rosenqvist at the White House for a preview that included a live pit-stop demonstration outside the West Wing.

“I don’t think anything will ever ... top what we’re going to be having,” Trump said of the Freedom 250 Grand Prix.

While officials have touted the Freedom 250 Grand Prix as an opportunity to showcase the city, some restaurants in the security zone saw disruptions to their businesses last week by road closures and parking restrictions. BASIS DC, a public charter school in Penn Quarter, had to dismiss classes early to accommodate increased security and event setup.

Preservationists, too, raised concerns about the effect that racecars running more than seven times the speed limit would have on federal art collections, potentially causing damage through vibration.

Still, the White House and Bowser touted the benefits of bringing a “world-class sporting event” to the District.

Keith Krach, the Freedom 250 CEO, said after the race that he’d love to do it again.

“We’ll determine that later on, but people are talking about that, left and right,” Krach said.

Krach added that he spent “a lot of time” talking with Bowser about the prospect of the race returning to the District.

“Everybody’s been supportive of this,” he said.

But for now, most of the track will be gone by Labor Day, Krach said. But the viewing suites will take three or four weeks to remove.

A photo collage from Sunday’s Freedom 250 Grand Prix event in Washington.

The IndyCar race, which drew upward of 150,000 spectators, was the culmination of events this summer launched by President Donald Trump to mark America’s 250th birthday.

Bored with cookie-cutter gowns, more Washington brides are going vintage

VINTAGE GOWNS FROM C7

exists and persists.”

Libby Rasmussen, co-founder of Vintage Vintage Vintage, a shop near Union Market that hosted the pop-up, said shopping vintage is the best way to avoid dresses that feel cookie-cutter. When Rasmussen and co-owner Rajni Rao first hosted a bridal pop-up in December 2024, there were four vendors. At the most recent iteration in March, more than 30 booths packed into the Square on K Street NW.

The region is going through a vintage revival, Rasmussen said, after high rent prices pushed a lot of established vintage stores out of business in the early 2000s.

Along with finding a cool way to express personal style, young consumers are shopping retro to lessen the harmful environmental effects of fast fashion.

The clothing industry contributes 2 to 8 percent of the world’s total carbon emissions, according to the U.N. Environment Program. Some brands use fabrics such as polyester, a fiber made from petroleum, which are inexpensive but produce high carbon emissions during the manufacturing process.

When Margaret Cohen, 29, got engaged last October, she immediately decided to shop for a secondhand dress. She grew up composting with her “hippie” dad and said sustainability is what brought her into the world of vintage.

“Not to get too political, but I feel that our government is not caring at all about the impact of the policies that they create on our environment, which is, I think, the number-one existential threat facing our world right now,” she said. “So I try to do my part, whatever that means.”

Cohen came to the pop-up just to browse for her May 2027 wedding, but she left with a holy grail: a \$3,200 cream-colored strapless Vera Wang from the 1990s. It was the first wedding gown she had ever tried on.

“I like that it has a history and a story to it — that it has lived through decades,” she said.

Weddings are expensive, and gowns are no exception. The bridalwear market is a \$65.5 billion global industry. Brides in the United States spend on average \$2,100 for a dress, according to the Knot, though luxury gowns can go for \$20,000 or more.

Vintage shoppers aren’t necessarily looking for a cheaper alternative, as pieces are still sold for thousands. True budget shoppers are more likely to go to a thrift store, where there’s the chance of finding a gown for less than \$100, but it may not necessarily be “vintage,” meaning anything more than 20 years old but less than 100, which is officially antique territory.

Vintage gowns offer a glimpse into the past that modern gowns can’t. That sense of a continuing story is what draws in brides like Ray Dominguez, 28, who said vintage wedding dresses feel more intimate and personal than modern designs.

Dominguez got into vintage fashion as a way to connect with their grandmother Nellie. The pair bonded over interesting silhouettes and colorful brooches. Dominguez said searching through pre-loved garb has made them feel even more connected to Nellie, who died in 2024.

When wandering around vintage shops, Dominguez said they like to imagine what pieces their own grandchildren may like to see in their closet one day. As far as wedding gowns go, Dominguez started looking well before they got engaged on New Year’s Eve.

Once it was time to buy, they made an appointment at With Love Studios in Alexandria, the only dedicated vintage bridal store in the capital region. Other shops have vintage collections but don’t exclusively sell vintage bridal.

Dominguez, whose wedding date has yet to be set, tried on a handful of sleeveless gowns ranging from a drop waist with flowers along the bodice, to a more subdued A-line cream-colored dress that they said matched their “Gothic castle” aesthetic.

No matter the dress, the tattoo on the back of Dominguez’s left elbow was visible. “Love, Nellie” — written in their grandmother’s handwriting — served as a reminder of the connection vintage clothing had fostered.

Erica Hewins, the owner of With Love Studios, previously sold vintage clothes and bridal gowns as a vendor at Vintage Vintage before opening the Alexandria storefront in October 2025. She has a bachelor’s of fine arts in fashion design from Syracuse University but really got into the vintage bridal space when planning her own wedding.

There weren’t any local vintage bridal stores, so she furiously ordered dresses off eBay and



PHOTOS BY CAROLINE GUTMAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST



TOP: Wedding dresses hanging from a rack at With Love Studios in Alexandria — the only dedicated vintage bridal store in the capital region.

CENTER LEFT: Erica Hewins, owner of With Love Studios, makes an adjustment for customer Catarina Martinez.

CENTER RIGHT: Hewins shows off a vintage dress’s appliqué during a bridal appointment.

BOTTOM: Bridal accessories, including gloves and necklaces, at With Love Studios.



crossed her fingers that something would work. After her wedding, Hewins slowly started to build up her own retail collection.

She said she is drawn to the wedding industry by the romance and dreaminess that lets her “finally play dress-up.” Her customers are just as varied and unique as the dresses hanging around her studio.

Catarina Martinez, 32, busted through the door speaking a mile a minute. She already knew her way around the suite, as she had

shopped there before.

She’s having a Catholic Mass in her hometown of Miami at the end of November and needs many outfits for the many celebrations: a ceremony dress, a welcome-party ensemble, a reception gown, a getting-ready outfit — and maybe more. She had already decided to wear a modern wedding gown with her mother’s veil at the ceremony but wants vintage pieces for the other parties.

Martinez works on climate resilience at an engineering firm

and said sustainability is part of what drew her to vintage bridal. But mostly, she is drawn to the interesting details you can’t find in a modern store.

“There’s a sentimental component, knowing that someone wore it — I don’t know who wore it, but hopefully it’s got good juju,” she said. “Still, it’s just interesting, and I feel it was made with more care.”

Martinez grew up wearing her parents’ old college sweatshirts and was the target consumer

when vintage trends exploded in the 2010s. She said that when she got engaged in August 2025, she knew she wanted to look at vintage bridal but joked that the petite sizing didn’t always accommodate her bust.

“Modern ta-tas are hard to get into vintage gowns,” she quipped.

Still, the whimsy of old garments eclipses the annoyance of their lackluster bustiers for Martinez, who is drawn to floral motifs and classic silhouettes. She ultimately left with a negligee, which she assured was “not for public consumption.”

Hewins plopped down on the old couch in the studio for a quick breather between appointments, surrounded by garments she called pieces of art. She views her job as more than selling cap sleeves and empire waists: She’s preserving physical representations of love.

“It’s not just a pretty dress,” Hewins said. “Whether I know the story or not, they all have them.”

OBITUARIES

NANCY KASSEBAUM BAKER, 94

Senator followed her conscience across party lines

BY JOHN HANNA
Associated Press

TOPEKA, KAN. — Nancy Kassebaum Baker, a Kansas governor's daughter who became the first woman elected to the U.S. Senate without following a spouse into office, has died. She was 94.

Ms. Kassebaum Baker died Friday of natural causes, according to her son Bill Kassebaum.

"She loved Kansas. She loved people from Kansas and representing Kansas for 18 years in the U.S. Senate," he told the Associated Press. "She was an independent-minded Republican who was willing to stand up for what she thought was right, even if that meant going against the party."

She was elected to the U.S. Senate in 1978 and served three terms. Her modest demeanor endeared her to voters of all political stripes, though she shared the moderate-to-progressive Republican politics of her father, Gov. Alf Landon, the unsuccessful 1936 GOP nominee for president. Even after leaving the Senate early in 1997, she continued taking on public service roles.

She married former senator Howard Baker, a Tennessee Republican, in 1996. He died in 2014.

Ms. Kassebaum Baker remained an icon for Kansans. She could work with Senate colleagues of all political philosophies, and a 1996 health insurance law bore her name, along with that of liberal Massachusetts Sen. Edward M. Kennedy.

A centrist politician from America's heartland

Ms. Kassebaum Baker's election to the Senate brought her immediate national attention. When she announced her retirement, she was among elected women senators and the only one to chair a Senate committee, the Labor and Human Resources panel.

She was also in a dwindling bloc of moderate-to-liberal Republicans, having supported, for example, a ban on assault weapons championed by President Bill Clinton, a Democrat.

Yet she never polarized Kansas conservatives as other GOP moderates did. She connected with voters because she never seemed caught up in the trappings of power, and when she retired, she acknowledged, "I'd rather cuddle up and do needlepoint all day."

She was born on July 29, 1932, as her father, an oilman from Independence, was running for the first of his two terms as governor. She earned a political science degree from the University of Kansas and a master's degree in diplomatic history from the University of Michigan in the mid-1950s.

She was a radio station execu-



DAYNA SMITH/THE WASHINGTON POST

When Nancy Kassebaum married Howard Baker in 1996, it marked the first time a man and a woman who had both served in the U.S. Senate had wed.

tive, spent a year in the 1970s on the staff of Kansas Sen. James B. Pearson and served on the school board in the Wichita suburb of Maize. She had four children with her first husband, Phil Kassebaum, including Bill, who served a term in the Kansas House. She and Kassebaum divorced in 1979.

A moderate who sought sensible solutions

When Ms. Kassebaum Baker decided to run for U.S. Senate, she figured that "a woman with a background different from a man might be appealing" to people growing weary of politics. Pundits at the time estimated a Senate race would require \$1 million, at the time a huge sum by Kansas politics standards. In the first quarter of 1978, she spent less than \$12,000 on her campaign and saw herself "at the bottom of the totem pole."

However, nine candidates crowded the primary field, including three state senators and a prominent Wichita businessman. Ms. Kassebaum Baker won the GOP nomination with less than 31 percent of the vote.

Running as Nancy Landon Kassebaum, she won almost 54 percent of the vote that November against former two-term Democratic congressman Bill Roy.

Her moderate politics came to the fore when, only months later, she refused to endorse an amendment to the U.S. Constitution to require a balanced budget.

"We should be wary of the seemingly simple solution," she said.

Her father, who would die at age 100 in 1987, still cast a long political shadow during her first years in office. Though he had overwhelmingly lost the 1936

presidential race to Democratic incumbent Franklin D. Roosevelt, he later became an elder statesman for the party. A lecture series named for him at Kansas State University attracted presidents and foreign leaders.

"She was an independent-minded Republican ... willing to stand up for what she thought was right."

Bill Kassebaum, son

Ms. Kassebaum Baker became even more popular in her time. She won reelection in 1984 with 76 percent of the vote and in 1990 with 74 percent of the vote.

But despite her popularity, she frustrated conservative activists. She said her vote in favor of the assault weapons ban inspired the angriest mail of her career.

A public servant to the end

Ms. Kassebaum Baker had contemplated not seeking a third term, but Republican leaders prevailed upon her to run one more time. In 1996, when she decided not to seek reelection, she said she would return to a ranch and 90-year-old farmhouse in Kansas's scenic Flint Hills and babysit her grandchildren — she had seven, as well as two great-grandchildren.

When there was talk of naming a new highway in Topeka after her, she said: "Oh, goodness. Absolutely not — no."

She and Baker kept their romance low-key, and speculation

about a possible marriage didn't emerge until mid-1996, in a Washington Post story. They married that December.

It was the first time a man and a woman who had both served in the Senate had wed. Baker was elected to three terms, serving from 1967 to 1985 before becoming President Ronald Reagan's chief of staff. His first wife, Joy, had died in 1993 after a long battle with cancer.

After the marriage, public service still beckoned, including as a member of a bipartisan commission on campaign finance reform under Clinton and on a British commission in Africa in 2004-05.

President George W. Bush named her husband ambassador to Japan in 2001, and she went with him for the four-year posting. Baker said she became an important figure in the Asian nation.

Before she left for Tokyo, she told a reporter that she saw her stint in Japan as an adventure but added: "All I can say is, I will miss the Kansas prairie."

No fan of Trump

Later in life, Ms. Kassebaum Baker broke with the Republican Party as it became more conservative, endorsing Democratic candidates for Kansas governor and U.S. senator, including Democratic Gov. Laura Kelly — even though Kelly's 2022 GOP opponent, then state-Attorney General Derek Schmidt, had worked on her Senate staff.

She also declared in 2021 that President Donald Trump should be impeached after his supporters attacked the U.S. Capitol hoping to stop congressional certification of Trump's defeat in 2020 by Democrat Joe Biden.

"This just has gone too far," she told Kansas City's KMBC.

JANIE BRADFORD HOBBS, 87

Hit songwriter 'believed in the dream,' helped turn Motown into a music industry powerhouse

BY COREY WILLIAMS
Associated Press

Early Motown songwriter Janie Bradford Hobbs, who helped pen hits including "Money (That's What I Want)" and "Too Busy Thinking About My Baby," has died following an extended illness at a Los Angeles hospital, her family said Saturday. She was 87.

Ms. Bradford Hobbs was born in Charleston, Missouri, and later moved to Detroit.

She was introduced in the late 1950s to Motown founder Berry Gordy by a neighbor, singer Jackie Wilson. She joined Motown as a receptionist in 1958 and, like many of the company's employees, took part in the creative process that helped make Motown a music industry powerhouse.

She and Gordy co-wrote "Money (That's What I Want)." The song was recorded in 1959 by Barrett Strong and became an early hit. It was covered by the Beatles and became one of that group's hits.

"Too Busy Thinking About My Baby" first was recorded by the Temptations and later became a hit for Marvin Gaye. Ms. Bradford Hobbs also wrote songs for Stevie Wonder, the Supremes, Martha and the Vandellas, and others.

"Janie was there with me from the very beginning, before there was even a Motown, and she will



RICHARD SHOTWELL/AP

Janie Bradford Hobbs speaks at a dedication ceremony for funk musician George Clinton's star on the Hollywood Walk of Fame in 2024.

always hold a very special place in my heart and in the Motown family," Gordy said in a statement.

"Janie was one of a special group I have always thought of as the original Motown family — the unsung heroes who believed in the dream before anyone knew

what Motown would become," Gordy continued. "She was one of the people who helped make Motown what it became."

Ms. Bradford Hobbs later became head of writer relations for Jobete, Motown's publishing company. After leaving Motown, she founded the annual Heroes

and Legends Awards. The event spanned about 30 years, honoring music icons and awarding scholarships, according to her family.

She is survived by her husband, Wardean Hobbs; daughter, Nicole Hobbs; son, Lance Finney; and two grandsons.

DEATH NOTICE

HICKMAN



DR. RUDOLPH HICKMAN (Age 91)
Dr. Rudolph Hickman died peacefully with his family around on August 6, 2026. Services will be held on Sat. August 29th at Brightwood Park United Methodist Church at 744 Jefferson Street, NW, Washington, DC from 12-2pm.

When the need arises, let families find you in the Funeral Services Directory.

To be seen in the Funeral Services Directory, please call paid Death Notices at 202-334-4122.

The Washington Post

DEATH NOTICE

KELLEY



EUGENE KELLEY "Gene" (Age 90)
On August 15, 2026, Eugene "Gene" Kelley, husband of 61 years to Irene "Rene" Emmet Kelley, father of Alice (Bob) Scanlon, Mary (Mike) Nagle, Kathy Kelley; Pop Pop to Erin, Rob (Catie), Emmet Scanlon, Matt (Claudia), Addy and Tom Nagle, Owen Johnson and

Great Pop Pop to Audrey Nagle, died peacefully at home surrounded by his family. Pre-deceased by his parents, John and Kathryn Kelley, his sister, Kay Keating (Jim) and brother Jack (Sue) Kelley. He attended Our Lady of Lourdes, St. John's, B-CC and the University of Maryland (Phi Sigma Kappa). He proudly served in the US Navy rising to the rank of Commander and collected a lifetime of sea stories that he regaled to anyone who wanted to listen (and even those who didn't) as a true Irishman. At Kelley Company Realtors he famously coined the phrase "Caulk the hell out of it!" and relied on it for 55 years. He was often heard saying at The Brandy Hollow Farm "The difficult we do with ease, the impossible just takes a little longer" when incorporating or fixing his "Trash and Treasure" finds. A Mass of Christian Burial will be at 10:00 am on Friday, August 28, 2026, at Our Lady of Lourdes Catholic Church in Bethesda, MD with visitation at 9:30 am. In lieu of flowers, contributions may be made to the Parkinson's Foundation of the National Capital Area, 3570 Olney-Laytonville Rd. #490, Olney, MD 20830 or enjoy a beautiful day in the country with family and friends as he would have done.

KRYSA



BEVERLY BIRKEL KRYSA (Age 91)
Beverly Birkel Krysa, passed away on August 13, 2026 from complications after a stroke in Belvoir Woods, VA. She was born on November 26, 1934 in Waco, TX, the only child of Clarence Nicholas Birkel, a Safeway regional manager, and Helen Zelazny Birkel, a homemaker and seamstress. Beverly grew up in Austin and Tyler, TX and enjoyed summer trips to her parents' hometown farms in southeastern Nebraska. She graduated from Tyler High School in 1952, where she was a baton twirler and head drum major with the band. She earned an associate degree in 1954 from Tyler Junior College and was head dance captain for the Apache Belles, a precision dance team which performed at football games, parades and on stage. Beverly performed with the group at the Cotton Bowl and Junior Rose Bowl, and in Denver, Milwaukee and Mexico City.

Beverly transferred to the University of Texas at Austin and graduated with a BA in English in June 1956. She was a member of Delta Gamma and the Texas Stars, a precision baton twirling team which performed with the UT Longhorn Band, serving as Captain of the Stars her senior year. While at UT, she met her husband, Stanley Francis Krysa of Hudson, MA, a UT Law School student. They were married in July 1957 and moved to Alexandria for the start of Stan's 42-year legal career at the US Department of Justice. They lived for over 60 years in their home in the Fort Hunt area of Alexandria. Stan predeceased her in March 2025.

A woman of many talents and interests, Beverly was an avid gardener, talented artist, accomplished seamstress and quilter, gracious hostess, gourmet cook, avid reader, gifted accordion player, theater and museum enthusiast, a world traveler and Boston Terrier lover.

Beverly loved tending her gardens. She was

a member of the Riverport Garden Club, winning numerous blue ribbons in horticulture and floral arrangement competitions. She provided seasonal homegrown floral arrangements for The Robert Lee Boyhood Home (Potts-Fitzhugh House) in Alexandria, VA.

Beverly was an award-winning artist working in oils, pastels and watercolors. She was a resident artist sharing a working studio at the Torpedo Factory Arts Center in Alexandria during the 1970s. She participated in art classes throughout the US and in San Miguel de Allende, Mexico, Provence, France, Australia and New Zealand. Beverly's art was featured in several juried shows and exhibitions throughout the Washington, DC area. She was a member of several local and national art organizations including the Art League of Alexandria and the Mid-Atlantic Plein Air Painters Association.

Beverly operated her own business, "Beverly's Bridesmaids," specializing in designing and sewing wedding gowns, bridesmaid dresses and formal attire. She was a member of Quilters Unlimited of Northern Virginia. She designed, pieced and hand-quilted many beautiful quilts including white Baptismal quilts for her grandchildren and decorative quilts for her home. She also made curtains and reupholstered furniture.

She traveled extensively throughout the US and abroad (17 countries) touring and visiting family and friends. A devout Catholic, she was a parishioner of The Basilica of St. Mary in Alexandria, VA.

Beverly was devoted to her husband, Stan, and to her five children who survive her: Caroline (Brendan) O'Hara of Alexandria, VA; Victoria (Craig) Wolf of Naperville, IL; Katherine (David) Wright of Sterling, VA; Jennifer Krysa of Alexandria, VA; and Caroline (Matthew) Neufeldt and Stephanie Wolf; Natalie (Bradley) Webster, Daniel (Molly) Wright and Scott Wright; and John (Mackenzie) Krysa, Joseph Krysa and Samuel Krysa; and by three great-grandchildren: Eli, Benito, Jack Webster and Ella Webster. The family thanks Hewan Deneke for her loyalty and devotion in caring for Beverly.

A Mass of Christian Burial will be celebrated on Friday, August 28 at 2:30 pm at The Basilica of St. Mary, 310 South Royal Street, Alexandria, VA. A reception will immediately follow the service at her home, Interment at Arlington National Cemetery Columbarium with Stan will follow at a later date. In lieu of flowers, donations may be made to Catholic Relief Services.

PHIPPARD



JAMES ROCHE PHIPPARD
James Roche "Jim" Phippard, a former USAID official and lawyer, passed away August 16, 2026 at Sunrise on Connecticut Ave in Washington, D.C. after a long illness. Jim was born in Springfield, MA and spent his early years in Willimantic, CT. He was still in grade school when the family moved to Greenfield, MA. A graduate at 17 of Greenfield High School, he won a diocesan scholarship to Catholic University where Jim studied economics, graduating in 1954. After graduation, he joined the Navy as a junior supply corps officer. He served in the Mediterranean supplying the 6th fleet, and served as a Naval Reserve Officer until 1977.

After active duty, he attended Georgetown Law School graduating in 1961. His early legal career included stints at the National Capitol Planning Commission (to work on the Metro) and a clerkship with Justice Prettyman at the U.S. District Court in Washington. Appointed as Congressman John Blatnik's (D-MN) legal advisor, Jim took on the jobs of tracking legislation and budget issues, where he met the USAID General Counsel and joined the Agency for International Development in 1965, serving initially as Assistant General Counsel for Legislation and then as Assistant General Counsel for Africa working on many African assistance projects.

Joining the U.S. Foreign Service in 1973, Jim became the legal counsel for USAID's West African Development Services Office then based in Abidjan, Cote d'Ivoire, covering work in the region from Mauritania to Zaire. In 1976, USAID appointed him legal advisor at its new Cairo Mission created in the wake of the U.S. decision to restore relations with Egypt in support of the Egypt-Israeli Sinai Accords. In this position he facilitated major investments in Egyptian infrastructure and economic development.

Moving to USAID management, Jim attended the Harvard Kennedy School during 1979-80 where he focused on economic development and strategic planning, becoming Director of the Office of North Africa and European Affairs in 1980. Responsible for programming in Morocco, Tunisia, Spain and Portugal, he also coordinated the U.S.

response to the Southern Italian earthquake in 1980.

Appointed Mission Director to Tunisia in late 1982, Jim sought to reduce Tunisia's aid dependence and diversify the economy. His vision to move control of many projects to the community level led to the development of water user groups in Central Tunisia promoting irrigation and fruit production in the area. This work merited three Senior Foreign Service Performance awards. In 1987 upon his departure, the President of Tunisia awarded him the Commander of the Order of the Republic — the only USAID Mission Director since independence to be so honored.

Returning to Washington, Jim joined the Senate Ag Committee Staff at the request of Senator Patrick Leahy to help reshape U.S. food assistance. In this position he made key contributions to the 1990 Farm Bill and the U.S. Foreign Operations Appropriations Act, revamping PL 480 legislation, promoting privatization of state run marketing agencies, and recognizing the potential impact of climate change on agriculture.

Retiring as a Minister-Counselor in 1991, Jim applied his expertise initially as Vice President for Central Europe and Global Programs at Agricultural Development International (ACDI) and later serving the expanded nonprofit, ACDI-VOCA as Chief Financial Officer through 2004.

In retirement, Jim maintained his active interest in North Africa serving as a member and then President of the American Tunisian Association until 2004 and organizing a trip to the region in 2001. In 2008 the Tunisian American Association awarded him its Ibn Khaldun Award for his efforts in promoting Tunisian-American relations. In 2010, Catholic University recognized his work in economic development with its Distinguished Alumni Award. Until 2022, Jim split his time at a Florida condo, summer stays in Linekin Bay and Mount Desert, Maine and home in DC. An ardent traveler in later years, Jim toured Sicily in 2016 and explored the Mayan ruins at Chichen Itza in 2018.

Jim's first marriage to Janet St. Marie Gary ended in divorce in 1973. His elder son, Jim, Jr. died in 2014. He is survived by three adult children, Edwin of Arlington, VA, Kathleen of Millsboro, DE, and Melanie of Walnut Creek, CA and his wife of 53 years, Melinda L. Kimble, a retired Senior Foreign Service Officer.

Relatives and Friends are invited to call on Sunday August 30 from 5:00 PM to 7:00 PM at Joseph Gawlik & Sons, 5130 Wisconsin Ave NW. A Mass of Christian Burial will follow on Monday August 31 at 10:30 AM at Holy Trinity Catholic Church, 3513 N St NW. Interment will be private.



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815 Legal Notices

ORDER OF PUBLICATION
COMMONWEALTH OF
VIRGINIA
LOUDDON Circuit Court
P.O. Box 350, 19 E. Market St.,
3rd Floor Leesburg, VA 20178
Case No. CL26002387-00
Lakview Loan Servicing, LLC
Professional Foreclosure
Corporation of Virginia
v.
Unknown Heirs of Charles
Love
The object of this suit is to:
Enter an Order authorizing Plaintiffs
to proceed with a judicial
foreclosure sale of the real property
commonly known as 6199
Fleet Terrace, Sterling, VA 20166
It is ORDERED that Unknown
Heirs of Charles Love appear
at the above-named court and
protect his/her interests on or
before September 4, 2026 @
10am.
Date: 7-15-26
Honorable James P. Fisher
Judge

850 Montgomery County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR
MONTGOMERY COUNTY,
MARYLAND
KEITH YACKO, et al,
Substitute Trustee,
Plaintiff,
v.
JOSHUE E. ARMOLT, et al,
Defendants
Case No. C-15-CV-26-001787
NOTICE
Notice is hereby issued this 10th
day of August, 2026, that the
sale of the property in this case,
18350 SAGE WAY, GERMAN-
TOWN, MD 20874, reported by
Kendall Clark, Attorney for the
Substitute Trustee, be ratified
and confirmed, unless cause to
the contrary be shown on or
before the 9th day of September,
2026, provided a copy of this
Notice be inserted in the
Washington Post, a newspaper
published in Montgomery County,
Maryland, once in each of three
(3) successive weeks on or before
the 2nd day of September, 2026.
The report states the amount of
sale to be \$265,722.23.
Karen A. Bushell
Clerk of the Circuit Court
50 Maryland Avenue
Rockville, MD 20850
Aug 17,24,31, 2026 001252474
IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR
MONTGOMERY COUNTY,
MARYLAND
James E. Clarke, et al,
Substitute Trustee
Plaintiffs)
v.
Esther D. Williams
Defendants)
Civil No. 483710V
NOTICE PURSUANT TO
MD RULE 14-215 (A)
ORDERED, by the Circuit Court
for Montgomery County, Mary-
land, this 10th day of August
2026, that the foreclosure sale
of the property described in the
deed of trust docketed herein
and located at 3000 Indell
Street, Silver Spring, MD
20902 made and reported by
James E. Clarke, Mary L. Hurley,
Paul J. Moran, Joanne Brown
and John Ansell III, Substitute
Trustees, be RATIFIED and CON-
FIRMED, unless cause to the con-
trary be shown on or before the
9th day of September, 2026,
provided a copy of this Order
be inserted in the WASHINGTON
POST, once in each of three (3)
successive weeks before the 9th
day of September, 2026. The
report of sale states the amount
of the sale at \$429,000.00.
BY THE COURT:
Karen A. Bushell
Clerk of the Circuit Court
Orlans 19-01462 001252475
Aug 17,24,31, 2026

851 Prince Georges County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR
PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY,
MARYLAND
Brennan Ferguson, et al,
Substitute Trustee
Plaintiffs,
v.
Estate of Meron Atefwork,
Defendant.
Case No. C-16-CV-26-000468
NOTICE
Notice is hereby issued this 3rd
day of August 2026 that the
sale of the property in this case,
6528 Jodie St., Hyatts-
ville, Maryland 20784, reported
by Brennan Ferguson, et al, Sub-
stitute Trustee, be ratified and
confirmed, unless cause to the
contrary be shown on or before
the 3 day of September, 2026,
provided a copy of this Notice
be inserted in the Washington
Post, a newspaper published in
Prince George's County, Mary-
land, once in each of three (3)
successive weeks on or before
the 3 day of September, 2026.
The report states the amount
of sale to be \$266,000.00.
Mahasin El Amin
Clerk
Aug 10,17,24, 2026 001252419
IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR
PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY,
MARYLAND
Brennan Ferguson, et al,
Substitute Trustee
Plaintiffs,
v.
Thu-Van T. Tran, et al,
Defendants.
Case No. C-16-CV-24-002647
NOTICE
Notice is hereby issued this 3rd
day of August 2026 that the
sale of the property in this case,
12504 Ewell Ct, Bethesda,
Maryland 20814, reported by
Brennan Ferguson, John C. Han-
rahan, Jeremy B. Wilkins, Amanda
Driscole, Robert Oliveri, and Paul
Heinmuller, Substitute Trustee,
be ratified and confirmed, unless
cause to the contrary be shown
on or before the 2nd day of
September, 2026, provided a
copy of this Notice be inserted
in the Washington Post, a news-
paper published in Prince George's
County, Maryland, once in each
of three (3) successive weeks on
or before the 2nd day of Septem-
ber, 2026. The report states the
amount of sale to be \$701,250.00.
Mahasin El Amin
Clerk
Aug 10,17,24, 2026 001252095

840 Trustees Sale - DC

1907 SAVANNAH PLACE SE, WASHINGTON DC 20020
In execution of the Superior Court for the District of
Columbia Decree of Sale in Case. 2025-CAB-004269
the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property
known as 1907 SAVANNAH PLACE SE, WASHINGTON DC
20020 at a public auction within the offices of, HARVEY
WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC., 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite
440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 On September
8, 2026 AT 11:00 A.M., the land and premises situated in
the District of Columbia, and designated as and being Lot
0016 and in Square 5895 and more particularly described in
the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the
District of Columbia, on August 8, 2017, as Instrument
number 201708690, property will be sold by Trustee's Deed
"as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee
Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and
all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust
referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$25,000.00
or 10% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in cash
or certified funds. The deposit required to bid at the auction
is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or
assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and
may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be
announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is
to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the
sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

If purchaser fails to settle within the aforesaid for thirty
days (30) of the ratification, the purchaser agrees to pay
the trustees' reasonable attorney fees as ordered by the
Court, plus all costs incurred, if the Trustees have filed the
aforelaid motion with the Court to rescall the property.
Purchaser waives personal service of any paper filed with
the Court in connection with such motion and any Show
Cause Order issued by the Court and expressly agrees to
accept service of any such paper or Order by certified
mail and regular mail sent to the address provided by the
purchaser and as recorded on the documents executed by the
purchaser at the time of the sale. Service shall be deemed
effective upon the purchaser 3 days after postmarked by
the United States Post Office. If it is expressly agreed by the
purchaser that actual receipt of the certified mail is not
required for the sale to be effective. If the purchaser fails to
go to settlement the deposit shall be forfeited to the Trustees
and all expenses of this sale (including attorney fees and
full commission on the gross sales price of the sale) shall
be charged against and paid from the forfeited deposit. In
the event of resale the defaulting purchaser shall not be
entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from
any resale of the property regardless of any improvements
made to the real property. Interest is to be paid on the
unpaid purchase money at the rate contained in the Deed
of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date the funds
are received in the office of the Trustees. In the event that
the settlement is delayed for ANY REASON WHATSOEVER,
there shall be no abatement of interest. Taxes, water rent,
condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues,
all public charges/assessments payable on an annual
basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district
charges, if applicable, to be adjusted for the current year
to date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser.
Purchaser shall be responsible for the costs of all transfer
taxes, documentary stamps and all other costs incident
to settlement. Purchaser shall be responsible for physical
possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of
loss from the date of sale forward. The sale is subject to
post sale audit by the Mortgage holder to determine whether
the borrower filed bankruptcy, entered into any repayment/
forbearance agreement, reinstated or paid off prior to the
sale. In any such event the Purchaser agrees that upon
notification by the Trustees of such event the sale is null
and void and of no legal effect and the deposit returned
without interest. Trustee's File No. 23-008759

JAMES E. CLARKE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE

C/O ORLANDS PC
1602 Village Market Blvd SE, Suite 310
Leesburg, VA 20175
(703) 777-7010



Aug 10,17,24,31, 2026 0012524011

832 Anne Arundel County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR
ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY
Nicole Lipinski
Substitute Trustee
Versus
Audrey Better
Defendant
No. C-02-CV-26-000154
NOTICE
Notice is hereby issued this
Monday, August 03, 2026 that
the sale of the property in the
proceedings mentioned, made
and reported by Nicole Lipinski,
Esquire, Substitute Trustee BE
RATIFIED AND CONFIRMED, UN-
LESS cause to the contrary there-
of be shown on or before the 2nd
day of September 2026 next,
provided, a copy of this Notice
be inserted in some newspaper
published in Anne Arundel Coun-
ty, once in each of three succes-
sive weeks before the 2nd day
of September 2026 next. The
report states that the amount
of sale of the property at \$209,
KILMORY COURT, SEVERN,
MD 21144 to be \$247,000.00.
Scott A. Poyer
Circuit Court for
Anne Arundel County, MD
Aug 10,17,24, 2026 0012524114
Lisa E. Yates
Clerk Circuit Court for
CHARLES COUNTY

840 Trustees Sale - DC

1907 SAVANNAH PLACE SE, WASHINGTON DC 20020
In execution of the Superior Court for the District of
Columbia Decree of Sale in Case. 2025-CAB-004269
the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property
known as 1907 SAVANNAH PLACE SE, WASHINGTON DC
20020 at a public auction within the offices of, HARVEY
WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC., 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite
440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 On September
8, 2026 AT 11:00 A.M., the land and premises situated in
the District of Columbia, and designated as and being Lot
0016 and in Square 5895 and more particularly described in
the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the
District of Columbia, on August 8, 2017, as Instrument
number 201708690, property will be sold by Trustee's Deed
"as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee
Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and
all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust
referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$25,000.00
or 10% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in cash
or certified funds. The deposit required to bid at the auction
is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or
assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and
may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be
announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is
to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the
sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

If purchaser fails to settle within the aforesaid for thirty
days (30) of the ratification, the purchaser agrees to pay
the trustees' reasonable attorney fees as ordered by the
Court, plus all costs incurred, if the Trustees have filed the
aforelaid motion with the Court to rescall the property.
Purchaser waives personal service of any paper filed with
the Court in connection with such motion and any Show
Cause Order issued by the Court and expressly agrees to
accept service of any such paper or Order by certified
mail and regular mail sent to the address provided by the
purchaser and as recorded on the documents executed by the
purchaser at the time of the sale. Service shall be deemed
effective upon the purchaser 3 days after postmarked by
the United States Post Office. If it is expressly agreed by the
purchaser that actual receipt of the certified mail is not
required for the sale to be effective. If the purchaser fails to
go to settlement the deposit shall be forfeited to the Trustees
and all expenses of this sale (including attorney fees and
full commission on the gross sales price of the sale) shall
be charged against and paid from the forfeited deposit. In
the event of resale the defaulting purchaser shall not be
entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from
any resale of the property regardless of any improvements
made to the real property. Interest is to be paid on the
unpaid purchase money at the rate contained in the Deed
of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date the funds
are received in the office of the Trustees. In the event that
the settlement is delayed for ANY REASON WHATSOEVER,
there shall be no abatement of interest. Taxes, water rent,
condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues,
all public charges/assessments payable on an annual
basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district
charges, if applicable, to be adjusted for the current year
to date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser.
Purchaser shall be responsible for the costs of all transfer
taxes, documentary stamps and all other costs incident
to settlement. Purchaser shall be responsible for physical
possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of
loss from the date of sale forward. The sale is subject to
post sale audit by the Mortgage holder to determine whether
the borrower filed bankruptcy, entered into any repayment/
forbearance agreement, reinstated or paid off prior to the
sale. In any such event the Purchaser agrees that upon
notification by the Trustees of such event the sale is null
and void and of no legal effect and the deposit returned
without interest. Trustee's File No. 23-008759

JAMES E. CLARKE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE

C/O ORLANDS PC
1602 Village Market Blvd SE, Suite 310
Leesburg, VA 20175
(703) 777-7010



Aug 10,17,24,31, 2026 0012524011

832 Charles County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR
CHARLES COUNTY,
MARYLAND
NICOLE LIPINSKI
Substitute Trustee
Plaintiff
v.
NAJAH TURNER
Defendant
Civil No. C-08-CV-25-000807
NOTICE OF SALE
4903 Saylor Pl 18-KR2,
Waldorf, MD 20602
Notice is hereby issued by the
Circuit Court of CHARLES COUN-
TY this 3rd day of August, 2025
that the sale of the property
mentioned in these proceedings,
made and reported by NICOLE
LIPINSKI, Substitute Trustee, be
ratified and confirmed, unless
cause to the contrary there-
of be shown on or before the 3rd
day of Sept. 2025 provided a
copy of this notice be inserted
in WASHINGTON STATE A NEWS-
PAPER published in CHARLES
COUNTY once in each of three
successive weeks, before the
2nd day of Sept., 2025. The
Report of Sale states the amount
of sale to be \$139,000.00.
Lisa E. Yates
Clerk Circuit Court for
CHARLES COUNTY

850 Montgomery County

Brock and Scott, PLLC
6431 Olander Drive
Wilmington NC, 28403
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE OF
VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
7521 Tarpley Dr
Rockville, MD 20855
Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a
certain Deed of Trust to WILLIAM T. MORRISON AND PHILIP
M. RUDISILL, Trustee(s), dated December 11, 2017, and
recorded among the Land Records of MONTGOMERY COUNTY,
MARYLAND in Liber 53836, folio 427, the holder of the
indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed
the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly
recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having
occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the
party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee
will offer for sale at public auction at THE MONTGOMERY
COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 50 MARYLAND AVENUE,
ROCKVILLE, MD 20850 ON,

AUGUST 26, 2026 at 11:00 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements
thereon situated in MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MD, and more
fully described in the above-referenced Deed of Trust Tax
ID# - 09-02049336.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS"
condition without either express or implied warranty or
representation, including but not limited to the description,
fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity,
physical condition, construction, extent of construction,
workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision,
environmental condition, merchantability, compliance
with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances
or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to
easements, agreements and restrictions of record which
affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to
all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record
affecting same including any condominium and of HOA
assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$33,500.00 payable
in certified check or by a cashier's check will be required from
purchaser at time of sale, balance in immediately available
funds upon final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court of
MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND interest to be paid at
the rate of 4% on unpaid purchase money from date of sale
to date of settlement. The secured party herein, if a bidder,
shall not be required to post a deposit. Third party purchaser
(excluding the secured party) will be required to complete
full settlement of the purchase of the property within TEN
(10) CALENDAR DAYS of the ratification of the sale by the
Circuit Court otherwise the purchaser's deposit shall be
forfeited and the property will be resold at the risk and
expense of the defaulting purchaser. The purchaser waives
personal service of any papers filed in connection with its
failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly
agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address
provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum
of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any
surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such
surplus results from improvements to the property by said
defaulted purchaser.

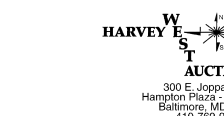
Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural
taxes, if applicable, and any and all public/private
charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts
survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground
rent, and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to
the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser.
Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead
tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes hall be
paid by purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners
association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser
from the date of sale.

Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession
of the property and assumes risk of loss or damage to the
property from the date of sale. If the sale is rescinded or not
ratified for any reason, including post sale lender audit, or
a resale is to take place for any reason, the purchaser(s)
sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund
of the aforementioned deposit. The Substitute Trustees will
convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot
deliver one or the other, or if the ratification of the sale is
denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the purchasers
sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of their deposit,
without interest.

The purchaser waives all rights and claims against the
Substitute Trustees whether known or unknown. These
provisions shall survive settlement Upon refund of the
deposit, this sale shall be void and of no effect, and the
purchaser shall have no further claim against the
Substitute Trustees. The sale is subject to post-sale review
of the status of the loan and that if any agreement to cancel
the sale was entered into by the lender and borrower prior
to the sale then the sale is void and the purchaser's deposit
shall be refunded without interest. Additional terms and
conditions, if applicable, may be announced at the time and
date of sale.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real
Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank
Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE
Rule must be obtained provided to the Reporting Person, as
defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing. File No. (25-01014)

BRENNAN FERGUSON, JOHN C. HANRAHAN,
JEREMY B. WILKINS, AMANDA DRISCOLE,
ROBERT OLIVERI, AND PAUL HEINMULLER ,
Substitute Trustees



Aug 10,17,24, 2026 0012523490

274 Merchandise Wanted

LOOK
\$ BUYING \$
MOTORCYCLES
"BUYING"
ALL MOTORCYCLES
"BEFORE 1995"
ALL MAKES & MODELS
ANY CONDITION!
SCASH PAIDS!
RUNNING OR NOT.
CALL: (315)-569-8094
OR E-MAIL:
Cyclerestoration@aol.com
Location:Fairfax, VA

245 Electronics
Get DISH Satellite TV + Internet!
Get DISH Satellite TV + Internet
Free Install. Free HD-PCR Upgrade.
80,000 On-Demand Movies. Plus
Unlimited Time Up To \$600 in Gift
Cards. Call Today! 1-866-541-7929

265 Home & Garden
No more cleaning out gutters.
Guaranteed! LeafLifter is backed
by a no-clog guarantee and lifetime
transferable warranty. Call today
1-844-566-3227 to schedule a FREE
inspection and no obligation esti-
mate. Get 15% off your entire order.
Plus, Military & Seniors get an ad-
ditional 10% off. Limited time only.
Restrictions apply. See representa-
tive for warranty and offer details.

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WELL+
BEING
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840 Trustees Sale - DC

Pardo & Drazin, LLC
Jason A. Pardo, Attorney
4400 Janifer Street, NW, Suite 2
Washington, DC 20015
202-223-7900
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF REAL PROPERTY
2901 Nelson Place, SE
Washington, DC 20019
Lot 0001 in Square 5505-S

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of
Trust and Security Agreement (the "Deed of Trust") dated
November 21, 2019 and recorded on December 5, 2019 as
Instrument No. 2019131658, Jesse Kaye ("Borrower"), as
grantor, conveyed to Westcore Land Title Insurance Company
("Original Trustee"), as trustee, securing that certain
Promissory Note (the "Note") dated November 21, 2019
in the original principal amount of \$982,500.00, default
having occurred under the terms thereof, pursuant to a Deed
of Appointment of Substitute Trustee dated May 6, 2026 and
recorded on June 18, 2026 as Instrument No. 2026059979
removing Original Trustee as trustee under the Deed of Trust
and appointing JASON A. PARDO and RUSSELL S. DRAZIN
("Substitute Trustees") as substitute trustees under the
Deed of Trust, and following the mailing and recordation of
an Affidavit of Non-Residential Mortgage Foreclosure and a
Notice of Foreclosure Sale of Real Property or Condominium
Unit, at the request of the current noteholder, Substitute
Trustees will sell at public auction at the office of Harvey
West Auctioneers, Inc., 5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW, Suite
440, Washington, DC 20015, on

AUGUST 25, 2026 AT 10:00 AM

ALL THAT LOT OF GROUND AND THE IMPROVEMENTS
THEREON (if any) situated in the City of Washington, District
of Columbia, known as 2901 Nelson Place, SE, Washington,
DC 20019 (Lot 0001 in Square 5505-S), and more fully
described in the Deed of Trust.

TOGETHER WITH any and all buildings, structures,
improvements or appurtenances now erected on the above-
described land, including, without limitation, all equipment,
apparatus, machinery and fixtures of any kind or character
forming a part of said buildings, structures, improvements
or appurtenances, which are not owned by any third party,
upon or about the above-described land and any buildings
thereon all as more particularly described in the aforesaid
Deed of Trust (the "Property").

The property will be sold in an "AS IS" condition, with no
warranty of any kind, and subject to conditions, restrictions,
agreements, liens, and encumbrances of record affecting
the same – except those encumbrances of record that are
extinguished by operation of District of Columbia law by
virtue of the foreclosure of the Deed of Trust. The successful
purchaser recognizes that any investigation, examination or
inspection of the Property is within the control of the owner
or other parties in possession of the Property and not within
the control of the Substitute Trustees or the noteholder.
Purchaser will take title to the property subject to all taxes,
water and sewer charges, and other utility charges, if any.
Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the
property from the date of sale forward. Purchaser shall be
responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property.

TERMS OF SALE: The Property will be offered as
an entirety only. All the bid which yields the highest price for
the Property will be accepted by the Substitute Trustees
(unless the sale is postponed or cancelled) and all bids
will be provisional until acceptance. Notwithstanding the
foregoing, the Substitute Trustees absolutely reserve the
right to postpone the sale and/or cancel the sale at any time
until the auctioneer announces that the Property is "sold"
and the deposit in the required amount and form is received
by the Substitute Trustees. A deposit in the amount of
\$25,000.00 will be required at the time of sale. Such deposit
must be by cashier's check or certified check or in such other
form as the Substitute Trustees may determine in their sole
discretion. The deposit must be increased to 10% of the
winning bid amount and delivered to the Substitute Trustees
within one (1) business day after the consummation of the
sale in the same form of funds as the initial deposit or in
such other form as the Substitute Trustees may determine in
their sole discretion. Failure to timely tender the deposit or
additional deposit shall constitute a material default by the
purchaser and result in forfeiture of the deposit. Balance
of the purchase price to be paid in cash or certified funds
at settlement. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase
money from the date of sale to the date of settlement at
the applicable interest rate set forth in the debt instrument
secured by the Deed of Trust. Purchaser shall be responsible
for payment of all settlement costs.

The noteholder and its affiliates, if a bidder, shall not be
required to post a deposit or to pay interest.

In the event that purchaser does not settle as required
for any reason, purchaser shall be in default. Upon such
default, the deposit shall be forfeited to Substitute Trustees
and all of the expenses of this sale (including legal fees and
costs, and full commission on the gross sale price) shall
be charged against and paid out of the forfeited deposit.
Substitute Trustees may resell the property at the risk
and expense of the defaulting purchaser. The defaulting
purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds or
profits resulting from any resale of the property. Defaulting
purchaser shall be liable to Substitute Trustees for legal
fees and costs incurred by Substitute Trustees in connection
with such default.

If Substitute Trustees are unable to settle as set forth
herein, purchaser's sole remedy at law and in equity shall
be limited to a refund of the deposit and the sale shall be
considered null and void and of no effect whatsoever.

Substitute Trustees reserve the right, in Substitute Trustees'
sole discretion, to reject any and all bids, to withdraw the
property from sale at any time before or at the auction,
to extend the time to receive bids, to waive or modify the
deposit requirement, to waive or modify the requirement
that interest be paid on the unpaid purchase money, and/or
to extend the period of time for settlement.

Additional terms may be announced at the sale. The
successful bidder will be required to execute and deliver to
Substitute Trustees a memorandum or contract of the sale
at the conclusion of bidding.

Jason A. Pardo and Russell S. Drazin, Substitute Trustee



Aug 11,13,18,20,24, 2026 0012523040

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840 Trustees Sale - DC

Pardo & Drazin, LLC
Jason A. Pardo, Attorney
4400 Janifer Street, NW, Suite 2
Washington, DC 20015
202-223-7900
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF REAL PROPERTY
2901 Nelson Place, SE
Washington, DC 20019
Lot 0001 in Square 5505-S

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of
Trust and Security Agreement (the "Deed of Trust") dated
November 21, 2019 and recorded on December 5, 2019 as
Instrument No. 2019131658, Jesse Kaye ("Borrower"), as
grantor, conveyed to Westcore Land Title Insurance Company
("Original Trustee"), as trustee, securing that certain
Promissory Note (the "Note") dated November 21, 2019
in the original principal amount of \$982,500.00, default
having occurred under the terms thereof, pursuant to a Deed
of Appointment of Substitute Trustee dated May 6, 2026 and
recorded on June 18,

MONDAY, AUGUST 24, 2026

EZ

840 Trustees Sale - DC	840 Trustees Sale - DC
Brock and Scott, PLLC 5431 Oleander Drive Wilmington NC, 28403	

In execution of the Superior Court for the District of Columbia Decree of Sale in , CASE NUMBER 2017-CA-003179-R(RP) the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property known as **123 Peabody Street, NW, Washington, DC 20011** at public auction within the offices of, HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC., 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite 440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 On **SEPTEMBER 22, 2026 AT 11:30 AM**, the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia, and designated as and being in SQUARE 3376 AND LOT 0028 , and more particularly described in the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the District of Columbia, on APRIL 10, 2007 as Instrument Number 2007049437.

The property will be sold by Trustee's Deed "as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$ 500.00 or 0.5% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in certified check or a cashier's check. The deposit required to bid at the auction is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

If purchaser fails to settle within the aforesaid thirty (30) days of the ratification, the purchaser agrees to pay the Trustees' reasonable attorney fees as ordered by the Court, plus all costs incurred, if the Trustees have filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. Purchaser waives personal service of any paper filed with the Court in connection with such motion and any Show Cause Order issued by the Court and expressly agrees to accept service of any such paper or Order by certified mail and regular mail sent to the address provided by the purchaser and as recorded on the documents executed by the purchaser at the time of the sale. Service shall be deemed effective upon the purchaser 3 days after postmarked by the United States Post Office. It is expressly agreed by the purchaser that actual receipt of the certified mail is not required for service to be effective. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement the deposit shall be forfeited to the Trustees and all expenses of this sale (including attorney fees and full commission on the gross sales price of the sale) shall be charged against and paid from the forfeited deposit. In the event of resale the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from any resale of the property regardless of any improvements made to the real property. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Trustees. In the event that the settlement is delayed for ANY REASON WHATSOEVER, there shall be no abatement of interest. Taxes, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, to be adjusted for the current year to date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for the costs of all transfer taxes, documentary stamps and all other costs incident to settlement. Purchaser shall be responsible for physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss from the date of sale forward. The sale is subject to post sale audit by the Mortgage holder to determine whether the borrower filed bankruptcy, entered into any repayment/forbearance agreement, reinstated or paid off prior to the sale. In any such event the Purchaser agrees that upon notification by the Trustees of such event the sale is null and void and of no legal effect and the deposit returned without interest.

Brennan Ferguson, John C. Hanrahan, Jeremy B. Wilkins, Amanda Driscole, Robert Oliveri, and Paul Heinmuller Trustees File No. 19-15821	
	
Aug 24,31,Sep 7,14, 2026	0012524808

Brock and Scott, PLLC 5431 Oleander Drive Wilmington NC, 28403	
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In execution of the Superior Court for the District of Columbia Decree of Sale in, case number 2023-CAB-006038 the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property known as **2215 Hunter Place SE, #303, Washington, DC 20020** at public auction within the offices of, HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC., 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite 440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 On **SEPTEMBER 22, 2026 AT 11:30 AM**, the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia, and designated as and being 2006001865 in BOOK 5812 AND SQUARE 2023, and more particularly described in the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the District of Columbia, on DECEMBER 30, 2005 as Instrument Number 2006001865 .

The property will be sold by Trustee's Deed "as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$ 19,000.00 or 10% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in certified check or a cashier's check. The deposit required to bid at the auction is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

If purchaser fails to settle within the aforesaid thirty (30) days of the ratification, the purchaser agrees to pay the Trustees' reasonable attorney fees as ordered by the Court, plus all costs incurred, if the Trustees have filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. Purchaser waives personal service of any paper filed with the Court in connection with such motion and any Show Cause Order issued by the Court and expressly agrees to accept service of any such paper or Order by certified mail and regular mail sent to the address provided by the purchaser and as recorded on the documents executed by the purchaser at the time of the sale. Service shall be deemed effective upon the purchaser 3 days after postmarked by the United States Post Office. It is expressly agreed by the purchaser that actual receipt of the certified mail is not required for service to be effective. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement the deposit shall be forfeited to the Trustees and all expenses of this sale (including attorney fees and full commission on the gross sales price of the sale) shall be charged against and paid from the forfeited deposit. In the event of resale the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from any resale of the property regardless of any improvements made to the real property. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Trustees. In the event that the settlement is delayed for ANY REASON WHATSOEVER, there shall be no abatement of interest. Taxes, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, to be adjusted for the current year to date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for the costs of all transfer taxes, documentary stamps and all other costs incident to settlement. Purchaser shall be responsible for physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss from the date of sale forward. The sale is subject to post sale audit by the Mortgage holder to determine whether the borrower filed bankruptcy, entered into any repayment/forbearance agreement, reinstated or paid off prior to the sale. In any such event the Purchaser agrees that upon notification by the Trustees of such event the sale is null and void and of no legal effect and the deposit returned without interest.

John Ansell, Jeremy B. Wilkins, Robert A. Oliveri, Amanda Driscole, Paul Heinmuller, John C. Hanrahan, Kristopher Hawkins Trustees' File No. 19-15999	
	
Aug 24,31,Sep 7,14, 2026	0012524809

840 Trustees Sale - DC	840 Trustees Sale - DC
Samuel I. White, P.C. 6100 EXECUTIVE BLVD. SUITE 400 ROCKVILLE, MARYLAND 20852	

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF VALUABLE RESIDENTIAL DWELLING
KNOWN AS:
1931 16TH STREET NW UNIT 1,
WASHINGTON, DC 20009**

By virtue of Deed of Trust recorded in the land records of the District of Columbia recorded on March 3, 2022, as Instrument Number 2022024404 , and in accordance Judgment filed on July 6, 2026 in case 2025-CAB-002197 and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer to sell at public auction, within the office of

HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.
5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW
Suite 440
Washington, DC 20015-2034
On
September 8, 2026 at 12:00 PM

the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia and more particularly described in the above referenced Deed of Trust and as of the date hereof designated on the Records of the Assessor of the District of Columbia for assessment purposes as

1931 16th Street NW Unit 1, Washington, DC 20009,
LOT 0067 AND SQUARE 0190

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, the ability of the purchaser to obtain title insurance or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to any assessments including assessment pursuant to D.C. Code Section 42-1903.13.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY BY certified funds, shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note (4% per annum) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Trustees, payable in cash or certified funds within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. Adjustment of current year's real property taxes are adjusted as of the date of sale, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All other public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, ground rent, whether incurred prior to or after the sale are to be paid by the purchaser. All costs of deed recordation included but not limited to title examination, conveying, city revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from date of sale. Time is of the essence for the Purchaser. If the Purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, Purchaser agrees that the property will be resold and the entire deposit retained by the Substitute Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser agrees to accept service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for all correspondence including any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into and repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to sale. In any such event or if the sale is not ratified, the purchaser's only remedy is return of the deposit without interest.

Trustee's File No. 90445 Daniel J. Pesachowitz, Esquire Attorney for Trustees	
	
Aug 10,17,24,31, 2026	0012523346

850 Montgomery County	850 Montgomery County
Robertson, Anschutz, Schneid & Crane, LLC 11350 McCormick Road, EP 1, Suite 302 Hunt Valley, MD 21031 470-321-7112	

**TRUSTEE'S SALE OF
VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
24 COURTHOUSE SQUARE UNIT 912
ROCKVILLE, MD 20850**

Under a power of sale contained in that Deed of Trust dated February 8, 2024, and recorded in Liber 67745, folio 80, of the land records of MONTGOMERY COUNTY, with the unpaid principal balance of \$249,644.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the appointed Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction AT 50 MARYLAND AVENUE, ROCKVILLE, MD 20850 ON,

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 at 11:30 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND together with any buildings or improvements thereon situated in MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MD, located at the above address and more fully described in the aforementioned Deed of Trust.

TAX-ID# - 04-02937123

The property and improvements will be sold in an "AS IS" physical condition without warranty of any kind and subject to all conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, including any condominium or homeowners association assessments pursuant to MD Real Property Article A§11-110 and A§11B-117.

TERMS OF SALE: A non-refundable bidder's deposit of \$24,000.00 by cashier's/certified check or such other form as the Substitute Trustee may determine, in their sole discretion, required at time of sale except for the party secured by the Deed of Trust. Risk of loss on purchaser from date and time of auction. The balance of the purchase price together with interest thereon at 5.99% per annum from date of sale to receipt of purchase price by Substitute Trustees must be paid by cashier's check within 10 days after final ratification of sale. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event that additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. All real estate taxes and other public charges and/or assessments to be adjusted as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. If applicable, any condominium and/or homeowners association dues and assessments that may become due after the date of sale shall be purchaser's responsibility. Purchaser shall pay all transfer, documentary and recording taxes/fees and all other settlement costs. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining possession of the property. Time is of the essence for the purchaser. If purchaser defaults, deposit will be forfeited and property resold at the risk and cost of the defaulting purchaser who shall be liable for any deficiency in the purchase price and all costs, expenses and attorney's fees of both sales. If Substitute Trustees do not convey title for any reason, purchaser's sole remedy is return of deposit without interest. This sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan secured by the Deed of Trust including but not limited to determining whether prior to sale a bankruptcy was filed; forbearance, repayment or other agreement was entered into; or loan was reinstated or paid off. In any such event this sale shall be null and void and purchaser's sole remedy shall be return of deposit without interest. File No. (26-394588)

Keith Yacko, David Williamson, Substitute Trustees	
	
Aug 17,24,31, 2026	0012522798

The Washington Post

857 Howard County	857 Howard County
Brock and Scott, PLLC 5431 Oleander Drive Wilmington NC, 28403	

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF
VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
10578 Cross Fox Lane, Unit B-2
Columbia, MD 21044**

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to A. BRUCE CLEVELAND AND JOHN SCHOEMER, Trustee(s), dated May 30, 2006, and recorded among the Land Records of HOWARD COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 10050, folio 25 , the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE HOWARD COUNTY COURTHOUSE, LOCATED AT 9250 JUDICIAL WAY, ELLICOTT CITY, MD 21043 ON,

AUGUST 26, 2026 at 12:30 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in HOWARD COUNTY, MD and more fully described in the above-referenced Deed of Trust Tax ID# - 15-029234

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$9,000.00 payable in certified check or by a cashier's check will be required from purchaser at time of sale, balance in immediately available funds upon final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court of HOWARD COUNTY, MARYLAND interest to be paid at the rate of 6.875 % on unpaid purchase money from date of sale to date of settlement. The secured party herein, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit. Third party purchaser (excluding the secured party) will be required to complete full settlement of the purchase of the property within TEN (10) CALENDAR DAYS of the ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court otherwise the purchaser's deposit shall be forfeited and the property will be resold at the risk and expense, of the defaulting purchaser. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser.

Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public/private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent, and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes hall be paid by purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale.

Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. If the sale is rescinded or not ratified for any reason, including post sale lender audit, or a resale is to take place for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the aforementioned deposit. The Substitute Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if the ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the purchasers sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of their deposit, without interest.

The purchaser waives all rights and claims against the Substitute Trustees whether known or unknown. These provisions shall survive settlement Upon refund of the deposit, this sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. The sale is subject to post-sale review of the status of the loan and that if any agreement to cancel the sale was entered into by the lender and borrower prior to the sale then the sale is void and the purchaser's deposit shall be refunded without interest. Additional terms and conditions, if applicable, may be announced at the time and date of sale.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing. File No. (25-30583 ADC)

BRENNAN FERGUSON, JOHN C. HANRAHAN, JEREMY B. WILKINS, AMANDA DRISCOLE, ROBERT OLIVERI, AND PAUL HEINMULLER ,
Substitute Trustees

Potential Bidders: For sale information, please visit
www.Auction.com or call (800) 280-2832.

610 Dogs for Sale	610 Dogs for Sale
Aug 10,17,24, 2026	



Dogs for Sale

Pembroke Welsh Corgi The puppies in this litter are born to Registered parents and each puppy comes with their own AKC papers. Father comes from an AKC champion bloodline. Mother is AKC DNA tested and cleared on everything including DM, EIC, and VonWVW05. We have hard copies of both parents AKC Pedigree showing their AKC lineage 5 generations back. Puppies are 12 weeks old and ready to go to their new homes (8/20/26). Price is \$1300 per puppy. Please text or call me at 703-498-7755. Thank you!

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840 Trustees Sale - DC	840 Trustees Sale - DC
5029 JUST STREET NE, WASHINGTON DC 20019	

In execution of the Superior Court for the District of Columbia Decree of Sale in Case: 2025-CAB-004149 the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property known as 5029 JUST STREET NE, WASHINGTON DC 20019 at a public auction within the offices of, HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC., 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite 440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 On **September 8, 2026 At 11:00 A.M.**, the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia, and designated as and being Lot 0946 and in Square 5176 and more particularly described in the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the District of Columbia, on AUGUST 2, 2018 as Instrument Number: 2018076997 property will be sold by Trustee's Deed "as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$25,000.00 or 10% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in cash or certified funds. The deposit required to bid at the auction is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

If purchaser fails to settle within the aforesaid for thirty days (30) of the ratification, the purchaser agrees to pay the Trustees' reasonable attorney fees as ordered by the Court, plus all costs incurred, if the Trustees have filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. Purchaser waives personal service of any paper filed with the Court in connection with such motion and any Show Cause Order issued by the Court and expressly agrees to accept service of any such paper or Order by certified mail and regular mail sent to the address provided by the purchaser and as recorded on the documents executed by the purchaser at the time of the sale. Service shall be deemed effective upon the purchaser 3 days after postmarked by the United States Post Office. It is expressly agreed by the purchaser that actual receipt of the certified mail is not required for service to be effective. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement the deposit shall be forfeited to the Trustees and all expenses of this sale (including attorney fees and full commission on the gross sales price of the sale) shall be charged against and paid from the forfeited deposit. In the event of resale the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from any resale of the property regardless of any improvements made to the real property. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Trustees. In the event that the settlement is delayed for ANY REASON WHATSOEVER, there shall be no abatement of interest. Taxes, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, to be adjusted for the current year to date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for the costs of all transfer taxes, documentary stamps and all other costs incident to settlement. Purchaser shall be responsible for physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss from the date of sale forward. The sale is subject to post sale audit by the Mortgage holder to determine whether the borrower filed bankruptcy, entered into any repayment/forbearance agreement, reinstated or paid off prior to the sale. In any such event the Purchaser agrees that upon notification by the Trustees of such event the sale is null and void and of no legal effect and the deposit returned without interest.Trustees' File No. 25-006094

JAMES E. CLARKE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE	
C/O ORLANDS PC 1602 Village Market Blvd SE, Suite 310 Leesburg, VA 20175 (703) 777-7101	
	
Aug 10,17,24,31, 2026	0012524012

944 EASTERN AVENUE NE UNIT 10 PARKING SPACE P-7, WASHINGTON DC 20019
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In execution of the Superior Court for the District of Columbia Decree of Sale in Case: 2024-CAB-002462 the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property known as 944 EASTERN AVENUE NE UNIT 10 PARKING SPACE P-7, WASHINGTON DC 20019 at a public auction within the offices of, HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC., 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite 440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 On **September 8, 2026 AT 11:00 A.M.**, the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia, and designated as and being Lot 2023 AND 2046 and in Square 5203 and more particularly described in the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the District of Columbia, on MAY 6, 2009 as Instrument Number: 2009048224 property will be sold by Trustee's Deed "as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$15,000.00 or 10% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in cash or certified funds. The deposit required to bid at the auction is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

If purchaser fails to settle within the aforesaid for thirty days (30) of the ratification, the purchaser agrees to pay the Trustees' reasonable attorney fees as ordered by the Court, plus all costs incurred, if the Trustees have filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. Purchaser waives personal service of any paper filed with the Court in connection with such motion and any Show Cause Order issued by the Court and expressly agrees to accept service of any such paper or Order by certified mail and regular mail sent to the address provided by the purchaser and as recorded on the documents executed by the purchaser at the time of the sale. Service shall be deemed effective upon the purchaser 3 days after postmarked by the United States Post Office. It is expressly agreed by the purchaser that actual receipt of the certified mail is not required for service to be effective. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement the deposit shall be forfeited to the Trustees and all expenses of this sale (including attorney fees and full commission on the gross sales price of the sale) shall be charged against and paid from the forfeited deposit. In the event of resale the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from any resale of the property regardless of any improvements made to the real property. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Trustees. In the event that the settlement is delayed for ANY REASON WHATSOEVER, there shall be no abatement of interest. Taxes, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, to be adjusted for the current year to date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for the costs of all transfer taxes, documentary stamps and all other costs incident to settlement. Purchaser shall be responsible for physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss from the date of sale forward. The sale is subject to post sale audit by the Mortgage holder to determine whether the borrower filed bankruptcy, entered into any repayment/forbearance agreement, reinstated or paid off prior to the sale. In any such event the Purchaser agrees that upon notification by the Trustees of such event the sale is null and void and of no legal effect and the deposit returned without interest.Trustees' File No. 23-014442

JAMES E. CLARKE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE	
C/O ORLANDS PC 1602 Village Market Blvd SE, Suite 310 Leesburg, VA 20175 (703) 777-7101	
	
Aug 10,17,24,31, 2026	0012524013

MONDAY, AUGUST 24, 2026

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Prince Georges County

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Prince Georges County

ORLANS LAW GROUP

1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD. SE, SUITE 310
LEESBURG, VA 20175
703-777-7101

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

1714 Blount Dr
Fort Washington, MD 20744

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from CARLA Y. HOLLAND, AS SOLE OWNER, dated September 15, 2020 and recorded in Liber 44175, folio 246 among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No.C-16-CV-24-001082; Tax ID No.05-0366260) the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772, on

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$20,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 23-013706)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
JASON N. GREENBERG,
JOANNA FORONDA
JOHN ANSELL III,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES

HARVEY W

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AUCTIONEERS, LLC

300 E. Joppa Road
Hampton Plaza - Suite 1103
Baltimore, MD 21286
410-769-9797

Aug 17,24,31, 2026 0012523992

ORLANS LAW GROUP

1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD. SE, SUITE 310
LEESBURG, VA 20175
703-777-7101

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

6112 GOTHIC LANE
BOWIE, MD 20720

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from SHALEEN M YANCEY, dated October 27, 2022 and recorded in Liber 48409, folio 251 among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No.C-16-CV-26-002142; Tax ID No.14-1635762) the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772, on

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$10,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 25-008328)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
JOANNA FORONDA,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
JASON N. GREENBERG,
JOHN ANSELL III,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES

HARVEY W

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AUCTIONEERS, LLC

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Baltimore, MD 21286
410-769-9797

Aug 17,24,31, 2026 0012523956

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ORLANS LAW GROUP

1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD. SE, SUITE 310
LEESBURG, VA 20175
703-777-7101

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

2127 KEATING STREET
TEMPLE HILLS, MD 20748

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from EVELYN SHAW, UNMARRIED, dated March 26, 2022 and recorded in Liber 47483, folio 185 among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No.C-16-CV-24-005863; Tax ID No.12-1228311) the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772, on

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$25,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 24-010552)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES

HARVEY W

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AUCTIONEERS, LLC

300 E. Joppa Road
Hampton Plaza - Suite 1103
Baltimore, MD 21286
410-769-9797

Aug 17,24,31, 2026 0012523117

ORLANS LAW GROUP

1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD. SE, SUITE 310
LEESBURG, VA 20175
703-777-7101

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

7260 MAHOGANY DRIVE #5
LANDOVER, MD 20785

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from JESSICA IVY MYLES, SINGLE WOMAN, dated May 31, 2013 and recorded in Liber 44853, folio 440 among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No.CAEF15-00137; Tax ID No.13-2845170) the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772, on

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$5,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 14-700017)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
JOANNA FORONDA,
JOHN ANSELL III,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES

HARVEY W

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AUCTIONEERS, LLC

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Baltimore, MD 21286
410-769-9797

Aug 17,24,31, 2026 0012523044

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ORLANS LAW GROUP

1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD. SE, SUITE 310
LEESBURG, VA 20175
703-777-7101

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

13713 GULLIVERS TRAIL
BOWIE, MD 20720

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from FATMATA CAREW, A MARRIED WOMAN AS SOLE OWNERSHIP, dated September 5, 2024 and recorded in Liber 50313, folio 350 among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No.C-16-CV-26-001529; Tax ID No.14-1638147) the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772, on

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$50,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 25-009883)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
JOANNA FORONDA,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
JASON N. GREENBERG,
JOHN ANSELL III,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES

HARVEY W

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410-769-9797

Aug 17,24,31, 2026 0012522883

ORLANS LAW GROUP

1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD. SE, SUITE 310
LEESBURG, VA 20175
703-777-7101

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

8508 SUMTER LANE
CLINTON, MD 20735

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from MURRAY TOWNES AND ERIKA TOWNES, dated October 25, 2005 and recorded in Liber 24181, folio 266 MODIFIED ON MARCH 19, 2015, IN LIBER 36789 FOLIO 256, among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No.C-16-CV-25-002708; Tax ID No.09-0940338) the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772, on

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$35,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 25-004970)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
JOANNA FORONDA,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
JASON N. GREENBERG,
JOHN ANSELL III,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES

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Aug 17,24,31, 2026 0012522789

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Prince Georges County

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Prince Georges County

ORLANS PC

1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD. SE, SUITE 310
LEESBURG, VA 20175
703-777-7101

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

5504 San Juan Drive
Clinton, MD 20735

Under the Order for Decree of Sale entered APRIL 7, 2026, in Circuit Court Case Number C-16-CV-25-002972, a s to that real property described in a Deed of Trust dated March 25, 2003 and recorded in Liber 17319, folio 516 MODIFIED ON SEPTEMBER 21, 2022 IN LIBER 48147 FOLIO 153; among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD, and identified by Tax ID No.09-0918185 default having occurred thereunder, the Substitute Trustees will sell same at public auction at the PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772, on

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$5,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 25-000721)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
JOANNA FORONDA,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
JASON N. GREENBERG,
JOHN ANSELL III,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES

HARVEY W

E

AUCTIONEERS, LLC

300 E. Joppa Road
Hampton Plaza - Suite 1103
Baltimore, MD 21286
410-769-9797

Aug 17,24,31, 2026 0012522251

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Anne Arundel County

852

Anne Arundel County

Trustee's Sale of

205 & 206 Allensway Dr., Edgewater, MD 21037

In execution of a Purchase Money Deed of Trust ("Deed of Trust") dated June 18, 1997, and recorded June 24, 1997, at Page 219 of Book 7952 in the Land Records of Anne Arundel County (the "Land Records"), default having occurred under the terms thereof, and following the mailing of a Notice of Intent to Foreclose a Residential Property, at the request of the current noteholder, the Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at the courthouse steps of the Anne Arundel County Circuit Court, 8 Church Cir., Annapolis, MD 21401 on

August 28, 2026, at 10:00 a.m.

all that property and the structures and improvements thereon situated in Anne Arundel County, known as 205 & 206 Allensway Dr., Edgewater, MD 21037, and more fully described in the Deed of Trust (the "Property").

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of 10% of the purchase price or \$40,000.00, whichever is lower, by cash or cashiers check, will be required of Purchaser at the time and place of sale. The balance of the purchase price, with interest thereon at the annual rate of 10%, shall be due and payable in cash or certified funds within THIRTY (30) CALENDAR DAYS after the day of sale. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE WITH RESPECT TO SETTLEMENT BY PURCHASER. The noteholder, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit or to pay interest. The Property will be AS IS, with no warranty of any kind, and subject to conditions, restrictions, agreements, liens, and encumbrances of record. All charges or assessments, including but not limited to property taxes, utility charges, and ground rent, whether assessed or incurred prior to or after the sale are to be paid by Purchaser. All costs of deed recordation including but not limited to title examination, conveyingancy, city revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by Purchaser. Purchaser will pay reasonable attorney fees for services rendered by counsel for Trustee at the request of Purchaser or due to failure of Purchaser to comply with the terms of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining possession of the property and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from date of sale. In the event that Purchaser does not settle as required for any reason, Purchaser shall be in default. Upon such default, the deposit shall be forfeited to Trustee and all expenses of this sale (including attorneys fees and full commission on the gross sale price) shall be charged against the forfeited deposit. Trustee may resell the property at the risk and expense of the defaulting Purchaser. The defaulting Purchaser is not entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from any resale of the property. Trustee reserves the right, in his sole discretion, to reject any and all bids, to withdraw the property from sale at any time before or at the auction, to extend the time to receive bids, to waive or modify the deposit requirement, to waive or modify the requirement that interest be paid on the unpaid purchase money, and/or to extend the period of time for settlement. In the event Trustee is unable to convey marketable title or in the event the borrower entered into a repayment plan, reinstated or paid the loan off prior to the sale, or if for any other reason, Trustee did not have the right to sell, the sale is null and void and Purchaser is not entitled to any legal or equitable remedy other than return of the deposit without interest and any and all other claims of Purchaser are hereby released. The successful bidder will be required to execute and deliver to Trustee a memorandum or contract of the sale at the conclusion of bidding. Other terms and conditions may be announced at the sale.

FOR INFORMATION CONTACT:
Jonathan E. Levine, Counsel for Sudeb Basu, Trustee
11350 Random Hills Rd., Ste. 700
Fairfax, VA 22030
703-352-1300

A181, A316, A311, A183, A425, A426, A461, A463, A508

HARVEY W

E

AUCTIONEERS, LLC

300 E. Joppa Road
Hampton Plaza - Suite 1103
Baltimore, MD 21286
410-769-9797

Aug 10,17,24, 2026 0012524184

CLASSIFIED C15

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Anne Arundel County

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Anne Arundel County

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THE WEATHER

WASHINGTONPOST.COM/WEATHER

Perfectly pleasant

Monday's a good one: sunny to partly cloudy with a high in the mid-80s and a calm, westerly breeze. In the evening it'll be mostly clear, with only an iota's chance of rainfall. Expect temperatures to drop to around 60 degrees.

● AccuWeather FORECAST

Today

Partly cloudy

84° 64°

REALFEEL®: 87°

CHANCE PRECIP: 5%

WIND: W 6-12 mph

HUMIDITY: Low

Tuesday

Sunny

85° 66°

REALFEEL® 88°

CHANCE PRECIP: 0%

WIND: WNW 6-12 mph

HUMIDITY: Low

Wednesday

Partly sunny

87° 69°

REALFEEL® 91°

CHANCE PRECIP: 25%

WIND: SSE 4-8 mph

HUMIDITY: Moderate

Thursday

Heavy t-storms; humid

87° 71°

REALFEEL® 91°

CHANCE PRECIP: 90%

WIND: SE 7-14 mph

HUMIDITY: High

Friday

Humid with some sun

87° 71°

REALFEEL® 92°

CHANCE PRECIP: 25%

WIND: SE 4-8 mph

HUMIDITY: High

Saturday

Partly sunny

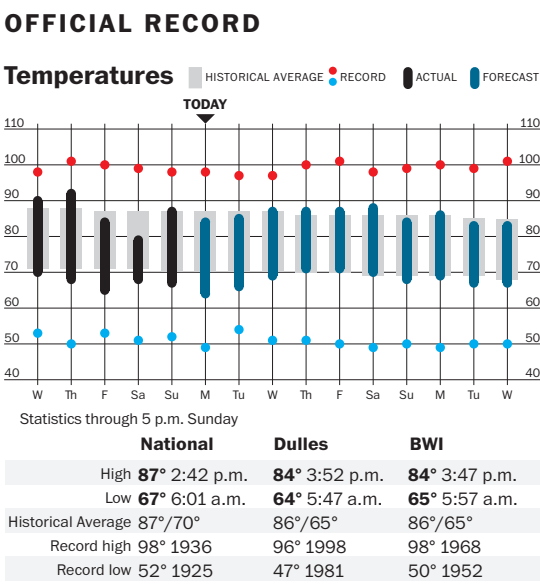
88° 70°

REALFEEL® 92°

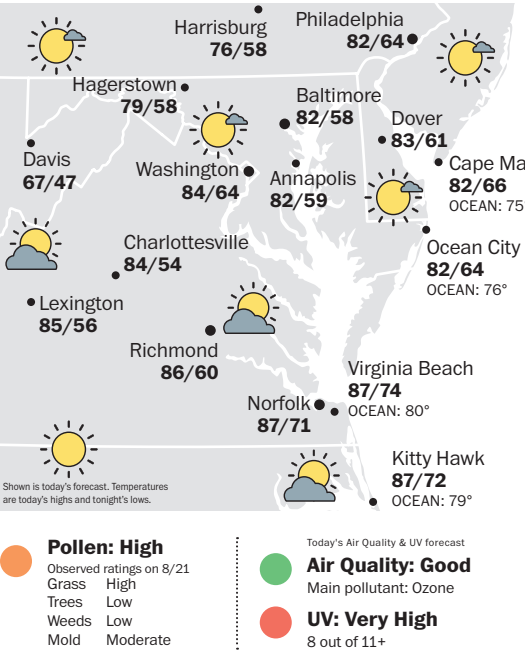
CHANCE PRECIP: 25%

WIND: ENE 4-8 mph

HUMIDITY: High



REGION TODAY



Blue Ridge: *Shenandoah National Park:* Today, mostly sunny. High 80. Winds west-northwest 4-8 mph. Tonight, mainly clear. Low 52. Winds northwest 4-8 mph. • *Great Smoky Mtns. National Park:* Today, partly sunny, cooler. High 68. Winds northwest 4-8 mph. Tonight, turning cloudy. Low 56. Winds east-southeast 4-8 mph.

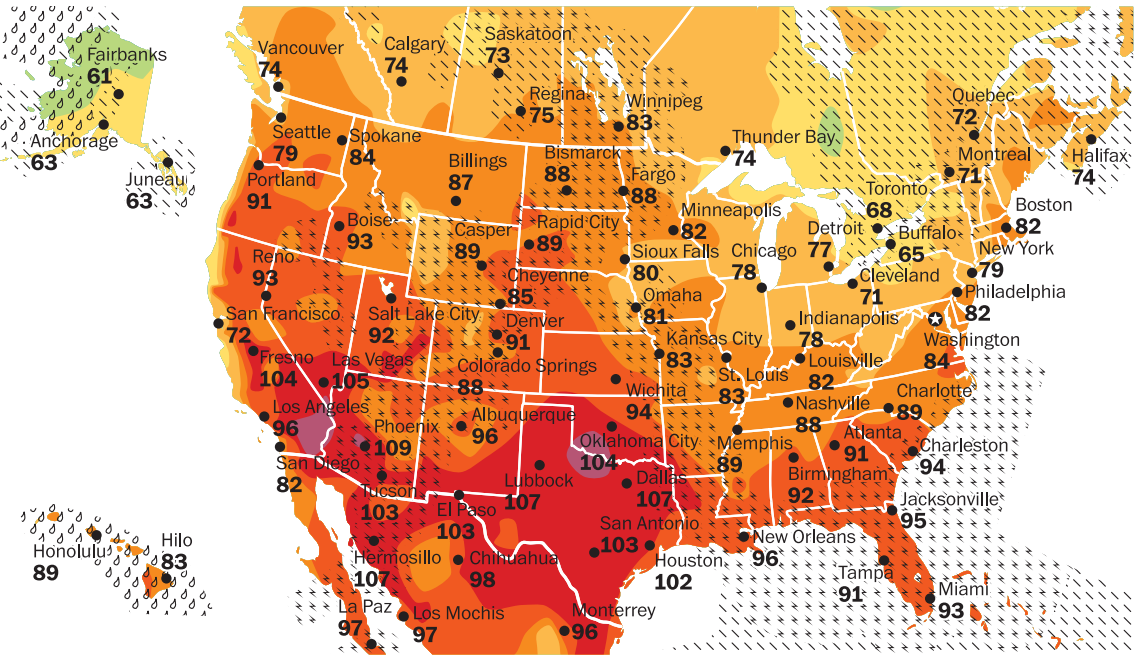
Atlantic beaches: *Ocean City, MD:* Today, partly sunny. High 82. Winds east-southeast 6-12 mph. Tonight, clear. Low 64. Winds northwest 4-8 mph. • *Virginia Beach:* Today, less humid, partly sunny. High 87. Winds south 6-12 mph. Tonight, mainly clear. Low 74. Winds west-southwest 4-8 mph.

Waterways: *Upper Potomac River:* Today, mostly sunny. Wind west 4-8 knots. Waves less than a foot. Visibility clear to the horizon. • *Lower Potomac and Chesapeake Bay:* Today, sunny. Wind southwest 4-8 knots. Waves 0-1 foot on the Lower Potomac and the Chesapeake Bay. • *River Stages:* The stage at Little Falls will be around 3.10 feet today, rising to 3.40 Tuesday. Flood stage at Little Falls is 10 feet.

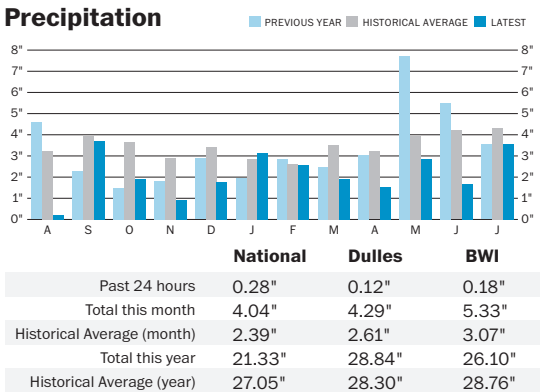
Today's tides (Shown are High tides in **Bold** and low tides.)

Washington	12:10 a.m.	6:08 a.m.	1:11 p.m.	6:44 p.m.
Annapolis	3:22 a.m.	10:13 a.m.	3:00 p.m.	9:02 p.m.
Ocean City	5:20 a.m.	11:21 a.m.	5:57 p.m.	none
Norfolk	1:38 a.m.	7:36 a.m.	1:25 p.m.	7:59 p.m.
Point Lookout	6:29 a.m.	11:24 a.m.	5:04 p.m.	none

NATION TODAY



Showers		T-storms		Rain		Flurries		Snow		Ice		Yesterday's National High: Needles, CA 114° Low: Lakeview, OR 35°		Yesterday's World High: Omidiyeh, Iran 119° Low: Balmaceda, Chile 21°			
-10° -0s		0s		10s 20s 30s 40s		50s 60s 70s 80s		90s 100s 110s									
												Low the 48 contiguous states		Excludes Antarctica			
NATIONAL		Today		Tomorrow		Des Moines		81/65/c		83/67/p		Oklahoma City		104/73/p		100/76/t	
						Detroit		77/58/s		78/59/p		Omaha		81/67/t		82/67/t	
						El Paso		103/75/s		104/77/s		Orlando		94/76/t		93/77/t	
						Fairbanks, AK		61/51/c		58/46/r		Philadelphia		82/64/s		82/67/s	
						Fargo, ND		88/64/t		85/61/p		Phoenix		109/89/t		114/90/s	
Atlanta		91/68/p		91/71/p		Hartford, CT		79/56/s		78/57/s		Pittsburgh		71/57/p		75/58/p	
Austin		106/76/s		104/76/s		Honolulu		89/79/r		89/75/sh		Portland, ME		78/58/p		78/58/sh	
Baltimore		82/58/s		84/60/s		Houston		102/78/p		100/80/s		Portland, OR		91/63/p		89/60/s	
Billings, MT		87/59/p		84/58/p		Indianapolis		78/57/p		79/60/s		Providence, RI		81/61/s		78/59/s	
Birmingham		92/67/p		92/68/t		Jackson, MS		92/74/t		92/75/t		Raleigh, NC		88/64/s		88/66/s	
Bismarck, ND		88/57/t		82/57/s		Jacksonville, FL		95/73/t		89/73/t		Reno, NV		93/61/p		93/61/p	
Boise		93/65/p		97/69/s		Kansas City, MO		93/66/s		108/69/s		Richmond		86/60/s		84/62/p	
Boston		82/65/s		79/64/s		Las Vegas		105/83/s		108/87/s		Sacramento		93/61/s		95/63/s	
Buffalo		65/59/t		72/57/s		Little Rock		86/74/t		97/74/p		St. Louis		83/65/p		86/69/p	
Burlington, VT		74/58/t		74/59/sh		Los Angeles		86/72/s		95/74/s		St. Thomas, VI		92/82/p		92/81/p	
Charleston, SC		94/73/t		88/73/t		Louisville		82/61/p		83/63/p		Salt Lake City		92/69/t		95/70/s	
Charlotte, WV		78/54/p		81/56/p		Memphis		89/74/c		91/73/t		San Diego		82/71/s		83/73/s	
Charlotte		89/64/s		88/68/p		Miami		93/80/t		93/80/t		San Francisco		72/58/p		73/58/p	
Cheyenne, WY		85/57/t		80/56/t		Milwaukee		74/57/p		79/65/s		San Juan, PR		92/80/r		92/80/r	
Chicago		78/59/p		80/64/p		Minneapolis		82/67/p		85/67/t		Seattle		79/58/p		85/57/p	
Cincinnati		77/56/p		81/57/s		Nashville		88/61/p		89/65/t		Spokane, WA		84/59/p		92/65/s	
Cleveland		71/58/p		76/58/s		New Orleans		96/78/t		90/77/t		Syracuse		71/60/t		73/59/sh	
Dallas		107/83/p		105/81/p		New York City		79/64/s		78/65/s		Tampa		91/78/t		92/77/t	
Denver		91/63/t		88/59/t		Norfolk		87/71/p		84/69/s		Wichita		94/71/s		96/71/t	



Moon Phases	Solar system
Aug 28 Full	Sun Rise 6:30 a.m. Set 7:50 p.m.
Sep 4 Last	Moon 6:09 p.m. 2:39 a.m.
Sep 10 New	Venus 2:08 a.m. 5:00 p.m.
Sep 18 First	Mars 4:53 a.m. 6:58 p.m.
	Saturn 9:40 a.m. 10:06 a.m.

A celebration of strength, resilience and community



TOP LEFT: Cora Craver, 84, prepares to throw a ball during a fitness class at Iona Senior Services in Washington on Friday.



TOP RIGHT: Carla Chissell holds a stretch to loosen up her arm muscles.

BOTTOM RIGHT: Nancy Felvman, 73, dances to music from the 1950s and '60s.

The “Strength, Balance and Core” exercise class, led by instructor Emma Swain, coincided with National Senior Citizens Day.



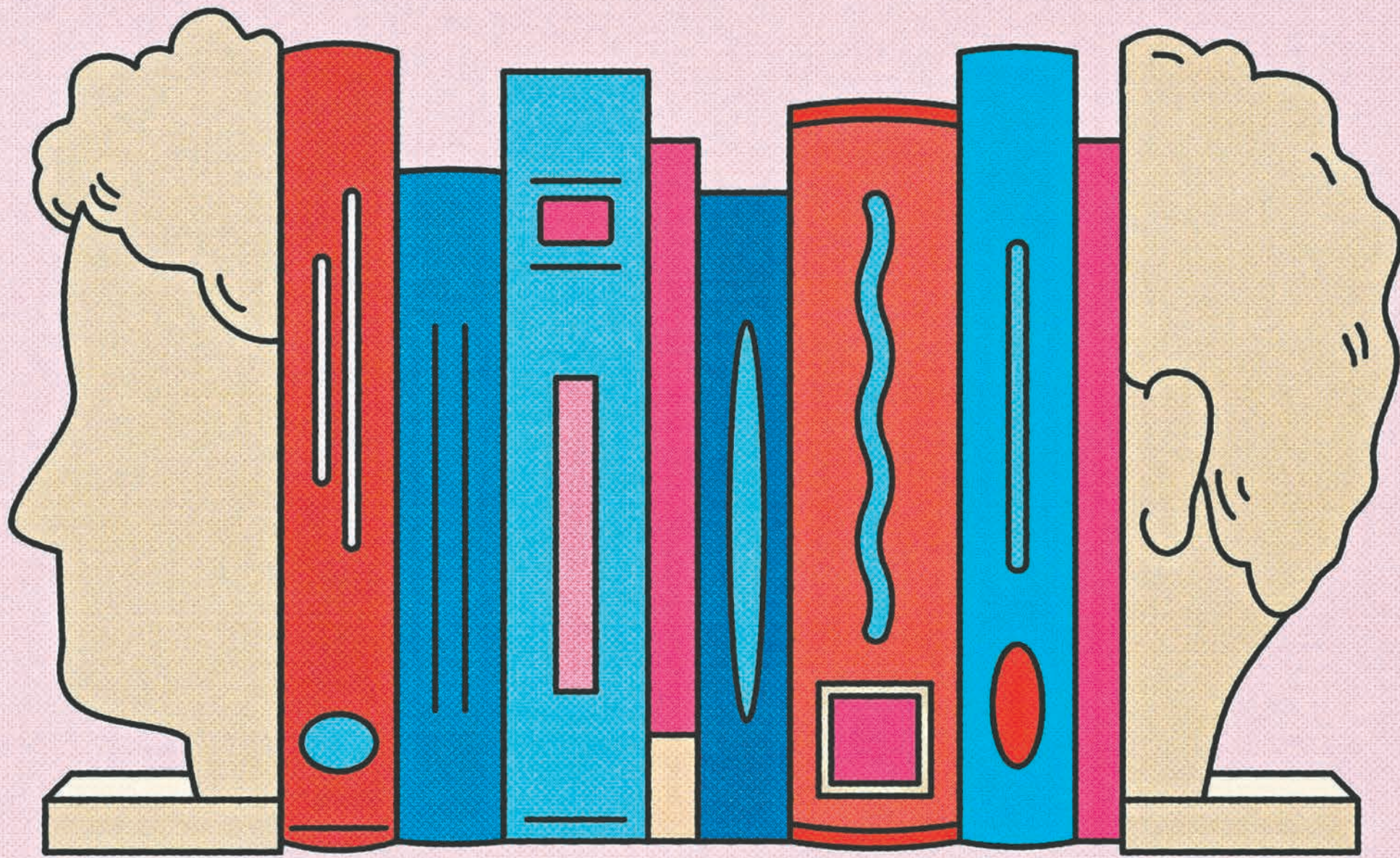


ILLUSTRATION BY GEORGE WYLESOL/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

WELL+BEING

Strategies to reduce the impact of tinnitus

BY ALISON KARLENE HODGINS

It can sound like a fire alarm, a kettle whistle, a hiss of air escaping from a balloon, a chorus of tree frogs or a roaring jet engine. For me, tinnitus is a blaring sound in my right ear, similar to the high-pitched whine that follows an explosion in a war movie, except it never fades away. The screeching sound is with me from the moment I wake up until I fall asleep.

More than 740 million adults worldwide experience tinnitus, and some studies suggest 1 in 10 people have it. Some barely notice it. Others can't function because of the phantom noise. It steals their sleep, fractures their relationships and triggers depression and anxiety. Severe tinnitus affects about 2 percent of adults overall.

While there is no treatment proven to silence chronic tinnitus, there are a handful of strategies you can try to reduce symptoms and the discomfort they bring. Here's what experts suggest.

What causes tinnitus

Tinnitus is a sound without an external source, heard in one or both ears, or elsewhere in the head. Commonly called ringing in the ears, it can be temporary and resolve on its own, or persist

SEE TINNITUS ON D4

BRAIN MATTERS

The very real benefits of fiction

All books are good for your mind, but imaginary stories do something special

BY RICHARD SIMA

Curling up with a good book isn't just enjoyable. It's also good for your brain.

Reading in general — newspapers, magazines, nonfiction books — has been linked to slower rates of cognitive decline in older adults and even longer lives.

But reading fiction may have unique benefits. For example, the amount of fiction people read seems to be a better predictor of language ability than nonfiction, research finds. And, perhaps even more importantly, research has found that fiction is linked to better social cognition — our ability to think about and interact with other people — and an increased understanding of the world as a complex place.

Why? Fiction forces you to imagine a story's world and characters. It makes you grapple with different perspectives, mentally inhabiting distinct points of view, according to Nick Buttrick, an assistant professor of psychology at the University of Wisconsin at Madison.

This can help us find "better insight into our own experiences, insight into the experiences of others who are very different from us," said Raymond Mar, a professor of psychology at York University in Toronto, who recently wrote a review on the benefits of reading narrative fiction. "It just tends to evoke a form of reflection

SEE FICTION ON D4

FITNESS

Viral workouts make our Spidey senses tingle, but Tom Holland's routine really can help you get stronger in short bursts. D6



GUT

If you've ever had food poisoning, it's worth knowing about this condition that lingers long after the illness. D3

BRAIN

Getting older seems to lessen the sting of regrets. It's not the only silver lining to going gray. D5

Standing more may cut risk of 13 cancers



Your Move

GRETCHEN REYNOLDS

To reduce your risks for at least 13 types of cancer, jog up and down the nearest steps for three minutes or stand up from your desk or couch for 30.

Either strategy might help drop your risks of certain cancers by as much as 7 percent, according to a new study of how the ways we move — and don't move — during the day affect our chances of malignancies.

The study, published in July in BMC Medicine, is one of the first to examine in detail how replacing sitting time with almost any kind of activity alters cancer risk.

Relying on extensive activity data from nearly 60,000 men and women, it used statistical models to determine which movements, from standing to strolling to rushing around the block, seem most strongly associated with fewer cancer cases, including breast, colorectal and lung cancers.

"The reassuring finding is that every movement contributed," said John J. Mitchell, a senior research fellow at University College London's Institute of Sport, Exercise & Health, and the study's lead author.

But they didn't contribute equally.

SEE YOUR MOVE ON D6

The most common type of cancer is easy to miss. Here’s what to look for.

BY LINDSEY BEVER

Basal cell carcinoma is the most common type of cancer, affecting 1 in 5 adults in the United States during their lifetimes. Yet it can be easy to miss.

Alexa Frank thought the small, pink, flaky spot on her nose was an acne scar or eczema, a condition that causes dry, itchy skin.

It turned out to be basal cell carcinoma.

“I was completely shocked. I remember thinking, ‘I’m 23. How could I have skin cancer?’” said Frank, now 24, of Syosset, New York.

As in Frank’s case, basal cell carcinoma often can start off looking like a small, skin-colored bump, sore or scaly patch — easily mistaken for dry skin or a pimple on the mend. While very rarely life-threatening, it can grow deep into the skin, which is why experts said early detection is important for the best recovery.

Basal cell carcinoma can affect anyone, but it’s more common in people older than 40, those who are light-skinned, have a history of skin cancer or are immunocompromised, said Kelly Nelson, a professor of dermatology at the University of Texas MD Anderson Cancer Center in Houston.

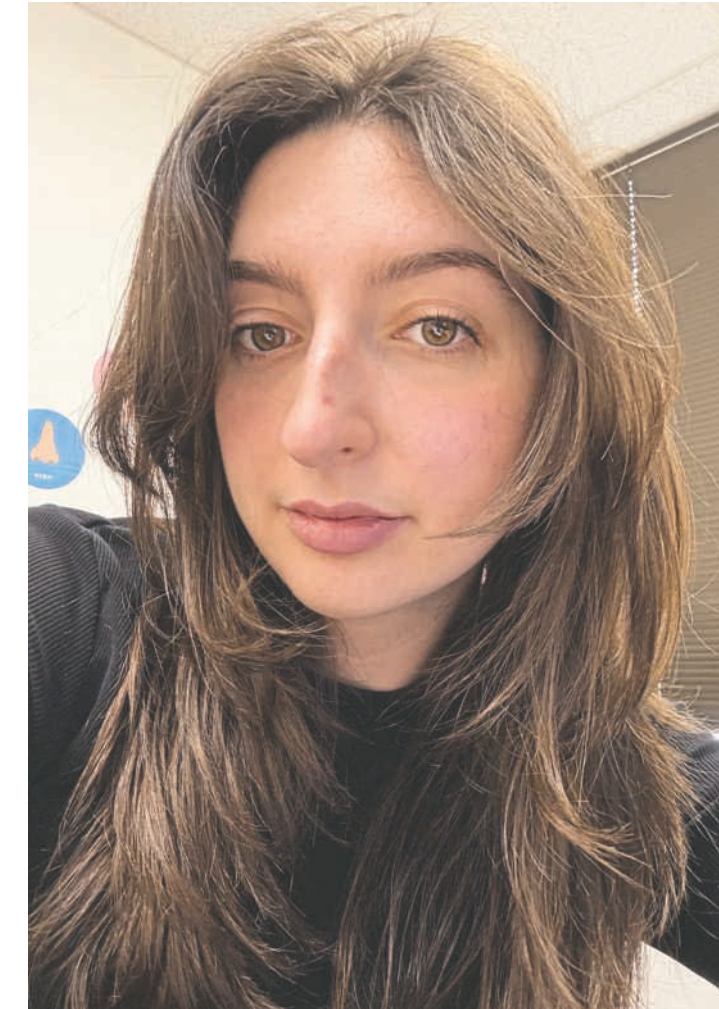
Here are some other things dermatologists and patients want you to know about basal cell carcinoma, including how to prevent it.

What to look for

Basal cell carcinoma often appears on the face — particularly the nose, ears or bare scalp — as well as other areas with increased sun exposure, such as the neck, shoulders, arms and hands. It rarely spreads to other parts of the body, though it can grow into nearby tissue.

“I liken it to rust on a car. It’s not going to stop your engine, but it is something that we want to stop when it’s a small problem because if we let it get out of hand, it can become an issue, particularly if it’s close to important structures,” such as your eyes, Nelson said.

Depending on the type, it can form as a nodular bump with tiny blood vessels; a superficial



LEFT: Alexa Frank, 24, of Syosset, New York, after a biopsy of the small, pink, flaky spot on her nose, which she initially thought was an acne scar or eczema. It turned out to be basal cell carcinoma. RIGHT: Frank after two surgeries to treat her skin cancer.



patch that looks like dry skin; or a flat, firm scar-like lesion that can extend deeper beneath the skin, making it more difficult to treat, according to the American Academy of Dermatology.

Because basal cell carcinoma can be difficult for the untrained eye to spot, Nelson suggested using the “ugly duckling sign” — a self-check method that involves looking for a mole, spot or patch that looks different from any other on your body and then having it evaluated by a dermatologist. Additionally, a new hard, pink bump, a new sore, or a spot that bleeds and does not heal within a few weeks should be assessed, she said.

Although it’s best to identify it early, this type of skin cancer is typically slow-growing, expanding by an average of about 2 to 3

millimeters per year, Nelson said. So even if you don’t catch it on your own, as long as you’re diligent about getting routine annual dermatologic examinations, it can usually be found and treated before it causes significant problems, she said.

Treatments for basal cell carcinoma

Once basal cell carcinoma is diagnosed through a biopsy, the recommended treatment may vary based on the type as well as the growth’s size, location and whether it is a new or returning cancer.

For higher-risk growths, Mohs surgery is the preferred treatment.

During Mohs surgery, a specialized dermatologist called a Mohs surgeon removes thin lay-

ers of cancerous tissue one at a time and examines each under a microscope until no more cancer cells are seen. Once the margins are clear, either the Mohs surgeon or a plastic surgeon will reconstruct the area, said Anthony Rossi, a dermatologist and Mohs surgeon at the Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center in New York.

Stephanie Townes, 35, of Charlotte, had Mohs surgery to remove nodular basal cell carcinoma in 2025. She had been aware of a small, translucent mole next to her nose for years. But then it started to grow, itch and bleed. Initially, she decided to have it removed for cosmetic reasons.

But her dermatologist told her it was skin cancer.

“I was kind of laughing at the irony since I went in for vanity

reasons, and it ended up being this news that I didn’t expect at all,” she said.

In retrospect, however, she said she was at higher risk. A competitive swimmer, she spent much of her adolescence in the sun, and her dad has had multiple surgeries to treat basal cell carcinoma, she said.

This year, Frank also had Mohs surgery. She then had plastic surgery to repair the area. “I went from having a tiny, pink spot that I was barely worried about to having a ton of stitches and a scar that was at least five times the size of the actual skin cancer,” she said.

Depending on the type, basal cell carcinoma can be removed surgically or through less-invasive procedures, such as using a scraping tool and electric cur-

Avoiding these 3 risk factors might buy you 13 more dementia-free years

BY ERICA SLOAN

The link between cardiovascular health and dementia is well established; research shows that what’s good for your heart generally is also good for your brain. Now, a new study suggests that avoiding a few specific risk factors in adulthood could allow you to live a greater portion of your life without dementia — roughly 13 more years.

The study, published in *Neurology Open Access*, explored how vascular risk factors at midlife may affect the age at which people develop dementia and when they die of other causes. The finding underscores the importance of good cardiovascular health in middle age: It seems to give you more years free of dementia compared with your peers, said Josef Coresh, the study’s senior investigator and founding director of the Optimal Aging Institute at NYU Langone.

To start, the researchers measured three risk factors in more than 12,400 middle-aged people (on average, 56 years old): whether they had high blood pressure, had diabetes and currently smoked. (None of them had dementia when the study began.) Then, the researchers followed these participants for about 30 years, periodically conducting cognitive tests at in-person visits and via phone, and using medical records to identify who got dementia and who died without developing dementia.

In the end, people with zero of the tracked risk factors skirted dementia for 30.1 years, compared with just 17.5 in those with all three risk factors.

What the study shows about how vascular risk factors affect aging

While prior studies have tied various measures of poor heart health at midlife to greater dementia risk, these results have mostly reflected population-level patterns and relative lifetime risk. What this new study adds is a clearer picture of how vascular risk factors affect a person’s aging trajectory: The more you have at midlife, the fewer years you may live with no cognitive issues.

Each additional risk factor — high blood pressure, diabetes or smoking — was tied to about four fewer years of dementia-free survival, Coresh said, such that



High blood pressure is among the risk factors that, if avoided in adulthood, could allow you to live a greater part of your life dementia-free.

those with one risk factor lived 26.3 years without dementia and those with two risk factors lived 21 years without dementia.

Some of that drop is the result of people with any of these heart-related risk factors dying sooner of non-dementia causes; the rest reflects people with such risk factors getting dementia earlier in life. Avoiding both outcomes — which the researchers described as dementia-free survival — is what people truly care about, said Heather Whitson, director of the Duke Center for the Study of Aging and Human Development, who was not involved in the study. “Yes, people want to live longer, but nobody wants to outlive their brain.”

Though the link between vascular risk factors and years without dementia held true across all groups, Black participants consistently lived fewer years without dementia than their White counterparts, and women lived

longer without dementia than men — which suggests that the benefits of early intervention might be even more powerful for some than others.

A few limitations of the study include that it was observational and therefore can’t prove that avoiding the risk factors caused a delay in dementia, just that avoiding them is linked to more years without the condition.

The researchers also only checked people’s vascular risk factors at one moment in time. So they weren’t able to capture whether making changes to certain risk factors at a later point in life — for instance, picking up or quitting smoking — would then influence a person’s dementia-free survival.

Why lowering cardiovascular risk factors could stave off dementia

The new study didn’t explore the reasons behind this link, but

based on the growing understanding of what drives dementia, health experts have several possible explanations.

For starters, each of the risk factors in the study can damage blood vessels, which threatens the brain in several ways. If the little vessels inside the brain are harmed, “you get fewer nutrients into the brain and poorer clearance of toxins out of the brain,” Coresh said. “And the brain requires a good supply of oxygen and glucose to every part of it to function.” (A stroke caused by a bigger decrease in blood to the brain can also majorly raise dementia risk, he noted.)

There’s also the “inflammatory reaction” to that vessel damage, Whitson said. The body ramps up inflammation to try to repair vessels, but as a by-product, you can wind up with poor healing, plaque buildup and further inflammation, Coresh said,

which may also affect brain health.

At the same time, vascular disease may “enhance the accumulation of the Alzheimer’s disease proteins like amyloid in the brain,” Coresh added, which would layer on additional risk.

By avoiding high blood pressure, diabetes and smoking, you can help prevent this negative cascade from starting, which may then safeguard your brain.

How to improve your cardiovascular health and protect your brain along the way

Ideally, the goal is to “prevent the onset” of high blood pressure and Type 2 diabetes (the most common type of diabetes, which can sometimes be delayed or prevented with lifestyle changes), and to not smoke at midlife, Coresh said, which often means thinking about these factors and taking action before then. He

rent to remove the growth or even through prescription creams.

The cure rate for certain types of basal cell carcinoma is about 98 to 99 percent, though people who have had one non-melanoma skin cancer are at higher risk of developing another “because it’s a marker of how much UV exposure you’ve had and how much DNA damage you’ve had,” Rossi said.

How to prevent basal cell carcinoma

Since having basal cell carcinoma, both Frank and Townes said they have become vigilant about wearing sunscreen and hats to help protect their skin. Frank even had the windows on her car tinted to reduce UV exposure.

Dermatologists recommend using a broad-spectrum chemical or mineral sunscreen with at least SPF 30 and reapplying it about every two hours, or more often if you’re sweating or swimming. Rossi likes mineral sunscreens because he said they are less irritating for sensitive skin.

For patients with an increased risk of skin cancer, such as those who have had it multiple times, Rossi said he also sometimes recommends taking supplemental nicotinamide, a form of vitamin B3.

Some researchers believe nicotinamide helps restore cellular energy and enhances the skin’s ability to repair UV-induced DNA damage, Rossi said. But consult your doctor before starting nicotinamide, as it can interact with certain medications, including some anticonvulsants, blood thinners and diabetes medications, he said.

In some cases, Rossi also recommends photodynamic therapy, which uses special medicines and light to destroy precancerous non-melanoma cancer cells.

Townes said she still enjoys the outdoors but thinks constantly about the precautions she needs to take, including dermatologic exams every six months.

“I won’t stop doing the activities that I love just because of this. But I’ve become hyper aware of what can happen,” she said.

pointed to the lifestyle tactics included in the American Heart Association’s “Life’s Essential 8,” such as following a diet rich in whole plant foods and engaging in a total of 2.5 hours of moderate physical activity or 75 minutes of vigorous activity per week.

Last year, a large clinical trial found that lifestyle interventions alone — including diet and exercise modifications — could improve cognitive function in people at risk of dementia, Whitson said, which lends credence to the benefit of embracing these behaviors at any point.

If you already have one or more of the vascular risk factors in the new study, and especially if you’re at or approaching midlife, you should know that there are plenty of solutions and resources to help that didn’t exist even 10 years ago, Whitson said. For instance, in the realm of smoking cessation, there are modern text-to-quit programs and multiple nicotine replacement therapies. GLP-1s, a class of medications used for blood sugar and weight management, have also been game-changing for diabetes, and some research even suggests these same drugs could help people stop smoking too, Whitson pointed out. It’s worth starting (or restarting) the conversation with your doctor about the best risk-mitigating tactics for you.

Ultimately, this study adds to an increasing body of evidence that shifting your risk profile in your 50s or 60s can benefit your brain down the line, Whitson said: “Many of us really feel that our best chance of defeating [dementia], which has been stumping the field for a long time, is to start early.”

HEALTH & SCIENCE

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This condition can make it feel like you never fully recovered from a GI infection

BY ERICA SLOAN

The one saving grace when it comes to a stomach bug is that it's typically short-lived. The brutal nausea and vomiting of norovirus, for instance, subsides in one to three days; even the relentless diarrhea of cyclosporiasis can let up in a couple of days with an antibiotic. But after certain gut infections, once the most intense symptoms have resolved, GI troubles can linger, turning into chronic bowel issues and pain. That's the usual course of post-infection irritable bowel syndrome (PI-IBS).

As many as 1 in 10 people who have had some type of gastrointestinal infection go on to develop PI-IBS, research suggests.

At first, you might suspect that you're just not getting over the initial bug — but in reality, the infection “causes damage to the lining of the GI tract, which then subsequently causes the nerves in the gut to become more sensitive,” said Kyle Staller, a gastroenterologist and director of the Gastrointestinal Motility Laboratory at Mass General.

That can translate to irritable bowel syndrome (IBS), he said, which is characterized by a disconnect in communication between the brain and the gut that causes the brain to perceive normal gut contractions as painful.

The symptoms of PI-IBS mirror those of typical IBS, defined by recurrent abdominal pain related to defecation and changes in stool frequency and form, such as diarrhea or constipation. You might also deal with cramping, bloating or gas.

A doctor can diagnose PI-IBS by simply asking about your symptoms and recent medical history — so long as you don't also have any “alarm symptoms,” like bloody stools or unexplained weight loss, which trigger the need for testing to rule out other conditions, Staller said. Any IBS diagnosis also entails having the related symptoms consistently for at least three months.

Read on to learn more about what causes post-infection IBS, who is most at risk and how to find relief.



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Post-infection irritable bowel syndrome is a subtype of this common disorder that's triggered by a gut infection, such as food poisoning.

What causes post-infection irritable bowel syndrome?

Though it isn't fully clear why it occurs, experts have identified a couple of ways it can happen.

For starters, an infection — whether it's caused by a bacterium, virus or parasite — can disrupt the gut microbiome, or the community of microbes that populate the GI tract. “This can be a result of the infection itself, for example, diminishing some of the healthy bacteria, and it can also be caused by how the infection changes the gut lining, so that certain bacteria are more happy to live there than others,” Staller explained. An altered microbiome can then lead to shifts in gut function and the gut nerves, setting the stage for IBS symptoms.

There's also evidence that a stomach bug may cause the gut lining to become more permeable, allowing substances in the

gut such as bile acid, nutrients and by-products of microbes to be more exposed to the gut's immune system, said Lin Chang, a gastroenterologist and director of the Walter and Shirley Wang Center for Integrative Digestive Health at UCLA Health. As the gut's main layer of protection breaks down, the immune system launches a response, releasing chemicals that “act on the nerves in the gut and cause them to increase their firing,” Chang said.

Who is most at risk for PI-IBS?

Several groups who are generally at higher risk for IBS are also at elevated risk for the post-infection type, including women, young people and those with mental health conditions such as anxiety or depression. “The GI infection may be just the straw that breaks the camel's back and brings out that underlying predis-

position,” Staller said.

Experiencing psychological distress while having a stomach bug may also raise the chance that you wind up with PI-IBS afterward, Chang said. This kind of mental state can shift the way the brain reads signals from the gut and responds to them, she explained, which could make you more susceptible to a breakdown in that communication. Stress can also increase intestinal permeability, making your gut less resilient in the face of an infection, she added.

More severe, long-lasting GI illnesses — often caused by parasites and bacteria rather than viruses — are also linked to a greater risk of developing PI-IBS, probably because they can cause more damage to the gut lining, Staller said. Parasitic infections, in particular, can also wax and wane for a while in ways that might make people delay seeking treatment,

Chang pointed out. The more time a parasitic infection goes untreated, the more of an impact it can have on your system — which may then increase the likelihood that you get stuck with PI-IBS.

To note, it's not clear yet if there will be a surge in PI-IBS cases after this summer's cyclosporiasis outbreak; researchers are currently investigating to learn more.

What is the treatment for post-infection IBS?

Some good news: While typical IBS is considered a lifelong condition, “there's evidence to suggest that PI-IBS generally gets better with time,” Chang said, though that could take anywhere from several months to a few years.

Treatment looks mostly the same as it does for typical IBS, which typically starts with dietary adjustments, Chang said, for instance identifying and limiting

trigger foods. These are often foods high in FODMAPs — a type of fermentable carbohydrate — such as onions, garlic, wheat-based products and dairy. (It's best to work with a registered dietitian before diving into a full-scale low-FODMAP diet because it can involve a lot of restriction.) Ramping up fiber intake, including by taking a supplement like psyllium husk, can also help lessen mild symptoms, Staller said.

Then there are therapies that work by minimizing gut spasms, such as over-the-counter peppermint capsules and prescription medications including hyoscyamine and dicyclomine, which Chang said can help with abdominal pain.

And finally, a slate of different medications are geared more specifically toward either diarrhea or constipation-predominant types of IBS. Research suggests most people with PI-IBS have a mixed version (and deal with both issues), followed by diarrhea, then constipation.

The main diarrhea solutions include the prescription eluxadoline, which slows down the bowels, and rifaximin, a minimally absorbed antibiotic. Some doctors also recommend neuromodulators called tricyclic antidepressants, which aren't used much for depression these days but may help IBS by improving nerve signaling, Staller said. Popular constipation options include the prescription medications lubiprostone and linaclotide, which enhance the secretion of chloride into the gut to help raise fluid levels and move stool along, Chang said.

The ideal protocol for you may be anyone or a combination of the above. What's important is to take note of GI symptoms that linger for more than a couple of weeks after a gut infection and flag them to your doctor, Chang said. There's a chance you're dealing with a different beast than the original infection — and need a different kind of care to tackle it.

If that's the case, Staller said, remember that “there's hope” when it comes to PI-IBS that you will ultimately recover with time, “even if you feel like you've exhausted all your options.”

Take these simple steps to avoid common foot problems as you get older

Ask A Doctor

PAUL LANGER

Q: It seems like my feet develop new aches and pains every year. What can I do to reduce the

discomfort and avoid more foot issues as I get older?

A: Every day, your feet carry you over thousands of steps and are subjected to tons of walking impact. It is easy to take this for granted until foot pain turns normal daily activities and fitness routines into painful ordeals.

Common, highly treatable foot conditions not only have the potential to sideline you from the physical activities you love, but they can also begin to dictate daily choices, transforming something as simple as selecting a shoe into a stressful negotiation between fashion, comfort and pain.

Like other parts of the body, feet change over time. With age, the foot may lose some range of motion and tactile sensation and strength, and conditions such as bunions, plantar fasciitis, hammertoes and changes in the arch or forefoot can become more common. These all may alter how shoes fit and can contribute to pain.

As a podiatrist, I see patients every day who feel defeated by their foot pain, but keeping your feet healthy and active doesn't always require a trip to the doctor's office. Often, the most powerful relief comes from a few simple, consistent adjustments to your daily routine and a thoughtful approach to the shoes you wear.

Here's how to manage three of the most common foot concerns I see in adults in midlife and beyond.

Heel pain

Heel pain, often caused by plantar fasciitis, which is inflammation and degeneration of the plantar fascia (a band of tissue that runs along the bottom of the foot and supports the arch), usually appears as pain on the bottom of the heel and may radiate into the arch. Reduced ankle and big-toe range of motion, decreased foot strength and weight gain have all been implicated as contributing factors.

Some studies suggest that plantar fasciitis may resolve on its own over time. If it doesn't,

comfortably supporting the arch, doing targeted stretching exercises and reducing high impact activities can reduce pain.

Many people instinctively try to cushion the heel, but a better starting strategy is often to support the arch firmly with an off-the-shelf insole. Insoles should be selected much like shoes: Try them on and choose the option that feels best. Better-quality insoles typically cost between \$30 and \$70. Some sandals also have firm arch support that can help with heel pain.

Gently stretching the Achilles tendon as well as the plantar fascia multiple times each day has been shown to relieve pain for up to 70 percent of people.

In the short term, it is best to minimize going barefoot and wear shoes as often as possible, even indoors, until the pain resolves. In terms of staying active, one of the merciful things about plantar fasciitis is that it usually causes little or no pain during activity and only becomes more painful after sitting, sleeping or as the day goes on. I tell my patients that it is okay to stay as active as they can tolerate during this time as long as the pain does not worsen.

Bunions and hammertoes

The most common toe changes I see include hammertoes and bunions. One study found that 36 percent of women over age 65 had bunions, a bony protrusion at the base of the big toe joint caused by alignment changes. Another study found that more than 60 percent of older adults had toe deformities, like hammertoes, which are structural changes that cause one of the small toes to start to curl in a downward direction. In both cases, the prevalence increases with age.

These conditions often begin with joint and muscle imbalances in the foot and may progress to stiff, contracted toes that gradually become painful. This then leads to toe alignment changes, which can alter shoe fit and forefoot pressure during walking, leading to more pain and misalignment in the toes themselves, pain in other areas such as the metatarsals (the long bones of the midfoot) and an increased risk of falling.

Many of my patients have already tried toe spacers and

digital pads (bandage-like toe wraps that protect from friction) before their office visit but these are doomed to fail if the shoe does not have adequate space to accommodate them. There is some research that shows that changing footwear and starting physical therapy may be able to slow bunion progression if it's recognized and started early enough. Once a bunion or hammertoe becomes stiff and painful, however, conservative measures are often aimed at reducing pressure and improving comfort; at this point, surgery is the only real fix.

Before considering surgery, I advise patients to accommodate their foot shape with shoes that have a less tapered toe box and adequate width. A common misconception is that a wide shoe size alone should reduce forefoot pain. Many wide shoes still have a tapered toe box, which may provide enough room at the ball of the foot but not enough room for the toes.

Calluses

Calluses are the skin's response to pressure or friction. Over time, repeated friction causes the skin to become thicker to protect the soft tissue and bone. A corn is a type of a callus generally described as having a hard center or being located on the toes, but it does not have a separate medical definition and is treated the same, so I will use the term callus to discuss both.

It is not a coincidence that calluses are common on the toes and the bottom of the forefoot, where the mismatch between foot shape and shoe shape is often most pronounced. Unless the pressure causing the thickened skin is addressed, the callus will usually return, even if you see a podiatrist to have it removed.

Calluses between the toes are commonly caused by a stiff, contracted toe pressing against the neighboring toe, shoes that squeeze the toes together, or both. Calluses on the ball of the

foot are typically related to thinning of the plantar fat pad (which provides cushioning under the ball of the foot and can thin over time), and abnormal pressure under the metatarsal heads.

Calluses on the toes can often be managed by choosing shoes that better accommodate the shape of the foot and by using silicone toe sleeves to cushion the bony spots. Calluses under the ball of the foot may improve with cushioned insoles and metatarsal pads that shift pressure away from the painful area. (You can buy all of these items at your local drugstore or online.)

Once you relieve the pressure, skin care can help: a daily exfoliating lotion, such as 40 percent urea, and gentle use of a pumice stone after a bath or shower once or twice a week can reduce thickened skin.

The bottom line

Small, consistent habits can go a long way toward keeping feet



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Insoles should be selected much like shoes: Try them on and choose the option that feels best. Better-quality insoles run about \$30 to \$70.

How to make tinnitus less disruptive to your daily life

TINNITUS FROM DI

and become chronic. The noise can vary from a faint hum to a shrieking wail.

Bruce Hubbard, a psychologist who also has tinnitus, likens his to a smoke alarm. “A smoke alarm is designed to get people’s attention and drive them away. And that’s what [some of us] have in our heads, basically a smoke alarm 24/7,” Hubbard said.

Most people with tinnitus have some level of hearing loss. Mine began with sudden sensorineural hearing loss, a medical emergency that causes abrupt hearing changes and requires early treatment for the best chance of recovery, but tinnitus is also associated with age- or noise-related hearing loss — though it might not always be apparent on hearing tests.

The Tinnitus Handicap Inventory measures how tinnitus affects your daily life, from slight to catastrophic. Two years after my tinnitus began, my score is severe. I miss silence.

The leading theory for why tinnitus occurs is that when the brain receives less auditory information, the central nervous system adapts by increasing neural activity, said Stéphane Maison, director of the Tinnitus Clinic at Mass Eye and Ear, who also has tinnitus. “Tinnitus is not a sound in your ears. Tinnitus is the result of your brain trying to adapt to a lack of information that is no longer coming from your ears,” he said, comparing it to phantom limb pain.

Medical evaluation can identify treatable or less common causes, including earwax, ear infections, head injury, vascular problems, an inner ear disorder, tumor and jaw-joint problems. Some medications, such as powerful antibiotics called aminoglycosides and certain chemotherapy drugs, can cause hearing loss, tinnitus or both.

Strategies to make tinnitus less disruptive to everyday life

There’s no cure for tinnitus, “but we’re working on it,” Maison said. (For some people with hearing loss, hearing aids or cochlear implants — surgically implanted devices that directly stimulate the auditory nerve — can improve hearing and may reduce tinnitus.)

Tinnitus treatment is often focused on changing your perception of and reaction to the noise. “The idea is not so much to make the sound go away, although that’d be great, but to help that person coexist with this thing they don’t like by improving their understanding and their ability to rationally think about it,” said Marc Fagelson, an audiologist and professor who has tinnitus and works with veterans.

Treatment options include the following:

- Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT), a type of talk therapy that focuses on recognizing and changing unhelpful thought patterns and resulting behaviors, has the clearest evidence for reducing tinnitus-related distress.
- Acceptance and commitment therapy (ACT), another type of psychotherapy that focuses more



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Tinnitus, often described as ringing in the ears, can cause profound distress. While there’s no proven cure, there are a few things you can try to reduce its impact.

on accepting thoughts and changing how you relate to them, may also be effective, though it can feel initially counterintuitive to people searching for a cure. “Acceptance is a practical choice,” Hubbard said.

• Tinnitus retraining therapy (TRT) aims to promote habituation, the process of paying less attention and reacting less strongly to the sound, through education, counseling and sound therapy. (The propensity to closely monitor and try to control tinnitus can keep your attention focused on the noise, making it harder to tune out.)

• Tinnitus activities treatment (TAT) focuses on addressing four problem areas: thoughts and emotions, hearing and communication, sleep and concentration. Individualized treatment may include counseling, communication and hearing strategies, exercises to redirect attention and sound therapy.

Mindfulness practices may help some people cope. Acupuncture, yoga and meditation have not been shown to treat tinnitus directly, but Maison said people who find these activities relaxing can use them to reduce overall stress.

James Henry, a retired tinnitus researcher who has tinnitus, sug-

gested listening to an audiobook or podcast to help fall asleep at night. White noise, nature sounds or calming music may help mask tinnitus or make it less noticeable. Tinnitus can feel more intrusive in some situations, such as when you’re in a quiet room, because there are no external sounds to mask the ringing, or after exposure to a very loud environment. (Some people with tinnitus also experience hyperacusis, a hypersensitivity to everyday sounds.)

Having a strong support system can help reduce isolation, which people with tinnitus may feel if they avoid social situations because of difficulty following conversations, low tolerance of noisy environments or fear that their tinnitus will worsen. But staying socially engaged is important, Fagelson said.

Anxiety and depression may worsen tinnitus distress, and tinnitus may also contribute to anxiety and depression. While antidepressants or anti-anxiety medications can’t resolve tinnitus itself, they may be helpful for addressing any mental health concerns related to the condition.

Tinnitus related to a traumatic incident can be associated with PTSD, Fagelson said. Tinnitus is the most common disability for

U.S. veterans. Military service can involve repeated exposure to damaging noise, including gunfire and explosions, which can trigger lasting tinnitus. “The potential is there for the tinnitus to serve as a trauma reminder and be extremely burdensome in that regard,” Fagelson said.

Although the sound may persist when trying the above tactics, many people may adapt over time and find it bothers them less or they eventually notice it less. “The brain is highly capable of adapting to it and even screening it out,” Hubbard said.

What doesn’t the evidence support? Supplements such as zinc, Ginkgo biloba, magnesium and Lipo-Flavonoid are touted online as offering relief, but studies have not shown they reliably improve tinnitus and guidelines from the American Academy of Otolaryngology-Head and Neck Surgery Foundation specifically recommend against using supplements to treat tinnitus. And while some people say that certain triggers fluctuate the volume of their tinnitus, including caffeine, salt and alcohol, research doesn’t back up any specific dietary changes.

Emerging technologies

Bimodal neuromodulation, which stimulates two sensory

systems at once to prompt changes in the brain, has emerged in recent years as a potential treatment for some people with tinnitus. Lenire, a prescription device that pairs sound delivered through headphones with mild electrical stimulation of the tongue, was authorized by the Food and Drug Administration in 2023 to temporarily relieve tinnitus symptoms in adults with at least moderate tinnitus. (That authorization does not establish that the device cures tinnitus or works for everyone.)

Susan Shore, an auditory neuroscientist and researcher at the University of Michigan, developed another bimodal neuromodulation device that works a little differently. It pairs sounds tailored to a person’s tinnitus with precisely timed stimulation on the face or neck, with the aim of altering abnormal neural activity associated with tinnitus.

Studies on these devices have been relatively small and largely conducted by the companies and researchers behind the devices so more independent research is needed. (Also of note: Lenire is offered only through audiologists, and according to the company’s website, is not broadly covered by major commercial insurance plans or Medicare.)

The ultimate goals: Habituation and acceptance

Without a proven way to silence chronic tinnitus, the most realistic long-term goal is habituation, Henry said. “Habituation means not paying attention to your tinnitus most of the time. And when you do pay attention to it, you don’t react to it.”

Henry said he’s fully habituated and comfortable with his tinnitus, despite it being loud. “I hate it. I wish it would go away,” he said. “I wish there was a cure, but otherwise, I can live with it.”

Hubbard compared tinnitus to losing a loved one and processing grief and loss. “I’ve got to somehow make peace with that in order to move on,” he said. He suggested focusing on your values and the life you want to live, while acknowledging that tinnitus can be extremely difficult to deal with.

When my tinnitus first started, I couldn’t imagine spending one waking minute without noticing it. While I still make daily adjustments, avoid noisy restaurants and listen to white noise, I can now spend hours without consciously noticing my tinnitus or letting it rule my life.

For now, that’s success.

Books are good for your brain, but fiction has a surprising added benefit

FICTION FROM DI

and contemplation, which can only be good for us.”

Why reading is actually social

Social health is important for overall health. And it turns out that reading, though often thought of as a solitary activity, can boost our social abilities.

To understand why, it helps to look at how reading shapes us as we grow.

Between ages 4 and 6, children develop a theory of mind — the ability to understand that others have different beliefs, perspectives and feelings. Studies find that children exposed to more storybooks are further along this developmental milestone than those exposed to fewer ones, Mar said.

A 2025 meta-analysis of 21 studies found that children who read more storybooks had more empathy. And there is evidence that empathy and reading go both ways. Better reading comprehension was a predictor of empathy later in life, while empathy also was a predictor of better reading ability, according to a 2024 study of more than 900 children. And adolescents who read more for fun became more social adults, a 2023 study found.

Reading fiction “presents to us a complex cognitive and emotional simulation of the social world,” which is useful in the real world, Mar said.

The power of storytelling

These benefits may be due, in part, to the power of storytelling.

Neuroimaging studies find that brain networks involved in understanding stories overlap with brain networks needed for theory of mind. This suggests that “while engaging with stories, we’re also pulling online the same kinds of brain networks that we use to understand other people,” said Mar, who wrote a review about these studies.

Other forms of storytelling, such as television and movies, may provide similar benefits, but “one of the things that you do when you read is you have to construct the world” in your head, Buttrick said. “The world is not given to you. You have to do the work of imagining.”

This extra work may amplify the benefits of engaging in a story.

Spending time with our favorite story characters may also help us feel connected. “Even if our friends aren’t around and can’t get together, we can always open up a book,” Mar said.

Reading can be a social activity, too, one that reinforces the joys and benefits of reading. Book clubs, shared reading organizations and social media communities like BookTok can connect us with other readers and add yet another layer to building our social cognitive abilities.

Talking to others about the books you read means you’re not only imagining the characters in

a story, but also gaining an understanding of how other people respond to those characters, Buttrick said.

Exposure to difference

Beyond helping our social cognition, reading fiction can expand our world and our understanding of its complexities. Good authors are master observers of the human condition and can expose us to experiences outside our comfort zone.

Reading fiction can help us find “better insight into our own experiences, insight into the experiences of others who are very different from us. It just tends to evoke a form of reflection and contemplation, which can only be good for us.”

Raymond Mar, professor of psychology at York University in Toronto

“Reading is an encounter with difference, with a different kind of mind, a different place, a different approach to the world,” Buttrick said. “And so a lot of the places where I think reading is most interesting are in places where it smashes this up with difference as strongly as it can.”

In a 2022 study of more than 5,000 people published in *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*, Buttrick and his colleagues

found that those who grew up reading more literary fiction were more likely to become adults with more complex worldviews — with more nuance, more psychological richness and intellectual humility.

“I think if we want to live in a world in which everyone’s treated as something like an individual, knowing that the world is complex, especially socially complex, is probably really good,” he said.

But there are inherent difficul-

ties with studying the effects of reading because “reading is a part of a person’s life,” Buttrick said. “And when people have more time, more space to read, more inclination to read, they’re not doing that at random.”

Benefits probably take time to accrue, and socioeconomic status is a strong predictor of reading behavior and ability, though a 2025 study of more than 14,000 students found that leisure read-

ing had the largest benefits for children whose parents had less education.

“Successful art resonates with a great number of people because it captures something about being human that appeals to us and maybe that we don’t fully understand,” Mar said.

How to read more

Start slow. Mar recommends getting off your phone before going to bed and spending that time reading instead. “Maybe you have to build up to an hour,” he said. “But you can start with 15 minutes and then work to 30 minutes, then 45 in an hour before you go to sleep. It’s probably a good thing.”

Cultivate a habit. Consistency is key. “I don’t think that any one book will change a person’s life,” Buttrick said. “I think it’s the accretion of lots of books, you know, reading again and again and again, that really has an effect on how people think about the world more broadly.”

Dive into the vast diversity of reading. Different forms of reading — short stories, graphic novels and fan fiction, for example — also count. Given his busy work schedule and reading of academic journals, Mar prefers to read short stories. “It’s hard for me to commit to a book,” said Mar, who has most recently read the works of Irish writer Claire Keegan.

(Buttrick is currently reading Spencer Ackerman’s “Reign of

Terror” and gearing up to read William Vollmann’s 3,000-plus-page novel, “A Table for Fortune.” And I’ve been reading through my collection of Terry Pratchett, who is a hilarious satirical writer, including “Small Gods,” which tackles religion, and “The Truth,” which is about journalism.)

Audiobooks can be beneficial, too. Buttrick said audiobooks still count as reading. In fact, the format may make certain books easier to grasp. Listening to James Joyce’s “Ulysses” not only makes it easier to understand and funnier, but also makes “you realize how much of it is just a song,” Buttrick said.

Remember that reading should be enjoyable. “I don’t think of reading as a monastic experience that you have to do alone at night in order to grow as a person,” Buttrick said. Lean into what you enjoy.

Make it social. Book clubs are excellent and flourishing. It’s nice to have an accountability partner and others with whom to share perspectives, Buttrick said.

Read unselfconsciously. Reading is for enjoyment. “A lot of times people seem embarrassed about the things that they’ve been reading,” Mar said. But “there’s nothing to be embarrassed about whatever you’re reading.”

Do you have a question about human behavior or neuroscience? Email BrainMatters@washpost.com and we may answer it in a future column.

WELL+BEING

You really do get wiser as you age. Here are 3 silver linings to going gray.

BY RICHARD SIMA

When people think about getting older, many picture an inevitable decline in health.

But that isn't always the case. You can improve with age, both mentally and physically. This mindset may even be beneficial; having negative ideas about aging is linked to worse health outcomes, almost like a self-fulfilling prophecy.

While the aging process, like life as a whole, varies from person to person, research shows that there are aspects of brain health that can actually continue improving well past your midlife. Here are three examples of the silver linings to going gray.

Fewer regrets

Living without regrets is a common maxim but an uncommon reality. About 90 percent of people say they have at least one major life regret, research shows.

"Many of us might worry that we will reach the end of life and have these really big regrets that we can never resolve, and they may take some solace in knowing that that is a very, very common experience," said Julia Nolte, an assistant professor of economic psychology at Tilburg University in the Netherlands.

But getting older seems to lessen both the sting and the frequency of regrets.

In a recent study published in the journal *Emotion*, Nolte and her colleagues analyzed how age affected feelings of major regret in 90 adults ranging in age from 21 to 89. Older adults reported they had fewer major regrets within the past year than younger adults. In fact, older adults were more likely to say they didn't have any recent regrets. And when older adults



ILLUSTRATION BY GEORGE WYLESOL/ FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

did have a major recent regret, they were less likely to be about relationships or their dealings with other people.

In older adults, major regrets both recent and lifelong were more likely to be about missed opportunities or the road not taken. Also, older adults had fewer "hot" emotions such as anger or frustration in response to thoughts of what might have been.

"Older adults tend to be more likely to say, 'I don't have recent

big regrets,'" and when they do, the negative emotions are less impactful, said Nolte, who conducted the study when she was a psychology graduate student at Cornell University. "I think that that's something to look forward to and to help decrease these age-related negative stereotypes a lot of us carry."

More knowledge

As you age, you might be more forgetful and slower at mental processing. But on average, older

adults actually perform better on tests requiring knowledge or language.

For example, adults in their 70s and 80s scored higher on vocabulary knowledge than those in the 20s, 30s and 40s, according to a large 2019 study.

Your ability to quickly reason through and adapt to new situations — called fluid intelligence — tends to peak in early to middle adulthood, around your 20s by some measures.

But your ability to apply all your

accumulated experiences, facts and skills — known as crystallized intelligence — remains stable or continues to improve through the seventh decade of life, research finds.

A 2022 study, which followed almost 9,000 adults for up to 18 years, found normal age-related decline of fluid abilities was still largely linked with increased crystallized abilities.

As you get older, your hard-won knowledge and experience may still be growing.

More wisdom

Older people may not only continue to grow in knowledge, but also in wisdom.

Wisdom is a complex personality trait that includes having empathy and compassion, as well as the ability to self-reflect, self-regulate and accept different perspectives, said Dilip Jeste, a geriatric neuropsychiatrist and president of the World Federation for Psychotherapy, who has researched wisdom since 2008.

Having higher wisdom is linked to better overall health and emotional well-being throughout the lifespan, research shows.

There's evidence that older adults on average measure higher than younger adults on different components of wisdom, including empathy, emotional regulation and self-reflection, Jeste said.

Not everyone who gets old is necessarily wise — there are many ready examples to the contrary. But by and large, "people who have these components of wisdom, as they get older, they tend to become wiser," said Jeste, who wrote a 2025 review on wisdom and aging.

For example, during the isolation of the covid-19 pandemic, everyone felt lonelier. But unexpectedly, older people generally fared better with their mental health than younger people.

When researchers asked why the older people had better resilience despite being at higher risk, "they said, we have been through problems like this before when we were growing up," said Jeste, who wrote about this finding.

And they had made it through.

Do you have a question about human behavior or neuroscience? Email BrainMatters@washpost.com and we may answer it in a future column.

I developed a sun allergy out of nowhere. It's more common than you think.

BY CASEY GUEREN

It was my third day in St. Martin when I noticed the tiny, itchy bumps on my legs. They were smaller than hives but more rash-like than bug bites. I figured I had just gotten too much sun, given that this was the first time my body had seen prolonged sunlight after an especially harsh winter. But I had been diligent with sunscreen and shade — not even a hint of sunburn. So I lathered back up and spent my last day at the pool.

Several nights later, home in New York City, I noticed the same tiny red bumps crop up on the tops of my arms; the rash now painting an itchy line from my shoulder to the crook of my elbow, down to my forearm. Benadryl and cortisone cream calmed things down a bit, but it flared up every night and morning for a week before finally disappearing.

I assumed it was a contact allergy and blamed all the usual suspects: hotel detergent, a new sunscreen, a hair serum that may have migrated to my arms while I slept. But it kept coming back. After a few months of trial and error and allergy testing, I finally went to my dermatologist. She listened to the story, zoomed in on pictures of the rash in my camera roll, and asked whether I had ever heard of PMLE: polymorphous light eruption.

It turns out, I'm allergic to the literal sun.

What is polymorphous light eruption?

Polymorphous light eruption (PMLE) is a delayed skin reaction to UV radiation, and it's actually the most common photosensitive condition, said Hana Ahmed, board-certified dermatologist and dermatopathologist in Florida. It can show up hours or days after exposure, so most people don't automatically think to blame the sun.

"They call it polymorphous because it can look like a lot of different things, but it's usually always the same pattern in one individual," said double board-certified dermatologist Jennifer Tran, who sees this a lot where she practices in Ontario, Canada. That pattern can range from small, raised bumps to larger hives, blisters, eczema-like patches or plaques.

It tends to appear on the outside of the arms, forearms and chest, though it can also occur on the legs, upper back and rarely the face. Redness and itch are pretty standard. (Fair warning before you Google the condition: There's a wide variety of presentations, and the photos in search results tend to show more severe, widespread reactions.)



CASEY GUEREN

The author in Sardinia last month — the first vacation she has taken since finding out she had PMLE, or polymorphous light eruption.

It's not unusual for this condition to show up randomly in adulthood, though family history is a strong predictor, Tran said. PMLE can happen to anyone at any age, but being female between the ages of 20 and 40 and having a history of being sensitive to the sun can increase your risk, too. PMLE is more common in certain geographic areas, with research showing a 10 to 20 percent prevalence in Northern Europe and less common in people who live closer to the equator.

What causes PMLE?

"We don't know exactly why it happens, but the working theory is that it's a delayed immune reaction, almost like an allergic reaction to your own skin after it's been altered from UV damage," Ahmed said.

Typically, when your skin is exposed to UV rays, it causes both cell damage and an immunosuppressive effect. The latter is meant to prevent your skin from overreacting to the sun, Ahmed explained.

In people with PMLE, that local immunosuppression is faulty; the immune system mistakes the molecules that form in the skin as a result of UV exposure as threatening. It then mounts an immune response against the perceived invader, causing an itchy rash — similar to what happens with a contact allergy to a skin care ingredient or poison ivy, Ahmed said. Dermatologists call this a type IV or delayed hypersensitivity, she explained.



ISTOCK

An example of PMLE, which takes different forms, from small bumps to larger hives, blisters, eczema-like patches or plaques.

PMLE seems to be triggered by UVA radiation more than UVB radiation, so some people even get the reaction through car windows (which don't reliably block UVA rays).

It usually happens in the early spring with the first significant sun exposure of the year. Apparently my March getaway to the Caribbean was the perfect PMLE trigger.

Over the course of spring and summer, flares tend to become less intense as your skin becomes less sensitive, explained Lindsay Boyers, a board-certified dermatologist at Boulder Medical Center in Colorado. Dermatologists call this process "photohardening."

How to prevent a flare

I was relieved to hear that having a sun allergy doesn't necessarily mean I have to hide out in my apartment for the rest of my life. But it does mean being more proactive about sun protection. Here are some things you can do to reduce your chances of experiencing a flare.

Phototherapy: For people with severe, recurring flare-ups of PMLE, phototherapy is a safe way to help "harden" the skin and get it used to more UV exposure. Unlike what you would get in a tanning bed or outside, phototherapy exposes you to just narrow-band UVB, which can reduce inflammation and help produce that immunosuppressive effect.

Treatment typically involves going to the dermatologist's office two to three times a week for several weeks at the start of spring, which can be inconvenient or inaccessible for some. Some people might find a similar benefit from gradually increasing their exposure to natural sunlight in the spring, Tran said, ideally in the morning for 10 to 15 minutes a day.

SPF and UPF: All the experts recommended wearing broad-spectrum sunscreen that blocks both UVA and UVB rays, with at least 30 SPF. But unfortunately, PMLE doesn't seem to be completely deterred by even the strongest sunscreens, so you'll need to layer in more sun protection strategies, like hats, shade and UPF clothing.

"I am a huge proponent of UPF clothing, which means it's been treated to be sun protective," Boyers said. "Mostly because sunscreen only works as well as you use it." This lets you stay protected even while you're in the water.

Polypodium leucotomos supplement: Both Boyers and Ahmed take a supplement to help prevent their own PMLE flare-ups. The extract of *Polypodium leucotomos*, a type of tropical fern, is sold in various supplements. "It doesn't fully protect you from the sun, but it does provide a little bit of extra protection because it's a potent antioxidant," Tran said.

The research is still emerging but promising: A 2011 Italian

study of 57 people (53 with PMLE and 4 with solar urticaria, another sun-induced skin reaction) found that nearly 74 percent had fewer reactions and symptoms after sun exposure when taking the supplement. A 2018 systematic review looked at 18 studies on *Polypodium leucotomos* (most of which involved Fernblock, the patented formulation used in Heliocare) and found it to have photoprotective effects with no serious adverse effects, but the review noted the need for more research on other formulations. (The review was partially funded by the company that makes Heliocare.) "The studies on Polypodium are very small," Ahmed added. But it's widely used for a lot of photo-related rashes, she noted, "things like vitiligo, melasma and anything that could be mitigated by UV exposure."

How to soothe the skin during a flare

If, despite your best efforts, you end up with a rash, a topical corticosteroid — such as over-the-counter hydrocortisone cream or a prescription-strength option from your dermatologist — can help calm things down, Boyers said.

You can also try taking a second-generation antihistamine like cetirizine hydrochloride (Zyrtec) or fexofenadine hydrochloride (Allegra), which are preferable to diphenhydramine hydrochloride (Benadryl) because they last longer and come with fewer side effects, Boyers said. Your doctor may instruct you to take one of these medications more frequently to control the itch, Boyers said. In severe cases, they might prescribe oral steroids.

As much as possible, try to stay out of the sun while your skin heals. "Strict sun avoidance forever is not recommended, as natural photohardening would not occur," Ahmed explained. "But during an acute flare, sun should be avoided until the lesions have resolved, typically about one week. After the eruption resolves, gradual, controlled exposure can help prevent recurrence through photohardening."

If I can offer anyone else a little hope in the meantime, I can confirm that my own flares have gotten less intense over the course of the summer and as I've implemented the above expert tips. While I'm not thrilled that this might be a yearly occurrence, it was comforting to hear from my dermatologist (and these experts) that I don't have to let it stop me from booking my next trip. I'll just try to save any tropical destinations for later in the season and make room in my carry-on for my ever-expanding sun protection tool kit.



Jogging up and down the nearest steps for three minutes or standing up from your desk or couch for 30 might help drop your risks of certain cancers by as much as 7 percent, according to a new study.

Sitting less and moving more may lower risk of 13 cancers

YOUR MOVE FROM D1

“Some choices,” Mitchell said, “proved more beneficial than others.”

Is standing up good for us?

On average, American adults sit for nearly 10 hours a day, studies show. Being so sedentary is not good for us. Substantial evidence links uninterrupted sitting with heightened risks for heart disease, Type 2 diabetes, obesity and other conditions.

Sitting also makes us more vulnerable to many cancers, studies show.

Ideally, we should reduce the amount of time we spend seated every day and be more physically active instead.

But how? Does standing up count? Do we need to move around? Is it enough to meander slowly down the hallway? Or should we raise our heart rates and break a sweat?

Those questions matter because many of us are tied to our desks and schedules. In that

case, what are the most realistic and efficient options for sitting less?

The link between activity and cancer risk

Past studies of sitting and health generally focused on one change, such as standing more often, and not multiple types of movement and how they might affect sitting’s health risks in comparison to one another.

They didn’t tell us, in other words, if standing up for a few minutes would undo the effects of sitting as potently as climbing stairs.

So, for the new study, the scientists drew records for 59,218 adult men and women who’d joined the large-scale UK Biobank health study and worn a sophisticated activity tracker for a week.

Using machine learning algorithms, the researchers parsed everyone’s activity data and determined how much time they spent sitting (generally around 10 hours) or in other activities

on most days, including standing up; light movement, such as leisurely walks; moderate activity, meaning brisker walks; or vigorous activities, which would get people breathing hard, such as running to catch a bus.

They also checked medical records for eight years or so after people joined the Biobank, to see whether they’d developed any of 13 cancers that have been associated with inactivity.

The best ways to break up sitting

With those mountains of data, the researchers then created complex, statistical models of what theoretically would happen if people replaced some of their normal sitting time with movement.

First, they looked at standing. Compared to nonstop sitting, standing up for any period of time reduced the cancer risks associated with sitting.

But standing was about half as potent as moving. In general, moving in any way, even short,

gentle strolls, for about 15 minutes dropped cancer risks to the same extent as half an hour of standing.

The gains were even more striking when the researchers focused on different intensities of movement. Again, standing was better than sitting and light activity was better than standing.

But vigorous movement — such as hurrying up and down the stairs or rushing to the subway station — was, by far, the most effective. Three minutes of daily vigorous activity dropped cancer risks to the same extent as 90 minutes of light-intensity movement.

Pick the routine that works for you

“I think these results show there can be different routes” to the same goal, said Emmanuel Stamatakis, a professor of physical activity and health at Monash University in Australia, and senior author of the new study.

If we can’t find 90 minutes to wander around the block or from cubicle to cubicle, we could instead head for the nearest stairwell and jog up and down for a few minutes.

“This is a really interesting paper,” said Lora Giangregorio, an exercise scientist at the University of Waterloo in Canada. She studies physical activity and health but wasn’t involved with the new study. “It is really encouraging that adding movement or standing is associated with reduced risk of cancer. But what stuck out for me was the finding that ‘only three minutes of additional vigorous physical activity in place of any other intensity was associated with lower cancer risk.’”

Many of us can probably find a way to fit those three strenuous minutes into our day.

‘Any movement counts’

The study was observational and shows links between more activity and lower cancer risk but doesn’t prove the additional movement directly caused

that effect.

It also doesn’t explain how moving instead of sitting changes the likelihood of cancer, though muscles release a slew of biochemicals when they contract, Stamatakis said. Some of them likely jump-start physiological processes that dampen the development or progression of cancer.

The study doesn’t say, either, whether we should lump our movement time into a single session or spread those three minutes of speedy or 90 minutes of laid-back activity throughout the day.

More study is needed, Stamatakis and Mitchell agree.

But, for now, the takeaway is to rise from your chair whenever you can, Stamatakis said, even if it’s just to stand.

“Any movement,” he said, “counts.”

Do you have a fitness question? Email YourMove@washpost.com and we may answer your question in a future column.

Tom Holland’s go-to workout can help you get stronger in just 20 minutes

BY ERICA SLOAN

When Tom Holland returned as Peter Parker in “Spider-Man: Brand New Day” on July 31, fans were quick to notice that he looked especially fit. Within a few days, an interview clip of the actor discussing his workouts at an event last year resurfaced and went viral.

Holland told a reporter for Men’s Health UK that when he’s short on time, he does a CrossFit workout called the “Cindy,” which involves doing five pull-ups, 10 push-ups and 15 squats as many times as you can in 20 minutes.

“You don’t have to think about anything, you just count your rounds,” he said in the interview. What makes his take extra-impressive is just how many rounds he said he can complete: “If I’m feeling great,” he said, “I will, you know, just push through. ... I think my record is 27 rounds,” which equates to 810 repetitions total. (Holland’s representative did not respond to a request for comment on the topic.)

While plenty of people have taken to social media to try to beat Holland’s record, you certainly don’t have to hit this many reps to get a great workout. “One of the beauties of this style of workout is that it’s very scalable to the person when done as intended,” said Natalie Ribble, a certified personal trainer at Seattle Strength and Performance.

You can rest in between rounds or move as slowly as needed. It’s also a good way to track progress, she added: If you continue to do

the Cindy, over time, you’ll find that you can layer on additional rounds within the 20 minutes.

Ribble called the three exercises it includes — pull-up, push-up and squat — “meat-and-potatoes movements” because they involve flexing multiple muscles in unison, modeling how we move in day-to-day life. They’re also among the five exercises that longtime Washington Post fitness columnist Gretchen Reynolds has covered as essential for healthy aging.

Doing these moves in succession for 20 minutes is an efficient way to target several key muscle groups at once. That said, all three can be challenging for people new to strength training, so it’s okay to start with fewer reps over a shorter period or swap in an easier variation of each move instead.

Here, Ribble breaks down each exercise in Holland’s go-to quick workout, including how to do it safely, pitfalls to avoid and a modified version for beginners.

Pull-up

Using your arms to hike up your body will target your back muscles while also working out your core and improving your grip strength, Ribble said.

If you’re new to pull-ups or struggle to get your nose to the height of the bar, you can opt for a simple dead hang, Ribble said.

And if *all* moves with your arms overhead are difficult or painful, perhaps because of shoulder mobility issues, you can replace the pull-up with any row-

ing-style exercise (whether with dumbbells or a machine) to similarly target your back muscles, she added.

Push-up

With push-ups, you’ll primarily work out your chest, triceps and shoulders, Ribble said, which covers the remaining upper-body muscles. It’s best to maintain “a strong plank position, not letting the hips sag toward the floor and keeping the shoulder blades down, with elbows tucked to your sides,” she said, to avoid straining your lower back or shoulders.

If a regular push-up feels out of reach, you can do a wall push-up. Modifications that fall between a traditional push-up and a wall push-up in terms of difficulty include push-ups with your hands on, say, the back of a couch, a weight bench or a box on the floor — the closer to the ground you are, the harder it will be.

Ribble recommends these versions over a knee push-up because they involve full-body tension and greater core engagement, which will get you closer to a standard push-up with time.

Squat

Squatting activates the legs, mostly the quadriceps running along the front of the thighs, Ribble said. Be sure to lower down with control, versus just sinking to the bottom of your squat, to maximize the tension and steer clear of knee issues.

Also look out for the tendency to hinge your chest forward and use your back — rather than your

legs — to pump yourself up to standing, Ribble added, which can ultimately cause back problems.

The simplest modification for a typical squat is a chair squat, which involves sitting for a moment during each rep and offers support at the bottom of the movement.

As you cycle through these

moves à la Tom Holland, it’s important to keep in mind whether you are becoming fatigued and adjust as needed, Ribble said. For example, “maybe you start out doing the 10 push-ups in the standard format, and then by Round 5, you’re doing incline push-ups on a bench and by the last round, you’re doing wall push-ups,” Ribble said. Or per-

haps you just begin with a single repetition of each move and add in more when that feels easy.

However you slice it, Holland’s quick workout checks the boxes when it comes to a simple strength routine that exercises much of your body in little time.

“So if that’s what gets you excited to move,” Ribble said, “then, by all means, do it.”



Tom Holland’s routine went viral when fans noticed how fit he looked in the new Spider-Man movie.